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John - Introduction

John

John - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of John

1. Introduction about who Jesus is (1:1–18)
2. John the Baptizer baptizes Jesus, and Jesus chooses 12 disciples (1:19–51)
3. Jesus preaches, teaches, and heals people (2–11)
4. The seven days before Jesus' death (12–19)

- Mary anoints the feet of Jesus (12:1–11)
- Jesus rides a donkey into Jerusalem (12:12–19)
- Some Greek men want to see Jesus (12:20–36)
- The Jewish leaders reject Jesus (12:37–50)
- Jesus teaches his disciples (13–16)
- Jesus prays for himself and his disciples (17)
- Jesus is arrested and undergoes trial (18:1–19:15)
- Jesus is crucified and buried (19:16–42)

1. Jesus rises from the dead (20:1–29)
2. John says why he wrote his Gospel (20:30–31)
3. Jesus meets with the disciples (21)

More detailed outlines are in the introduction for each chapter.

What is the Gospel of John about?
The Gospel of John is one of four books in the New Testament that describe some of the life and teachings of Jesus Christ. These books are called "Gospels," which means "good news." Their authors wrote about different aspects of who Jesus was and what he did. John said that he wrote his Gospel "so that people might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of the living God" (20:31). John's Gospel repeatedly emphasizes that Jesus is God in human form.

John's Gospel is very different from the other three Gospels. John does not include some of the teachings and events that the other writers included in their Gospels. Also, John wrote about some teachings and events that are not in the other Gospels.

John wrote much about the miraculous signs Jesus did to prove that what Jesus said about himself was true. (See: sign, proof, reminder)

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "The Gospel of John" or "The Gospel According to John." Or they may choose a title that may be clearer, such as, "The Good News About Jesus That John Wrote." (See: How to Translate Names)

Who wrote the Gospel of John?
This book does not give the name of the author. However, since early Christian times, most Christians have thought that the apostle John was the author. Further evidence that the apostle John wrote this Gospel is the fact that his name does not occur once within the book. Instead, this Gospel contains the phrases "the disciple whom Jesus loved" or "the other disciple" in places where the other Gospels indicate that John was present (13:23–25; 19:26–27; 20:2–8; 21:7, 20–24). The apostle John most likely referred to himself in this manner because he wanted to humbly say that he had a very close relationship with Jesus. He was part of Jesus' inner circle of disciples who became the "pillars" of the early church (Galatians 2:9).

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

Why does John write so much about the final week of Jesus' life?
John wrote much about Jesus' final week. He wanted his readers to think deeply about Jesus' final week and his death on the cross. He wanted people to understand that Jesus willingly died on the cross so that God could forgive them for sinning against him. (See: sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

Why does Jesus refer to himself as the "Son of Man"?
In the Gospels, Jesus calls himself the "Son of Man." This is a reference to Daniel 7:13–14. In that passage, there is a person who is described as like a "son of man." That means that the person was someone who looked like a human being. God gave authority to this "son of man" to rule over the nations forever. All people will worship him forever.

Jews of Jesus' time did not use "Son of Man" as a title for anyone. But Jesus used it for himself to help them understand who he truly was. (See: Son of Man, son of man)

Translating the title "Son of Man" can be difficult in many languages. Readers may misunderstand a literal translation. Translators can consider alternatives, such as "The Human One." It may also be helpful to include a footnote to explain the title.

John - Chapter 1 Introduction

What does the word "sign" mean in the Gospel of John?
While other New Testament writers use terms like "mighty works" or "wonders" to refer to the miracles that Jesus did, John prefers to use the term "sign." The miracles John calls "signs" were significant displays of divine power. John called them signs to emphasize that an important purpose of Jesus' miracles was to prove that Jesus was God and that what Jesus said about himself was true. John said that in his Gospel he only wrote about some of the signs that Jesus did. John said, "these have been written so that you would believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and so that believing, you would have life in his name" (20:30–31).

What do the words "remain," "reside," and "abide" mean in the Gospel of John?
John often used the words "remain," "reside," and "abide" as metaphors. John spoke of a believer becoming more faithful to Jesus and knowing Jesus better as if Jesus' word "remained" in the believer. John also spoke of someone being spiritually joined to someone else as if the person "remained" in the other person. Christians are said to "remain" in Christ and in God. The Father is said to "remain" in the Son, and the Son is said to "remain" in the Father. The Son is said to "remain" in believers. The Holy Spirit is also said to "remain" in the believers.

Many translators will find it impossible to represent these ideas in their languages in exactly the same way. For example, Jesus intended to express the idea of the Christian being spiritually together with him when he said, "He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood remains in me, and I in him" (6:56). The UST uses the idea of "will be united with me, and I will be united with them," but translators may have to find other ways of expressing the idea.

In the passage, "my words remain in you" (15:7), the UST expresses this idea as "obey what I have taught you." Translators may find it possible to use this translation as a model.

What is double meaning in the Gospel of John?
John occasionally used words or phrases that could have two meanings (double entendre) in the language in which he originally wrote this Gospel. For example, the phrase translated as "born again" in the ULT could also mean "born from above" (3:3, 7). In such cases, you may want to choose one meaning and put the other meaning in a footnote.

What are the major issues in the text of the Gospel of John?
The following verses are found in older versions of the Bible but are not included in most modern versions. Translators are advised not to translate these verses. However, if there are older versions of the Bible in the translators' region that include these verses, then the translators can include them. If they are translated, they should be put inside square brackets ([ ]) to indicate that they were probably not originally in John's Gospel.

- "waiting for the moving of the water. For an angel of the Lord went down into the pool and stirred up the water at certain times, and whoever then first stepped in after the water was stirred was healed from whatever disease he suffered from." (5:3–4)
- "going through the midst of them, and so passed by" (8:59)

The following passage is included in most older and modern versions of the Bible. But it is not in the earliest copies of the Bible. Translators are advised to translate this passage. It should be put inside of square brackets ([ ]) to indicate that it may not have been original to John's Gospel.

- The story of the adulterous woman (7:53–8:11) (See: Textual Variants)

John - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus is God (1:1–5)
2. John the Baptist was Jesus' witness (1:6–8)
3. Summary of Jesus' ministry on earth (1:9–13)
4. Jesus is God in the flesh (1:14–18)
5. John the Baptist prepares the way for Jesus (1:19–34)
6. Jesus meets Andrew, Peter, Philip, and Nathaniel (1:35–51)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 1:23, which are words from the Old Testament.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"The Word"
John uses the phrase "the Word" to refer to Jesus (1:1, 14). This title does not refer to a word that is spoken by someone. By using this title for Jesus, John is saying that Jesus is God's most important message

to all people. Jesus is the one who reveals who God is. As John explains, Jesus is a person who has always existed, who is God, who was active in creation, and who became a man with a physical body. In your translation of this title, try to make it clear that this is the title of a person whose role it is to communicate a message. Something like "The Message" or "The Revealer" might be appropriate, or you might prefer to use the title that is used in an accepted translation in your area. (See: word of God, word of Yahweh, word of the Lord, word of truth, scripture)

Light and Darkness
In 1:4–9, John uses an extended metaphor in which light represents what is true and good and darkness represents what is false and evil. John applies that light metaphor to Jesus in order to show that Jesus is God's truth and goodness displayed in a human body. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

"Children of God"
People are sometimes described as "children of God" because God created them. However, John uses this expression in a different sense in this chapter. He uses it to describe people who have entered into a father-child relationship with God by putting their faith and trust in Jesus. God indeed created all people, but people can only become children of God in this sense by believing in Jesus. "Children" in this usage does not refer to those who are young, but only to the relationship that people have to their father at any age. (See: believe, believer, belief, unbeliever, unbelief)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Metaphors
John uses the metaphors of light and darkness and of "the Word" to tell the reader that he will be writing more about good and evil and about what God wants to tell people through Jesus. (See: Metaphor)

"In the beginning"
Some languages and cultures speak of the world as if it has always existed, as if it had no beginning. But "very long ago" is different from "in the beginning," and you need to be sure that your translation communicates correctly.

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" in this chapter (1:51). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 1:1 (#2)

ὁ λόγος

"the Word"

Here, **the Word** refers to Jesus. It does not refer to a spoken word. The ULT capitalizes **Word** to indicate that this is a title for Jesus. Be sure to retain this title in your translation. Use whatever convention your language uses to indicate that this is a title. If "word" is feminine in your language, it could be translated as "the one who is called the Word." See the discussion in the chapter introduction for more information. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who is the Word]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:1 (#1)

ἐν ἀρχῇ ἦν

"In the beginning was"

This phrase refers to the very earliest time before God created the heavens and the earth. It does not refer to time in the distant past. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Before the beginning of the universe there was] or [Before the universe began there was]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:2 (#2)

ἐν ἀρχῇ

"in the beginning"

John assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to the very earliest time before God created the heavens and the earth. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated this phrase in verse 1. Alternate translation: [before the beginning of the universe] or [before the universe began]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:2 (#1)

οὗτος

"He"

He here refers to Jesus, whom John has called "the Word" in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus] or [the Word]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:3 (#2)

αὐτοῦ

"him"

The pronoun **him** is referring to Jesus, the one who is called "the Word." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus] or [the Word]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:3 (#4)

χωρὶς αὐτοῦ ἐγένετο οὐδὲ ἕν ὃ γέγονεν

"without him came into being not one thing that has come into being"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God did not make one thing without him] or [with him, God made everything that God has made]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:3 (#1)

πάντα δι' αὐτοῦ ἐγένετο

"All things came into being through him"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God made all things through him]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:3 (#3)

χωρὶς αὐτοῦ ἐγένετο οὐδὲ ἕν ὃ γέγονεν

"without him came into being not one thing that has come into being"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [with him came into being everything that came into being]

See: Double Negatives

John 1:4 (#1)

ζωὴ

"life"

Here it is best to use a general term for **life**. If you must use a more specific word, consider that **life** here could refer to: (1) eternal life, which is the meaning John uses for this term throughout this Gospel. Alternate translation: [the means of receiving eternal life]; (2) physical life, which would mean that this verse continues the discussion about the creation of the universe in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [the life of all living things]; (3) both physical life and eternal life. Alternate translation: [the life of all living things and the source of eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:4 (#4)

τὸ φῶς τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"the light of men"

John uses **of** to indicate to whom the **light** is given. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the light given to men]

See: Possession

John 1:4 (#3)

τὸ φῶς τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"the light of men"

John uses **light** to refer to God's truth and goodness. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the true and good things God has for men]

See: Metaphor

John 1:4 (#2)

καὶ ἡ ζωὴ

"and the life"

Here, **the life** refers to the same life stated in the previous phrase. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and that life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:4 (#5)

τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, John is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [of people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 1:5 (#1)

τὸ φῶς & φαίνει

“the light shines”

John uses **the light shines** to refer to God’s truth and goodness being revealed as if it were a light shining. This truth and goodness was revealed to the world by Jesus. He is the embodiment of God’s truth and goodness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [God reveals his truth and goodness] or [God’s truth and goodness is like a light that shines]

See: Metaphor

John 1:5 (#4)

αὐτὸ οὐ κατέλαβεν

“did not overcome it”

Here, **it** refers to the light mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [did not overcome the light]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:5 (#3)

αὐτὸ οὐ κατέλαβεν

“did not overcome it”

The word translated as **overcome** could also be translated as “understand.” It could mean: (1) the evil forces in the world did not conquer God’s truth and goodness. Alternate translation: [did not conquer it]; (2) the people in the world who do not know God do not understand his truth and goodness. Alternate translation: [did not comprehend it]; (3) the evil forces of this world neither conquered nor understood God’s truth and goodness. Alternate translation: [did not conquer or comprehend it]

John 1:5 (#2)

ἐν τῇ σκοτίᾳ & καὶ ἡ σκοτία

“in the darkness, and the darkness”

John uses **darkness** to refer to what is false and evil. It is the spiritual **darkness** of the people in the world who do not love Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [in the false and evil world, and that evil world] or [in the evil world that is like a dark place, and that dark place]

See: Metaphor

John 1:6 (#1)

ἀπεσταλμένος παρὰ Θεοῦ

“having been sent from God”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [whom God has sent]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:6 (#2)

Ἰωάννης

“was} John”

Here, **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:7 (#3)

δι’ αὐτοῦ

“through him”

John assumes that his readers will understand that **through him** indicates the means by which everyone might believe in the light. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by means of him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:7 (#2)

περὶ τοῦ φωτός

“about the light”

John uses **light** to refer to the revelation of God’s truth and goodness in Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [about Jesus, who revealed the true and good things of God]

See: Metaphor

John 1:7 (#1)

οὗτος

“He”

This use of the pronoun **He** refers to John the Baptist, who was introduced in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:8 (#2)

τὸ φῶς & τοῦ φωτός

“the light & the light”

See how you translated **light** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who revealed the true and good things of God ... Jesus]

See: Metaphor

John 1:8 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος

“That one”

That one refers to John the Baptist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:9 (#1)

τὸ φῶς τὸ ἀληθινὸν, ὃ

“The true light, which”

John uses **light** to refer to Jesus as the one who both reveals the truth about God and is himself that truth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who truly embodied God’s truth, who]

See: Metaphor

John 1:9 (#3)

ἄνθρωπον

“men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, John is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 1:9 (#2)

ὃ φωτίζει πάντα ἄνθρωπον

“which gives light to all men”

John uses **light** to refer to God’s truth and goodness. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [which reveals the true and good things of God to all men]

See: Metaphor

John 1:10 (#2)

ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ

“in the world”

Here, **world** refers to the earth on which people live. It does not refer only to the people in the world or to the entire universe. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the earth]

See: Metonymy

John 1:10 (#6)

οὐκ ἔγνω

“did not know”

Alternate translation: [did not acknowledge]

John 1:10 (#3)

ὁ κόσμος

“the world”

Here, **world** refers to the universe God created. It does not refer only to the people in the world or only to the earth. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the whole universe]

See: Metonymy

John 1:10 (#1)

ἦν & δι’ αὐτοῦ & αὐτὸν

“He was & through him & him”

He and **him** in this verse refer to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus was ... through Jesus ... Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:10 (#5)

ὁ κόσμος

“the world”

Here, **world** refers to the people who lived in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 1:10 (#4)

καὶ ὁ κόσμος αὐτὸν οὐκ ἔγνω

“and the world did not know him”

Here, **and** introduces a contrast between what was expected, that the world would recognize its Creator, and what happened, that the world did to do that. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a contrast. Alternate translation: [but the world did not know him] or [yet the world did not know him]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

John 1:11 (#3)

αὐτὸν οὐ παρέλαβον

“did not receive him”

John assumes that his readers will understand that **receive** means to accept a person into one’s presence with friendliness. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [did not accept him] or [did not welcome him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:11 (#1)

τὰ ἴδια & οἱ ἴδιοι

“his own & his own”

Here, **his own** could refer to: (1) his own people, the nation of Israel. Alternate translation: [his fellow Jews … his fellow Jews]; (2) his own creation. Alternate translation: [the people he created … the people he created]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:11 (#2)

καὶ

“and”

Here, **and** introduces a contrast between what was expected, that his own people would know their Messiah, and what happened, that his own people did not do that. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a contrast. Alternate translation: [but]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

John 1:12 (#3)

ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ἐξουσίαν

“he gave to them the authority”

Alternate translation: [he gave to them the right] or [he made it possible for them]

John 1:12 (#5)

πιστεύουσιν εἰς τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“believing in his name”

John uses **name** to refer to Jesus’ identity and everything about him. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who believed in him]

See: Metonymy

John 1:12 (#2)

ἔλαβον αὐτόν

“received him”

Here, **received** means to accept a person into one’s presence with friendliness. See how you translated this word in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [accepted him] or [welcomed him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:12 (#4)

τέκνα Θεοῦ

“children of God”

John uses **children** to refer to people who love and obey God. The relationship between God and those who love him is like the relationship between a father and his children. Because this is an important concept in the Bible, you should not state the meaning plainly here, but you may use a simile. Alternate translation: [like children who have God as their father]

See: Metaphor

John 1:12 (#1)

ὅσοι δὲ ἔλαβον αὐτόν, ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ἐξουσίαν τέκνα Θεοῦ γενέσθαι, τοῖς πιστεύουσιν εἰς τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“But as many as received him, he gave to them the authority to become children of God, to the ones believing in his name”

If it would be natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. You will also need to adjust some words to fit the new order. Alternate translation: [But as many as received him and believed

in his name, he gave to them the authority to become children of God]

See: Information Structure

John 1:13 (#5)

οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος σαρκὸς

“nor from the will of the flesh”

John is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [nor were they born from the will of the flesh]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:13 (#8)

οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος ἀνδρὸς

“nor from the will of a man”

John is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [nor were they born from the will of man]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:13 (#6)

ἐκ

“from”

Again, **from** could refer to any of the following: (1) the means by which God’s children are born. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [by]; (2) the source from which God’s children are born. Alternate translation: [of]; (3) the cause of the birth of God’s children. Alternate translation: [as a result of]

John 1:13 (#9)

ἐκ

“from”

Again, **from** could refer to any of the following: (1) the means by which God’s children are born. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [by]; (2) the source from which God’s children are born. Alternate translation: [of]; (3) the cause of the birth of God’s children. Alternate translation: [as a result of]

John 1:13 (#1)

οἳ

“the ones”

Here **the ones** refers to the children of God mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be misunderstood for your readers, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:13 (#7)

ἐκ θελήματος σαρκὸς

“from the will of the flesh”

John is using the term **flesh** to refer to a human being, which is made of flesh. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the human will]

See: Metonymy

John 1:13 (#11)

ἀλλ’ ἐκ Θεοῦ

“but from God”

John is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [but they were born from God]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:13 (#4)

ἐξ

“from”

Here, **from** could refer to any of the following: (1) the means by which God’s children are born. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [by]; (2) the source from which God’s children are born. Alternate translation: [of]; (3) the cause of the birth of God’s children. Alternate translation: [as a result of]

John 1:13 (#10)

ἐκ θελήματος ἀνδρὸς

“from the will of a man”

The term **a man** used here refers specifically to an adult male person and may also be translated as “husband.” In this verse it refers to a father’s desire to have a child like himself. Alternate translation: [from the will of a husband]

John 1:13 (#3)

οὐκ ἐξ αἱμάτων & ἐγεννήθησαν

“not born from bloods”

Here, **bloods** refers to the bloodlines or genetic contributions of both parents of a child. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [were not born from human bloodlines] or [were not born from human decent]

See: Metaphor

John 1:13 (#12)

ἐκ

“from”

The word **from** could refer to any of the following: (1) the means by which God’s children are born. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [by]; (2) the source from which God’s children are born. Alternate translation: [of]; (3) the cause of the birth of God’s children. Alternate translation: [as a result of]

John 1:13 (#2)

οἳ οὐκ ἐξ αἱμάτων & ἐγεννήθησαν

“the ones not born from bloods”

John uses **born** to describe God changing a person from being spiritually dead to being spiritually alive when they believe in Jesus. John recorded Jesus referring to this change as being “born again” in 3:3. (See: born again, born of God, new birth) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that indicates spiritual rebirth rather than physical birth. Alternate translation: [These were born spiritually, not from blood]

See: Metaphor

John 1:14 (#7)

παρὰ πατρός

“from the Father”

The implication is that the phrase **from the Father** means that Jesus came to the world from the presence of God the Father. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:14 (#4)

τὴν δόξαν αὐτοῦ, δόξαν

“his glory, glory”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [his glorious character, the glorious character]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 1:14 (#10)

πλήρης χάριτος καὶ ἀληθείας

“full of grace and truth”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **grace** and **truth**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [full of God’s gracious and faithful character] or [full of kind acts and true teachings]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 1:14 (#8)

πατρός

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:14 (#6)

μονογενοῦς

“of the One and Only”

Here and throughout John’s Gospel, the phrase **the One and Only** is a title for Jesus that could refer to: (1) Jesus being unique as the only member of his kind. Alternate translation: [the Unique One]; (2) Jesus being the only child of his Father. Alternate translation: [the Only Begotten One]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:14 (#1)

ὁ λόγος

“the Word”

The phrase **the Word** refers to Jesus. It does not refer to a spoken word. ULT indicates this by capitalizing **Word** to indicate that this is a title for Jesus. Use whatever convention your language uses to indicate that this is a name. If “word” is feminine in your language, it could be translated as “the one who is called the Word.” See how you translated this phrase in John 1:1. Alternate translation: [Jesus, the Word]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:14 (#9)

πλήρης χάριτος καὶ ἀληθείας

“full of grace and truth”

John uses **full of** to describe Jesus fully possessing a quality, as if grace and truth were objects that could fill a person. If this might confuse you readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [fully possessing grace and truth]

See: Metaphor

John 1:14 (#5)

μονογενοῦς παρὰ πατρός

“of the One and Only from the Father”

The phrase **the One and Only** refers to Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of the One and Only from the Father, Jesus,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:14 (#2)

σὰρξ ἐγένετο

“became flesh”

Here, **flesh** represents “a person” or “a human being.” If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [became human] or [became a human being]

See: Synecdoche

John 1:14 (#3)

ἡμῖν, καὶ ἐθεασάμεθα

“us, and we beheld”

The pronouns **us** and **we** are exclusive since John is speaking on behalf of himself and the other eyewitnesses to the earthly life of Jesus, but the people to whom he is writing did not see Jesus. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 1:15 (#5)

ἔμπροσθέν μου γέγονεν

“has become greater than me”

Alternate translation: [is more important than I am] or [is superior to me]

John 1:15 (#1)

Ἰωάννης μαρτυρεῖ περὶ αὐτοῦ

“John testifies about him”

To call attention to a development in the story, John uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you can use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [John testified about him]

See: Predictive Past

John 1:15 (#3)

οὗτος ἦν ὃν εἶπον, ὁ ὀπίσω μου ἐρχόμενος, ἔμπροσθέν μου γέγονεν, ὅτι πρῶτός μου ἦν

“This was the one of whom I said, ‘The one coming after me has become greater than me, for he was before me”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [This was the one I said would come after me, and who would be greater than me for he was before me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 1:15 (#4)

ὁ ὀπίσω μου ἐρχόμενος

“The one coming after me”

John is speaking about Jesus. The phrase **coming after me** means that John’s ministry has already started, and Jesus’ ministry will start later. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [He who starts his ministry after I have done so]

See: Metaphor

John 1:15 (#2)

καὶ κέκραγεν λέγων

“and has cried out, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [and has cried out, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 1:15 (#6)

ὅτι πρῶτός μου ἦν

“for he was before me”

Here, **before me** means that Jesus existed earlier in time than John. This does not mean that Jesus is more important because he is older than John in human years. Jesus is greater and more important than John because he is God the Son, who has always existed. Alternate translation: [for he existed before I was born]

See: Metaphor

John 1:16 (#5)

πάντες ἐλάβομεν καὶ χάριν

“have all received even grace”

Alternate translation: [have all received, that is, grace] or [have all received, namely, grace]

John 1:16 (#2)

αὐτοῦ

“his”

Here, **his** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus’]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:16 (#1)

ὅτι

“For”

For introduces the reason why John said that Jesus is “full of grace and truth” in verse 14. Alternate translation: [We can say that Jesus is full of grace and truth because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 1:16 (#7)

χάριν ἀντὶ χάριτος

“grace after grace”

Here, **after** could mean: (1) the second “grace” replaces the first “grace,” which is the most common use for this word. This meaning could indicate that the first “grace” refers to “the law” and the second “grace” refers to “Grace and truth” in the next verse. Alternate translation: [grace in place of grace] or [grace instead of grace]; (2) the second “grace” is in addition to the first “grace.” Alternate translation: [grace in addition to] or [grace upon grace]

John 1:16 (#3)

τοῦ πληρώματος αὐτοῦ

“his fullness”

Here, **fullness** refers to the grace and truth which John said Jesus was full of in verse 14. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fullness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what he is full of] or [his full amount of grace and truth]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 1:16 (#4)

ἡμεῖς πάντες ἐλάβομεν

“we have all received”

Here, **we** refers to John and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form. Alternate translation: [all of we believers have received]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 1:16 (#6)

χάριν ἀντὶ χάριτος

“grace after grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [kind act after kind act]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 1:17 (#2)

ὁ νόμος διὰ Μωϋσέως ἐδόθη

“the law was given through Moses”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God gave the law through Moses]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:17 (#3)

ὁ νόμος & ἐδόθη

“the law was given”

The word **law** is a singular noun that refers to the many laws and instructions that God gave to the Israelites. If your language does not use singular nouns in that way, you can use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the group of laws was given] or [God’s laws were given]

See: Collective Nouns

John 1:17 (#1)

ὁ νόμος διὰ Μωϋσέως ἐδόθη, ἡ χάρις καὶ ἡ ἀλήθεια διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐγένετο

"the law was given through Moses. Grace and truth came about through Jesus Christ"

John placed the two sentences in this verse next to each other without any connecting word in order to show a contrast between the law of Moses and the grace and truth of Jesus. This does not mean that the law of Moses did not have grace and truth. Rather, John is indicating that the grace and truth revealed by Jesus is more complete than that revealed in the law of Moses. Although God revealed himself and his will through the law of Moses, he did so much more clearly though Jesus, who is God in human form. Alternate translation: [the law was given through Moses. In contrast, grace and truth came about through Jesus Christ]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

John 1:17 (#4)

ἡ χάρις καὶ ἡ ἀλήθεια

"Grace and truth"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **grace** and **truth**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [God's gracious and faithful character] or [Kind acts and true teachings]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 1:18 (#7)

ἐξηγήσατο

"has made {him} known"

John assumes that his readers will understand that the word translated as **has made him known** refers to making people know something by explaining or revealing it clearly. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has explained him] or [has fully revealed him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:18 (#5)

ἐκεῖνος

"that one"

Here, **that one** refers to Jesus in an emphatic way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:18 (#3)

ὁ ὢν εἰς τὸν κόλπον τοῦ Πατρὸς

"the one being in the bosom of the Father"

Here, **in the bosom of** is an idiom that refers to having a close and intimate relationship with someone. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [who has a close relationship with the Father]

See: Idiom

John 1:18 (#1)

μονογενὴς Θεὸς

"The One and Only God"

Here and throughout John's Gospel, the phrase **the One and Only** is a title for Jesus that could refer to: (1) Jesus being unique as the only member of his kind. Alternate translation: [the Unique God]; (2) Jesus being the only child of his Father. Alternate translation: [the Only Begotten God]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:18 (#4)

τοῦ Πατρὸς

"of the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:18 (#6)

ἐξηγήσατο

"has made {him} known"

Here, **him** is not in the original text, but is necessary for English. It refers to God the Father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [has made the Father known]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:18 (#2)

μονογενὴς Θεὸς

“The One and Only God”

Here, **God** indicates that Jesus, who is called **the One and Only**, is God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the One and Only, who is God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:19 (#2)

ἀπέστειλαν οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews sent”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the “Jewish leaders.” If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders sent]

See: Synecdoche

John 1:19 (#1)

τοῦ Ἰωάννου

“of John”

John refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of John the Baptist] or [of John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:20 (#1)

ὡμολόγησεν καὶ οὐκ ἠρνήσατο, καὶ ὡμολόγησεν

“he confessed—and he did not deny, but confessed”

The phrase “he confessed” expresses in positive terms the same thing that **he did not deny** expresses in negative terms. This emphasizes that John was telling the truth and was strongly stating that he was not the Christ. Your language may have a different way of doing this. Alternate translation: [he strongly confessed] or [he solemnly testified]

See: Doublet

John 1:21 (#4)

λέγει

“he says”

John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:21 (#2)

τί οὖν

“What then”

Alternate translation: [If you are not the Messiah, then who are you?]

John 1:21 (#1)

ἠρώτησαν

“they asked”

Here, **they** refers to “the Jews,” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state it explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jews asked]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:21 (#5)

ὁ προφήτης

“the Prophet”

Here, **the Prophet** refers to a prophet for whom the Jews were waiting, based on God’s promise to send a prophet like Moses, a promise recorded in Deuteronomy 18:15. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophet whom God promised to send to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:21 (#3)

Ἠλείας

“Elijah”

Elijah was the name of a prophet whom the Jews expected to return to earth shortly become the arrival of the Messiah.

See: How to Translate Names

John 1:22 (#2)

τίς εἶ? ἵνα ἀπόκρισιν δῶμεν τοῖς πέμψασιν ἡμᾶς; τί

“Who are you, so that we might give an answer to the ones having sent us? What”

John is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. This may require you to change the punctuation of the sentences. Alternate translation: [Who are you? Tell us so that we might given an answer to those who sent us. What]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:22 (#3)

δῶμεν & ἡμᾶς

“we might give & us”

Here, **we** and **us** refer to the priests and Levites, not to John. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 1:22 (#1)

εἶπαν & αὐτῷ

“they said to him”

The pronouns **they** and **him** refer to the priests and Levites and John the Baptist, respectively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the priests and Levites said to John the Baptist]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:22 (#5)

τοῖς πέμψασιν ἡμᾶς

“to the ones having sent us”

This phrase refers to the Jewish leaders in Jerusalem. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to those leaders in Jerusalem who sent us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:22 (#4)

ἵνα ἀπόκρισιν δῶμεν

“so that we might give an answer”

Alternate translation: [so that we might tell your answer]

John 1:23 (#5)

Ἡσαΐας ὁ προφήτης

“Isaiah the prophet”

Isaiah is the name of the man who wrote the book of **Isaiah**, in the Bible.

See: How to Translate Names

John 1:23 (#2)

ἐγὼ φωνὴ βοῶντος ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ

“I am a voice, crying out in the wilderness”

Here, **voice** refers to the person who is crying out in the wilderness. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am the one calling out in the wilderness]

See: Metonymy

John 1:23 (#1)

φωνὴ βοῶντος ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, εὐθύνατε τὴν ὁδὸν Κυρίου

“a voice, crying out in the wilderness: ‘Make the way of the Lord straight”

In these phrases, John quotes from the Old Testament book of Isaiah (Isaiah 40:3). It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 1:23 (#3)

ἐγὼ φωνὴ βοῶντος ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, εὐθύνατε τὴν ὁδὸν Κυρίου

“I am a voice, crying out in the wilderness: ‘Make the way of the Lord straight”

This clause is a quotation within a quotation. John is quoting from the book of Isaiah, and Isaiah is quoting the words of the person calling out in the wilderness. It would be best to indicate that by punctuating this material as a second-level quotation, since Luke is quoting from Scripture. However, if your language does not put one direct quotation within another, you could translate this material as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [I am a voice crying out in the wilderness to make the way of the Lord straight]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 1:23 (#4)

εὐθύνατε τὴν ὁδὸν Κυρίου

“Make the way of the Lord straight”

John the Baptist quotes Isaiah, using this clause to refer to telling people to get ready to listen to the Lord’s message when it comes. They are to do this by repenting of their sins. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Repent of your sins so that you will be ready to listen to the Lord’s message when it comes]

See: Metaphor

John 1:24 (#1)

This verse is background information about the people who questioned John. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 1:24 (#3)

ἀπεσταλμένοι ἦσαν

“the ones that had been sent were”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom the Jewish leaders sent]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:24 (#4)

ἦσαν ἐκ τῶν Φαρισαίων

“were from the Pharisees”

This phrase could refer to: (1) the priests and Levites who had been sent. Alternate translation: [belonged to the Pharisees]; (2) the leaders in Jerusalem who sent the priests and Levites. Alternate translation: [were sent from the Pharisees]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:24 (#2)

ἀπεσταλμένοι

“the ones that had been sent”

Here, **the ones** refers to the priests and Levites, as introduced in verse 19. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the priests and Levites who had been sent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:25 (#2)

ὁ προφήτης

“the Prophet”

Here, **the Prophet** refers to a prophet for whom the Jews were waiting, based on God’s promise to send a prophet like Moses, which is recorded in Deuteronomy 18:15. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophet whom God promised to send to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:25 (#1)

ἠρώτησαν

“they asked”

Here, **they** refers to the priests and Levites who had been sent from Jerusalem, as introduced in verse 19. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the priests and Levites from Jerusalem asked]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:26 (#2)

ἀπεκρίθη αὐτοῖς ὁ Ἰωάννης λέγων

“John answered them, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [John answered them, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 1:26 (#1)

ὁ Ἰωάννης

“John”

Here, **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:27 (#2)

μου & οὗ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐγὼ ἄξιος, ἵνα λύσω αὐτοῦ τὸν ἱμάντα τοῦ ὑποδήματος

“me, of whom I am not worthy that I might untie the strap of his sandal”

Untying sandals was the work of a slave or servant. John the Baptist uses this expression figurative to refer to the most unpleasant work of a servant. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [me. I am not even worthy to untie the strap of his sandal] or [me, whom I am not worthy to serve in even the most unpleasant way]

See: Metaphor

John 1:27 (#1)

ὁ ὀπίσω μου ἐρχόμενος

“the one coming after me”

John is speaking about Jesus. The phrase **coming after me** means that John’s ministry has already started and Jesus’ ministry will start later. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the one who starts his ministry after I have done so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:28 (#2)

ταῦτα

“These things”

Here, **these things** refers to the events that were described in 1:19–27. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [This conversation between John and the priests and Levites from Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:28 (#3)

πέραν τοῦ Ἰορδάνου

“beyond the Jordan”

Here, **beyond the Jordan** refers to the region of Judea that is on the east side of the Jordan River, which is the side opposite from Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [on the side of the Jordan River opposite from Jerusalem]

See: How to Translate Names

John 1:28 (#1)

This verse provides background information about the setting of the story that is recorded in 1:19–27. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 1:28 (#4)

ὁ Ἰωάννης

“John”

Here, **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:29 (#4)

ἴδε, ὁ Ἀμνὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Behold, the Lamb of God”

The phrase **Lamb of God** refers to Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Behold, Jesus, the Lamb of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:29 (#2)

βλέπει & λέγει

“he sees & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:29 (#3)

ἴδε

“Behold”

John the Baptist uses the term **Behold** to call his audience’s attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here.

See: Metaphor

John 1:29 (#7)

τοῦ κόσμου

“of the world”

John the Baptist uses **world** to refer to all the people in the world. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of those who live in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 1:29 (#6)

ὁ αἴρων

“the one taking away”

John the Baptist speaks of forgiving sin as if sin were an object that Jesus is **taking away**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [who is forgiving]

See: Metaphor

John 1:29 (#1)

τῇ ἐπαύριον

“The next day”

The next day here indicates that the events the story will now relate came after the event it has just described in 1:19–28. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [The day after John spoke with the priests and Levites from Jerusalem]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 1:29 (#5)

Ἀμνὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Lamb of God”

John the Baptist uses a metaphor here to refer to Jesus as God’s perfect sacrifice. (See: lamb, Lamb of God) Since **Lamb of God** is an important title for Jesus, you should translate the words directly and not provide a plain explanation in the text of your translation.

See: Metaphor

John 1:30 (#1)

ὀπίσω μου ἔρχεται ἀνὴρ, ὃς ἔμπροσθέν μου γέγονεν, ὅτι πρῶτός μου ἦν

“After me comes a man who has become greater than me, for he was before me”

See how you translated this in verse 15.

John 1:31 (#3)

ἵνα φανερωθῇ τῷ Ἰσραὴλ διὰ τοῦτο

“so that he might be revealed to Israel, because of this”

John uses the redundant words **so that** and **because of this** to emphasize the reason why he was baptizing people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine these phrases and indicate the emphasis. Alternate translation: [for the exact purpose that he might be revealed to Israel]

See: Doublet

John 1:31 (#5)

διὰ τοῦτο

“because of this”

Here, **this** refers to the revealing of the Messiah to Israel that is mentioned in the previous clause. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because he might be revealed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:31 (#1)

κἀγὼ οὐκ ᾔδειν αὐτόν

“And I did not know him”

Here, **him** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I did not know Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:31 (#4)

τῷ Ἰσραὴλ

“to Israel”

John uses the name of the nation, **Israel**, to represent the people who belong to that nation. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

John 1:31 (#2)

κἀγὼ οὐκ ᾔδειν αὐτόν

“And I did not know him”

John means that he did not know previously that Jesus was the Messiah. It does not mean that he did not know who Jesus was, because Jesus was his cousin. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I did not know that he was the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:32 (#2)

ὡς περιστερὰν

“like a dove”

This phrase is a simile. As Luke 3:22 indicates, the Holy Spirit came down with an appearance that resembled a **dove**. Alternate translation: [resembling a dove]

See: Simile

John 1:32 (#3)

ἐπ’ αὐτόν

“upon him”

Here, **him** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [upon Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:32 (#1)

ἐμαρτύρησεν Ἰωάννης λέγων

"John testified, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [John testified, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 1:33 (#2)

ὁ πέμψας με βαπτίζειν ἐν ὕδατι, ἐκεῖνός

"the one having sent me to baptize in water, that one"

Here, the phrases **the one who sent me** and **that one** both refer to God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [God, who sent me to baptize in water,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:33 (#3)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ βαπτίζων ἐν Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ

"he is the one baptizing in the Holy Spirit"

John the Baptist is using literal baptism, which puts a person under water, to refer to spiritual baptism, which puts people under the influence of the **Holy Spirit**, who purifies them. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is the one who will put you under the influence of the Holy Spirit, who will purify you]

See: Metaphor

John 1:33 (#1)

κἀγὼ οὐκ ᾔδειν αὐτόν

"And I did not recognize him"

John means that he did not know previously that Jesus was the Messiah. It does not mean that he did not recognize who Jesus was when he saw him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I did not recognize that he was the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:34 (#1)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the Son of God"

Although most copies of this text say **Son of God**, some say "chosen one of God" or "chosen Son of God." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the phrase it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to follow the example of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

John 1:34 (#2)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Son of God"

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:35 (#1)

τῇ ἐπαύριον πάλιν

"The next day & again"

The next day here indicates that the events the story will now relate came after the event it has just described in 1:29–34. John saw Jesus two days after his conversation with the priests and Levites that is described in verses 19–28. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [Two days after John spoke with the priests and Levites from Jerusalem]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 1:36 (#2)

ἴδε, ὁ Ἀμνὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Behold, the Lamb of God"

The phrase **Lamb of God** refers to Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Behold, Jesus, the Lamb of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:36 (#3)

ἴδε

"Behold"

John records John the Baptist using the term **Behold** to call his audience's attention to what he is about to

say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here.

See: Metaphor

John 1:36 (#1)

λέγει

"he says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:36 (#4)

Ἀμνὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Lamb of God"

See how you translated this same phrase in John 1:29.

See: Metaphor

John 1:37 (#1)

ἤκουσαν οἱ δύο μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ

"his two disciples heard {him"

Here, **his** and **him** refer to John the Baptist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [John's two disciples heard him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:38 (#4)

ποῦ μένεις

"where are you staying"

Alternate translation: [where are you spending the night]

John 1:38 (#3)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:38 (#1)

θεασάμενος αὐτοὺς

"having seen them"

Here, **them** refers to the two disciples of John the Baptist who were mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [having seen John's two disciples]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:38 (#5)

ποῦ μένεις

"where are you staying"

This question is the answer to the question Jesus just asked in the previous sentence. It is a way for the two men to imply that they would like to have a private conversation with Jesus at the place where he was staying. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [where are you staying? We would like to speak with you privately.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:38 (#2)

θεασάμενος αὐτοὺς ἀκολουθοῦντας

"having seen them following"

John is leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [having seen them following him]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:39 (#2)

μένει

"he is staying"

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

John 1:39 (#3)

τὴν ἡμέραν ἐκείνην

"that day"

Here, **that day** refers to the day the two disciples left John the Baptist to follow Jesus, as indicated in verse 35. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the same day that they left John]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:39 (#1)

λέγει αὐτοῖς & μένει

“He says to them & he is staying”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:39 (#4)

ὥρα & δεκάτη

“the tenth hour”

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. Here, **the tenth hour** indicates a time in the late afternoon, before dark, at which it would be too late to start traveling to another town. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [about 4:00 PM]

John 1:40 (#2)

Σίμωνος Πέτρου

“of Simon Peter”

Simon was also called **Peter** by Jesus, as recorded in verse 42. Alternate translation: [Simon, who is also called Peter]

John 1:40 (#1)

Ἰωάννου

“John”

Here, **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:40–42 (#1)

Verses [40–42] give background information about Andrew and how he brought his brother Peter to Jesus.

See: Background Information

John 1:41 (#3)

ὅ ἐστιν μεθερμηνευόμενον, Χριστός

“which is translated “Christ”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which means Christ]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:41 (#2)

εὑρίσκει & λέγει

“finds & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:41 (#1)

οὗτος

“This one”

This one here refers to Andrew, who was mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Andrew]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:41 (#4)

ὅ ἐστιν μεθερμηνευόμενον, Χριστός

“which is translated “Christ”

John assumes that his readers will know that he is saying what the title “Messiah” means when translated from the Aramaic language into Greek. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which is “Christ” in Greek] or [which is the Aramaic word for “Christ”]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:42 (#3)

υἱὸς Ἰωάννου

“son of John”

This is neither John the Baptist nor John the apostle.

John 1:42 (#6)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, Πέτρος

“which is translated “Peter”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which means “Peter]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:42 (#1)

ἤγαγεν αὐτὸν

“He brought him”

He here refers to Andrew and **him** refers to Simon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Andrew brought Simon]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:42 (#4)

σὺ κληθήσῃ Κηφᾶς

“You will be called Cephas”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People will call you Cephas]

See: Active or Passive

John 1:42 (#2)

ἐμβλέψας αὐτῷ, ὁ Ἰησοῦς εἶπεν

“Jesus, having looked at him, said”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [Jesus looked at him, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 1:42 (#5)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, Πέτρος

“which is translated “Peter”

Cephas is a word in the Aramaic language that means “rock.” Here, Jesus uses the word as a name for Simon. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which is translated as “Peter” and means “rock” in Aramaic]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:42 (#7)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, Πέτρος

“which is translated “Peter”

John assumes that his readers will know that he is saying what the name Cephas means when translated from the Aramaic language into Greek. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which is “Peter” in Greek] or [which is the Aramaic word for “Peter”]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:43 (#3)

ἀκολούθει μοι

“Follow me”

In this context, to **follow** someone means to become that person’s disciple. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [Become my disciple] or [Come, follow me as your teacher]

See: Idiom

John 1:43 (#2)

καὶ εὑρίσκει Φίλιππον, καὶ λέγει

“and he finds Philip and says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:43 (#1)

τῇ ἐπαύριον

“The next day”

The next day here indicates that the events the story will now relate came after the event it has just described in the previous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [The day after Andrew brought Simon to Jesus,]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 1:44 (#1)

This verse provides background information about **Philip**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 1:45 (#1)

Φίλιππος τὸν Ναθαναὴλ & Μωϋσῆς & Ἰησοῦν & τοῦ Ἰωσὴφ

“Philip & Nathaniel & Moses & Jesus & of Joseph”

These are the names of five men.

See: How to Translate Names

John 1:45 (#2)

εὑρίσκει Φίλιππος τὸν Ναθαναὴλ, καὶ λέγει

“Philip finds Nathaniel and says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:45 (#3)

οἱ προφῆται

“the prophets”

John is leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [the prophets wrote about]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:46 (#2)

ἐκ Ναζαρὲτ δύναταί τι ἀγαθὸν εἶναι

“Is any good thing able to be from Nazareth”

Nathaniel is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No good thing can come out of Nazareth!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 1:46 (#3)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:46 (#1)

εἶπεν αὐτῷ Ναθαναήλ

“Nathaniel said to him”

Here, **him** refers to Philip. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Nathaniel said to Philip]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 1:47 (#2)

ἴδε

“Behold”

John records Jesus using the term **Behold** to call his audience’s attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here.

See: Metaphor

John 1:47 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:47 (#3)

ἐν ᾧ δόλος οὐκ ἔστιν

“in whom is no deceit”

Jesus is using a figure of speech that expresses a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that means the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [a completely truthful man]

See: Litotes

John 1:48 (#2)

πρὸ τοῦ σε Φίλιππον φωνῆσαι, ὄντα ὑπὸ τὴν συκῆν, εἶδόν σε

“Before Philip called you, being under the fig tree, I saw you”

Nathaniel’s reaction to this statement in the next verse indicates that this is a display of supernatural knowledge. It appears that Jesus knew something about Nathaniel that no one else could have known. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Before Philip called you, being completely alone under the fig tree, I saw you.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:48 (#3)

ὄντα ὑπὸ τὴν συκῆν

“being under the fig tree”

The subject of this clause is Philip, not Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [while you were under the fig tree]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:48 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:49 (#1)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Son of God”

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 1:50 (#2)

ὅτι εἶπόν σοι, ὅτι εἶδόν σε ὑποκάτω τῆς συκῆς, πιστεύεις

“Because I said to you that I saw you underneath the fig tree, do you believe”

John records Jesus using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You believe because I said that I saw you underneath the fig tree!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 1:50 (#4)

μείζω τούτων

“greater things than these”

Jesus uses the plural pronoun **these** to refer to a general category of something, in this case the miraculous display of supernatural knowledge that took place in 1:48. Alternate translation: [greater things than this type of thing] or [greater things that this kind of miracle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:50 (#3)

πιστεύεις

“do you believe”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [do you believe that I am the Messiah]

See: Ellipsis

John 1:50 (#1)

ὅτι εἶπόν σοι, ὅτι εἶδόν σε ὑποκάτω τῆς συκῆς, πιστεύεις

“Because I said to you that I saw you underneath the fig tree, do you believe”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the result for the reason that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Do you believe because I said to you that I saw you underneath the fig tree]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 1:51 (#3)

λέγω ὑμῖν

“I say to you”

Jesus is using the plural form of **you** to indicate that he is speaking to all those who are with him at that moment. He is not only speaking to Nathaniel. If it would be misunderstood to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I say to all of you here]

See: Forms of You

John 1:51 (#4)

ὄψεσθε τὸν οὐρανὸν ἀνεῳγότα, καὶ τοὺς ἀγγέλους τοῦ Θεοῦ ἀναβαίνοντας καὶ καταβαίνοντας

“you will see the heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending”

Jesus refers to an event described in the book of Genesis. While fleeing from his brother, Jacob had a dream in which he saw angels descending from and ascending to heaven. If it would be helpful to your readers who may not be familiar with the story, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [just as Jacob saw in his vision, you will see heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 1:51 (#2)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus repeats **Truly** in order to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine

these phrases, forming a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [What I am about to tell you is very true.]

See: Doublet

John 1:51 (#1)

λέγει

"he says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 1:51 (#5)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 1:51 (#6)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

The title **Son of Man** is equivalent to "Messiah." Jesus uses it to claim that role subtly and implicitly. You may want to translate this title directly into your language. On the other hand, if you think it would be helpful to your readers, you could state what it means. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [the Messiah]

See: Translating Son and Father

John - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus' first sign: he turns water into wine (2:1–12)
2. Jesus causes controversy in the Temple (2:13–22)
3. Jesus' ministry in Jerusalem at Passover (2:23–25)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Wine
The Jews drank wine at many meals and especially when they were celebrating special events. They did not believe that it was a sin to drink wine.

Driving out the money changers
Jesus drove the money changers out of the temple to show that he had authority over the temple and over all of Israel. As the Son of God, it was his Father's temple that was being used inappropriately for making money. Therefore, he had the authority to drive out those who were misusing the temple.

"He knew what was in man"
Jesus knew what other people were thinking only because he is the Son of Man and the Son of God. Because he is the Son of God, he has supernatural insight into what other people were thinking and could correctly judge their intentions.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"His disciples remembered"
John used this phrase to stop telling the main historical narrative and to tell about something that happened much later. The Jewish authorities spoke to Jesus right after he scolded the sellers in the temple in (2:16). Jesus' disciples remembered what the prophet had written long ago and that Jesus was talking about the temple of his body after Jesus became alive again (2:17 and 2:22).

John 2:1 (#1)

Jesus and his disciples were invited to a wedding. This verse gives background information about the setting of the story. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 2:1 (#2)

τῇ ἡμέρᾳ τῇ τρίτῃ

"on the third day"

This phrase introduces a new event. The **third day** could refer to: (1) the third day from when Jesus called Philip and Nathaniel to follow him in 1:43. According to the Jewish way of counting days, the first day would have been the day in 1:43, making **the third day** occur two days afterward. Alternate translation: [two days after Jesus called Philip and Nathaniel]; (2) the day after Jesus called Philip and Nathaniel to follow him in 1:43. In this case, the first day would have occurred in 1:35 and the second day in 1:43. Alternate translation: [on the day after Jesus called Philip and Nathaniel]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 2:2 (#1)

ἐκλήθη & καὶ ὁ Ἰησοῦς καὶ οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ εἰς τὸν γάμον

"Jesus also was invited, and his disciples, to the wedding"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they also invited Jesus and his disciples to the wedding]

See: Active or Passive

John 2:3 (#2)

οἶνον οὐκ ἔχουσιν

"They do not have wine"

Jesus' mother is using a declarative statement to give an indirect request. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a more natural form for a request. Alternate translation: [They ran out of wine. Could you do something to solve this problem?]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 2:3 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:3 (#3)

οἶνον

"wine"

Regarding the drinking of **wine** in Jewish culture, see the discussion in the introduction to this chapter.

John 2:4 (#4)

οὔπω ἥκει ἡ ὥρα μου

"My hour is not yet come"

The word **hour** refers to the right occasion for Jesus to show that he is the Messiah by working miracles. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It is not yet the right time for me to perform a mighty act]

See: Metonymy

John 2:4 (#3)

τί ἐμοὶ καὶ σοί, γύναι

"Woman, what to me and to you"

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Woman, this has nothing to do with me or you]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 2:4 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:4 (#2)

γύναι

"Woman"

Woman here refers to Mary. If it is impolite for a son to call his mother "woman" in your language, you can use another word that is polite, or leave it out.

John 2:5 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:6 (#1)

μετρητὰς δύο ἢ τρεῖς

"two or three metretes"

A **metretes** was equivalent to about 40 liters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the quantity in modern measurements. Alternatively, to help your readers recognize that the biblical writings come from long ago when people used different measurements, you could express the amount using the ancient measurement, the metretes, and explain the equivalent in modern measurements in a footnote. Alternate translation: [80 to 120 liters]

See: Biblical Volume

John 2:7 (#2)

αὐτοῖς

“to them”

Here, **them** refers to the servants at the wedding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the servants]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 2:7 (#3)

ἕως ἄνω

“up to the brim”

The **brim** is the top edge of the water pot. Alternate translation: [to the very top]

John 2:7 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:8 (#3)

τῷ ἀρχιτρικλίνῳ

“to the head waiter”

The term **head waiter** refers to the person in charge of the servants who served the food and drink at meals and feasts.

John 2:8 (#1)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:8 (#2)

αὐτοῖς & οἱ δὲ ἤνεγκαν

“to them & And they carried {it”

Here, **them** and **they** refer to the servants at the wedding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the servants ... And the servants carried it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 2:9 (#1)

ὁ ἀρχιτρίκλινος & ὁ ἀρχιτρίκλινος

“the head waiter & the head waiter”

See how you translated this term in the previous verse.

John 2:9 (#3)

φωνεῖ

“calls”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 2:9 (#2)

John provides this background information about who knew where the wine came from in order to emphasize the veracity of this miracle. The head waiter did not know that the wine was originally water from the water pots. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 2:10 (#2)

πᾶς ἄνθρωπος

“Every man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, the head waiter is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [Every person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 2:10 (#1)

πᾶς ἄνθρωπος

“Every man”

Every man here is an exaggeration that refers to something being a common practice. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [A man usually]

See: Hyperbole

John 2:10 (#3)

καὶ ὅταν μεθυσθῶσιν τὸν ἐλάσσω

“and the cheaper wine when they have become drunk”

This means that guests were given the cheaper wine, which is of lower quality and inferior flavor, after their

senses had been dulled by drinking too much alcohol and were thus unable to tell that it was inferior wine. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the cheaper wine when they have become drunk and unable to discern the quality of the wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:11 (#3)

ἐφανέρωσεν τὴν δόξαν αὐτοῦ

"he revealed his glory"

Here, **glory** refers to the mighty power of Jesus that enabled him to do miracles. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [revealed his glorious power]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 2:11 (#1)

In this verse John provides background information about the events described in 2:1–10. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 2:11 (#2)

ἀρχὴν τῶν σημείων

"beginning of the signs"

John wrote much about the miraculous **signs** Jesus did. Turning water into wine at the wedding is the first of those **signs**. See the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:12 (#3)

κατέβη

"went down"

This indicates that they went from a higher place to a lower place. Capernaum is at a lower elevation than Cana.

John 2:12 (#1)

μετὰ τοῦτο

"After this"

After this introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time afterward]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 2:12 (#2)

μετὰ τοῦτο

"After this"

Here, **this** refers to the what took place in Cana that was described in 2:1–11. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [After Jesus' first sign in Cana]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:13 (#1)

ἀνέβη εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα

"went up to Jerusalem"

This indicates that Jesus went from a lower place to a higher place. Jerusalem is built on a hill.

John 2:14 (#1)

τοὺς πωλοῦντας βόας καὶ πρόβατα καὶ περιστερὰς

"the ones selling oxen and sheep and pigeons"

These animals were used for sacrifices in the temple. People were buying animals in the temple courtyard in order to sacrifice them to God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [those selling oxen and sheep and pigeons for people to sacrifice to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:14 (#3)

καθημένους

"sitting there"

The next verse makes it clear that these people are in the temple courtyard. That area was intended for worship and not for commerce. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [sitting in the temple courtyard that was intended for worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:14 (#2)

κερματιστὰς

“money changers”

Jewish authorities required people who wanted to buy animals for sacrifices in the temple to exchange their money for special money from the **money changers**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [people who exchanged money for special money approved for temple use]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:15 (#2)

πάντας

“them} all”

Here, **them all** refers to the people selling the animals and the money changers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [all the sellers and money changers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 2:15 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

John is telling his readers what Jesus did as a result of the commerce he saw going on in the temple. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 2:16 (#1)

τὸν οἶκον τοῦ πατρός μου οἶκον ἐμπορίου

“the house of my Father a house of commerce”

Jesus uses **the house of my Father** to refer to the temple. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the house of my Father, which is the temple, a house of commerce]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:16 (#2)

τοῦ πατρός μου

“of my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 2:17 (#3)

ὁ ζῆλος τοῦ οἴκου σου καταφάγεταί με

“Zeal for your house will consume me”

This sentence is a quotation from Psalm 69:9. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 2:17 (#5)

τοῦ οἴκου σου

“for your house”

Here, **house** refers to the temple, which is often called God’s **house** in the Bible. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [for your house, the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:17 (#2)

γεγραμμένον ἐστίν

“it is written”

John uses **it is written** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 69:9). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that John is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [it had been written in the scriptures]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 2:17 (#1)

γεγραμμένον ἐστίν

“it is written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone had written]

See: Active or Passive

John 2:17 (#4)

τοῦ οἴκου σου

“for your house”

Here, **your** refers to God and is singular. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for God's house]

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

John 2:17 (#6)

καταφάγεταί

"will consume"

The author uses **consume** to refer to Jesus' intense love for the temple, as if it were a fire that burned within him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will be intense within] or [will be like a fire that consumes]

See: Metaphor

John 2:18 (#1)

ταῦτα

"these things"

Here, **these things** refers to Jesus' actions against the animal sellers and money changers in the temple. (See the discussion of this event in the introduction to this chapter.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these disruptive activities in the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:19 (#2)

λύσατε τὸν ναὸν τοῦτον, καὶ ἐν τρισὶν ἡμέραις ἐγερῶ αὐτόν

"Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up"

Here, John records Jesus using the words **Destroy** and **raise** to describe his killing and resurrection, as if tearing down and rebuilding a building. However, the Jewish leaders did not understand this and Jesus does not explain the metaphor to them. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 2:19 (#1)

λύσατε τὸν ναὸν τοῦτον, καὶ ἐν τρισὶν ἡμέραις ἐγερῶ αὐτόν

"Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up"

This is an imperative, but it should be translated as introducing a hypothetical situation rather than as a command. Jesus is stating a hypothetical situation in which the event in the second clause would happen if the event in the first clause took place. In this case, Jesus would certainly **raise** the **temple** up if the Jewish authorities were to **destroy** it. Alternate translation: [If you destroy this temple, then in three days I will raise it up]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 2:20 (#1)

σὺ ἐν τρισὶν ἡμέραις ἐγερεῖς αὐτόν

"you will raise it up in three days"

The Jewish leaders are using the question form for emphasis. They think that Jesus wants to tear down the temple and rebuild it in three days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you cannot possibly rebuild it in three days!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 2:21 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος δὲ ἔλεγεν

"But that one was speaking"

Here, **that one** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But Jesus was speaking]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 2:21–22 (#1)

2:21–22 are a comment John made about the story that was described in 2:13–20. These verses tell about something that happened later.

See: End of Story

John 2:22 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Therefore indicates that in this verse John is giving the result of Jesus making the statement in 2:19. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because Jesus said this about his body]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 2:22 (#3)

ἐμνήσθησαν οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ

“his disciples remembered”

John is speaking about something that happened long after the event described in the previous verses. See the discussion of this in the introduction to this chapter.

John 2:22 (#2)

ἠγέρθη ἐκ νεκρῶν

“he was raised from the dead”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God raised him from the dead]

See: Active or Passive

John 2:22 (#4)

τοῦτο & τῷ λόγῳ ὃν εἶπεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς

“this & the word that Jesus had spoken”

Here, **this** and **the word** refer back to Jesus’ statement in 2:19. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [this statement about his body ... the word about his body that Jesus had spoken]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:22 (#5)

τῇ Γραφῇ

“the Scripture”

John is speaking of **the Scripture** in general, not of one particular book within the Bible. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [the scriptures]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 2:23 (#5)

τὰ σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 2:23 (#2)

ἐν τῷ Πάσχα ἐν τῇ ἑορτῇ

“at the Passover, at the festival”

These two phrases could refer to: (1) two different parts of the festival, **the Passover** referring to the first day of **the festival**, and **the festival** referring to the Festival of Unleavened Bread that begins at Passover and was one week long. Alternate translation: [at the Passover, during the Festival of Unleavened Bread]; (2) the same event. Alternate translation: [at the Passover festival]

John 2:23 (#3)

ἐπίστευσαν εἰς τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“believed in his name”

Here, **name** represents the person of Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [believed in him] or [trusted in him]

See: Metonymy

John 2:23 (#1)

ὡς δὲ ἦν ἐν τοῖς Ἱεροσολύμοις

“Now when he was in Jerusalem”

Now here introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after the previous events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later in Jerusalem]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 2:23 (#4)

θεωροῦντες αὐτοῦ τὰ σημεῖα

“seeing his signs”

Here, **seeing** indicates the reason why the people were believing in Jesus. These people were only believing in Jesus because of the miracles he performed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because they saw his signs]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 2:24 (#2)

τὸ αὐτὸν γινώσκειν πάντας

“he knew all {men”

Although the word **men** is masculine, John is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [he knew all people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 2:24 (#1)

οὐκ ἐπίστευεν αὐτὸν αὐτοῖς

"did not trust himself to them"

Although many people were believing in him, Jesus knew that their belief was superficial and only lasted as long as he performed miracles for them. Therefore, he did not trust them the way he trusted his true disciples. Alternate translation: [did not trust them as true disciples] or [did not believe their belief in him]

John 2:25 (#2)

τί ἦν ἐν τῷ ἀνθρώπῳ

"what was in man"

This refers to the inner thoughts and desires of people, which some cultures refer to as "the heart." (See the discussion of this in the introduction to this chapter.) If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [what people think] or [the thoughts and desires people have]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 2:25 (#1)

περὶ τοῦ ἀνθρώπου & τί ἦν ἐν τῷ ἀνθρώπῳ

"about man & what was in man"

Although both instances of the word **man** are masculine, John is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [about mankind ... what was in mankind] or [about people ... what was in people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus teaches Nicodemus about being born again (3:1–21)
2. John the Baptist testifies about Jesus (3:22–36)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Light and Darkness
The Bible often speaks of unrighteous people, people who do not do what pleases God, as if they were walking around in darkness. It speaks of light as if it were what enables those sinful people to become righteous, to understand what they are doing wrong, and to begin to obey God. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

The kingdom of God
The kingdom of God is a concept that is very rich in meaning. It includes the idea of eternal life in the presence of God, but it also includes the idea of what the earth will be like in the future when Jesus returns and rules everything, and the idea of life on earth right now, when and where God's wishes are carried out fully. The unifying concept behind all of these ideas is God ruling and people embracing God's rule over their lives. (See: kingdom of God, kingdom of heaven)

Born again
A major idea in this chapter is the spiritual new birth that Jesus says is necessary in order for someone to enter the kingdom of God 3:3–8. Jesus also uses the following expressions to refer to being born again: "born from water and the Spirit" (3:4) and "born from the Spirit" (3:6,8). (See: born again, born of God, new birth)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" twice in this chapter (3:13–14). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 3:1 (#2)

ἦν & ἄνθρωπος ἐκ τῶν Φαρισαίων, Νικόδημος ὄνομα αὐτῷ

"there was a man from the Pharisees, Nicodemus {was} his name"

Here, **there was a man** is used to introduce Nicodemus as a new character in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character. The phrase **from the Pharisees** identifies him as member of a strict Jewish religious sect. Alternate translation: [there was a man named Nicodemus, who was a member of a strict Jewish religious group]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 3:1 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Now here introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related in

the previous chapter. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 3:1 (#3)

ἄρχων τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"a ruler of the Jews"

This phrase means that Nicodemus was a member of the Jewish religious leadership, specifically the Jewish council called the Sanhedrin which made decisions about Jewish law. (See: council) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a member of the Jewish ruling council]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:2 (#3)

οἴδαμεν

"we know"

Here, **we** is exclusive. Nicodemus is only referring to himself and the other members of the Jewish council. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 3:2 (#4)

ἐὰν μὴ ᾖ ὁ Θεὸς μετ' αὐτοῦ

"unless God is with him"

Nicodemus uses **with him** to refer to God's help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [without God's help]

See: Metaphor

John 3:2 (#2)

πρὸς αὐτὸν

"to him"

Here, **him** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:2 (#1)

οὗτος

"This one"

This one here refers to Nicodemus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Nicodemus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:3 (#3)

γεννηθῇ ἄνωθεν

"would be born again"

The word translated as **again** could also be translated as "from above." It could refer to: (1) spiritual rebirth as a second birth that takes place in addition to physical birth. Alternate translation, as in the ULT: [would be born again]; (2) spiritual rebirth as a birth that is caused by God, in which case "above" is a euphemism for God. Alternate translation: [would be born from above]; (3) spiritual rebirth as both a second birth and a birth caused by God. See the discussion of John's use of double meaning in Part 3 of the Introduction to this book. Alternate translation: [would be born again by God]

John 3:3 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω σοι

"Truly, truly I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 3:3 (#2)

γεννηθῇ ἄνωθεν

"would be born again"

The phrase **born again** is a metaphor that refers to spiritual rebirth. See the discussion of this expression in the introduction to this chapter. Nicodemus does not understand this metaphor and Jesus does not explain it to him in this verse. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 3:3 (#5)

τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the kingdom of God"

This phrase refers to both the place where God currently rules in heaven and to the earth when God rules over it in the future. See the discussion of this

concept in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [the place where God rules]

See: Metaphor

John 3:3 (#4)

ἰδεῖν τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"to see the kingdom of God"

Jesus uses **see** to refer to experiencing an event or state. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to experience the kingdom of God] or [to participate in the kingdom of God]

See: Metaphor

John 3:4 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 3:4 (#3)

μὴ δύναται εἰς τὴν κοιλίαν τῆς μητρὸς αὐτοῦ δεύτερον εἰσελθεῖν καὶ γεννηθῆναι

"He is not able to enter a second time into the womb of his mother and to be born, is he"

Nicodemus uses this question to emphasize his belief that a second birth is impossible. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [He surely cannot enter a second time into his mother's womb!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 3:4 (#2)

πῶς δύναται ἄνθρωπος γεννηθῆναι, γέρων ὤν

"How is a man able to be born, being an old man"

Nicodemus uses this question to emphasize that this cannot happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A man certainly cannot be born again when he is old!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 3:5 (#4)

τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the kingdom of God"

See how you translated this phrase in 3:3.

See: Metaphor

John 3:5 (#3)

εἰσελθεῖν εἰς τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"to enter into the kingdom of God"

Jesus uses **enter into** to refer to experiencing something. The meaning is similar to the meaning of "see" in 3:3. Alternate translation: [to experience the kingdom of God] or [to participate in the kingdom of God]

See: Metaphor

John 3:5 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω σοι

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 3:3.

See: Doublet

John 3:5 (#2)

γεννηθῇ ἐξ ὕδατος καὶ Πνεύματος

"would be born from water and Spirit"

The phrase **born from water and Spirit** could refer to: (1) spiritual birth that includes cleansing from sin and spiritual transformation by the Holy Spirit. In this case, Jesus' words would be understood as a reference to Ezekiel 36:25–27, which Nicodemus would have been familiar with. Alternate translation: [would be born again by cleansing and the Spirit.]; (2) physical birth and spiritual birth. Alternate translation: [would be born physically and spiritually]

See: Metaphor

John 3:6 (#1)

τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τῆς σαρκὸς

"What} has been born from the flesh"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [What flesh has given birth to]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:6 (#3)

τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τοῦ Πνεύματος

“what} has been born from the Spirit”

Here, **the Spirit** refers to the Holy Spirit, who enables people to be born again. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [what has been born again by means of the Holy Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:6 (#2)

τῆς σαρκὸς, σάρξ ἐστιν

“the flesh is flesh”

Jesus is describing human beings by referring to something associated with them, the **flesh** they are made of. The word **flesh** here does not refer to sinful human nature as it does in other verses in the New Testament. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a human being is a human being]

See: Metonymy

John 3:6 (#4)

πνεῦμά

“spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to the new spiritual nature that God gives a person when they are born again. (See: born again, born of God, new birth) If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [a new spiritual nature]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:7 (#1)

γεννηθῆναι ἄνωθεν

“to be born again”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:3.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 3:8 (#1)

τὸ πνεῦμα ὅπου θέλει, πνεῖ

“The wind blows where it wishes”

The word translated as **wind** can also mean spirit. Jesus here speaks of the Holy Spirit, as if he were **wind**. Just like people in Jesus’ time could not understand how the **wind** blew but could observe the effects of the wind, people cannot understand how the Holy Spirit works but can witness the effects of his work. If this might confuse your readers, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [The Holy Spirit is like the wind that blows wherever it wants]

See: Metaphor

John 3:8 (#3)

πᾶς ὁ γεγεννημένος ἐκ τοῦ Πνεύματος

“everyone having been born from the Spirit”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:6.

John 3:8 (#2)

οὕτως ἐστὶν

“So is”

This phrase connects this sentence with the previous sentence. In the same way that people cannot understand the wind but recognize its effects, people who are not born from the Spirit cannot understand those who are born from the Spirit but can recognize the effects of the new birth. Alternate translation: [So it is with] or [So it happens with]

John 3:8 (#4)

τοῦ Πνεύματος

“the Spirit”

Here, **the Spirit** refers to the Holy Spirit, who enables people to be born again. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:9 (#1)

πῶς δύναται ταῦτα γενέσθαι

“How are these things able to happen”

This question could be: (1) a genuine question that shows that Nicodemus is confused. Alternate translation: [How are these things possible]; (2) a rhetorical question Nicodemus uses to add emphasis to the statement. Alternate translation: [These things cannot be!] or [These things are impossible!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 3:9 (#2)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** refers to all that Jesus had spoken in 3:3–8. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these things you have just told me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:10 (#2)

σὺ εἶ ὁ διδάσκαλος & οὐ γινώσκεις

“Are you the teacher & you do not understand”

The word **you** is singular and refers to Nicodemus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Are you, Nicodemus, the teacher ... you do not understand]

See: Forms of You

John 3:10 (#1)

σὺ εἶ ὁ διδάσκαλος τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ, καὶ ταῦτα οὐ γινώσκεις

“Are you the teacher of Israel and yet you do not understand these things”

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. He is not asking Nicodemus a question in order to get information. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are a teacher of Israel, so I am surprised you do not understand these things!] or [You are a teacher of Israel, so you should understand these things!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 3:10 (#3)

ὁ διδάσκαλος τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ

“the teacher of Israel”

Here, **the teacher** indicates that Nicodemus was recognized as a master teacher and religious authority in the land of Israel. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the renowned religious teacher in Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:10 (#4)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** refers to all that Jesus had spoken in 3:3–8. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated this phrase is the previous verse. Alternate translation: [these things you have just told me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:11 (#3)

οὐ λαμβάνετε

“you do not receive”

The word **you** is plural and could refer to: (1) the Jewish people in general. Alternate translation: [you Jews]; (2) Nicodemus and his fellow Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [you Jewish leaders do not welcome]

See: Forms of You

John 3:11 (#2)

ὃ οἴδαμεν λαλοῦμεν & τὴν μαρτυρίαν ἡμῶν

“we speak {what} we know & our testimony”

When Jesus says **we** and **our** in this verse, he was not including Nicodemus. Jesus used these pronouns as a contrast to Nicodemus saying **we** in 3:2. While Nicodemus used **we** to refer to himself and the other Jewish religious leaders, Jesus could have been referring to: (1) himself and his disciples. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [my disciples and I speak what we know ... our testimony]; (2) himself and the other members of the Godhead. Alternate translation: [the Father, Spirit, and I speak what we know ... our testimony]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 3:11 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω σοι

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 3:3.

See: Doublet

John 3:12 (#1)

εἰ τὰ ἐπίγεια εἶπον ὑμῖν

“If I told you earthly things”

John records Jesus speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since I told you earthly things]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 3:12 (#2)

ὑμῖν & οὐ πιστεύετε, πῶς ἐὰν εἴπω ὑμῖν & πιστεύσετε

"you & you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you"

Throughout this verse, **you** is plural and could refer to: (1) the Jewish people in general. Alternate translation: [you Jews ... you Jews do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you]; (2) Nicodemus and his fellow Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [you Jewish leaders ... you Jewish leaders do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you] See how you translated this word in the previous verse.

See: Forms of You

John 3:12 (#3)

τὰ ἐπίγεια

"earthly things"

Here, **earthly things** refers to what Jesus had spoken in 3:3–8. Those things are called **earthly** because they are about things that take place on earth. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [these truths about what takes place on earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:12 (#4)

πῶς ἐὰν εἴπω ὑμῖν τὰ ἐπουράνια, πιστεύσετε

"how will you believe if I tell you heavenly things"

Jesus uses a question to emphasize the disbelief of Nicodemus and the Jews. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you certainly will not believe if I tell you about heavenly things!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 3:12 (#5)

τὰ ἐπουράνια

"heavenly things"

Here, **heavenly things** refers to things that take place in heaven or are related to heaven. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [truths about what takes place in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:13 (#2)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

The title **Son of Man** is equivalent to "Messiah." Jesus uses it to claim that role subtly and implicitly. You may want to translate this title directly into your language. On the other hand, if you think it would be helpful to your readers, you could state what it means. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [the Messiah]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:13 (#1)

ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβάς

"the one having descended from heaven"

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, the one who descended from heaven]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:14 (#4)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:14 (#1)

καὶ καθὼς Μωϋσῆς ὕψωσεν τὸν ὄφιν ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ

"And just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness"

In this verse, John records Jesus comparing his crucifixion to Moses lifting up a bronze snake. John assumes that his readers will know that Jesus is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of Numbers. In that story, the Israelites complained against God, and God punished them by sending poisonous snakes to kill them. God then told Moses to make a bronze snake and raise it up on a pole so that whoever was bitten by one of the poisonous snakes and looked at the bronze snake would not die. You could indicate this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation: [And just as Moses lifted

up the bronze serpent on a pole when the Israelites were wandering in the wilderness]

See: Simile

John 3:14 (#3)

ὑψωθῆναι & τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man to be lifted up”

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, the Son of Man, to be lifted up]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:14 (#2)

ὑψωθῆναι δεῖ τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“it is necessary for the Son of Man to be lifted up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it is necessary for people to lift up the Son of Man]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:15 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

Here, **so that** indicates that Jesus is stating the purpose for which he would be crucified. In your translation, follow the conventions of your language for purpose clauses. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 3:16 (#7)

τὸν Υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ

“his One and Only Son”

One and Only Son is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:16 (#6)

τὸν Υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ

“his One and Only Son”

Here and throughout John’s Gospel, the phrase **One and Only** is a title for Jesus that could refer to: (1) Jesus being unique as the only member of his kind. Alternate translation: [his Unique Son]; (2) Jesus being the only child of his Father. Alternate translation: [his Only Begotten Son]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:16 (#3)

τὸν κόσμον

“the world”

Here, **world** refers to the people who live in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 3:16 (#4)

ὥστε

“that”

Here, **that** introduces the result of what the previous clause stated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [as a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 3:16 (#5)

τὸν Υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ

“his One and Only Son”

Here, **One and Only Son** refers to Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [his One and Only Son, Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:16 (#2)

οὕτως & ἠγάπησεν ὁ Θεὸς τὸν κόσμον

“God so loved the world”

Here, **so** could refer to: (1) the manner in which God loved the world. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [God loved the world in this way]; (2) the degree to which God loved the world. Alternate translation: [God loved the world so much]; (3) both the manner in which and the degree to which God loved the world. For this interpretation, see the discussion of John’s use of double meaning in Part 3 of the Introduction to this book. Alternate translation: [in this way God loved the world so much]

John 3:16 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

For here indicates that Jesus is giving a reason why the statement in the previous two verses is true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [This is true because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 3:17 (#3)

τὸν Υἱὸν

“the Son”

Son is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:17 (#6)

ἵνα κρίνῃ

“so that he might condemn”

Here, **he** refers to God; it does not refer to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [so that God might condemn]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:17 (#5)

τὸν κόσμον

“the world”

Here, **world** refers to the universe God created. It does not refer only to the people in the world or only to the earth. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the universe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:17 (#7)

ἵνα κρίνῃ τὸν κόσμον

“so that he might condemn the world”

The word translated as **condemn** means to judge someone to be guilty and deserving of punishment. Alternate translation: [so that he might judge the world as guilty]

John 3:17 (#8)

τὸν κόσμον & τὸν κόσμον

“the world & the world”

Here, **world** refers to the people who live in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people in the world ... the people in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 3:17 (#2)

οὐ γὰρ ἀπέστειλεν ὁ Θεὸς τὸν Υἱὸν εἰς τὸν κόσμον, ἵνα κρίνῃ τὸν κόσμον, ἀλλ’ ἵνα σωθῇ ὁ κόσμος δι’ αὐτοῦ

“For God did not send the Son into the world so that he might condemn the world, but so that the world might be saved through him”

These two clauses mean nearly the same thing, said twice for emphasis, first in the negative and then in the positive. Use whatever form your language uses for emphasis. Alternate translation: [For God truly sent his Son into the world so that he might save it]

See: Parallelism

John 3:17 (#10)

δι’ αὐτοῦ

“through him”

This phrase indicates the means by which God would save the world. Alternate translation: [by means of him]

John 3:17 (#9)

ἵνα σωθῇ ὁ κόσμος

“so that the world might be saved”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [so that God might save the world]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:17 (#4)

τὸν Υἱὸν & δι’ αὐτοῦ

“the Son & through him”

Jesus is speaking about himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person. Alternate translation: [me ... through me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:17 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

For here indicates that Jesus is giving a reason why the statement in the previous verse is true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [God gave his One and Only Son because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 3:18 (#5)

μὴ πεπίστευκεν εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ μονογενοῦς Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“he has not believed in the name of the One and Only Son of God”

Here, **name** represents Jesus’ identity and everything about him. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he has not believed in the One and Only Son of God]

See: Metonymy

John 3:18 (#2)

εἰς αὐτὸν

“in him”

Here, **him** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:18 (#1)

οὐ κρίνεται & ἤδη κέκριται

“is not condemned & has already been condemned”

The word translated as **condemn** means to judge someone to be guilty and deserving of punishment. See how you translated this term in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [is not judged as guilty ... has already been judged as guilty]

John 3:18 (#7)

Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“of & Son of God”

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:18 (#6)

τοῦ μονογενοῦς Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“of the One and Only Son of God”

Here and throughout John’s Gospel, the phrase **One and Only** is a title for Jesus that could refer to: (1) Jesus being unique as the only member of his kind. Alternate translation: [of the Unique Son of God]; (2) Jesus being the only child of his Father. Alternate translation: [of the Only Begotten Son of God]

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:18 (#3)

ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτὸν οὐ κρίνεται

“The one believing in him is not condemned”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God does not condemn the one who believes in him]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:18 (#4)

ὁ δὲ μὴ πιστεύων, ἤδη κέκριται

“but the one not believing has already been condemned”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [but God has already condemned the one who does not believe]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:19 (#4)

οἱ ἄνθρωποι

“men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Jesus uses the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 3:19 (#1)

ἡ κρίσις

“the judgment”

Here, **judgment** could refer to: (1) a verdict a judge pronounces in a court trial. Alternate translation: [the verdict]; (2) the reason for a condemning judgment. Alternate translation: [the basis for condemnation]

John 3:19 (#3)

τὸ φῶς ἐλήλυθεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον & ἢ τὸ φῶς

"the light has come into the world & than the light"

Jesus is speaking about himself in the third person. If your language does not allow people to speak of themselves in the third person, you may need to specify who **the light** is. Alternate translation: [I, the light, have come into the world ... than me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:19 (#5)

ἠγάπησαν οἱ ἄνθρωποι & τὸ σκότος

"men loved the darkness"

Jesus uses **darkness** to refer to what is false and evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See the discussion of light and darkness in the introduction for Chapter 1. Alternate translation: [men loved evil]

See: Metaphor

John 3:19 (#2)

τὸ φῶς ἐλήλυθεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον & ἢ τὸ φῶς

"the light has come into the world & than the light"

Jesus uses **light** to refer to the revelation of God's truth and goodness in Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. See how you translated this term in those places where **the light** also refers to Jesus in the 1:7–9. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who revealed the true and good things of God, has come into the world ... than Jesus]

See: Metaphor

John 3:20 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

For here indicates another reason why men love the darkness, as stated in the previous verse. People who do evil things hate the light. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 3:20 (#4)

τὸ φῶς, καὶ & πρὸς τὸ φῶς

"the light and & to the light"

Jesus is speaking about himself in the third person. If your language does not allow people to speak of themselves in the third person, you may need to specify who **the light** is. Alternate translation: [me, the light, and ... to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:20 (#5)

ἵνα μὴ ἐλεγχθῇ τὰ ἔργα αὐτοῦ

"so that his deeds might not be exposed"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that the light might not expose his deeds]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:20 (#2)

πᾶς & ὁ φαῦλα πράσσων

"everyone is doing evil"

This phrase refers to someone who habitually does evil things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everyone who habitually does evil]

John 3:20 (#3)

τὸ φῶς, καὶ & πρὸς τὸ φῶς

"the light and & to the light"

See how you translated **the light** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who revealed the true and good things of God, and ... to Jesus]

See: Metaphor

John 3:21 (#1)

ὁ & ποιῶν τὴν ἀλήθειαν

"the one doing the truth"

This phrase refers to someone who habitually does true things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everyone who habitually does the truth]

John 3:21 (#3)

ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸ φῶς

“comes to the light”

See how you translated **the light** in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [comes to Jesus, who revealed the true and good things of God]

See: Metaphor

John 3:21 (#4)

ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸ φῶς

“comes to the light”

Jesus is speaking about himself in the third person. If your language does not allow people to speak of themselves in the third person, you may need to specify who **the light** is. See how you translated this expression in the previous two verses.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:21 (#6)

ὅτι ἐν Θεῷ ἐστιν εἰργασμένα

“that they have been worked in God”

This clause indicates what the light will reveal about the deeds of those who come to the light. The phrase **in God** indicates that the works these people have done were done with God’s help and not by their own strength or effort. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that they have been done with God’s help]

John 3:21 (#5)

φανερωθῇ αὐτοῦ τὰ ἔργα

“his deeds might be revealed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the light might reveal his deeds]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:21 (#2)

ὁ & ποιῶν τὴν ἀλήθειαν

“the one doing the truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the one who does true things] or [the one who does what is true]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 3:22 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

“After these things”

This phrase introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 3:23 (#2)

Αἰνὼν

“Aenon”

Aenon is the name of a town near the Jordan River close to Samaria. **Aenon** is the Aramaic word for springs of water, which explains John’s comment in the next clause about there being much water there.

See: How to Translate Names

John 3:23 (#3)

τοῦ Σαλείμ

“Salim”

Salim is the name of a town near the Jordan River close to Samaria.

See: How to Translate Names

John 3:23 (#4)

ἐβαπτίζοντο

“were being baptized”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that John the Baptist did it. Alternate translation: [John was baptizing them] or [he was baptizing them]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:23 (#1)

ὁ Ἰωάννης

“John”

The name **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. If this might confuse your readers, you could

express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:24 (#1)

οὔπω & ἦν βεβλημένος & ὁ Ἰωάννης

“John had not yet been thrown”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Mark 6:17 implies that Herod did it. Alternate translation: [Herod had not yet thrown John]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:25 (#2)

ἐγένετο οὖν ζήτησις ἐκ τῶν μαθητῶν Ἰωάννου μετὰ Ἰουδαίου

“Then a dispute came about from the disciples of John with a Jew”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Then John’s disciples and a Jew began to dispute]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:25 (#1)

ἐγένετο οὖν ζήτησις ἐκ τῶν μαθητῶν Ἰωάννου

“Then a dispute came about from the disciples of John”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dispute**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Then the disciples of John began arguing]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 3:25 (#3)

Ἰωάννου

“of John”

The name **John** refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [of John the Baptist] or [of John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:26 (#1)

ἦλθον

“they went”

Here, **they** refers to John the Baptist’s disciples, who were disputing in the previous verse. If it would be misunderstood in your language, you could state it explicitly. Alternate translation: [John’s disciples went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:26 (#2)

ὃς ἦν μετὰ σοῦ πέραν τοῦ Ἰορδάνου, ᾧ σὺ μεμαρτύρηκας

“the one who was with you beyond the Jordan, about whom you had testified”

This phrase refers to Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who was with you beyond the Jordan, about whom you had testified]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:26 (#3)

ἴδε, οὗτος βαπτίζει

“behold, he is baptizing”

John the Baptist’s disciples used the term **behold** to call John’s attention to what Jesus was doing. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here. Alternate translation: [see how he is baptizing]

See: Metaphor

John 3:26 (#4)

πάντες ἔρχονται πρὸς αὐτόν

“they are all going to him”

John the Baptist’s disciples use the word **all** as a generalization for emphasis. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [it seems like everyone is going to him]

See: Hyperbole

John 3:27 (#2)

ᾖ δεδομένον αὐτῷ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

“it has been given to him from heaven”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [heaven has given it to him]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:27 (#1)

οὐ δύναται ἄνθρωπος

"A man is not able"

John is speaking of people in general, not of one particular man. Alternate translation: [A person is not able]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 3:27 (#3)

ᾖ δεδομένον αὐτῷ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"it has been given to him from heaven"

John the Baptist uses **heaven** to refer to God, who dwells in **heaven**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [it has been given to him by God]

See: Metonymy

John 3:28 (#4)

ἐκείνου

"that one"

Here, **that one** refers to Jesus, whom John has called "the Christ" in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus] or [the Christ]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:28 (#1)

αὐτοὶ ὑμεῖς

"You yourselves"

Here, **You** is plural and refers to all the people to whom John the Baptist is talking. Alternate translation: [You all] or [All of you]

See: Forms of You

John 3:28 (#3)

ἀπεσταλμένος εἰμὶ ἔμπροσθεν ἐκείνου

"I have been sent before that one"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God sent me before that one]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:28 (#2)

ὅτι εἶπον, οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐγὼ ὁ Χριστός, ἀλλ' & ἀπεσταλμένος εἰμὶ ἔμπροσθεν ἐκείνου

"that I said, 'I am not the Christ,' but, 'I have been sent before that one"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [that I said that I am not the Christ but that I have been sent before that one]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 3:29 (#3)

χαρᾷ χαίρει

"rejoices with joy"

These words mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize how much joy John had because Jesus had come. Alternate translation: [rejoices greatly]

See: Doublet

John 3:29 (#4)

αὕτη & ἡ χαρὰ ἡ ἐμὴ πεπλήρωται

"this my joy has been made complete"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I rejoice greatly] or [I rejoice with complete joy]

See: Active or Passive

John 3:29 (#5)

αὕτη & ἡ χαρὰ ἡ ἐμὴ

"this my joy"

Here, **my** refers to John the Baptist, the one who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [this joy that I, John, have]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:29 (#1)

ὁ ἔχων τὴν νύμφην, νυμφίος ἐστίν & τοῦ νυμφίου & τὴν φωνὴν τοῦ νυμφίου

“The one having the bride is the bridegroom & of the bridegroom & of the voice of the bridegroom”

John the Baptist uses **bride** and **bridegroom** to refer to people who believe in Jesus and Jesus himself, respectively. Since these are important terms for Christians and for Jesus, you should translate the words directly and not provide a plain explanation in the text of your translation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words with similes. Alternate translation: [The one who is like one who has a bride is like a bridegroom ... of the one who is like a bridegroom ... of the voice of one who is like a bridegroom]

See: Metaphor

John 3:29 (#2)

ὁ δὲ φίλος τοῦ νυμφίου, ὁ ἑστηκὼς καὶ ἀκούων αὐτοῦ, χαρᾷ χαίρει

“But the friend of the bridegroom, the one having stood and hearing him, rejoices with joy”

John the Baptist is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [But I am the friend of the bridegroom, and I stood and heard him, and I rejoice]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:30 (#2)

αὐξάνειν & ἐλαττοῦσθαι

“to increase & to decrease”

John the Baptist uses **increase** to refer to growing in importance and influence, while **decrease** refers to diminishing in importance and influence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to be more influential ... to be less influential]

See: Metaphor

John 3:30 (#1)

ἐκεῖνον δεῖ αὐξάνειν

“It is necessary for that one to increase”

Here, **that one** refers to Jesus, whom John the Baptist called “the bridegroom” in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [It is necessary for Jesus to increase] or [It is necessary for the bridegroom to increase]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:31 (#5)

ὁ ὢν ἐκ τῆς γῆς, ἐκ τῆς γῆς ἐστιν, καὶ ἐκ τῆς γῆς λαλεῖ

“The one being from the earth is from the earth and speaks from the earth”

John the Baptist is referring to himself in the third person, but the statement is also true for all humans other than Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, the one who is from the earth, am from the earth and speak from the earth]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 3:31 (#1)

ὁ ἄνωθεν ἐρχόμενος, ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν & ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ ἐρχόμενος, ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν

“The one coming from above is above all things & The one coming from heaven is above all things”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. John repeats himself to emphasize that Jesus is greater than every person and every thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine these phrases and include words that show emphasis. Alternate translation: [The one who comes from heaven is certainly above all things]

See: Doublet

John 3:31 (#6)

ἐκ τῆς γῆς ἐστιν

“is from the earth”

This phrase refers to having an earthly origin, which is the case for John the Baptist and every human being other than Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [originates from the earth] or [has an earthly origin]

See: Metaphor

John 3:31 (#2)

ὁ ἄνωθεν ἐρχόμενος, ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν & ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ ἐρχόμενος, ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν

“The one coming from above is above all things & The one coming from heaven is above all things”

Both of these phrases refer to Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus, the one who comes from above, is above all things ... Jesus, the one who comes from heaven, is above all things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:31 (#8)

ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν

“is above all things”

John the Baptist uses **above** to refer to having superior status. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is superior to all things]

See: Metaphor

John 3:31 (#4)

ἐπάνω πάντων ἐστίν

“is above all things”

John the Baptist uses **above** to refer to having superior status. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is superior to all things]

See: Metaphor

John 3:31 (#3)

ἄνωθεν

“from above”

John the Baptist uses **above** to refer to heaven, the place where God dwells. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [from heaven]

See: Metonymy

John 3:31 (#7)

καὶ ἐκ τῆς γῆς λαλεῖ

“and speaks from the earth”

This phrase refers to speaking based on an earthly perspective, which is the perspective of John the Baptist and every human being other than Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and speaks from an earthly perspective] or [and speaks as someone from the earth]

See: Metaphor

John 3:32 (#2)

ὃ ἑώρακεν καὶ ἤκουσεν

“which he has seen and heard”

John assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to what Jesus saw and heard while he was in heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which he has seen and heard in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:32 (#3)

τὴν μαρτυρίαν αὐτοῦ, οὐδεὶς λαμβάνει

“no one receives his testimony”

John the Baptist exaggerates to emphasize that only a few people believed Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [very few people receive his testimony] or [it seems like no one receives his testimony]

See: Hyperbole

John 3:32 (#1)

ὃ ἑώρακεν καὶ ἤκουσεν, τοῦτο μαρτυρεῖ & τὴν μαρτυρίαν αὐτοῦ

“He testifies about that which he has seen and heard & his testimony”

He and **his** in this verse refer to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus testifies about that which he has seen and heard ... Jesus’ testimony]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:33 (#2)

αὐτοῦ τὴν μαρτυρίαν

“his testimony”

Here, **his** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus’ testimony]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:33 (#1)

ὁ λαβὼν αὐτοῦ τὴν μαρτυρίαν

“The one having received his testimony”

This phrase does not refer to a specific person, but to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Anyone who has received his testimony]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 3:33 (#3)

ἐσφράγισεν

“has set his seal”

This expression refers to placing a **seal** on a document in order to certify that what is written in the document is true. (See: seal, sealed, unsealed) Here this meaning is extended to refer to certifying that God is true. If your readers would not be familiar with this practice of sealing documents, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [has certified] or [has attested]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 3:34 (#1)

ὃν & ἀπέστειλεν ὁ Θεὸς

“the one whom God has sent”

John assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Jesus, whom God has sent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:34 (#5)

οὐ & ἐκ μέτρου δίδωσιν τὸ Πνεῦμα

“he does not give the Spirit by measure”

This clause is a figure of speech that expresses a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that means the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [he certainly gives the Spirit without measure]

See: Litotes

John 3:34 (#4)

οὐ & ἐκ μέτρου δίδωσιν τὸ Πνεῦμα

“he does not give the Spirit by measure”

John is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context, especially this discussion of God giving to his Son in the next verse. Alternate translation: [he does not give the Spirit to him by measure]

See: Ellipsis

John 3:34 (#2)

γὰρ

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why the previous sentence is true. We know that Jesus speaks the words of God because God has given him the Holy Spirit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [We know this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 3:34 (#3)

οὐ & δίδωσιν

“he does not give”

Here, **he** refers to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God does not give]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 3:35 (#2)

πάντα δέδωκεν ἐν τῇ χειρὶ αὐτοῦ

“has given all things into his hand”

Here, giving **into his hand** means putting under his power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [has given him control over everything]

See: Idiom

John 3:35 (#1)

Πατὴρ & Υἱόν

“Father & Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:36 (#2)

εἰς τὸν Υἱὸν & τῷ Υἱῷ

“in the Son & the Son”

Son is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 3:36 (#7)

ἡ ὀργὴ τοῦ Θεοῦ μένει ἐπ’ αὐτόν

“the wrath of God remains on him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wrath**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God will continue to be angry against him]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 3:36 (#3)

ὁ δὲ ἀπειθῶν

"but the one disobeying"

This phrase does not refer to a specific person, but to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but anyone who disobeys]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 3:36 (#1)

ὁ πιστεύων

"The one believing"

This phrase does not refer to a specific person, but to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Anyone who believes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 3:36 (#4)

ὁ δὲ ἀπειθῶν

"but the one disobeying"

The word translated as **disobeys** can also be translated as "does not believe." Alternate translation: [but the one who does not believe]

John 3:36 (#6)

οὐκ ὄψεται ζωήν

"will not see life"

Here, **life** refers to eternal life, as indicated by the previous clause. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will not see eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 3:36 (#5)

οὐκ ὄψεται ζωήν

"will not see life"

John the Baptist uses **see** metaphorically to refer to experiencing or participating in something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not experience life]

See: Metaphor

John - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus leaves Judea for Galilee (4:1–6)
2. Jesus meets a Samaritan woman (4:7–14)
3. Jesus teaches the Samaritan woman about worship (4:15–26)
4. Jesus teaches his disciples about evangelism (4:27–38)
5. Jesus' ministry in Samaria (4:39–42)
6. Jesus goes to Galilee (4:43–45)
7. Jesus' second sign: he heals an official's son (4:46–54)

John 4:7–38 forms one story centered on the teaching of Jesus as the "living water" who gives eternal life to all who believe in him. (See: believe, believer, belief, unbeliever, unbelief)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"It was necessary for him to pass through Samaria"
Jews avoided traveling through the region of Samaria, because Jews and Samaritans were longtime enemies who hated each other. So Jesus did what most Jews did not want to do. (See: Samaria, Samaritan)

"an hour is coming"
Jesus used these words to begin prophecies about events that could be shorter or longer than sixty minutes. In such instances, "hour" refers to a point in time when something happens, not a set length of time. For example, "an hour ... when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth" refers to the point in time when people begin to do so (4:23).

The proper place of worship
Long before Jesus came to earth, the Samaritan people had broken the law of Moses by setting up their own temple on Mount Gerizim (4:20). Jesus explained to the Samaritan woman that in the near future it would no longer be important where people worshiped (4:21–24).

Harvest
Harvest refers to the time when people go out to get the food they have planted so they can bring it to their houses and eat it. Jesus used this as a metaphor to

teach his followers that they need to go and tell other people about Jesus so those people can be part of God's kingdom. (See: faith)

"The Samaritan woman"
John probably told this story to show the difference between the Samaritan woman, who believed, and the Jews, who did not believe and would later kill Jesus. (See: believe, believer, belief, unbeliever, unbelief)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"in spirit and truth"
The people who truly know who God is and enjoy worshiping him for who the Bible says he is are the ones who truly please him. The place where they worship him is not important.

John 4:1 (#2)

John 4:1–3 is one long sentence. It may be necessary in your language to divide this long sentence into several shorter sentences.

John 4:1 (#1)

4:1–6 give the background to the next event, which is Jesus' conversation with a Samaritan woman. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 4:1 (#3)

ὡς οὖν ἔγνω ὁ Ἰησοῦς ὅτι ἤκουσαν οἱ Φαρισαῖοι, ὅτι Ἰησοῦς πλείονας μαθητὰς ποιεῖ καὶ βαπτίζει ἢ Ἰωάννης

"Then when Jesus knew that the Pharisees heard that Jesus is making and baptizing more disciples than John"

If it would be natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [Now Jesus was making and baptizing more disciples than John. When he knew that the Pharisees had heard that he was doing this]

See: Information Structure

John 4:1 (#4)

ὡς οὖν ἔγνω ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"Then when Jesus knew"

Then here introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later, when Jesus knew]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 4:2 (#2)

ἀλλ' οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ

"but his disciples"

John is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [but his disciples were baptizing people]

See: Ellipsis

John 4:2 (#1)

Ἰησοῦς αὐτὸς οὐκ ἐβάπτιζεν

"Jesus himself was not baptizing"

Here, **himself** is used to emphasize that Jesus was not baptizing disciples, but his disciples were doing the baptizing. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis.

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 4:5 (#1)

ἔρχεται οὖν

"Then he comes"

Then here indicates that the events the story will now relate came after the event just described in 4:3. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [After leaving Judea, he comes]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 4:5 (#2)

ἔρχεται

"he comes"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:5 (#3)

Συχὰρ

"Sychar"

Sychar is the name of a place.

See: How to Translate Names

John 4:6 (#4)

ἐκ τῆς ὁδοιπορίας

“from the journey”

This phrase indicates the reason why Jesus had grown weary. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because of the journey]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:6 (#1)

ἐκεῖ

“there”

In this case, **there** refers to the town of Sychar mentioned in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [there at Sychar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:6 (#3)

κεκοπιακὼς

“having grown weary”

This clause indicates the reason why Jesus sat by the well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because he had grown weary]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:6 (#5)

ὥρα ἦν ὡς ἕκτη

“It was about the sixth hour”

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. Here, **the sixth hour** indicates a time in the middle of the day, when it would be the hottest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [about noon] or [about 12:00 PM]

John 4:6 (#2)

ὁ οὖν Ἰησοῦς

“Then Jesus”

Then here indicates that the events the story will now relate came after the event just described in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [When Jesus came to Sychar]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 4:7 (#1)

ἔρχεται & λέγει

“comes & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:7 (#2)

δός μοι πεῖν

“Give me to drink”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please give me to drink]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 4:7 (#3)

δός μοι πεῖν

“Give me to drink”

John records Jesus leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [Give me something to drink]

See: Ellipsis

John 4:8 (#1)

οἱ γὰρ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ ἀπεληλύθεισαν

“for his disciples had gone away”

This phrase indicates the reason why Jesus asked the woman for water. The disciples had gone away and taken the tools for drawing water with them, so that Jesus could not draw the water himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because his disciples had gone away]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:9 (#2)

πῶς σὺ Ἰουδαῖος ὢν, παρ’ ἐμοῦ πεῖν αἰτεῖς γυναικὸς Σαμαρείτιδος οὔσης

“How do you, being a Jew, ask from me to drink, being a Samaritan woman”

The woman is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate her words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I cannot believe that you, being a Jew, are asking a Samaritan woman for a drink!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 4:9 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:9 (#3)

οὐ & συνχρῶνται

“do not have dealings with”

Alternate translation: [do not associate with] or [have nothing to do with]

John 4:10 (#4)

τίς ἐστιν ὁ λέγων σοι & ἂν ᾔτησας αὐτὸν, καὶ ἔδωκεν ἄν

“who is the one saying to you & would have asked him, and he would have given”

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [who I am who is saying to you ... would have asked me, and I would have given]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 4:10 (#6)

ὕδωρ ζῶν

“living water”

The phrase **living water** usually refers to moving or flowing water. However, Jesus uses **living water** here to refer to the Holy Spirit who works in a person to save and transform them. However, the woman does not understand this and Jesus does not explain the metaphor to her in this verse. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 4:10 (#2)

τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the gift of God”

Here, **the gift of God** refers to the “living water” that Jesus mentions at the end of the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God’s gift of living water]

John 4:10 (#3)

τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the gift of God”

Jesus uses **of** to describe a **gift** that comes from **God**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the gift from God]

See: Possession

John 4:10 (#5)

ὁ λέγων σοι, δός μοι πεῖν

“the one saying to you, ‘Give me to drink”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [who is asking you to give him a drink]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 4:10 (#1)

εἰ ᾔδεις τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ τίς ἐστιν ὁ λέγων σοι & σὺ ἂν ᾔτησας αὐτὸν

“If you had known the gift of God and who is the one saying to you & you would have asked him”

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he knows that the condition is not true. He knows that the woman does not know the gift of God or who he is. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [You surely do not know the gift of God and who it is who is saying to you ... Otherwise, you would have asked him]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 4:11 (#2)

κύριε

“Sir”

The Samaritan woman calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 4:11 (#3)

τὸ ὕδωρ τὸ ζῶν

“the living water”

See how you translated **the living water** in the previous verse.

John 4:11 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:12 (#3)

καὶ οἱ υἱοὶ αὐτοῦ, καὶ τὰ θρέμματα αὐτοῦ

“and his sons and his cattle”

John records the woman leaving out some words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and his sons drank water from it and his cattle drank water from it]

See: Ellipsis

John 4:12 (#1)

μὴ σὺ μείζων εἶ τοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν Ἰακώβ, ὃς ἔδωκεν ἡμῖν τὸ φρέαρ, καὶ αὐτὸς ἐξ αὐτοῦ ἔπιεν, καὶ οἱ υἱοὶ αὐτοῦ, καὶ τὰ θρέμματα αὐτοῦ

“You are not greater, are you, than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank from it himself, and his sons and his cattle”

The woman is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate her words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are certainly not greater than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank from it himself, and his sons and his cattle!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 4:12 (#2)

ἐξ αὐτοῦ ἔπιεν

“drank from it”

John records the woman leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [drank water from it]

See: Ellipsis

John 4:13 (#1)

διψήσει πάλιν

“will thirst again”

Alternate translation: [will need to drink water again]

John 4:14 (#1)

ὃς δ’ ἂν πίῃ ἐκ τοῦ ὕδατος οὗ ἐγὼ δώσω αὐτῷ, οὐ μὴ διψήσει & τὸ ὕδωρ ὃ δώσω αὐτῷ γενήσεται ἐν αὐτῷ πηγὴ ὕδατος, ἁλλομένου εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“but whoever drinks from the water that I will give him will never thirst & the water that I will give him will become a fountain of water in him, springing up to eternal life”

Jesus speaks about receiving the Holy Spirit by continuing the metaphor of water. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [but whoever is like one who drinks from the water that I will give him will be like one who never thirsts ... the water that I will give him will become like a fountain of water in him, resulting in eternal life]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:15 (#2)

κύριε

“Sir”

The Samaritan woman calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 4:15 (#3)

ἀντλεῖν

“to draw {water”

Here, **draw** refers to taking water out of a well using a container that can hold water. Alternate translation: [get water] or [pull water up from the well]

John 4:15 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:16 (#1)

λέγει

“He says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:17 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:17 (#2)

καλῶς εἶπας & ἄνδρα οὐκ ἔχω

“You have rightly said, ‘I do not have a husband”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [You have rightly said that you do not have a husband]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 4:18 (#1)

τοῦτο ἀληθὲς εἴρηκας

“This you have said is true”

This you have said refers to the Samaritan woman’s statement in the previous verse that she did not have a husband. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You have spoken the truth when you said you do not have a husband]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:19 (#2)

κύριε

“Sir”

The Samaritan woman calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 4:19 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:19 (#3)

θεωρῶ ὅτι προφήτης εἶ σύ

“I see that you are a prophet”

The woman uses **see** to refer to understanding something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I understand that you are a prophet]

See: Metaphor

John 4:20 (#1)

ἐν τῷ ὄρει τούτῳ

“on this mountain”

Here, **this mountain** refers to Mount Gerizim, the mountain where the Samaritans built their own temple. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [here on Mount Gerizim]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:20 (#3)

ὁ τόπος

“the place”

Here, **the place** refers to the Jewish temple, the place where God commanded his people to worship at that time. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:20 (#2)

ὑμεῖς λέγετε

“you say”

Here the word **you** is plural and refers to the Jewish people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you Jewish people say]

See: Forms of You

John 4:21 (#2)

γύναι

“woman”

Here, **woman** refers to the Samaritan woman. If it is impolite to call someone "woman" in your language, you can use another word that is polite, or leave it out.

John 4:21 (#3)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

"an hour is coming"

Here, **hour** refers to a point in time when something happens. It does not refer to a 60-minute length of time. See the discussion of this in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [a point in time is coming]

See: Metonymy

John 4:21 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:21 (#4)

Πατρί

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 4:21 (#5)

ἐν τῷ ὄρει τούτῳ

"on this mountain"

Here, **this mountain** refers to Mount Gerizim. See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [here on Mount Gerizim]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:22 (#3)

ὅτι ἡ σωτηρία ἐκ τῶν Ἰουδαίων ἐστίν

"for salvation is from the Jews"

The phrase **from the Jews** indicates that the Jewish people were the people group from which **salvation** came. This is true because the Savior Jesus was from the Jewish people. This phrase does not mean that the Jewish people themselves will save others from their sins. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for salvation comes from among the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:22 (#4)

ἡ σωτηρία

"salvation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the way to be saved]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 4:22 (#2)

ἡμεῖς & οἴδαμεν

"We & we know"

We here is exclusive. Jesus is only referring to himself and the Jewish people. Your language may require you to mark this form. Alternate translation: [We Jewish people ... we all know]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 4:22 (#1)

ὑμεῖς & οὐκ οἴδατε

"You & you do not know"

You is plural here in this verse and refers to the Samaritan people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you Samaritan people ... you all do not know]

See: Forms of You

John 4:23 (#2)

τῷ Πατρὶ & ὁ Πατὴρ

"the Father & the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 4:23 (#4)

ἐν πνεύματι καὶ ἀληθείᾳ

"in spirit and truth"

Here, **truth** refers to thinking correctly of what is true about God, which is revealed in the Bible. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another

way. Alternate translation: [in spirit and in accordance with God's Word]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 4:23 (#1)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

"an hour is coming"

See the discussion of **an hour is coming** in the introduction to this chapter and see how you translated this phrase in verse 21.

See: Metonymy

John 4:23 (#3)

ἐν πνεύματι

"in spirit"

Here, **spirit** could refer to: (1) the inner person, which is what a person thinks and feels. Alternate translation: [with their spirits]; (2) the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [in the Holy Spirit]

John 4:24 (#1)

ἐν πνεύματι καὶ ἀληθείᾳ

"in spirit and truth"

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

John 4:25 (#5)

ἡμῖν

"to us"

When the woman said "us," she was including the people to whom she was speaking, so this would be inclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 4:25 (#3)

ὅταν ἔλθῃ ἐκεῖνος

"When he comes, that one"

Here, **he** and **that one** refer to the Messiah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When the Messiah may come, the Messiah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:25 (#4)

ἐκεῖνος, ἀναγγελεῖ ἡμῖν ἅπαντα

"that one will declare everything to us"

The words **declare everything** imply all that the people need to know. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he will tell us all that we need to know]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:25 (#2)

ὁ λεγόμενος Χριστός

"the one called Christ"

Christ is the Greek translation of **Messiah**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the one called Christ in the Greek language]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:25 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:26 (#2)

ὁ λαλῶν σοι

"the one speaking to you"

Jesus is referring to himself in third person. If this would confuse your readers, you can use the first person form, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 4:26 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:27 (#1)

ἐπὶ τούτῳ

"at this"

Alternate translation: [at the time he said this] or [just as Jesus was saying this]

John 4:27 (#2)

καὶ ἐθαύμαζον ὅτι μετὰ γυναικὸς ἐλάλει

"and they were amazed that he was speaking with a woman"

In the culture of that time, it was very unusual for a Jew to speak with a **woman** he did not know, especially if they were alone or if that woman was a Samaritan. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they were amazed that he was speaking alone with an unknown woman, because people did not usually do that]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:27 (#3)

τί ζητεῖς

"What are you seeking"

This question could be spoken to: (1) Jesus. Alternate translation: [What do you want from this woman?]; (2) the woman. Alternate translation: [What do you want from him?]

John 4:28 (#2)

τοῖς ἀνθρώποις

"to the men"

Here, **the men** could refer to: (1) the men who lived in the nearby town and would have been working out in the fields at that time. Alternate translation: [to the men of the town]; (2) the people who lived in the nearby town. Alternate translation: [to the people of the town]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 4:28 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:29 (#1)

δεῦτε, ἴδετε ἄνθρωπον ὃς εἶπέ μοι πάντα ὅσα ἐποίησα

"Come, see a man who told me all things, as much as I have done"

The Samaritan woman exaggerates to show that she is impressed by how much Jesus knows about her. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Come see a man who knows very much about me even though I never met him before]

See: Hyperbole

John 4:29 (#2)

μήτι οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ Χριστός

"This is not the Christ, is it"

This question is not a rhetorical question. The woman is not sure that Jesus is the **Christ**, so she asks a question that expects "no" for an answer. However, the fact that she asked the question instead of making a statement indicates that she is uncertain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a way that shows her uncertainty. Alternate translation: [Is it even possible that this is the Christ?]

John 4:30 (#1)

ἐξῆλθον

"They went out"

They here refers to the men or people from the town to whom the woman had spoken. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Your translation will depend on how you translated "the men" in verse 28. Alternate translation: [The men of the town went out] or [The nearby townspeople went out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:31 (#2)

ἠρώτων αὐτὸν οἱ μαθηταὶ λέγοντες

"the disciples were urging him, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [the disciples were urging him, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 4:31 (#3)

Ῥαββεί, φάγε

"Rabbi, eat"

Here, **eat** is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your

language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Rabbi, please eat]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 4:31 (#1)

ἐν τῷ μεταξὺ

"In the meantime"

Alternate translation: [While the woman was going into town] or [During the time that the woman was in the town]

John 4:32 (#1)

ἐγὼ βρῶσιν ἔχω φαγεῖν

"I have food to eat"

Jesus uses the word **food** to refer to doing God's will, as he states in 4:34. However, his disciples do not understand this and Jesus does not explain the metaphor to them in this verse. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 4:33 (#1)

μή τις ἤνεγκεν αὐτῷ φαγεῖν

"No one brought him to eat, did he"

The disciples think Jesus is literally talking about something **to eat**. They begin asking each other this question, expecting a "no" response. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a way that shows their uncertainty. Alternate translation: [Is it even possible that someone brought him food to eat?]

John 4:34 (#3)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

"of the one having sent me"

Here, **the one who sent me** refers to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of God, the one who sent me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:34 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:34 (#2)

ἐμὸν βρῶμά ἐστιν ἵνα ποιήσω τὸ θέλημα τοῦ πέμψαντός με, καὶ τελειώσω αὐτοῦ τὸ ἔργον

"My food is that I might do the will of the one having sent me and might complete his work"

Here Jesus uses **food** to refer to obeying God's **will**. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [Like food satisfies a hungry person, doing the will of the one who sent me and completing his work satisfies me]

See: Metaphor

John 4:35 (#5)

λευκαί εἰσιν πρὸς θερισμόν ἤδη

"they are already white for harvest"

Jesus uses the phrase **white for harvest** to say that people are ready to receive the message of Jesus, like fields that are ready to be harvested. If it would be helpful in your language, you could convey the meaning with a simile or do it plainly. Alternate translation: [they are like a field that is ready to be harvested] or [they are already ready to believe my message]

See: Metaphor

John 4:35 (#1)

οὐχ ὑμεῖς λέγετε & ἔτι τετράμηνός ἐστιν καὶ ὁ θερισμὸς ἔρχεται

"Do you not say, 'There are still four months, and the harvest comes"

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You surely say, 'There are still four months, and the harvest comes'!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 4:35 (#2)

ἰδοὺ

"Behold"

Jesus using the term **Behold** to call the disciples' attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here.

See: Metaphor

John 4:35 (#3)

ἐπάρατε τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς ὑμῶν

“lift up your eyes”

This phrase, **lift up your eyes**, is a common idiom in the Bible that is used to describe the act of looking at something or direct one’s own attention toward something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [look]

See: Idiom

John 4:35 (#4)

θεάσασθε τὰς χώρας

“see the fields”

Jesus uses the word **fields** to refer to people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning with a simile or plainly. Alternate translation: [see these people who are like fields] or [see these people]

See: Metaphor

John 4:36 (#2)

μισθὸν, λαμβάνει

“receives wages”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. Those who proclaim Jesus’ message are described as those who receive **wages** for their labor. Here, **wages** refers to the joy those who proclaim the message will receive, as indicated by the last clause in this verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [has great joy that is like wages]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:36 (#4)

ὁ σπείρων

“the one sowing”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. The act of **sowing** seed is used to refer to the act of preparing people to receive Jesus’ message. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [the one who is preparing people to receive the message is like one who is sowing seed]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:36 (#1)

ὁ θερίζων & καὶ ὁ θερίζων

“The one harvesting & and the one harvesting”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. The act of **harvesting** crops is used to refer to the act of proclaiming Jesus’ message to those who are ready to receive it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [The one who is proclaiming the message to those who are being saved is like one who is harvesting ... and the one who is like a harvester]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:36 (#3)

καὶ συνάγει καρπὸν εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“and gathers fruit for eternal life”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. Jesus uses the phrase **fruit for eternal life** to refer to people who believe his message and are forgiven for their sins, so that they can have eternal life with God in heaven. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a simile. Alternate translation: [and the people who believe the message and receive eternal life are like the fruit that the one who is harvesting gathers]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:37 (#3)

ὁ θερίζων

“the one harvesting”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. This is part of an extended metaphor in verses 35–38. Here, **harvesting** refers to proclaiming the message of Jesus to those already prepared to receive it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [the one proclaiming the message to those who are receiving it is like one harvesting]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:37 (#1)

ἐν & τούτῳ

“in this”

Here, **this** could refer to: (1) the statements in the rest of this verse and the next verse. Alternate translation: [regarding what I am about to say,]; (2) the statement in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [regarding what I have just said,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:37 (#2)

ἄλλος ἐστὶν ὁ σπείρων

“One is the one sowing”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. This is part of an extended metaphor in verses 35–38. Here, **sowing** is used to refer to preparing people to receive the message of Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [One preparing people to receive the message is like one sowing]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:38 (#3)

ὃ οὐχ ὑμεῖς κεκοπιάκατε

“that on which you have not labored”

This phrase refers to those who received Jesus’ message when his disciples proclaimed it to them. Although the disciples did not prepare those people to receive the message, they enjoyed the benefits of seeing those people trust in Jesus for salvation. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [those people whom you previously did not prepare to receive the message]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:38 (#2)

ἐγὼ ἀπέστειλα ὑμᾶς θερίζειν

“I sent you to harvest”

Jesus continues to speak to describe people proclaiming and receiving his message. This is part of an extended metaphor in verses 35–38. Here, **harvest** refers to proclaiming the message of Jesus to those already prepared to receive it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [I sent you to successfully proclaim my message like those who harvest]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 4:38 (#4)

ἄλλοι κεκοπιάκασιν

“Others have labored”

Others here refers to those people who prepared people to receive Jesus’ message before Jesus’ disciples successfully proclaimed that message to them. This would include Jesus, John the Baptist, and possibly the Old Testament prophets as well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Others such as myself and the prophets have labored]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:38 (#1)

ὑμᾶς & ὑμεῖς & ὑμεῖς

“you & you & you”

In this verse **you** is plural and refers to the disciples to whom Jesus is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you who are my disciples … you … you disciples]

See: Forms of You

John 4:38 (#5)

ὑμεῖς εἰς τὸν κόπον αὐτῶν εἰσεληλύθατε

“you have entered into their labor”

Here, **entered into** means to have joined others or participated with others in doing something. Alternate translation: [you have joined in doing their work]

John 4:39 (#2)

εἶπέν μοι πάντα ἃ ἐποίησα

“He told me all things that I have done”

Here, **all things** is an exaggeration. The woman was impressed by how much Jesus knew about her. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [He told me many things that I have done]

See: Hyperbole

John 4:39 (#1)

ἐκ & τῆς πόλεως ἐκείνης

“from that city”

Here, **that city** refers to the Samaritan city of Sychar. You could include this information if that would be

helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from Sychar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:40 (#1)

πρὸς αὐτὸν & αὐτὸν & ἔμεινεν

“to him & him & he stayed”

In this verse **him** and **he** refer to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to Jesus ... Jesus ... Jesus stayed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:41 (#1)

τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ

“his word”

Here, **word** refers to the message that Jesus proclaimed. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his message]

See: Metonymy

John 4:42 (#4)

τοῦ κόσμου

“of the world”

Here, **world** refers to everyone throughout the world who believes in Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the believers in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 4:42 (#1)

ἔλεγον

“they said”

Here, **they** refers to the Samaritans from Sychar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the local Samaritans said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:42 (#3)

οὗτός

“this one”

Here, **this one** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [this man, Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:42 (#2)

πιστεύομεν & ἀκηκόαμεν & οἴδαμεν

“We & believe & we & have heard & we know”

We throughout this verse refers to the Samaritan townspeople who came to Jesus apart from the Samaritan woman, so the pronoun would be exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 4:43 (#2)

ἐκεῖθεν

“from there”

Here, **there** could refer to: (1) the Samaritan city of Sychar. Alternate translation: [from Sychar]; (2) the region of Samaria in general. Alternate translation: [from Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:43 (#1)

μετὰ δὲ τὰς δύο ἡμέρας

“Now after the two days”

This phrase introduces a new event that happened after the events the story has just related. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [After he had spent two days in Samaria]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 4:44 (#2)

αὐτὸς γὰρ Ἰησοῦς ἐμαρτύρησεν

“for Jesus himself testified”

The reflexive pronoun **himself** is added to emphasize that Jesus had **testified** or said this. You can translate this in your language in a way that will give emphasis to a person.

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 4:44 (#1)

γὰρ

“for”

Here, **for** indicates that this verse provides one reason why Jesus wanted to go to Galilee. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [he went to Galilee because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:44 (#3)

προφήτης ἐν τῇ ἰδίᾳ πατρίδι, τιμὴν οὐκ ἔχει

“a prophet has no honor in his own country”

Alternate translation: [people do not show respect or honor to a prophet of their own country] or [a prophet is not respected by the people in his own community]

John 4:44 (#4)

ἐν τῇ ἰδίᾳ πατρίδι

“in his own country”

This could refer to: (1) the whole region of Galilee where Jesus came from. Alternate translation: [in the Galilee region where he was from]; (2) the specific town Jesus grew up in, which is Nazareth. Alternate translation: [in his hometown of Nazareth]

John 4:45 (#4)

πάντα ἑωρακότες

“having seen all {the things”

Here, **all** is an exaggeration that refers to the Galileans having seen many of Jesus’ miracles. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [having seen many of the things]

See: Hyperbole

John 4:45 (#1)

ὅτε οὖν

“When therefore”

Here, **therefore** indicates that what follows is the result of what Jesus had testified in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [As a result of this being true, when]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:45 (#3)

πάντα ἑωρακότες

“having seen all {the things”

This clause indicates the reason why the Galileans welcomed Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because they had seen all the things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 4:45 (#5)

ἐν τῇ ἑορτῇ & εἰς τὴν ἑορτήν

“at the festival & to the festival”

Here, **the festival** refers the Passover festival, as indicated in 2:12–25. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the Passover festival ... to the Passover]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:45 (#2)

ἐδέξαντο αὐτὸν οἱ Γαλιλαῖοι

“the Galileans welcomed him”

Since this verse gives the result of Jesus saying in the previous verse that a prophet was not honored in his own country, it is important to indicate that welcoming Jesus was not the same as honoring him. They **welcomed him** because he did miracles, not because they honored him as a prophet. Alternate translation: [the Galileans only welcomed him]

John 4:46 (#2)

καὶ ἦν τις βασιλικὸς

“and there was a certain royal official”

This phrase introduces a new character in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character. The expression **royal official** identifies this man as someone who was in the service of the king. Since he is a new participant, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could call him something like “a man who was a government official who served the king”

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 4:46 (#1)

οὖν

“Then”

Then indicates that the events which the story will now relate came after the event it has just described. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alter-

nate translation: [After Jesus entered Galilee and the Galileans welcomed him]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 4:47 (#2)

ἤμελλεν

"he was about"

Here, **he** refers to the royal official's son. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the official's son was about]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:47 (#1)

οὗτος

"He"

He here refers to the royal official. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The official]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:48 (#2)

ἴδητε & πιστεύσητε

"you would see & you would & believe"

The word **you** is plural in this verse. This means that Jesus was not only speaking to the royal official, but also to the other people who were there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you all would see ... you all would ... believe]

See: Forms of You

John 4:48 (#3)

σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα

"signs and wonders"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **wonders** describes the character of Jesus' miraculous **signs**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [wonderful miraculous signs]

See: Hendiadys

John 4:48 (#1)

ἐὰν μὴ σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα ἴδητε, οὐ μὴ πιστεύσητε

"Unless you would see signs and wonders, you would certainly not believe"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [Only if you see signs and wonders will you believe]

See: Double Negatives

John 4:49 (#2)

κύριε

"Sir"

The royal official calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. See how you translated this word in 4:11. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 4:49 (#3)

κατάβηθι

"come down"

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [please come down]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 4:49 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:50 (#2)

ὁ ἄνθρωπος

"The man"

Here, **The man** refers to the royal official who was introduced in verse 46. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The royal official]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:50 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 4:50 (#3)

ἐπίστευσεν & τῷ λόγῳ

“believed the word”

Here, **word** refers to all that Jesus said to the man. It does not refer to one specific word that Jesus said. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [believed the words]

See: Metonymy

John 4:51 (#1)

αὐτοῦ

“he”

In this verse **he**, **his**, and **him** refer to the royal official who was introduced in verse 46. If it would be misunderstood to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the royal official]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:51 (#2)

λέγοντες, ὅτι ὁ παῖς αὐτοῦ ζῇ

“saying that his son lives”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. You will also need to adjust the sentence to indicate to whom they are speaking. Alternate translation: [saying, “Your son lives!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 4:52 (#3)

ὥραν ἑβδόμην

“at the seventh hour”

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. Here, the seventh hour indicates a time in the middle of the day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [at about one o’clock in the afternoon]

John 4:52 (#1)

ἐπύθετο οὖν τὴν ὥραν παρ’ αὐτῶν ἐν ᾗ κομψότερον ἔσχεν

“So he asked from them the hour in which he began to improve”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [So he asked from them, “In what hour did he begin to improve?”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 4:52 (#2)

κομψότερον ἔσχεν

“he began to improve”

Here, **he** refers to the royal official’s son who was ill. If it would be misunderstood to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his son began to improve]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 4:53 (#1)

ὁ πατὴρ

“the father”

Here, **the father** refers to the royal official who was introduced in verse 46. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the royal official]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 4:53 (#3)

ἐπίστευσεν αὐτὸς

“he himself & believed”

John uses the word **himself** to emphasize the importance of this event. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [that same royal official ... believed]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 4:53 (#2)

εἶπεν αὐτῷ ὁ Ἰησοῦς, ὁ υἱός σου ζῇ

“Jesus had said to him, “Your son lives”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Jesus had said to him that his son lives]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 4:54 (#1)

τοῦτο δὲ πάλιν δεύτερον σημεῖον ἐποίησεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"Now Jesus again did this second sign"

This verse is a comment about the events described in 4:46–53. John wrote much about the miraculous signs Jesus did. This is the second of those signs. Alternate translation: [That was the second sign Jesus did]

John 4:54 (#2)

σημεῖον

"sign"

See how you translated the term **sign** in 2:11. See also the discussion of signs in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracle]

John - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus' third sign: he heals a paralyzed man (5:1–9)
2. Jewish leaders oppose Jesus' ministry (5:10–18)
3. Jesus says he is equal with God (5:19–30)
4. Jesus' witnesses are John the Baptist, Jesus' works, God, and the Scriptures (5:31–47)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Healing water

Many of the Jews believed that God would heal people who got into some of the pools in Jerusalem when the waters were "stirred up." The man Jesus healed in this chapter was one of those people (5:2–7).

Testimony

In the Bible, a testimony is what one person says about another person. What a person says about himself is not as important as what other people say about that person. In this chapter, Jesus tells the Jews that God had told them who Jesus was, so he did not need to tell them who he was (5:34–37). This was because God had told the writers of the Old Testament what his Messiah would do, and Jesus had done everything they had written that he would do (5:44–47).

The resurrection of life and the resurrection of judgment

In this chapter, Jesus mentions two resurrections, the resurrection of life and the resurrection of judgment (5:28–29). Regarding the resurrection of life, God will make some people alive again, and they will live with him forever, because he gives them his grace. Regarding the resurrection of judgment, God will make some people alive again and they will live apart from him forever, because he will treat them justly.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The Son, the Son of God, and the Son of Man

Jesus refers to himself in this chapter as the "Son" (5:19), the "Son of God" (5:25), and the "Son of Man" (5:27). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. (See: First, Second or Third Person)

"Son of Man"

Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" in this chapter (5:27). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 5:1 (#3)

ἀνέβη & εἰς Ἱεροσόλυμα

"went up to Jerusalem"

Jerusalem is located on the top of a hill. Therefore, roads to **Jerusalem** went **up**. If your language has a different word for going up a hill than for walking on level ground or going down a gill, you should use it here.

John 5:1 (#2)

μετὰ ταῦτα

"After these things"

This phrase introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 5:1 (#1)

5:1–4 give background information about the setting of the story. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 5:2 (#3)

Βηθζαθά

"Bethesda"

Bethesda is the name of a place.

See: How to Translate Names

John 5:2 (#4)

στοὰς

“roofed porches”

These **porches** were structures with roofs that had at least one wall missing and were attached to the sides of buildings.

John 5:2 (#2)

Ἑβραϊστὶ

“in Hebrew”

When John says **in Hebrew** in his Gospel, he refers to the language spoken by the Jews during his time. This language is now called Jewish Aramaic. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in Jewish Aramaic]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:2 (#1)

κολυμβήθρα

“a pool”

This **pool** was a large manmade hole in the ground that people filled with water and used for bathing. Sometimes they lined these pools with tiles or stones.

John 5:5 (#1)

ἦν δέ τις ἄνθρωπος ἐκεῖ

“Now a certain man was there”

This verse introduces the man lying beside the pool as a new character to the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 5:5 (#2)

ἦν & ἐκεῖ

“was there”

Here, **there** refers being at the pool called Bethesda in verse 2. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [was at the Bethesda pool]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:6 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 5:7 (#1)

κύριε

“Sir”

The man calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 5:7 (#4)

ἄλλος πρὸ ἐμοῦ καταβαίνει

“another goes down before me”

The man believed that only the first person to enter the water after the water stirred would be healed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [another goes down before me and is healed]

John 5:7 (#3)

εἰς τὴν κολυμβήθραν

“into the pool”

See how you translated **pool** in verse 2.

John 5:7 (#2)

ὅταν ταραχθῇ τὸ ὕδωρ

“when the water is stirred up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, verse 4 indicates who the man believed was doing the action. Alternate translation: [when an angel moves the water]

See: Active or Passive

John 5:8 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 5:9 (#1)

δὲ & ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ

“Now that day”

John uses the word **Now** to show that the words that follow provide background information for a new event in the story that takes place in 5:10–13. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [The day on which Jesus healed the man]

See: Background Information

John 5:10 (#3)

Σάββατόν ἐστιν

“It is the Sabbath”

Your language might use an indefinite article rather than the definite article here, since the synagogue ruler is not speaking of a specific Sabbath. Alternate translation: [It is a Sabbath day]

John 5:10 (#2)

τῷ τεθεραπευμένῳ

“to the one healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John indicates who did the action in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [to the one whom Jesus had healed]

See: Active or Passive

John 5:10 (#1)

ἔλεγον οὖν οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“So the Jews said”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 5:10 (#4)

οὐκ ἔξεστίν σοι ἆραι τὸν κράβαττον σου

“not permitted for you to carry your bed”

The Jewish leaders (who were probably Pharisees) said this because they thought that the man was doing work by carrying his mat, and so he was disobeying God’s command to rest and not work on the Sabbath. (See: law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God; and Sabbath) If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [it is not permitted for you, according to our law, to carry your mat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:11 (#1)

ὁ ποιήσας με ὑγιῆ

“The one having made me healthy”

Alternate translation: [The one who made me well] or [The one who healed me of my illness]

John 5:11 (#2)

ἐκεῖνός μοι εἶπεν, ἆρον τὸν κράβαττόν σου

“that one said to me, ‘Pick up your bed”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [that one said to me to pick up my mat]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 5:12 (#2)

ὁ εἰπών σοι, ἆρον

“having said to you, ‘Pick {it} up”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [who told you to pick it up]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 5:12 (#1)

ἠρώτησαν αὐτόν

“They asked him”

They here refers to the Jewish leaders and **him** refers to the man whom Jesus had healed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The Jewish leaders asked the man who was healed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:13 (#2)

τίς ἐστιν

“who it was”

John is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply

these words from the context. Alternate translation: [who it was who had healed him]

See: Ellipsis

John 5:13 (#1)

ὁ & ἰαθεὶς

“the one having been healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John indicates who did the action in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [the one whom Jesus had healed]

See: Active or Passive

John 5:13 (#3)

ὄχλου ὄντος ἐν τῷ τόπῳ

“a crowd being in the place”

This could refer to: (1) the reason why Jesus left secretly. Alternate translation: [because a crowd was in the place]; (2) the time when Jesus left secretly. Alternate translation: [while a crowd was in the place]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 5:13 (#4)

ὄχλου

“a crowd”

The word **crowd** is a singular noun that refers to a group of people. If your language does not use singular nouns in that way, you can use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a group of people] or [many people]

See: Collective Nouns

John 5:14 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

“After these things”

After these things introduces a new event that happened some time after the events which the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 5:14 (#2)

εὑρίσκει

“finds”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 5:14 (#4)

ἴδε

“Behold”

Jesus uses the term **Behold** to call the man’s attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here.

See: Metaphor

John 5:14 (#3)

αὐτὸν & αὐτῷ

“him & to him”

Here, **him** refers to the man whom Jesus had healed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the healed man … that man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:15 (#1)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“to the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 5:10.

See: Synecdoche

John 5:16 (#3)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

John 5:16 (#4)

ὅτι ταῦτα ἐποίει

“because he was doing these things”

This phrase indicates a second reason why the Jewish leaders began persecuting Jesus. Here, **these things** refers to Jesus healing people on the Sabbath. The

plural **things** indicates that he healed on the Sabbath multiple times, not just on the occasion recorded in verses 5–9. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because he was doing these healings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:16 (#1)

καὶ διὰ τοῦτο, ἐδίωκον οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι τὸν Ἰησοῦν, ὅτι ταῦτα ἐποίει ἐν Σαββάτῳ

"And because of this, the Jews began to persecute Jesus, because he was doing these things on the Sabbath"

The writer uses the phrase **And because of this** to show that previous verse gave background information for what John will now present. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Now the Jews began to persecute Jesus because he was doing these things on the Sabbath.]

See: Background Information

John 5:16 (#2)

διὰ τοῦτο

"because of this"

Here, **this** refers to what the man whom Jesus had healed told the Jewish leaders. The Jewish leaders began to persecute Jesus because he had healed the man on the Sabbath, which was something they believed was against the law of Moses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because Jesus had healed him on the Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:16 (#5)

ἐν Σαββάτῳ

"on the Sabbath"

Your language might use an indefinite article rather than the definite article here, since the synagogue ruler is not speaking of a specific Sabbath. Alternate translation: [on a Sabbath day]

John 5:17 (#1)

ὁ Πατήρ μου

"My Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:18 (#3)

ὅτι οὐ μόνον ἔλυε τὸ Σάββατον

"because he not only was breaking the Sabbath"

The phrase **breaking the Sabbath** is an idiom that means to disobey the regulations for the Sabbath that God gave in the law of Moses. The Pharisees themselves added many regulations which they considered to be equal to those God had given. It was the additional Jewish regulations that Jesus was disobeying, thereby making the Jewish leaders very angry with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because he not only was disobeying their Sabbath regulations]

See: Idiom

John 5:18 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο οὖν

"Because of this, therefore"

Here, **this** refers to what Jesus had said in the previous verse. One of the reasons why the Jewish leaders wanted to kill Jesus was that Jesus called God his Father. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Because Jesus said this, therefore]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:18 (#2)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 5:10.

See: Synecdoche

John 5:18 (#4)

Πατέρα

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:18 (#5)

ἴσον ἑαυτὸν ποιῶν τῷ Θεῷ

"making himself equal to God"

This clause, **making himself equal to God**, is the result of what Jesus had said in the previous clause. The result of Jesus calling God Father is that he was claiming to be equal with God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the result being that he was making himself equal to God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 5:19 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Therefore indicates that what Jesus is about to say is a response to the accusations of the Jewish leaders that were mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because the Jewish leaders had made these accusations]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 5:19 (#8)

τι βλέπῃ τὸν Πατέρα ποιοῦντα

"what he would see the Father doing"

Jesus uses **see** to refer to knowing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what he would perceive the Father doing]

See: Metaphor

John 5:19 (#7)

ἀφ' ἑαυτοῦ

"from himself"

Here, **from** is used to indicate the source of Jesus' teaching and ability to do miracles. His teaching and miracles could only have authority if they came from God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on his own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:19 (#3)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 5:19 (#5)

Υἱὸς & Πατέρα

"Son & Father"

Son and **Father** are important titles that describe the relationship between Jesus and God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:19 (#6)

ὁ Υἱὸς & καὶ ὁ Υἱὸς & ποιεῖ

"the Son & also the Son does"

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If this would confuse your readers, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:19 (#4)

λέγω ὑμῖν

"I say to you"

Since Jesus is speaking to a group of Jewish leaders, **you** is plural here and through 5:47. If your language does not have a different form for plural **you**, you can use another way to express it. Alternate translation: [I say to you Jews] or [I say to you all]

See: Forms of You

John 5:19 (#2)

αὐτοῖς

"to them"

Here, **them** refers to the Jewish leaders who wanted to kill Jesus and made accusations against him in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the Jewish authorities]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:20 (#4)

δείξει αὐτῷ

"he will show him"

Here, **he** refers to God the Father and **him** refers to Jesus the Son. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Father will reveal to the Son]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:20 (#6)

μείζονα τούτων & ἔργα

“greater works than these”

Here, **these** refers to the miracles that Jesus had already performed by the time he spoke these words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [greater works than these miracles I have already performed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:20 (#1)

ὁ & Πατὴρ & τὸν Υἱὸν

“the Father & the Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between Jesus and God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:20 (#2)

τὸν Υἱὸν

“the Son”

As in the previous verse, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:20 (#5)

μείζονα τούτων & ἔργα

“greater works than these”

Here, **works** refers specifically to miracles. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [greater miracles than these]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:20 (#3)

δείκνυσιν αὐτῷ & δείξει αὐτῷ

“he shows him & he will show him”

Jesus uses **shows** and **show** to refer to revealing or making something known. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he reveals to him … he will reveal to him]

See: Metaphor

John 5:21 (#1)

Πατὴρ & Υἱὸς

“Father & Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:21 (#3)

ὁ Υἱὸς

“the Son”

As in the previous two verses, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [I, the Son]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:21 (#2)

ζῳοποιεῖ & οὓς θέλει ζῳοποιεῖ

“makes {them} alive & makes alive whom he desires”

The phrase **makes them alive** could refer to: (1) eternal life. Alternate translation: [makes them have eternal life … makes whom he desires have eternal life]; (2) physical life, in which case it would repeat the idea of “raises the dead” in the previous phrase. Alternate translation: [makes them live again … makes alive again whom he desires]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:22 (#1)

ὁ Πατὴρ & τῷ Υἱῷ

“the Father & to the Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:22 (#3)

τῷ Υἱῷ

“to the Son”

As in the previous three verses, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:22 (#2)

τὴν κρίσιν

“judgment”

Here, **judgment** refers to the legal authority to judge people as guilty or innocent. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [power to judge others]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 5:23 (#2)

τὸν Υἱὸν & ὁ μὴ τιμῶν τὸν Υἱὸν

“the Son & The one not honoring the Son”

As in the previous four verses, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:23 (#3)

τὸν Πατέρα, τὸν πέμψαντα αὐτόν

“the Father having sent him”

Here, this phrase refers to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God, the Father who sent him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:23 (#1)

τὸν Υἱὸν & τὸν Πατέρα. ὁ μὴ τιμῶν τὸν Υἱὸν, οὐ τιμᾷ τὸν Πατέρα

“the Son & the Father. The one not honoring the Son does not honor the Father”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:24 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 5:24 (#5)

τῷ πέμψαντί με

“the one having sent me”

Here, **the one who sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:24 (#3)

ὁ τὸν λόγον μου ἀκούων

“the one hearing my word”

Here, **hearing** means listening to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. It does not mean simply to hear what someone says. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one heeding my word]

See: Metaphor

John 5:24 (#2)

λέγω ὑμῖν

“I say to you”

Since Jesus is speaking to a group of Jewish leaders, **you** is plural here and through 5:47. If your language does not have a different form for plural **you**, you can use another way to express it. Alternate translation: [I say to you Jews] or [I say to you all]

See: Forms of You

John 5:24 (#4)

τὸν λόγον μου

“my word”

Here, **word** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my message]

See: Metonymy

John 5:24 (#7)

μεταβέβηκεν ἐκ τοῦ θανάτου εἰς τὴν ζωήν

“he has passed from death to life”

Here, **passed** means to move from one state to another. Alternate translation: [he has moved from death to life]

John 5:24 (#6)

εἰς κρίσιν οὐκ ἔρχεται

"does not come into judgment"

Jesus speaks of **judgment** as if it were a place a person could enter. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not be judged]

See: Metaphor

John 5:25 (#7)

ἀκούσουσιν & οἱ ἀκούσαντες

"will hear & the ones having heard"

Here, **heard** means to listen to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. See how you translated "hearing" in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [will heed ... those who have heeded]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:25 (#6)

τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

"of the Son of God"

As in the previous verses in this paragraph, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [of me, the Son of God]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:25 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Doublet

John 5:25 (#4)

οἱ νεκροὶ

"the dead"

Here, **the dead** could refer to: (1) people who are spiritually dead. Alternate translation: [the spiritually dead]; (2) people who are physically dead. Alternate translation: [the physically dead]; (3) both the spiritually dead and physically dead. In this case, **an hour that is coming** would refer to the future resurrection of the dead while **is now** would refer to those spiritually dead people who were listening to Jesus when he spoke these words. Alternate translation: [the spiritually dead and physically dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:25 (#3)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

"an hour is coming"

See the discussion of **an hour is coming** in the introduction to Chapter 4 and see how you translated this phrase in 4:21.

See: Metonymy

John 5:25 (#5)

τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

"of the Son of God"

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:25 (#2)

λέγω ὑμῖν

"I say to you"

Since Jesus is speaking to a group of Jewish leaders, **you** is plural here and through 5:47. If your language does not have a different form for plural **you**, you can use another way to express it. Alternate translation: [I say to you Jews] or [I say to you all]

See: Forms of You

John 5:25 (#8)

ζήσουσιν

"will live"

This could refer to: (1) having eternal life. Alternate translation: [will have eternal life]; (2) physical life, as in being resurrected after death. Alternate translation: [will become alive again]; (3) both eternal life and physical life. Alternate translation: [will have eternal life and become alive again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:26 (#3)

τῷ Υἱῷ & ζωὴν, ἔχειν ἐν ἑαυτῷ

"to the Son to have life in himself"

As in the previous verses in this paragraph, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:26 (#1)

ὁ Πατὴρ & τῷ Υἱῷ

“the Father & to the Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:26 (#2)

ἔχει ζωὴν ἐν ἑαυτῷ & ζωὴν, ἔχειν ἐν ἑαυτῷ

“has life in himself & to have life in himself”

Here, the phrases **has life** and **have life** refer to being the source of life or having the ability to create life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [is the source of life ... the right to be the source of life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:27 (#2)

ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ & Υἱὸς Ἀνθρώπου ἐστίν

“he gave him & he is the Son of Man”

As in the previous verses in this paragraph, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:27 (#3)

ἐξουσίαν ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ κρίσιν ποιεῖν

“he gave him authority to do judgment”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **authority** and **judgment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [he authorized him to act as judge]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 5:27 (#4)

Υἱὸς Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:27 (#1)

ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ & ἐστίν

“he gave him & he is”

The first occurrence of **he** refers to God the Father, but **him** and the second occurrence of **he** refer to the Son of Man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Father gave the Son ... the Son is]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:28 (#3)

ἀκούσουσιν τῆς φωνῆς αὐτοῦ

“will hear his voice”

As in the previous verses in this paragraph, Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:28 (#2)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

“an hour is coming”

See the discussion of **an hour is coming** in the introduction to Chapter 4 and see how you translated this phrase in verse 25.

See: Metonymy

John 5:28 (#1)

μὴ θαυμάζετε τοῦτο

“Do not be amazed at this”

Here, **this** refers to the Son of Man’s authority to give eternal life and to carry out judgment, as stated in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not be amazed that the Father has given the Son this authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:29 (#2)

ἀνάστασιν κρίσεως

“a resurrection of judgment”

In this phrase, Jesus uses **of** to describe a **resurrection** that results in eternal **judgment**. If it would be

helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. For further discussion of this phrase, see the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [a resurrection that results in judgment]

See: Possession

John 5:29 (#1)

ἀνάστασιν ζωῆς

“a resurrection of life”

In this phrase, Jesus uses **of** to describe a **resurrection** that results in eternal **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. For further discussion of this phrase, see the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [a resurrection that results in life]

See: Possession

John 5:30 (#4)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

“of the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:30 (#2)

καθὼς ἀκούω, κρίνω

“Just as I hear, I judge”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [Just as I hear from the Father, I judge]

See: Ellipsis

John 5:30 (#1)

ἀπ’ ἐμαυτοῦ

“from myself”

Here, **from** is used to indicate the source of Jesus’ teaching and ability to do miracles. His teaching and miracles could only have authority if they came from God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [on my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:30 (#3)

ἡ κρίσις ἡ ἐμὴ δικαία ἐστίν

“my judgment is righteous”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **judgment** and **righteous**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [I judge rightly] or [I judge justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 5:31 (#1)

ἐὰν ἐγὼ μαρτυρῶ περὶ ἐμαυτοῦ, ἡ μαρτυρία μου οὐκ ἔστιν ἀληθής

“If I testify about myself, my testimony is not true”

Jesus is referring to a rule in the law of Moses. According to Deuteronomy 19:15, a statement had to be confirmed by at least two witnesses in order to be considered true in legal decisions. If your audience is not familiar with the law of Moses in the Old Testament, then you can state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [You know that the law of Moses states that if I testify about myself, my testimony is not true]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:31 (#2)

ἐὰν ἐγὼ μαρτυρῶ περὶ ἐμαυτοῦ

“If I testify about myself”

Jesus assumed that his listeners understood that he was referring to testifying about himself without any other witnesses. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [If I testify about myself without any other witnesses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:32 (#1)

ἄλλος ἐστὶν ὁ μαρτυρῶν περὶ ἐμοῦ

“There is another one testifying about me”

Here, **another** refers to God the Father. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [There is another who is testifying about me, the Father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:33 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἀπεστάλκατε πρὸς Ἰωάννην

“You have sent to John”

Here and through 5:47, **You** is plural and refers to the Jewish leaders to whom Jesus is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [You Jewish authorities sent to John]

See: Forms of You

John 5:33 (#2)

ὑμεῖς ἀπεστάλκατε πρὸς Ἰωάννην

"You have sent to John"

Jesus is leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [You have sent messengers to John]

See: Ellipsis

John 5:33 (#3)

πρὸς Ἰωάννην

"to John"

Here, **John** refers to Jesus' cousin, often referred to as "John the Baptist." (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [to John the Baptist] or [to John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:34 (#3)

ἵνα ὑμεῖς σωθῆτε

"so that you might be saved"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Jesus implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [so that God might save you]

See: Active or Passive

John 5:34 (#2)

ταῦτα λέγω

"I say these things"

Here, **these things** could refer to: (1) what Jesus said about John the Baptist in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [I say this about John]; (2) all that Jesus has said in verses 17–33. Alternate translation: [I say these things about myself and John]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:34 (#1)

παρὰ ἀνθρώπου

"from man"

Here, **man** does not refer to any specific man, but to any human being. Alternate translation: [from mankind] or [from anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 5:35 (#3)

ἐν τῷ φωτὶ αὐτοῦ

"in his light"

Jesus uses the word **light** to refer to John the Baptist's teaching. In the way that light enables people to see in the dark, so John's teaching helped people understand God's truth and prepared them to receive Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could state this plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [in his teaching] or [in his teaching that was like a light]

See: Metaphor

John 5:35 (#2)

ἐκεῖνος ἦν ὁ λύχνος ὁ καιόμενος καὶ φαίνων

"That one was the lamp that was burning and shining"

Jesus uses the word **lamp** to refer to John the Baptist. In the way that lamps in those days burned oil and shined light, so John's teaching helped people understand God's truth and prepared them to receive Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could state this plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [That one taught you the truth about God] or [That one was like a lamp that was burning and shining]

See: Metaphor

John 5:35 (#4)

πρὸς ὥραν

"for an hour"

Here, **hour** refers to a short amount of time. It does not mean a 60-minute period of time or a specific point in time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for a moment]

See: Metonymy

John 5:35 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος

“That one”

That one here refers to Jesus’ cousin, often referred to as “John the Baptist.” (See: John (the Baptist)) If it would be misunderstood to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:36 (#2)

τὰ & ἔργα

“the works”

Here, **works** could refer to: (1) the miracles that Jesus did. Alternate translation: [the miracles]; (2) Jesus’ miracles and teaching. Alternate translation: [the miracles and teaching]

John 5:36 (#4)

αὐτὰ τὰ ἔργα ἃ ποιῶ, μαρτυρεῖ περὶ ἐμοῦ

“the very works that I do—testify about me”

Here Jesus is speaking of **works** as though they were a person who could **testify** about who he is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this plainly. Alternate translation: [the very works that I do —are evidence for who I am]

See: Personification

John 5:36 (#3)

ὁ Πατὴρ & ὅτι ὁ Πατήρ

“the Father & that the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:36 (#1)

γὰρ

“for”

Here, **for** indicates that what follows is an explanation of the “testimony” Jesus has mentioned in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [that testimony is]

John 5:37 (#2)

ὁ πέμψας με Πατὴρ

“the Father having sent me”

Here this phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 5:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:37 (#1)

ὁ πέμψας με Πατὴρ, ἐκεῖνος μεμαρτύρηκεν

“the Father having sent me has himself testified”

The reflexive pronoun **himself** emphasizes that it is the Father, not someone less important, who has testified about who Jesus is. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [none other than the Father himself who sent me has testified]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 5:38 (#2)

τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ οὐκ ἔχετε ἐν ὑμῖν μένοντα

“you do not have his word remaining in you”

Jesus is speaking of God’s **word** as if it were an object that could remain inside people. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you do not live according to his word]

See: Metaphor

John 5:38 (#3)

ὃν ἀπέστειλεν ἐκεῖνος, τούτῳ

“the one whom he has sent, this one”

This phrase refers to Jesus. He is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [me, the one whom he has sent, me whom]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 5:38 (#1)

τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ

“his word”

Here, **word** refers to the teachings that God gave to his people in the Scriptures. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his teachings] or [the Scriptures he gave us]

See: Metonymy

John 5:39 (#1)

ἐν αὐταῖς ζωὴν αἰώνιον ἔχειν

“in them you have eternal life”

Some Jews in Jesus’ time believed that a person could earn their way to heaven by studying the Scriptures and doing good deeds. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [you will get eternal life if you study them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:39 (#2)

ἐν αὐταῖς & ἐκεῖναί εἰσιν αἱ

“in them & these are the ones”

In this verse, **them**, **these**, and **the ones** all refer to the Scriptures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state some of these words explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the Scriptures ... these Scriptures are the ones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 5:39 (#3)

ἐκεῖναί εἰσιν αἱ μαρτυροῦσαι περὶ ἐμοῦ

“these are the ones testifying about me”

Jesus is speaking of the Scriptures as though they were a person who is **testifying** about who he is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this plainly. Alternate translation: [these indicate who I am]

See: Personification

John 5:40 (#2)

ζωὴν ἔχητε

“you might have life”

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you might have eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:40 (#1)

οὐ θέλετε ἐλθεῖν πρός με

“you are not willing to come to me”

Here, **come** does not mean to merely come near Jesus, but it means to follow him and be his disciple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you are not willing to come and by my disciples]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 5:41 (#1)

παρὰ ἀνθρώπων

“from men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Jesus uses the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [from people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 5:42 (#1)

τὴν ἀγάπην τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the love of God”

This could mean: (1) they did not **love God**. Alternate translation: [love for God]; (2) they had not received God’s love. Alternate translation: [love from God]

See: Possession

John 5:43 (#3)

οὐ λαμβάνετέ με

“you do not receive me”

Here, **receive** means to accept a person into one’s presence with friendliness. See how you translated a similar phrase in 1:11. Alternate translation: [you do not welcome me]

John 5:43 (#4)

ἐὰν ἄλλος ἔλθῃ ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τῷ ἰδίῳ

“If another comes in his own name”

John records Jesus using the word **name** to refer to authority. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If another comes in his own authority]

See: Metonymy

John 5:43 (#2)

τοῦ Πατρός

“of & Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 5:43 (#1)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Πατρός μου

“in the name of my Father”

Here, John records Jesus using the word **name** to refer to God’s power and authority. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the authority of my Father]

See: Metonymy

John 5:44 (#1)

πῶς δύνασθε ὑμεῖς πιστεῦσαι, δόξαν παρὰ ἀλλήλων λαμβάνοντες, καὶ τὴν δόξαν τὴν παρὰ τοῦ μόνου Θεοῦ, οὐ ζητεῖτε

“How are you able to believe, receiving glory from one another, and are not seeking the glory that is from the only God”

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [There is no way you are able to believe, receiving glory from one another, and are not seeking the glory that is from the only God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 5:44 (#3)

δόξαν παρὰ ἀλλήλων λαμβάνοντες

“receiving glory from one another”

Here, **receiving** could refer to: (1) the time they are receiving glory. Alternate translation: [while receiving glory from one another]; (2) a causal statement. Alternate translation: [since receiving glory from one another]

John 5:44 (#2)

πιστεῦσαι

“to believe”

John records Jesus leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [to believe me]

See: Ellipsis

John 5:45 (#1)

ἔστιν ὁ κατηγορῶν ὑμῶν Μωϋσῆς, εἰς ὃν ὑμεῖς ἠλπίκατε

“The one accusing you is Moses, in whom you have hoped”

Moses here could refer to: (1) the person named Moses who gave the Israelites the law of Moses. (2) the law of Moses itself. Alternate translation: [Moses accuses you in the law, the very law in which you have hoped]

See: Metonymy

John 5:46 (#1)

εἰ γὰρ ἐπιστεύετε Μωϋσεῖ, ἐπιστεύετε ἂν ἐμοί

“For if you believed Moses, you would believe me”

John records Jesus making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he is already convinced that the condition is not true. Jesus knows that the Jewish leaders do not truly believe Moses. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [you must not believe Moses since you do not believe me]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 5:47 (#3)

τοῖς ἐμοῖς ῥήμασιν

“my words”

Here, **words** refers to what Jesus said to these Jewish leaders. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what I have told you]

See: Metonymy

John 5:47 (#1)

εἰ & οὐ πιστεύετε

“if you do not believe”

John records Jesus speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since you do not believe]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 5:47 (#2)

πῶς τοῖς ἐμοῖς ῥήμασιν πιστεύσετε

“how will you believe my words”

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could trans-

late his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you will certainly never believe my words!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus' fourth sign: Jesus feeds a large crowd (6:1–14)
2. Jesus' fifth sign: Jesus walks on the Sea of Galilee (6:15–21)
3. Jesus says he is the bread of life (6:22–71)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

King
The king of any nation was the richest and most powerful person in that nation. The people wanted Jesus to be their king because he gave them food. They thought he would make the Jews into the richest and most powerful nation in the world. They did not understand that Jesus came to die so God could forgive his people's sins and that the world would persecute his people.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Bread
Bread was the most common and important food in Jesus' day, so the word "bread" was their general word for "food." It is often difficult to translate the word "bread" into the languages of people who do not eat bread, because the general word for food in some languages refers to food that did not exist in Jesus' culture. Jesus used the word "bread" to refer to himself. He wanted the people to understand that they need him so they can have eternal life, just as people need food to sustain physical life. (See: Metaphor; and Synecdoche)

Eating the flesh and drinking the blood
When Jesus said, "unless you would eat the flesh of the Son of Man and would drink his blood, you do not have life in yourselves," he was speaking of believing in his sacrificial death on the cross for the forgiveness of sins. He also knew that before he died he would tell his followers to commemorate this sacrifice by eating bread and drinking wine. In the event this chapter describes, he expected that his hearers would understand that he was using a metaphor but would not understand to what the metaphor referred.

Parenthetical ideas
Several times in this passage, John explains something or gives the reader some background information needed to better understand the story. These explanations are intended to give the reader some additional knowledge without interrupting the flow of the narrative. This information is placed inside parentheses.

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" several times in this chapter. Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 6:1 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

"After these things"

This phrase, **After these things**, introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 6:1 (#2)

τῆς θαλάσσης τῆς Γαλιλαίας τῆς Τιβεριάδος

"of the Sea of Galilee (of Tiberias"

The **Sea of Galilee** was called by several names, one of which was Sea **of Tiberias**. (See: Sea of Galilee, Sea of Kinnereth, lake of Gennesaret, Sea of Tiberias) If having two different names for the same place would be confusing in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of the Sea of Galilee (also known as the Sea of Tiberias)]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:1–4 (#1)

Jesus had traveled from Jerusalem to Galilee. A crowd has followed him up a mountainside. Verses 1–4 tell the setting of this part of the story. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 6:2 (#2)

σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 6:2 (#1)

ὄχλος πολύς

“a great crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 6:4 (#1)

ἦν δὲ ἐγγὺς τὸ Πάσχα, ἡ ἑορτὴ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“Now the Passover, the festival of the Jews, was near”

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about when the events happened. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [This event took place near the time of the Passover, the festival of the Jews]

See: Background Information

John 6:5 (#3)

πολὺς ὄχλος

“a great crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 6:5 (#4)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:5 (#2)

ἐπάρας & τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς

“having lifted up his eyes”

Here, “lifted up his eyes” is an idiom that means to look upward. See how you translated a similar phrase in 4:35.

See: Idiom

John 6:5 (#1)

οὖν

“Then”

Then here could mean: (1) what follows is the next event in the story. Alternate translation: [Next]; (2) what follows is the result of what happened in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [Therefore,]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 6:6 (#1)

τοῦτο δὲ ἔλεγεν πειράζων αὐτόν; αὐτὸς γὰρ ᾔδει τί ἔμελλεν ποιεῖν

“But he said this, testing him, for he himself knew what he was going to do”

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to explain why Jesus asked Philip where to buy bread. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Now he said this at that time to test him, for he himself knew what he was going to do]

See: Background Information

John 6:6 (#2)

πειράζων αὐτόν

“testing him”

John is stating the purpose for which Jesus asked Philip the question in the previous verse. In your translation, follow the conventions of your language for purpose clauses. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [so that he could test Philip]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 6:6 (#3)

αὐτόν

“him”

Here, **him** refers to Philip. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Philip]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 6:6 (#4)

αὐτὸς & ᾔδει

“he himself knew”

John uses the reflexive pronoun **himself** to make clear that the word **he** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus himself knew]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 6:7 (#1)

διακοσίων δηναρίων ἄρτοι

“200 denarii {worth} of bread”

The word **denarii** is the plural form of “denarius.” It was a denomination of money in the Roman Empire that was equivalent to one days’ wages. Alternate translation: [The amount of bread that cost 200 days’ wages]

See: Biblical Money

John 6:8 (#1)

Σίμωνος Πέτρου

“of Simon Peter”

See how you translated the name **Simon Peter** in 1:40.

See: How to Translate Names

John 6:8 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:9 (#2)

ταῦτα τί ἐστιν εἰς τοσούτους

“what are these to so many”

Andrew is using the question form to emphasize that they do not have enough food to feed everyone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [these are not enough to feed so many!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:9 (#1)

πέντε ἄρτους κριθίνους

“five barley bread loaves”

The grain **barley** was a common grain eaten by the poor in Israel because it was cheaper than wheat. (See: barley) They would bake the barley into **bread loaves**, which are lumps of flour dough that a person has shaped and baked. Alternate translation: [five loaves of barley bread]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 6:10 (#5)

ἀνέπεσαν οὖν οἱ ἄνδρες, τὸν ἀριθμὸν ὡς πεντακισχίλιοι

“So the men sat down, about 5,000 in number”

Here, **men** refers specifically to adult males. Although the term for “men” used earlier in this verse refers to a group that included men, women, and children, here John is counting only the **men**.

John 6:10 (#2)

τοὺς ἀνθρώπους

“the men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Jesus uses the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [the people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 6:10 (#1)

εἶπεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς, ποιήσατε τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἀναπεσεῖν

“Jesus said, “Make the men sit down”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Jesus said to make the men sit down]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 6:10 (#3)

ἦν δὲ χόρτος πολὺς ἐν τῷ τόπῳ. ἀνέπεσαν οὖν οἱ ἄνδρες, τὸν ἀριθμὸν ὡς πεντακισχίλιοι

“Now there was a lot of grass in the place.) So the men sat down, about 5,000 in number”

If it would be natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [So the men sat down, about 5,000 in number. (Now there was a lot of grass in the place.)]

See: Information Structure

John 6:10 (#4)

ἦν δὲ χόρτος πολὺς ἐν τῷ τόπῳ

“Now there was a lot of grass in the place”

John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about the place where this event happened. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [The place where the people were all coming together had a lot of grass]

See: Background Information

John 6:11 (#4)

τῶν ὀψαρίων

“the fish”

These **fish** are the two **fish** mentioned in verse 9. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those two small fish]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:11 (#3)

διέδωκεν

“he gave them”

Here, **he** refers to “Jesus and his disciples.” Alternate translation: [Jesus and his disciples gave them]

See: Synecdoche

John 6:11 (#1)

τοὺς ἄρτους

“the loaves”

This means **loaves** of bread, which are lumps of flour dough that a person has shaped and baked. These **loaves** are those five barley **loaves** mentioned in verse 9. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the five loaves of barley bread]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 6:11 (#2)

εὐχαριστήσας

“having given thanks”

John leaves out some words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [having given thanks to God for the food]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:12 (#3)

λέγει τοῖς μαθηταῖς αὐτοῦ, συναγάγετε

“he says to his disciples, “Gather up”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [he says to his disciples to gather up]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 6:12 (#2)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:12 (#1)

ἐνεπλήσθησαν

“they were filled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they had finished eating] or [they had filled themselves]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:13 (#1)

κοφίνους

“baskets”

Here, **baskets** refers to large baskets that were used for carrying food and goods while traveling. If your language has a word for this kind of basket, you could use it here. Alternate translation: [large traveling baskets]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 6:14 (#3)

ὃ & σημεῖον

“the sign”

Here, **sign** refers to the Jesus miraculously feeding the large crowd that was described in verses 5–13. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the sign of miraculously feeding the large crowd that]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:14 (#1)

οἱ & ἄνθρωποι

“the men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, John uses the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [the people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 6:14 (#2)

ἰδόντες ὃ ἐποίησεν σημεῖον

“having seen the sign he did”

This clause could refer to: (1) the time that they said the words which follow in the verse. Alternate translation: [at the time they saw the sign he did]; (2) the reason that they said what follows in the verse. Alternate translation: [because they saw the sign he did]

John 6:14 (#4)

ὁ προφήτης ὁ ἐρχόμενος εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“the Prophet coming into the world”

Here, **the Prophet** refers to a prophet the Jews were waiting for, based on God’s promise to send a prophet like Moses, which is recorded in Deuteronomy 18:15. If your readers will not be familiar with this Old Testament reference, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Prophet whom God said he would send into the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:15 (#1)

γνοὺς ὅτι μέλλουσιν ἔρχεσθαι

“having realized that they were about to come”

This clause could refer to: (1) the time that Jesus decided to withdraw. Alternate translation: [at the time he realized that they were about to come]; (2) the reason that Jesus decided to withdraw. Alternate translation: [because he realized that they were about to come]

John 6:15 (#2)

αὐτὸς μόνος

“by himself alone”

John uses the reflexive pronoun **himself** to emphasize that Jesus was completely alone. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [completely alone]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 6:16 (#1)

This is the next event in the story. Jesus’ disciples go out onto the Sea of Galilee in a boat.

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 6:16 (#2)

τὴν θάλασσαν

“the sea”

Here and throughout this chapter, **sea** refers to the Sea of Galilee. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly, as modeled by UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:17 (#1)

καὶ σκοτία ἤδη ἐγεγόνει, καὶ οὔπω ἐληλύθει πρὸς αὐτοὺς ὁ Ἰησοῦς

“and darkness had already happened, but Jesus had not yet come to them”

In these clauses John provides background information about the situation in order to help readers understand what happens in this story. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 6:18 (#2)

διηγείρετο

“was being aroused”

John uses **aroused** to refer to the wind causing the sea to become turbulent. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was being stirred up]

See: Metaphor

John 6:18 (#1)

ἥ τε θάλασσα ἀνέμου μεγάλου πνέοντος διηγείρετο

“A strong wind was blowing, and the sea was being aroused”

The first clause about the wind indicates the reason the **sea was being aroused** in the second clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could

express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because a strong wind was blowing, the sea was being aroused]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 6:18 (#3)

ἥ & θάλασσα & διηγείρετο

“the sea was being aroused”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the wind was causing the sea to be aroused]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:19 (#2)

ὡς σταδίους εἴκοσι πέντε ἢ τριάκοντα

“about 25 or 30 stadia”

The word **stadia** is the plural of “stadium,” which is a Roman measurement of distance equivalent to about 185 meters or a little over 600 feet. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or a footnote. Alternate translation: [about four and a half or five and a half kilometers] or [about three or three and a half miles]

See: Biblical Distance

John 6:19 (#3)

θεωροῦσιν

“they see”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:19 (#1)

ἐληλακότες

“having rowed”

The boats used on the Sea of Galilee usually had positions for two, four, or six people who sat together and **rowed** with oars on each side of the boat. If your readers would not be familiar with rowed boats, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [having propelled the boat through the water by using oars]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 6:20 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:21 (#1)

ἤθελον & λαβεῖν αὐτὸν εἰς τὸ πλοῖον

“they were willing to receive him into the boat”

It is implied that Jesus got **into the boat**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [they gladly received him into the boat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:22 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

“the crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 6:22 (#3)

πλοιάριον ἄλλο οὐκ ἦν ἐκεῖ, εἰ μὴ ἕν

“there was no other boat there except one”

Here, **one** refers to the boat that the disciples had taken to cross the Sea of Galilee. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [there was no other boat there except the one that the disciples had taken]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:22 (#2)

πέραν τῆς θαλάσσης

“on the other side of the sea”

Here, **the other side of the sea** refers to the side of the Sea of Galilee where Jesus had fed the crowd. It does not refer to the side of the Sea of Galilee that he and his disciples arrived at in the previous verse. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the side of the sea where Jesus performed the miracle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:23 (#2)

τοῦ Κυρίου

“the Lord”

Here, **the Lord** refers to Jesus. It does not refer to God the Father. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly, as modeled by the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:23 (#1)

ἄλλα ἦλθεν πλοῖα ἐκ Τιβεριάδος, ἐγγὺς τοῦ τόπου ὅπου ἔφαγον τὸν ἄρτον

“Other boats came from Tiberias close to the place where they had eaten the bread loaves”

In this verse John provides background information about the story. The day after Jesus miraculously fed the crowd, some **boats** with people from **Tiberias** came to see Jesus. However, Jesus and his disciples had left that place the night before. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Other boats came with people from Tiberias close to the place where the crowd had eaten the bread loaves]

See: Background Information

John 6:23 (#3)

εὐχαριστήσαντος τοῦ Κυρίου

“after the Lord had given thanks”

John leaves out some words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [after the Lord had given thanks to God for the food]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:24 (#1)

οὖν

“Therefore”

Therefore indicates that this verse is the result of what happened in verse 22. This verse resumes the narrative that was interrupted by the background information in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because Jesus and his disciples had gone to the other side of the Sea of Galilee]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 6:24 (#4)

εἰς τὰ πλοιάρια

“into the boats”

These **boats** are the **boats** mentioned in the previous verse. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [into the boats that had come from Tiberias]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:24 (#2)

ὁ ὄχλος

“the crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 6:24 (#3)

ἔστιν

“are”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 6:24 (#5)

ζητοῦντες τὸν Ἰησοῦν

“seeking Jesus”

John is stating the purpose for which the crowd went to Capernaum. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [so that they could seek Jesus]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 6:25 (#1)

πέραν τῆς θαλάσσης

“on the other side of the sea”

Here, **on the other side** refers to the side of the Sea of Galilee that is opposite the side where Jesus had miraculously fed the crowd. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the opposite side of the sea from where Jesus had fed the crowd]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:26 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase is in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 6:26 (#2)

σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated this term in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 6:26 (#3)

ἐχορτάσθητε

“were filled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [filled yourselves]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:27 (#3)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου & δώσει; τοῦτον

“the Son of Man will give & this one”

These two expressions are all refer to Jesus. He is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, the Son of Man, will give ... me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:27 (#5)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου & ὁ Πατὴρ & ὁ Θεός

“Son of Man & God the Father”

Son of Man and **God the Father** are important titles that describe the relationship between Jesus and God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:27 (#6)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

See how you translated **the Son of Man** in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:27 (#7)

τοῦτον & ἐσφράγισεν

“has set his seal on this one”

To “**set** a **seal**” on something means to place a mark on it in order to show to whom it belongs or to certify its authenticity. Here, the phrase is used as an idiom and could mean: (1) that the Father approves of the Son in every way. Alternate translation: [has affirmed his approval of him]; (2) that the Son belongs to the Father. Alternate translation: [has affirmed that the Son belongs to him]

See: Idiom

John 6:27 (#4)

ἣν ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου ὑμῖν δώσει

“which the Son of Man will give you”

This phrase could give further information about: (1) “the food that endures to eternal life.” Alternate translation: [that is, the food the Son of Man will give you]; (2) “eternal life.” Alternate translation: [that is, the life the Son of Man will give you]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

John 6:27 (#1)

τὴν βρῶσιν τὴν μένουσαν εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“for the food that endures to eternal life”

Jesus is using the word **food** to refer to himself, because he is the source of salvation, the One who gives **eternal life** to all who trust him. Jesus lasts forever, and so does the **eternal life** that he gives. However, the crowd does not understand this, and Jesus does not tell them this plainly at this time. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:27 (#2)

τὴν βρῶσιν τὴν μένουσαν εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“for the food that endures to eternal life”

John records Jesus leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [work for the food that endures to eternal life]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:29 (#2)

ὃν ἀπέστειλεν ἐκεῖνος

“the one whom that one has sent”

This phrase refers to Jesus. He is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:29 (#3)

ἀπέστειλεν ἐκεῖνος

“that one has sent”

Here, **that one** refers to God the Father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God has sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 6:29 (#1)

τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ ἔργον τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἵνα πιστεύητε εἰς ὃν ἀπέστειλεν ἐκεῖνος

“This is the work of God: that you would believe in the one whom that one has sent”

Jesus says which **work** one must do in order to receive “the food that endures to eternal life” that was mentioned in verse 27. This **work** is not any kind of labor or deed that can be done, but it is faith in Jesus, which is a gift from God (Ephesians 2:8–9). If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [This is the work of God that is required to receive the food that endures to eternal life: that you believe in the one whom that one has sent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:31 (#6)

ἄρτον ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς φαγεῖν

“He gave them bread from heaven to eat”

He here could refer to: (1) Moses, in which case the crowd was mistakenly quoting a scripture about God and applying it to Moses. This is possible because Jesus says in the next verse, “Moses has not given you the bread from heaven.” Alternate translation: [Moses gave them bread from heaven to eat]; (2) God, which is who it referred to in the scripture the crowd is quoting. Alternate translation: [God gave them bread from heaven to eat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 6:31 (#3)

ἐστιν γεγραμμένον

“it is written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the prophets wrote in the Scriptures]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:31 (#7)

ἄρτον

“bread”

John records the crowd using the word **bread** to represent food in general that is needed to sustain life. The manna that God gave the Israelites from heaven was not **bread**, but a food that could be baked into **bread**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

John 6:31 (#4)

ἐστιν γεγραμμένον

“it is written”

The crowd uses **it is written** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 78:24). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that the crowd is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [it was written in the scriptures]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 6:31 (#5)

ἐστιν γεγραμμένον, ἄρτον ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς φαγεῖν

“it is written, ‘He gave them bread from heaven to eat”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [it is written that he gave them bread from heaven to eat]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 6:31 (#2)

οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

“Our fathers”

The crowd used **fathers** to refer to their ancestors. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Our ancestors] or [Our forefathers]

See: Metaphor

John 6:31 (#1)

οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν τὸ μάννα ἔφαγον ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ

"Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness"

In this verse, John assumes that his readers will know that the crowd is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of Exodus. In that story, the Israelites complained against Moses and Aaron because they were hungry. God responded by providing a flake-like food that fell from the sky and could be baked into bread. The people called this flake-like food "manna." (See: manna) You could indicate this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation: [Our fathers ate the manna when they were wandering in the wilderness after leaving Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:32 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 6:32 (#6)

ὁ Πατήρ μου

"my Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:32 (#7)

ἄρτον

"bread"

See how you translated the word **bread** earlier in this verse and in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

John 6:32 (#5)

ὁ Πατήρ μου δίδωσιν ὑμῖν τὸν ἄρτον ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ τὸν ἀληθινόν

"my Father gives you the true bread from heaven"

Jesus is using **true bread** to refer to himself. However, the crowd does not understand this, and Jesus does not tell them this plainly until verse 35. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:32 (#3)

τὸν ἄρτον

"the bread"

John records Jesus using the word **bread** to represent food in general that is needed to sustain life. See how you translated this word in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

John 6:32 (#2)

οὐ Μωϋσῆς δέδωκεν ὑμῖν

"Moses has not given you"

John records Jesus speaking in a way that emphasizes that **Moses** was not the source of manna in the wilderness. He seems to be correcting the crowd's incorrect understanding of the scripture they quoted in the previous verse. Use whatever form best communicates this kind of negative emphasis in your language. Alternate translation: [Moses was not the one who has given you]

John 6:32 (#4)

ἀλλ' ὁ Πατήρ μου δίδωσιν

"but my Father gives"

This phrase serves two purposes. First, it implies that the **Father**, not Moses, was the source of the bread from heaven mentioned by the crowd in the previous verse. Second, it indicates that the **Father** is still giving bread from heaven, although not the kind of bread the crowd is expecting. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. You may also want to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Rather, my Father has given that bread and now gives]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:33 (#5)

τῷ κόσμῳ

“to the world”

Here, **the world** refers to the people who live in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people living in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 6:33 (#3)

ὁ καταβαίνων ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

“the one coming down from heaven”

This phrase refers to Jesus. However, the crowd does not understand this and Jesus does not tell them this plainly at this time. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:33 (#1)

ὁ & ἄρτος τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐστιν

“the bread of God is”

Jesus is using **bread** to refer to himself. However, the crowd does not understand this, and Jesus does not tell them this plainly until verse 35. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:33 (#2)

ὁ & ἄρτος τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the bread of God”

This phrase could mean: (1) the bread came from God. Alternate translation: [the bread that God gives]; (2) the bread belongs to God. Alternate translation: [God’s bread]

See: Possession

John 6:33 (#4)

ζωὴν

“life”

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly, as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:34 (#1)

κύριε

“Sir”

The crowd calls Jesus **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 6:34 (#2)

τὸν ἄρτον

“bread”

Here, **bread** could refer to: (1) food in general, as the word was used by the crowd in 6:31. This would mean that the crowd did not understand that Jesus was calling himself the bread from heaven. Alternate translation: [food]; (2) some gift from God of which the crowd was uncertain. This would mean that the crowd recognized that Jesus was talking about something more spiritual than mere food but did not understand that he was talking about himself. Alternate translation: [heavenly food]

See: Synecdoche

John 6:35 (#4)

ὁ ἐρχόμενος πρὸς ἐμὲ, οὐ μὴ πεινάσῃ; καὶ ὁ πιστεύων εἰς ἐμὲ, οὐ μὴ διψήσει πώποτε

“The one coming to me will certainly not hunger, and the one believing in me will certainly not ever thirst”

Jesus speaks about the person who trusts in him by continuing the metaphor of food that he began in verse 32. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [The one coming to me will be like a person who never gets hungry, and the one believing in me will be like a person who never gets thirsty]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 6:35 (#3)

τῆς ζωῆς

“of life”

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [of eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:35 (#5)

ὁ ἐρχόμενος πρὸς ἐμὲ, οὐ μὴ πεινάσῃ; καὶ ὁ πιστεύων εἰς ἐμὲ, οὐ μὴ διψήσει πώποτε

“The one coming to me will certainly not hunger, and the one believing in me will certainly not ever thirst”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that anyone who trusts in Jesus will never lack spiritual satisfaction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [The one who trusts me will certainly never lack spiritual satisfaction again]

See: Doublet

John 6:35 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ἄρτος τῆς ζωῆς

"I am the bread of life"

John records Jesus continuing the **bread** metaphor to refer to himself. In Jesus' culture, **bread** was the primary food people ate to stay alive. Just as **bread** is necessary for sustaining physical life, Jesus is necessary for giving spiritual life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [Just as food keeps you physically alive, I can give you spiritual life]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 6:35 (#7)

οὐ μὴ πεινάσῃ & οὐ μὴ διψήσει πώποτε

"will certainly not hunger & will certainly not ever thirst"

John records Jesus using a figure of speech twice in the same verse to express a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that has the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [will always be full ... will always have his thirst quenched]

See: Litotes

John 6:35 (#2)

ὁ ἄρτος τῆς ζωῆς

"the bread of life"

Jesus uses **of life** to the source of the **life** about which he is speaking. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the bread that produces life]

See: Possession

John 6:35 (#6)

ὁ ἐρχόμενος πρὸς ἐμὲ

"The one coming to me"

Here, **coming** does not mean to merely come near Jesus. It means to believe in him and be his disciple. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [The one coming to be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:37 (#3)

τὸν ἐρχόμενον πρός ἐμὲ, οὐ μὴ ἐκβάλω ἔξω

"the one coming to me I will certainly not throw out"

Jesus is using a figure of speech here to expresses a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that means the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [I will keep everyone who comes to me]

See: Litotes

John 6:37 (#1)

Πατὴρ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:37 (#2)

πρὸς ἐμὲ ἥξει & τὸν ἐρχόμενον πρός ἐμὲ

"will come to me & the one coming to me"

In this verse, **come** and **coming** do not mean to merely come near Jesus, but they mean to believe in him and be his disciple. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [will come to be my disciples ... the one coming to be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:38 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

For introduces the reason why Jesus will not throw out anyone who comes to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [This is true because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 6:38 (#2)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

“of the one having sent me”

Here, **the one who sent me** refers to God. See how you translated it in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:39 (#1)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

“of the one having sent me”

Here, **the one who sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:39 (#2)

πᾶν ὃ & μὴ ἀπολέσω ἐξ αὐτοῦ

“I would not lose from it anyone whom”

Jesus is using a figure of speech here to expresses a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that means the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [I should keep all of them whom he has given]

See: Litotes

John 6:39 (#3)

μὴ ἀπολέσω ἐξ αὐτοῦ, ἀλλὰ ἀναστήσω αὐτὸ

“I would not lose from it & but will raise it up”

Here, **it** refers to the whole group of believers as a whole. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [I would not lose from the group of believers ... but will raise that group up] or [I would not lose from them ... but will raise them up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 6:39 (#4)

ἀναστήσω αὐτὸ

“will raise it up”

Here, to **raise** up is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will cause them to live again]

See: Idiom

John 6:39 (#5)

τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

“on the last day”

Here, **the last day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, Jesus returns to earth, and the bodies of those who are dead are raised from their graves. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the day when I return and judge everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:40 (#2)

τοῦ Πατρός μου

“of my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:40 (#3)

πᾶς ὁ θεωρῶν τὸν Υἱὸν

“everyone seeing the Son”

Jesus uses **sees** to refer to understanding something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everyone who understands who the Son is]

See: Metaphor

John 6:40 (#1)

τοῦτο γάρ ἐστιν τὸ θέλημα τοῦ Πατρός μου, ἵνα πᾶς ὁ

“For this is the will of my Father, that everyone”

For introduces the reason for the Father’s will that Jesus stated in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [What I have just said is my Father’s will, because his will is also that everyone]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 6:40 (#4)

ἀναστήσω αὐτὸν ἐγὼ

“I will raise him up”

Here, to **raise** up is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again. See how you translated this term in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 6:40 (#5)

τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

“on the last day”

Here, **the last day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, Jesus returns to earth, and the bodies of those who are dead are raised from their graves. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh) See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [on the day when I return and judge everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:41 (#1)

οὖν οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“Then the Jews”

Here and to the end of this chapter, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 6:41 (#2)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ἄρτος

“I am the bread”

The Jewish leaders paraphrase what Jesus said in verse 33. See how you translated **bread** and **come down from heaven** in verse 33.

See: Metaphor

John 6:42 (#3)

πῶς νῦν λέγει & ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβέβηκα

“How then does he now say, ‘I have come down from heaven”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [How then does he now say that he has come down from heaven?]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 6:42 (#1)

οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν Ἰησοῦς ὁ υἱὸς Ἰωσήφ, οὗ ἡμεῖς οἴδαμεν τὸν πατέρα καὶ τὴν μητέρα

“Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know”

The Jewish leaders are using the form of a question to emphasize that they believe that Jesus is just a normal person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation, and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [This is just Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:42 (#2)

πῶς νῦν λέγει & ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβέβηκα

“How then does he now say, ‘I have come down from heaven”

The Jewish leaders are using the form of a question to emphasize that they do not believe that Jesus came from heaven. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [He is lying when he says that he came from heaven!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:44 (#1)

ἐλθεῖν πρός με

“to come to me”

Here, **come** does not mean to merely come near Jesus. It means to believe in him and be his disciple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to come to be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:44 (#2)

ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:44 (#3)

ὁ πέμψας με

“having sent me”

Here, this phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 5:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:44 (#5)

αὐτόν & αὐτὸν

“him & him”

Although the pronoun **him** is masculine, Jesus uses the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 6:44 (#4)

ἑλκύσῃ αὐτόν

“would draw him”

Alternate translation: [would pull him] or [would drag him]

John 6:44 (#6)

ἀναστήσω αὐτὸν

“will raise him up”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:40.

See: Idiom

John 6:44 (#7)

ἐν τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

“on the last day”

Here, **the last day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, Jesus returns to earth, and the bodies of those who are dead are raised from their graves. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh) See how you translated this phrase in verse 40. Alternate translation: [on the day when I return and judge everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:45 (#5)

τοῦ Πατρὸς

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:45 (#2)

ἔστιν γεγραμμένον ἐν τοῖς προφήταις

“It is written in the prophets”

Jesus uses **It is written** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Isaiah 54:13). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [It had been written by the prophets in the scriptures]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 6:45 (#4)

ἔσονται πάντες διδακτοὶ Θεοῦ

“all will be taught by God”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will teach all]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:45 (#3)

ἐν τοῖς προφήταις, καὶ ἔσονται πάντες διδακτοὶ Θεοῦ

“in the prophets, ‘And all will be taught by God”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [in the prophets that all will be taught by God]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 6:45 (#1)

ἔστιν γεγραμμένον ἐν τοῖς προφήταις

“It is written in the prophets”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation, as modeled by the UST: [The prophets wrote]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:45 (#6)

ἔρχεται πρὸς ἐμέ

“comes to me”

Here, **comes** does not mean to merely come near Jesus. It means to believe in him and be his disciple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [comes to be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:46 (#1)

τὸν Πατέρα & ἑώρακεν τὸν Πατέρα

“the Father & has seen the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:46 (#2)

ὁ ὢν παρὰ τοῦ Θεοῦ; οὗτος ἑώρακεν τὸν Πατέρα

“the one being from God—he has seen the Father”

John records Jesus referring to himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person. Alternate translation: [me, the who is from God—I have seen the Father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:47 (#2)

ὁ πιστεύων

“the one believing”

John records Jesus leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [the one believing in me] or [the one believing that I am the Messiah]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:47 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 6:48 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ἄρτος τῆς ζωῆς

“I am the bread of life”

See how you translated this phrase in John 6:35.

See: Metaphor

John 6:49 (#1)

οἱ πατέρες ὑμῶν

“Your fathers”

Jesus uses **fathers** to refer to ancestors. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your forefathers] or [Your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

John 6:49 (#2)

ἔφαγον ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ τὸ μάννα

“ate the manna in the wilderness”

See how you translated this expression in verse 31.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:50 (#3)

ὁ ἄρτος

“the bread”

See how you translated this term in verse 48.

See: Metaphor

John 6:50 (#5)

μὴ ἀποθάνῃ

“might not die”

Jesus uses **die** to refer to spiritual death, which is eternal punishment in hell that occurs after physical death. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [might not die spiritually] or [might not experience spiritual death]

See: Metaphor

John 6:50 (#1)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ ἄρτος ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβαίνων, ἵνα τις ἐξ αὐτοῦ φάγῃ, καὶ μὴ ἀποθάνῃ

“This is the bread which comes down from heaven, so that a {person} might eat from it and might not die”

Jesus continues using the **bread** metaphor to express that one must believe in him in order to have eternal life just as one must **eat bread** to sustain physical life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a simile. Alternate translation: [I am this bread that comes down from heaven, just as one must eat bread to live, so must one believe in me in order to not die spiritually]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 6:50 (#4)

ἐξ αὐτοῦ φάγῃ

“might eat from it”

Jesus uses **eat** to refer to believing in him for salvation. What Jesus said plainly in verse 47 he says here. If this would confuse your readers, you could express this with a simile. Alternate translation: [might believe in me as one eats bread to live]

See: Metaphor

John 6:50 (#2)

οὗτός ἐστιν & αὐτοῦ

“This is & it”

John records Jesus referring to himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person. Alternate translation: [I am ... me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:51 (#4)

ἐάν τις φάγῃ ἐκ τούτου τοῦ ἄρτου, ζήσεται εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“If anyone eats from this bread, he will live into eternity”

Here and in the previous verse, Jesus uses **eats** to refer to believing in Jesus for salvation. Jesus gives eternal life to those who believe in him. See how you translated “eat” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Just as food keeps you physically alive, I can give you spiritual life]

See: Metaphor

John 6:51 (#6)

ὁ ἄρτος

“the bread”

Jesus is using the **bread** metaphor slightly differently from how he has used it previously. Here it refers specifically to his physical body, which he would sacrifice on the cross to pay for the sins of those who believe in him. Since Jesus says this explicitly at the end of the verse, you do not need to explain its meaning further.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:51 (#8)

ὑπὲρ τῆς τοῦ κόσμου ζωῆς

“for the life of the world”

Here, **the world** is used to refer to the people in the world. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the life of the people in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 6:51 (#3)

ὁ ἄρτος ὁ ζῶν

“the living bread”

Here, **living** refers to being the source of life or having the ability to produce life, which is synonymous with “of life” in the phrase “the bread of life,” which Jesus used in 6:35. See how you translated “the bread of life” in 6:35. Alternate translation: [the bread that gives life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:51 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ἄρτος ὁ ζῶν ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβάς; ἐάν τις φάγῃ ἐκ τούτου τοῦ ἄρτου, ζήσεται εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“I am the living bread that has come down from heaven. If anyone eats from this bread, he will live into eternity”

As in the previous verse, Jesus continues using the **bread** metaphor to say that one must believe in him in order to have eternal life just as one **eats bread** to sustain physical life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a simile. Alternate translation: [I am the living bread that comes down from heaven. Just as one lives if they eat bread, so does one who believes in me live forever]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 6:51 (#5)

ἡ σάρξ μού

“my flesh”

John records Jesus using **flesh** to refer to his whole physical body. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my body]

See: Metonymy

John 6:51 (#2)

ἐγώ εἰμι

“I am”

Jesus uses this phrase emphatically to make a strong statement about who he is. Use the most natural way to express emphasis in your language. Alternate translation: [I myself am] or [I am indeed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:51 (#7)

ὑπὲρ τῆς τοῦ κόσμου ζωῆς

“for the life of the world”

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explic-

itly. Alternate translation: [for the eternal life of the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:52 (#3)

πῶς δύναται οὗτος ἡμῖν δοῦναι τὴν σάρκα φαγεῖν

"How is this one able to give us his flesh to eat"

The Jewish leaders are using the form of a question to emphasize that they are reacting negatively to what Jesus has said about **his flesh**. If this might be misunderstood in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [There is no way that this one is able to give us his flesh to eat!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:52 (#2)

ἐμάχοντο & πρὸς ἀλλήλους οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι λέγοντες

"the Jews began to argue among themselves, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [then the Jews began to argue among themselves, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 6:52 (#1)

οὖν & οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"Then the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 6:52 (#4)

τὴν σάρκα

"his flesh"

John records the Jews using **flesh** to refer to Jesus' whole physical body. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his body]

See: Metonymy

John 6:53 (#6)

οὐκ ἔχετε ζωὴν

"you do not have life"

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [you do not have eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:53 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 6:53 (#2)

φάγητε τὴν σάρκα τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, καὶ πίητε αὐτοῦ τὸ αἷμα

"you would eat the flesh of the Son of Man and would drink his blood"

Jesus is using the phrases **eat the flesh** and **drink his blood**. Just as people need to **eat** and **drink** in order to live, people need to trust Jesus in order to have eternal life. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:53 (#5)

τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"of the Son of Man"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:53 (#4)

τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, καὶ πίητε αὐτοῦ τὸ αἷμα

"of the Son of Man and would drink his blood"

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:53 (#3)

φάγητε τὴν σάρκα τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, καὶ πίητε αὐτοῦ τὸ αἷμα

“you would eat the flesh of the Son of Man and would drink his blood”

These two phrases, **eat the flesh** and **drink his blood**, mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that trusting in Jesus is the only way to have eternal life. Because Jesus’ **flesh** and **blood** are important concepts, do not combine them. Instead, you could communicate the emphasis in a way that is most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you would indeed eat the flesh of the Son of Man and would indeed drink his blood]

See: Doublet

John 6:54 (#1)

ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα, καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἷμα, ἔχει ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“The one eating my flesh and drinking my blood has eternal life”

The phrases “eating my flesh” and “drinking my blood” are a metaphor for trusting Jesus. Just as people need food and drink in order to live, people need to trust Jesus in order to have eternal life. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:54 (#3)

ἀναστήσω αὐτὸν

“will raise him up”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:40.

See: Idiom

John 6:54 (#2)

ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα, καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἷμα, ἔχει ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“The one eating my flesh and drinking my blood has eternal life”

As in the previous verse, these two phrases, **eat the flesh** and **drink his blood**, mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expressions in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Indeed, the one eating my flesh and drinking my blood surely has eternal life]

See: Doublet

John 6:54 (#4)

τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

“in the last day”

Here, **the last day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, Jesus returns to earth, and the bodies of those who are dead are raised from their graves. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh) See how you translated this phrase in verse 39. Alternate translation: [on the day when I return and judge everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:55 (#1)

ἡ & σάρξ μου & τὸ αἷμά μου

“my flesh & my blood”

Jesus is using the phrases **my flesh** and **my blood** to refer to believing in him. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:55 (#2)

ἡ & σάρξ μου ἀληθής ἐστι βρῶσις, καὶ τὸ αἷμά μου ἀληθής ἐστι πόσις

“my flesh is true food, and my blood is true drink”

Jesus is using the phrases **true food** and **true drink** to say that he, Jesus, gives life to those who trust in him. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:55 (#3)

ἡ & σάρξ μου ἀληθής ἐστι βρῶσις, καὶ τὸ αἷμά μου ἀληθής ἐστι πόσις

“my flesh is true food, and my blood is true drink”

As in the previous two verses, these two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expressions in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [my flesh is indeed true food, and my blood is indeed true drink]

See: Doublet

John 6:56 (#1)

ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα, καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἷμα

“The one eating my flesh and drinking my blood”

See how you translated this phrase in verse 54.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:56 (#3)

κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτῷ

“and I in him”

John records Jesus leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If this would be confusing in your language, you could supply the word from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and I remain in him]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:56 (#2)

ἐν ἐμοὶ μένει

“remains in me”

Here and frequently in John’s Gospel, **remains in** indicates being united in a continuous personal relationship with someone. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion of this expression in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [has a close relationship with me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:57 (#2)

Πατὴρ & Πατέρα

“Father & Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:57 (#5)

καὶ ὁ τρώγων με

“so the one eating me”

Jesus is using **eating me** to refer to trusting him. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here. See how you translated similar expressions in verses 53–56.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:57 (#1)

ὁ ζῶν Πατὴρ

“the living Father”

Here, **living** refers to being the source of life or having the ability to create life. This is also how Jesus used **living** in verse 51. See how you translated **living** in verse 51. Alternate translation: [the Father who causes life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:57 (#4)

κἀγὼ ζῶ διὰ τὸν Πατέρα

“and I live because of the Father”

Here, **because of the Father** indicates the reason why Jesus has the ability to cause life. God the Father gave Jesus the ability to cause others to live. Jesus explained this concept in 5:25–26. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and I cause life because the Father has enabled me to do so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:57 (#3)

κἀγὼ ζῶ διὰ τὸν Πατέρα

“and I live because of the Father”

Here, **live** refers to being the source of life or having the ability to create life. It does not mean to merely be alive. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and I cause life because of the Father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:57 (#6)

κἀκεῖνος ζήσει δι’ ἐμέ

“he will also live because of me”

Here, **live** refers to having eternal life. It does not refer to being the source of life, as **living** and **live** are used previously in this verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will also have eternal life because of me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:58 (#1)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ ἄρτος ὁ ἐξ οὐρανοῦ καταβάς

“This is the bread that has come down from heaven”

John records Jesus referring to himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:58 (#7)

ὁ τρώγων τοῦτον τὸν ἄρτον

“The one eating this bread”

Jesus is using **eating this bread** to refer to trusting him. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:58 (#2)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ ἄρτος & τοῦτον τὸν ἄρτον

“This is the bread & this bread”

Jesus is continuing the **bread** metaphor to refer to himself. Just as **bread** is necessary for our physical life, Jesus is necessary for our spiritual life. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 6:58 (#4)

οὐ καθὼς ἔφαγον οἱ πατέρες καὶ ἀπέθανον

“not just as the fathers ate and died”

John records Jesus leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [this bread is not just as the bread that the fathers ate and died]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:58 (#5)

ἔφαγον οἱ πατέρες καὶ ἀπέθανον

“the fathers ate and died”

The phrase **ate and died** does not mean that the people died immediately after eating the bread. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could translate it in a way that shows a time gap between eating and drinking. Alternate translation: [the fathers ate and still died at a later time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:58 (#3)

οἱ πατέρες

“the fathers”

Jesus uses **fathers** to refer to ancestors. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ancestors] or [the forefathers]

See: Metaphor

John 6:58 (#6)

ὁ τρώγων τοῦτον τὸν ἄρτον

“The one eating this bread”

Jesus spoke about himself as **this bread**. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:59 (#2)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** refers to what Jesus said to the crowd and Jewish leaders in verses 26–58. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these teachings about being the bread of life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:59 (#1)

In this verse John gives background information about when this event happened. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 6:60 (#4)

τίς δύναται αὐτοῦ ἀκούειν

“who is able to listen to it”

The disciples use the question form for emphasis. If this would be confusing in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [no one is able to listen to it!] or [it is too hard to listen to!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:60 (#1)

ἀκούσαντες

“having heard”

John leaves out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [having heard this]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:60 (#2)

ἐστιν ὁ λόγος οὗτος

"This word is"

Here, **word** stands for what Jesus had just spoken to the crowd in verses 26–58. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What he has just said is] or [These words are]

See: Metonymy

John 6:60 (#3)

σκληρός

"hard"

Here, **hard** refers to something that causes a negative reaction because it is harsh or unpleasant. It does not refer to something that is difficult to understand, but something that is difficult to accept. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [hard to accept] or [offensive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:61 (#3)

ὑμᾶς

"you"

Here and throughout 6:61–71 **you** is plural and refers to Jesus' disciples. If your language distinguishes between singular and plural second person pronouns, you should use the plural form of **you**. Alternate translation: [you disciples of mine]

See: Forms of You

John 6:61 (#1)

εἰδὼς δὲ ὁ Ἰησοῦς ἐν ἑαυτῷ

"But Jesus, knowing in himself"

This phrase implies that Jesus had supernatural knowledge. It indicates that Jesus knew what his disciples were saying even though he did not hear what they said. If it would be helpful to your readers, your could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Even though no one told Jesus, he knew] or [Even though Jesus had not heard them, he was fully aware]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:61 (#2)

περὶ τούτου & τοῦτο

"about this & this"

In this verse, **this** refers to what Jesus had just spoken to the crowd in verses 26–58. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [about these teachings ... what I teach]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:62 (#4)

ὅπου ἦν τὸ πρότερον

"to where he was before"

This phrase refers to heaven, where Jesus was **before** he came down to earth. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to heaven, where I used to be]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:62 (#1)

ἐὰν & θεωρῆτε τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, ἀναβαίνοντα ὅπου ἦν τὸ πρότερον

"if you would see the Son of Man going up to where he was before"

John records Jesus using only one part of a conditional sentence. He leaves out the second part of the conditional sentence for emphasis. Many languages need to have both parts of a conditional sentence in order to make the sentence complete. If this is true for your language, you could supply the second clause from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [if you would see the Son of Man going up to where he was before, would it offend you?]

See: Ellipsis

John 6:62 (#3)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:62 (#2)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, ἀναβαίνοντα ὅπου ἦν τὸ πρότερον

"the Son of Man going up to where he was before"

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 6:63 (#7)

ζωή

"life"

Here, **life** refers to eternal life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:63 (#6)

καὶ ζωή ἐστιν

"and they are life"

This could mean: (1) give life. Alternate translation: [and they give life]; (2) about life. Alternate translation: [and they are about life]

John 6:63 (#4)

τὰ ῥήματα & ζωή ἐστιν

"The words & they are life"

Here, **words** stands for the teachings that Jesus had just spoken to the crowd in verses 26–58. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The teachings ... these teachings are life]

See: Metonymy

John 6:63 (#2)

ἡ σὰρξ

"the flesh"

Here, **the flesh** could refer to: (1) human nature, as in the UST. (2) Jesus' body. Alternate translation: [my flesh]; (3) both human nature and Jesus' body. [your nature and my flesh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:63 (#5)

πνεῦμά ἐστιν

"are spirit"

This could mean: (1) from the Spirit. Alternate translation: [are from the Spirit]; (2) about the Spirit. Alternate translation: [are about the Spirit]

John 6:63 (#1)

τὸ Πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζῳοποιοῦν

"The Spirit is the one making alive"

Here, **making alive** refers to giving eternal life, not physical life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The Spirit is the one giving eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:63 (#3)

οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδέν

"profits nothing"

Here, **profit** means to be beneficial or useful. It does not mean to earn money. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has no benefit] or [is no help at all]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:64 (#2)

οἳ οὐ πιστεύουσιν & οἱ μὴ πιστεύοντες

"who do not believe & the ones not believing"

The implied object of **believe** and **believing** is Jesus or Jesus' teaching. If your language requires an object for these words, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who do not believe in me ... the ones not believing in me] or [who do not believe what I say ... the ones not believing what I say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:64 (#1)

ᾔδει γὰρ ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὁ Ἰησοῦς, τίνες εἰσὶν οἱ μὴ πιστεύοντες, καὶ τίς ἐστιν ὁ παραδώσων αὐτόν

"For Jesus knew from the beginning who are the ones not believing and who is the one that will be betraying him"

In this sentence John gives background information to explain why Jesus said the earlier part of this verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Jesus said this because he knew from the start who did not believe and who would later betray him]

See: Background Information

John 6:65 (#5)

Πατρός

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 6:65 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

“Because of this”

Here, **this** refers to the information Jesus said in the previous verse. If it would be misunderstood for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because of the disbelief I have just told you about]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:65 (#2)

οὐδεὶς δύναται ἐλθεῖν πρός με

“no one is able to come to me”

See how you translated the identical phrase in verse 44. Alternate translation: [no one is able to come to be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:65 (#4)

ᾖ δεδομένον αὐτῷ ἐκ τοῦ Πατρός

“it would have been granted to him by the Father”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Father would give it to him]

See: Active or Passive

John 6:65 (#3)

ᾖ δεδομένον αὐτῷ

“it would have been granted to him”

The pronoun **it** refers to the ability to come to Jesus and be his disciple. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the ability to come to me would be have been granted to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 6:66 (#2)

οὐκέτι μετ’ αὐτοῦ περιεπάτουν

“no longer were walking with him”

Although Jesus did walk from one place to another, here **walking** is used to refer to how a person lives and behaves. These people were **no longer** living according to Jesus’ teaching and thus were no longer his disciples. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no longer obeyed his teachings] or [no longer were his disciples]

See: Metaphor

John 6:66 (#1)

ἀπῆλθον εἰς τὰ ὀπίσω

“stayed behind”

Here, **stayed behind** is an idiom that refers to going back to living the way one had lived previously. Here, these people left Jesus to go back to living the way they had lived before they met him. If this might confuse your readers, you could state its meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [returned to their former manner of living] or [went back to their previous way of life]

See: Idiom

John 6:67 (#2)

τοῖς δώδεκα

“to the Twelve”

If your language does not ordinarily use adjectives as nouns, you may be able to do that in this case, since this is a title by which the apostles were known. Even though it is a number, if you translate it as a title, as the ULT does, follow the conventions for titles in your language. For example, capitalize main words and write out numbers rather than use digits.

See: How to Translate Names

John 6:67 (#3)

μὴ καὶ ὑμεῖς θέλετε ὑπάγειν

“You do not want to go away also, do you”

John records Jesus asking this question in a way that expects a negative response. He does this to contrast **the Twelve** from the many other disciples who had just abandoned him. If your language has a question form that assumes a negative response, you should use it here. Alternate translation: [You probably do not want to go away also, am I right?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:67 (#1)

τοῖς δώδεκα

“to the Twelve”

John is using the adjective **Twelve** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the 12 apostles] or [the 12 men whom he had appointed to be apostles]

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 6:68 (#1)

Σίμων Πέτρος

“Simon Peter”

See how you translated the name **Simon Peter** in 1:40.

See: How to Translate Names

John 6:68 (#4)

ῥήματα

“words”

John records Peter using the term **words** to describe the things that Jesus taught by using words. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the teaching]

See: Metonymy

John 6:68 (#2)

Κύριε, πρὸς τίνα ἀπελευσόμεθα

“Lord, to whom will we go”

Simon Peter is using the form of a question to emphasize that he desires to follow only Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Lord, we could never follow anyone but you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:68 (#3)

ῥήματα ζωῆς αἰωνίου ἔχεις

“You have words of eternal life”

Peter uses **of** to describe **words** that give **eternal life**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [You have words that give eternal life]

See: Possession

John 6:69 (#2)

ὁ Ἅγιος τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the Holy One of God”

Peter uses **of** to describe **the Holy One** who comes from **God**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Holy One from God]

See: Possession

John 6:69 (#1)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

When Peter says **we**, he is speaking of himself and the rest of the twelve disciples, so **we** would be exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 6:70 (#2)

τοὺς δώδεκα

“the Twelve”

See how you translated **the Twelve** in verse 67.

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 6:70 (#3)

ἐξ ὑμῶν εἷς διάβολός ἐστιν

“one of you is a devil”

The word **devil** could mean: (1) one of Jesus’ twelve disciples was a wicked person whose thoughts and actions resembled those of the **devil** or was being influenced or controlled by the **devil**. It does not mean that this person actually was the devil in human form. It also does not imply that there is more than one devil. Alternate translation: [one of you is wicked like the devil] or [one of you is controlled by the devil]; (2) one of Jesus’ twelve disciples was speaking harmful and untrue things about Jesus to others. This meaning is possible because the word translated as **devil** can also mean “slanderer.” Alternate translation: [one of you is a slanderer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 6:70 (#1)

οὐκ ἐγὼ ὑμᾶς τοὺς δώδεκα ἐξελεξάμην, καὶ ἐξ ὑμῶν εἷς διάβολός ἐστιν

“Did not I choose you, the Twelve, and one of you is a devil”

Jesus gives this remark in the form of a question in order to emphasize that one of the twelve disciples will betray him. Alternate translation: [I chose you, the Twelve, myself, and one of you is a devil!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 6:71 (#3)

τῶν δώδεκα

"the Twelve"

See how you translated **the Twelve** in verse 67.

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 6:71 (#1)

In this verse John provides background information about what Jesus said in the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 6:71 (#2)

τὸν Ἰούδαν Σίμωνος Ἰσκαριώτου

"of Judas, {son} of Simon Iscariot"

Judas and **Simon** are names of two men. This **Simon** is not the same as Simon Peter. **Iscariot** is a distinguishing term that most likely means he came from the village of Kerioth.

See: How to Translate Names

John - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus goes to Jerusalem for the Festival of Shelters (7:1–13)
2. Jesus says his authority is from God (7:14–24)
3. Jesus says he came from God (7:25–31)
4. Jesus says he will return to God (7:32–36)
5. Jesus says he is the living water (7:37–39)
6. The people disagree about who Jesus is (7:40–44)
7. The Jewish leaders disagree about who Jesus is (7:45–53)

Translators may wish to include a note at 7:53 to explain to the reader why they have chosen or chosen not to translate 7:53–8:11. These verses are not in the best and oldest ancient manuscripts. If the translators have chosen to translate these verses, then they will want to either put them in a footnote outside of the main text or mark them in some way, such as square brackets ([ ]), to indicate that the passage may not have originally been in John's Gospel. (See: Textual Variants)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"Believing in him"
A recurring theme in this chapter is the concept of believing Jesus to be the Messiah. Some people believed he was the Messiah, while others did not. Some were willing to recognize his power and even the possibility that he was a prophet, but most were unwilling to believe that he was the Messiah. (See: Christ, Messiah; and prophet, prophecy, prophesy, seer, prophetess)

"My time has not yet come"
This phrase and "his hour had not yet come" are used in this chapter to indicate that Jesus is in control of the events that are happening in his life.

"Living water"
This is an important metaphor used in the New Testament to refer to the Holy Spirit. See the discussion of this metaphor in the note about "living water" for 4:10. (See: Metaphor)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Prophecy
In 7:33–34 Jesus gives a prophecy about his return to heaven without explicitly indicating his statement as prophecy.

Irony
Nicodemus explains to the other Pharisees that the Law requires them to hear directly from a person before making a judgment about that person. The Pharisees in turn made a judgment about Jesus without speaking to Jesus.

"Did not believe in him"
Jesus' brothers did not believe that Jesus was the Messiah at the time the events in this chapter took place. (See: believe, believer, belief, unbeliever, unbelief)

"The Jews"
This term is used in two different ways in this passage. It is used specifically to refer to the Jewish leaders who opposed Jesus and were trying to kill him (7:1, 11, 13, 15, 35). It is also used in 7:2 to refer to Jewish people in general. The translator may wish to use the terms "Jewish leaders" and "Jewish people" to clarify this distinction.

John 7:1 (#2)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Here and throughout this chapter, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. Apart from one exception in 7:2, it does not refer to the Jewish people in general. See how you translated this term in 1:19. Alternate translation: [the Jewish authorities]

See: Synecdoche

John 7:1 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

“after these things”

This phrase introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 7:2 (#1)

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about when the events happened. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [This event took place near the time of the Shelters Festival, the festival of the Jews]

See: Background Information

John 7:2 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“of the Jews”

Unlike in the previous verse and throughout this chapter, **the Jews** here refers to the Jewish people in general. It does not refer to the Jewish leaders. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:3 (#1)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ

“his brothers”

These were Jesus’ younger **brothers**, the other sons of Mary and Joseph who were born after Jesus. Since the Father of Jesus was God and their father was Joseph, they were actually his half-brothers. That detail is not normally translated, but if your language has a specific word for a man’s younger brother, it would be appropriate to use it here. Alternate translation: [his younger brothers] or [his half-brothers]

See: Kinship

John 7:3 (#2)

σοῦ τὰ ἔργα ἃ ποιεῖς

“your works that you do”

Here, **works** refers to the powerful miracles that Jesus was performing. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your miracles that you do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:4 (#1)

ζητεῖ αὐτὸς

“seeks himself”

Jesus’ brothers use the reflexive pronoun **himself** in order to emphasize their belief that Jesus wants to make **himself** famous. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [seeks for his own benefit]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 7:4 (#3)

εἰ ταῦτα ποιεῖς

“If you do these things”

John records Jesus’ brothers speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but they mean that it is actually true. Although they did not believe that Jesus was the Messiah at this time, they did not deny that he was doing miracles. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what the brothers are saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since you do these things]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 7:4 (#4)

τῷ κόσμῳ

“to the world”

Here, **the world** is used figurative to refer to all of the people in the world. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to all people]

See: Metonymy

John 7:4 (#2)

ζητεῖ αὐτὸς ἐν παρρησίᾳ εἶναι

“seeks himself to be in openness”

Alternate translation: [seeks publicity for himself] or [seeks public attention]

John 7:5 (#2)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ

“his brothers”

See how you translated **brothers** in verse 3. Alternate translation: [his younger brothers] or [his half-brothers]

See: Kinship

John 7:5 (#1)

οὐδὲ γὰρ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ ἐπίστευον εἰς αὐτὸν

“For not even his brothers were believing in him”

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about the brothers of Jesus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Jesus’ brothers said this because even they did not believe in him]

See: Background Information

John 7:6 (#2)

ὁ καιρὸς ὁ ἐμὸς οὔπω πάρεστιν

“My time is not yet come”

This could mean: (1) It was not the right **time** for Jesus to go to Jerusalem for the festival because God had not yet told him to go. This meaning explains why he eventually went to the festival in verse 10. Alternate translation: [Now is not the right time for me to go to Jerusalem]; (2) It was not the right **time** for Jesus to publicly reveal himself as the Messiah, which is what his brothers wanted him to do. Alternate translation: [Now is not the right time for me to publicly reveal myself as the Messiah]

See: Metonymy

John 7:6 (#4)

ὁ δὲ καιρὸς ὁ ὑμέτερος πάντοτέ ἐστιν ἕτοιμος

“but your time is always ready”

Alternate translation: [but any time is good for you]

John 7:6 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 7:6 (#3)

ὁ ὑμέτερος

“your”

All instances of “you” and **your** in verses 6–8 are plural. They only refer to Jesus’ brothers.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

John 7:7 (#2)

μισεῖ & περὶ αὐτοῦ & τὰ ἔργα αὐτοῦ

“it hates & about it & the works of it”

In this verse, **it** refers to the people in **the world**. If you translated **the world** with a plural noun, then you should change these pronouns to plural form as well. Alternate translation: [they hate … about them … their works]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 7:7 (#3)

ἐγὼ μαρτυρῶ περὶ αὐτοῦ, ὅτι τὰ ἔργα αὐτοῦ πονηρά ἐστιν

“I testify about it that the works of it are evil”

Alternate translation: [I tell them that what they are doing is evil]

John 7:7 (#1)

οὐ δύναται ὁ κόσμος μισεῖν ὑμᾶς

“The world is not able to hate you”

The world here refers to the people who live in the world. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [All the people in the world are not able to hate you]

See: Metonymy

John 7:8 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἀνάβητε

“You go up”

John records Jesus saying **go up** to refer to going to Jerusalem, because that city is at a higher elevation than Galilee, which is where Jesus and his brothers were at this time. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate where they would go. Alternate translation: [You go up to Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:8 (#2)

ὁ ἐμὸς καιρὸς οὔπω πεπλήρωται

"my time has not yet been fulfilled"

This phrase means the same as "My time is not yet come" in verse 6. See how you translated this phrase there. Alternate translation: [Now is not the right time for me to go to Jerusalem] or [Now is not the right time for me to publicly reveal myself as the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:10 (#2)

καὶ αὐτὸς ἀνέβη

"he also went up"

See how you translated "go up" in verse 8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:10 (#3)

οὐ φανερῶς, ἀλλὰ ὡς ἐν κρυπτῷ

"not publicly, but as in secret"

These two phrases mean the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that Jesus did not want to attract public attention in Jerusalem. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [very secretly]

See: Doublet

John 7:10 (#1)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ

"his brothers"

See how you translated this phrase in verse 3. Alternate translation: [his younger brothers] or [his half-brothers]

See: Kinship

John 7:11 (#2)

ποῦ ἐστιν ἐκεῖνος

"Where is that one"

John records the Jewish leaders saying **that one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus without saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [Where is that so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:11 (#1)

οἱ & Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 7:12 (#2)

τοῖς ὄχλοις & τὸν ὄχλον

"the crowds & the crowd"

Here, **crowds** refers to several different groups of people, while **crowd** refers to a group of people in general. See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13. Alternate translation: [the groups of people ... the group of people]

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:12 (#1)

γογγυσμὸς

"murmuring"

Although the word translated as **murmuring** usually refers to grumbling or complaining, here it refers to speaking quietly, without a negative meaning. Some people in **the crowd** were discussing who Jesus was and did not want the religious leaders to hear them. If your word for **murmuring** only has a negative connotation in your language, use a different neutral expression. Alternate translation: [quiet discussion] or [whispering]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:12 (#3)

πλανᾷ τὸν ὄχλον

"he leads the crowd astray"

The people use **leads astray** to refer to persuading someone to believe something that is not true. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he misleads the crowd]

See: Metaphor

John 7:13 (#1)

διὰ τὸν φόβον τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“because of the fear of the Jews”

John is using **of** to describe the **fear** that the people had for the Jewish leaders. If this use of the possessive form would be confusing in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [because of their fear that the Jews would harm them]

See: Possession

John 7:13 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“of the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 7:14 (#1)

τῆς ἑορτῆς

“the festival”

Here, **the festival** refers to the Jewish Festival of Shelters mentioned in verse 1. See how you translated the word **festival** there. Alternate translation: [the Shelters festival]

John 7:14 (#2)

εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν

“into the temple”

Since only priests could enter **the temple** building, this refers to **the temple** courtyard. John is using the word for the entire building to refer to one part of it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into the temple courtyard]

See: Synecdoche

John 7:15 (#5)

μὴ μεμαθηκώς

“not being educated”

The Jewish leaders use **educated** to refer to receiving a Jewish religious education, which would include studying the Hebrew scriptures and Jewish religious traditions. This does not mean that they thought Jesus did not know how to read or write. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [not being trained in our scriptures and doctrines]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:15 (#3)

πῶς οὗτος γράμματα οἶδεν, μὴ μεμαθηκώς

“How does this one know letters, not being educated”

The Jewish leaders are using the form of a question to emphasize that they were surprised and annoyed by how much knowledge Jesus had about Scripture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate their words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [He certainly cannot know so much about the scriptures, not being educated!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:15 (#2)

ἐθαύμαζον

“marveled”

The word translated as **marveled** refers to being amazed or in wonder of something in either a negative or positive way. Since the Jewish leaders despised Jesus, their amazement was unfavorable toward him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [showed their surprise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:15 (#6)

ἐθαύμαζον & οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι λέγοντες

“the Jews marveled, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [the Jews marveled, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 7:15 (#4)

οὗτος

“this one”

John records the Jewish leaders saying **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:15 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 7:16 (#1)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

“of the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:17 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐστιν & ἀπ’ ἐμαυτοῦ

“it is from God & from myself”

Here, **from** is used to indicate the source of Jesus’ teaching. A teaching could only have authority if God was its source. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it is with God’s authority ... only with my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:18 (#1)

ἀφ’ ἑαυτοῦ

“from himself”

Here, **from** is used to indicate the source of what the person is speaking. A teaching could only have authority if God was its source. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by his own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:18 (#3)

ἀδικία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν

“there is no unrighteousness in him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **unrighteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he is not wicked]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 7:18 (#2)

τὴν δόξαν τὴν ἰδίαν ζητεῖ; ὁ δὲ ζητῶν τὴν δόξαν τοῦ πέμψαντος αὐτὸν

“seeks his own glory, but the one seeking the glory of the one having sent him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [seeks to make himself glorious, but the one seeking to make the one who sent him glorious]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 7:19 (#2)

τὸν νόμον & ποιεῖ τὸν νόμον

“the law & does the law”

See how you translated **the law** in 1:17.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:19 (#4)

τί με ζητεῖτε ἀποκτεῖναι

“Why do you seek to kill me”

Jesus is using the form of a question to emphasize that the Jewish leaders who want to **kill** him for breaking the law of Moses are themselves breaking that law. If your language does not use this type of question, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You break the law yourselves and yet you want to kill me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:19 (#3)

ποιεῖ τὸν νόμον

“does the law”

Here, **does the law** means to keep, follow, or obey **the law**. If this use of **does** would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obeys the law]

John 7:19 (#1)

οὐ Μωϋσῆς δέδωκεν ὑμῖν τὸν νόμον, καὶ οὐδεὶς ἐξ ὑμῶν ποιεῖ τὸν νόμον

“Did not Moses give you the law? Yet none of you does the law”

Jesus is using the form of a question to add emphasis. If your language does not use this type of question,

you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [It was Moses who gave you the law, but none of you obeys the law!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:20 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

"The crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:20 (#3)

τίς σε ζητεῖ ἀποκτεῖναι

"Who seeks to kill you"

The crowd is using the form of a question to add emphasis. If your language does not use this type of question, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No one wants to kill you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:20 (#2)

δαιμόνιον ἔχεις

"You have a demon"

Alternate translation: [A demon is inside of you!] or [You must be under the control of a demon!]

John 7:21 (#2)

πάντες θαυμάζετε

"you all marvel"

The word translated as **marvel** refers to being amazed or in wonder of something in either a negative or positive way. Since some people in this crowd despised Jesus, their amazement was unfavorable toward him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you are all surprised]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:21 (#1)

ἓν ἔργον

"one work"

Here, **work** refers to the time when Jesus miraculously healed a paralyzed man on the Jewish day of rest called the Sabbath, as recorded in 5:5–9. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one miracle on the Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:22 (#5)

ἄνθρωπον

"a man"

Jesus is speaking of any Jewish **man** in general, not of one particular **man**. If this use of **man** would be misunderstood in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [men]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 7:22 (#2)

οὐχ ὅτι ἐκ τοῦ Μωϋσέως ἐστὶν, ἀλλ' ἐκ τῶν πατέρων

"not that it is from Moses, but from the fathers"

Jesus provides additional information about where the Jewish practice of circumcision came from. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 7:22 (#4)

ἐν Σαββάτῳ περιτέμνετε ἄνθρωπον

"on the Sabbath you circumcise a man"

Jesus implies that to **circumcise** a child was a kind of work. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you circumcise a male baby on the Sabbath. That is working too]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:22 (#3)

τῶν πατέρων

"the fathers"

Here, **fathers** refers specifically to the first ancestors of the Jewish people, who are often called "the Patriarchs." Those people are Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. It does not refer to the ancestors of the Jewish people in general. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Patriarchs] or [the men who founded the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:22 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

"Because of this"

Here, **this** refers to someone doing something on the Sabbath to help someone else. More specifically, Jesus is referring to the time he offended the Jews by healing a paralyzed man on the Sabbath. This event was indirectly mentioned in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [On account of activities like healing taking place on the Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:23 (#4)

μὴ λυθῇ ὁ νόμος Μωϋσέως

"the law of Moses might not be broken"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you might not break the law of Moses]

See: Active or Passive

John 7:23 (#2)

λαμβάνει ἄνθρωπος

"a man receives"

See how you translated **man** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [men receive]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 7:23 (#3)

ὁ νόμος

"the law"

See how you translated **the law** in 1:17.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:23 (#1)

εἰ περιτομὴν λαμβάνει ἄνθρωπος ἐν Σαββάτῳ

"If a man receives circumcision on the Sabbath"

John records Jesus speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since a man receives circumcision on the Sabbath]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 7:23 (#6)

ἐμοὶ χολᾶτε ὅτι ὅλον ἄνθρωπον ὑγιῆ ἐποίησα ἐν Σαββάτῳ

"why are you angry with me because I made a man completely healthy on the Sabbath"

Jesus is using the question form for emphasis. If your language does not use this type of question, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you should not be angry with me because I made a man completely well on the Sabbath!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:23 (#5)

μὴ λυθῇ ὁ νόμος Μωϋσέως

"the law of Moses might not be broken"

Here, Jesus uses **broken** to refer to disobeying the regulations that God gave in **the law of Moses**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the regulations of the law of Moses might not be disobeyed]

See: Idiom

John 7:24 (#1)

μὴ κρίνετε κατ' ὄψιν, ἀλλὰ τὴν δικαίαν κρίσιν κρίνετε

"Do not judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment"

Jesus implies that the people should not decide what is right based only on what they can see. A person does something for a reason and that reason cannot be seen. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not judge people according to appearance! Instead, decide what is right according to what God says is right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:24 (#3)

τὴν δικαίαν κρίσιν κρίνετε

“judge righteous judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [judge righteously]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 7:24 (#2)

κατ᾽ ὄψιν

“according to appearance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **appearance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to what you see]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 7:25 (#1)

οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὃν ζητοῦσιν ἀποκτεῖναι

“Is not this the one they seek to kill”

Here, **the Jerusalemites** are using the question form for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [This is the one they are seeking to kill!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:26 (#2)

μήποτε ἀληθῶς ἔγνωσαν οἱ ἄρχοντες, ὅτι οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ Χριστός

“The rulers do not truly know that this is the Christ, do they”

The Jerusalemites ask this question in a way that expects a negative response, but also expresses uncertainty about that response. If your language has a question form that assumes a negative response with uncertainty, you should use it here. Alternate translation: [Could it be possible that the rulers really know this is the Christ?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:26 (#1)

οὐδὲν αὐτῷ λέγουσιν

“they say nothing to him”

The Jerusalemites use this phrase in order to imply that the Jewish leaders are not opposing Jesus. Alternate translation: [they say nothing to oppose him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:26 (#3)

οἱ ἄρχοντες

“The rulers”

This phrase refers to the Jewish religious leadership, specifically the Jewish council called the Sanhedrin, which made decisions about Jewish law. (See: council) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The members of the Jewish ruling council]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:27 (#1)

τοῦτον

“this one”

John records the Jerusalemites saying **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus without saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:28 (#6)

ἔστιν ἀληθινὸς ὁ πέμψας με

“the one having sent me is true”

Here, **true** could mean: (1) real, in contrast to a false god. In this case, Jesus would be saying that the Father is the only real God. Alternate translation: [the one who sent me is the real God]; (2) truthful, in contrast to a liar. In this case, Jesus would be saying that Father who sent him always tells the truth. Alternate translation: [the one who sent me can be trusted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:28 (#4)

ἀπ᾽ ἐμαυτοῦ

“from myself”

See how you translated **from myself** in verse 17.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:28 (#3)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“in the temple”

Jesus and the people were actually in the courtyard of the **temple**. See how you translated **temple** in 7:14. Alternate translation: [in the temple courtyard]

See: Synecdoche

John 7:28 (#1)

ἔκραξεν οὖν ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ διδάσκων Ἰησοῦς, καὶ λέγων

"Then Jesus cried out in the temple, teaching and saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [Then Jesus cried out in the temple. While he was teaching, he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 7:28 (#5)

ὁ πέμψας με

"the one having sent me"

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in verse 16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:28 (#2)

ἔκραξεν

"cried out"

Alternate translation: [spoke in a loud voice]

John 7:30 (#4)

οὔπω ἐληλύθει ἡ ὥρα αὐτοῦ

"his hour had not yet come"

Here, the word **hour** is used to refer to the time God had planned for Jesus to be arrested and killed. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the right time to arrest him had not yet come]

See: Metonymy

John 7:30 (#2)

ἐζήτουν

"they were seeking"

Here, **they** could refer to: (1) the Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [the Jewish authorities were seeking]; (2) the Jerusalemites. Alternate translation: [the people dwelling in Jerusalem were seeking]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 7:30 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Therefore indicates that this verse states the result of what had happened in the previous verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [As a result of Jesus saying these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 7:30 (#3)

οὐδεὶς ἐπέβαλεν ἐπ' αὐτὸν τὴν χεῖρα

"no one laid a hand on him"

To lay **a hand on** someone is an idiom which means to grab someone or hold onto someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [no one grabbed him]

See: Idiom

John 7:31 (#3)

σημεῖα

"signs"

See how you translated **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 7:31 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ ὄχλου

"from among the crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:31 (#2)

ὁ Χριστὸς, ὅταν ἔλθῃ, μὴ πλείονα σημεῖα ποιήσει ὧν οὗτος ἐποίησεν

"When the Christ may come, he will not do more signs than what this one has done, will he"

The **crowd** uses the form of a question to add emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [When the Christ may come, surely he will not do more signs than this one has done!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:32 (#1)

τοῦ ὄχλου

“the crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:32 (#2)

γογγύζοντος

“murmuring”

Although the word translated as **murmuring** usually refers to grumbling or complaining, here it refers to speaking quietly, without a negative meaning. Some people in **the crowd** were discussing whether or not Jesus was the Messiah and did not want the religious leaders to hear them. See how you translated this word in verse 12.

John 7:33 (#3)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

“the one having sent me”

This phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in verse 16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:33 (#1)

ἔτι χρόνον μικρὸν μεθ’ ὑμῶν εἰμι

“I am still with you for a short time”

Alternate translation: [I will remain with you for only a short period of time]

John 7:33 (#2)

ὑπάγω

“I go away”

Jesus uses **go away** to refer to his death and return to heaven. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 7:34 (#1)

ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ ὑμεῖς, οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

“where I am, you will not be able to come”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [you will not be able to come to the place where I am]

See: Information Structure

John 7:35 (#5)

τὴν διασπορὰν τῶν Ἑλλήνων

“the dispersion of the Greeks”

The Jews used the phrase **of the Greeks** to describe the location where the Jews were dispersed. If this use of the possessive form would be confusing in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the Jews who are dispersed among the Greeks]

See: Possession

John 7:35 (#3)

μὴ εἰς τὴν διασπορὰν τῶν Ἑλλήνων μέλλει πορεύεσθαι, καὶ διδάσκειν τοὺς Ἕλληνας

“He is not about to go to the dispersion of the Greeks and to teach the Greeks, is he”

The Jewish leaders are using the form of a question to add emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Surely he is not about to go to the dispersion of the Greeks and to teach the Greeks!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:35 (#2)

οὗτος

“this one”

John records the Jewish leaders saying **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. See how you translated this phrase in verse 15. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:35 (#4)

τὴν διασπορὰν

“the dispersion”

Here, **dispersion** refers to the Jewish people who were spread across the Greek-speaking world that was outside of the land of Israel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

Alternate translation: [the Jews who are dispersed] or [the Jews who are scattered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:35 (#1)

εἶπον οὖν οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι πρὸς ἑαυτούς

"The Jews therefore said among themselves"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 7:36 (#2)

εἶπε, ζητήσετέ με, καὶ οὐχ εὑρήσετέ; καὶ ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ, ὑμεῖς οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"he said, 'You will seek me, but will not find {me}, and where I am, you will not be able to come"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 7:36 (#3)

ζητήσετέ με, καὶ οὐχ εὑρήσετέ; καὶ ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ, ὑμεῖς οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"You will seek me, but will not find {me}, and where I am, you will not be able to come"

See how you translated this in verse 34.

John 7:36 (#1)

τίς ἐστιν ὁ λόγος οὗτος ὃν εἶπε

"What is this word that he said"

Here, **word** is used to refer to the meaning of the message that Jesus had shared. The Jewish leaders had failed to understand that message. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What was he talking about when he said]

See: Metonymy

John 7:37 (#5)

ἐρχέσθω πρός με καὶ πινέτω

"let him come to me and drink"

Jesus uses **come** and **drink** to refer together to believing in Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [let him believe in me]

See: Metaphor

John 7:37 (#2)

ἔκραξεν λέγων

"cried out, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [cried out, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 7:37 (#3)

ἔκραξεν

"cried out"

See how you translated this phrase in verse 28.

John 7:37 (#4)

ἐάν τις διψᾷ

"If anyone thirsts"

Jesus uses **thirst** to refer to a person's need for God, just as someone would **thirst** for water. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [If anyone who recognizes their need for God is like a thirsty person who desires water]

See: Metaphor

John 7:37 (#1)

About three or four days have passed since the events described in verses 14–36. It is now the last day of the Festival of Shelters, and Jesus speaks to the crowd.

See: Background Information

John 7:38 (#8)

ἐκ τῆς κοιλίας αὐτοῦ

"from his stomach"

The **stomach** is used to refer to the non-physical part of a person. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from inside of him] or [from his heart]

See: Metonymy

John 7:38 (#2)

καθὼς εἶπεν ἡ Γραφή, ποταμοὶ ἐκ τῆς κοιλίας αὐτοῦ ῥεύσουσιν ὕδατος ζῶντος

“just as the scripture says, ‘Rivers of living water will flow from his stomach”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [rivers of living water will flow from the stomach of the one believing in me, just as the scripture says]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 7:38 (#6)

ὕδατος ζῶντος

“of living water”

Here, **living** is used to mean “giving eternal life” or “causing people to live forever.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of water that gives eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:38 (#1)

ὁ πιστεύων εἰς ἐμὲ, καθὼς εἶπεν ἡ Γραφή

“The one believing in me, just as the scripture says”

If it would be natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. You will also need to adjust some words to fit the new order. Alternate translation: [As the scripture says about anyone who believes in me]

See: Information Structure

John 7:38 (#7)

αὐτοῦ

“his”

The pronoun **his** could refer to: (1) the person who believes in Jesus. This meaning is used in most Bible translations and assumes that a new sentence begins at the beginning of this verse. Alternate translation, as in the ULT: [his]; (2) Jesus. This meaning is used in some ancient church writings and assumes that the sentence at the end of the previous verse continues through **the one believing in me** in this verse. Alternate translation: [my]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 7:38 (#4)

ποταμοὶ & ῥεύσουσιν ὕδατος ζῶντος

“Rivers of living water will flow”

Jesus uses **rivers** to refer to a constant and abundant flow of **living water**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [An abundance of living water will flow]

See: Metaphor

John 7:38 (#5)

ὕδατος ζῶντος

“of living water”

Jesus uses **living water** here to refer to the Holy Spirit who works in a person to save and transform them. However, since John explains this meaning in the next verse, you do not need to explain it further here. See how you translated **living water** in 4:10.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 7:38 (#3)

εἶπεν ἡ Γραφή

“the scripture says”

Jesus uses **scripture** as if it were a person who could speak. If this might confuse your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the prophets spoke in the scriptures]

See: Personification

John 7:39 (#2)

οὔπω & ἦν Πνεῦμα

“the Spirit was not yet”

John implies here that **the Spirit** would later come to dwell in those who trusted in Jesus. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Spirit had not yet come to dwell in the believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:39 (#3)

οὐδέπω ἐδοξάσθη

“had not yet been glorified”

The word **glorified** could refer to: (1) the time when Jesus would die on the cross and rise from the dead (See: John 12:23). Alternate translation: [had not yet been crucified and resurrected]; (2) the time when Jesus would ascend to his Father in heaven. Acts 1–2 records the Holy Spirit coming after Jesus went up to heaven. Alternate translation: [had not yet returned to God in glory]; (3) both the crucifixion, resurrection, and ascension of Jesus. Alternate translation: [had not yet

been glorified by his death, resurrection, and return to heaven] See the discussion of double meaning in Part 3 of the Introduction to the Gospel of John.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:39 (#1)

In this verse John gives information to clarify what Jesus was talking about in the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 7:40 (#4)

ὁ προφήτης

"the Prophet"

See how you translated **the Prophet** in 1:21. Alternate translation: [the Prophet whom God promised to send to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:40 (#3)

τῶν λόγων τούτων

"these words"

John uses the term **words** to describe the content of what Jesus had said by referring to something associated with it, the **words** he used to communicate it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these things he was saying]

See: Metonymy

John 7:40 (#2)

ἐκ τοῦ ὄχλου

"some from the crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:40 (#1)

οὖν

"Then"

Then here indicates that what follows is the continuation of the narrative from 7:38, which John had interrupted with background information in 7:39. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show reference to earlier events by translating this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [After Jesus had said this about the Holy Spirit,]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 7:41 (#1)

μὴ γὰρ ἐκ τῆς Γαλιλαίας ὁ Χριστὸς ἔρχεται

"Indeed, the Christ does not come from Galilee, does he"

These people are using the form of a question to add emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Indeed, the Christ surely does not come from Galilee!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:42 (#1)

οὐχ ἡ Γραφὴ εἶπεν, ὅτι ἐκ τοῦ σπέρματος Δαυεὶδ, καὶ ἀπὸ Βηθλέεμ, τῆς κώμης ὅπου ἦν Δαυεὶδ, ἔρχεται ὁ Χριστός

"Has the Scripture not said that the Christ will come from the seed of David and from Bethlehem, the village where David was"

The people are using the form of a question to add emphasis. This group of people does not believe Jesus is the Messiah, because they do not think he came from Bethlehem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating the words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [The scriptures surely say that the Christ will come from the seed of David and from Bethlehem, the village where David was!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:42 (#2)

οὐχ ἡ Γραφὴ εἶπεν

"Has the Scripture not said"

Scripture here is referred to as though it were a person who could speak. If this use of **said** might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Have the prophets not said in the scriptures]

See: Personification

John 7:43 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ὄχλῳ

“in the crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:43 (#1)

σχίσμα & ἐγένετο ἐν τῷ ὄχλῳ

“a division happened in the crowd”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **division**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the crowd was divided]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 7:44 (#2)

οὐδεὶς ἐπέβαλεν ἐπ’ αὐτὸν τὰς χεῖρας

“no one laid hands on him”

See how you translated this phrase in 7:30.

See: Idiom

John 7:44 (#1)

τινὲς & ἐξ αὐτῶν

“some of them”

Here, **them** refers to the people in the crowd with whom Jesus had just spoken, particularly those who were opposed to him. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [some of his opponents in the crowd]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 7:47 (#2)

μὴ καὶ ὑμεῖς πεπλάνησθε

“You have not also been deceived, have you”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He has not also deceived you, has he?]

See: Active or Passive

John 7:47 (#1)

μὴ καὶ ὑμεῖς πεπλάνησθε

“You have not also been deceived, have you”

The **Pharisees** ask this question in a way that expects a negative response but also expresses uncertainty about that response. If your language has a question form that assumes a negative response with uncertainty, you should use it here. Alternate translation: [Could it be possible that you have also been deceived?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:48 (#1)

μή τις ἐκ τῶν ἀρχόντων ἐπίστευσεν εἰς αὐτὸν, ἢ ἐκ τῶν Φαρισαίων

“None from the rulers have believed in him, or from the Pharisees, have they”

Here, **the Pharisees** are using the form of a question to add emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Surely none from the rulers have believed in him, or from the Pharisees!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:48 (#2)

τῶν ἀρχόντων

“the rulers”

Here, **rulers** refers to the Jewish religious leadership, specifically the Jewish council called the Sanhedrin, which made decisions about Jewish law. (See: council) See how you translated **rulers** in 3:1. Alternate translation: [a member of the Jewish ruling council]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:49 (#2)

τὸν νόμον

“the law”

See how you translated **the law** in 1:17.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:49 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

“crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 7:49 (#3)

ἐπάρατοί εἰσιν

“they are accursed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has cursed them]

See: Active or Passive

John 7:50 (#1)

ὁ ἐλθὼν πρὸς αὐτὸν πρότερον, εἷς ὢν ἐξ αὐτῶν

"the one having come to him earlier, being one from them"

John provides this information to remind us of who Nicodemus is and the conversation he had with Jesus that is recorded in chapter 3. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [this man was a Pharisee who had spoken with Jesus at an earlier time]

See: Background Information

John 7:50 (#2)

εἷς ὢν ἐξ αὐτῶν

"being one from them"

Alternate translation: [although he was one of them] or [despite being one of them]

John 7:50 (#3)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 7:51 (#1)

μὴ ὁ νόμος ἡμῶν κρίνει τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ πρῶτον παρ' αὐτοῦ, καὶ γνῷ τί ποιεῖ

"Our law does not judge a man unless it first hears from him and knows what he does, does it"

Nicodemus is using the form of a question to add emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this type of question by translating his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Our law certainly does not judge a man unless it might first hear from him and might know what he does!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:51 (#2)

μὴ ὁ νόμος ἡμῶν κρίνει τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ πρῶτον παρ' αὐτοῦ, καὶ γνῷ τί ποιεῖ

"Our law does not judge a man unless it first hears from him and knows what he does, does it"

Nicodemus speaks of the **law** as if it were a person. If this use of **law** is not natural in your language, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It is not written in our law that we may judge a man unless we might first hear from him and might know what he does, is it]

See: Personification

John 7:51 (#3)

τὸν ἄνθρωπον

"a man"

Here, **a man** does not refer to a specific man. It refers to any man in general. Alternate translation: [any man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 7:52 (#2)

ἐραύνησον καὶ ἴδε

"Search, and see"

Here, John records the Jewish leaders leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply the missing words from the context. Alternate translation: [Look carefully and read what is written in the Scriptures to learn]

See: Ellipsis

John 7:52 (#4)

ἐγείρεται

"rises up"

Here, **rises up** means to appear. Alternate translation: [appears]

John 7:52 (#1)

μὴ καὶ σὺ ἐκ τῆς Γαλιλαίας εἶ

"You are not also from Galilee, are you"

The Jewish leaders know that Nicodemus is not **from Galilee**. They ask this question as a way of scoffing at him. If your language does not use questions in this way, use another way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must also be one of those people from Galilee!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 7:52 (#3)

προφήτης ἐκ τῆς Γαλιλαίας οὐκ ἐγείρεται

"no prophet rises up from Galilee"

The Jewish leaders believed that Jesus came **from Galilee** and that no **prophet** in the scriptures came **from Galilee**. Therefore, based on their reasoning, Jesus could not be a **prophet**. However, what they believed was incorrect. Jesus did not originally come from Galilee, but Bethlehem in Judea. Also, the prophet Jonah came **from Galilee** (2 Kings 14:25) and Isaiah 9:1–7 said that the Messiah would be a great light rising from Galilee. If your readers might not understand what the Jewish leaders are implying, you could state it explicitly. Alternate translation: [no prophet rises up from Galilee, so this man cannot be a true prophet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 7:53 (#1)

The best early texts do not have 7:53–8:11. The ULT has set them apart in square brackets ([ ]) to show that John probably did not include them in his original text. See the discussion of this textual issue in the introduction to this chapter.

See: Textual Variants

John - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus forgives the adulterous woman 8:1–11
2. Jesus says he is the light of the world (8:12–20)
3. Jesus says he came from above (8:21–30)
4. Jesus says he frees people from sin (8:31–36)
5. Jesus describes the true children of Abraham and the children of Satan (8:37–47)
6. Jesus is greater than Abraham (8:48–59)

Translators may wish to include a note at 8:1 to explain to the reader why they have chosen to translate or to not translate 8:1–11. 7:53–8:11 are not in the best and oldest ancient manuscripts. Those ancient texts which do have these verses also have many differences between them, which are additional evidence that these verses were not originally in the Gospel of John. If the translators have chosen to translate these verses, then they will want to either put them in a footnote outside of the main text or mark them in some way, such as square brackets ([ ]), to indicate that the passage may not have originally been in John's Gospel. (See: Textual Variants)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Light and darkness
Generally in John's Gospel, light represents what is true and good and darkness represents what is false and evil. Similar to the discussion of light in 1:4–9, in 8:12 Jesus applies the light metaphor to himself in order to show that he is the embodiment of God's truth and goodness. Jesus calls himself the Light of the World because he is the one who enables people to know God's truth and goodness.

I AM
John records Jesus saying these words as an independent phrase three times in this chapter (8:24, 28, 58). They stand alone as a complete sentence, and they literally translate the Hebrew expression "I AM," by which Yahweh identified himself to Moses in Exodus 3:14. For these reasons, many people believe that when Jesus said these words he was claiming to be Yahweh. (See: Yahweh, Yah).

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" in this chapter (8:28). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 8:1 (#1)

The best early texts do not have 7:53–8:11. The ULT has set them apart in square brackets ([ ]) to show that John probably did not include them in his original text. See the discussion of this textual issue in the introduction to this chapter.

See: Textual Variants

John 8:12 (#2)

πάλιν & αὐτοῖς ἐλάλησεν & λέγων

"again spoke to them, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [spoke to the people again, and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 8:12 (#1)

In this verse Jesus begins speaking to a crowd near the treasury in the temple some time after the events of John 7:1–52. John does not mark the beginning of this new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 8:12 (#7)

φῶς τῆς ζωῆς

"light of life"

Here, John records Jesus using the **of** to describe **light** that gives **life**. If this use of the possessive form is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [light that brings life]

See: Possession

John 8:12 (#5)

ὁ ἀκολουθῶν ἐμοὶ

"the one following me"

Here, **following** means to become Jesus' disciple and obey his teachings. See how you translated a similar phrase in 1:43. Alternate translation: [the one who becomes my disciple] or [the one who obeys me]

See: Idiom

John 8:12 (#4)

τοῦ κόσμου

"of the world"

Here, **world** refers to all the people in the world. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of the people of the world]

See: Metonymy

John 8:12 (#3)

ἐγώ εἰμι τὸ φῶς τοῦ κόσμου & ἀλλ' ἕξει τὸ φῶς τῆς ζωῆς

"I am the light of the world & but will have the light of life"

Jesus uses **light** to refer to God's truth and goodness that are revealed to the world by Jesus. He is the embodiment of God's truth and goodness. See the discussion of **light** and **darkness** in the introduction to this chapter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [I am the one who reveals God's truth and goodness, that is like a light, to the world ... but will have that truth and goodness of life]

See: Metaphor

John 8:12 (#6)

οὐ μὴ περιπατήσῃ ἐν τῇ σκοτίᾳ

"may certainly not walk in the darkness"

Jesus uses the phrase **walk in the darkness** to refer to living a sinful life. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [may certainly not live as if he were living in the darkness of sin]

See: Metaphor

John 8:12 (#8)

τῆς ζωῆς

"of life"

Here, **life** refers to eternal **life**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:13 (#1)

σὺ περὶ σεαυτοῦ μαρτυρεῖς

"You testify about yourself"

The Pharisees assumed that their listeners understood that they were referring to Jesus testifying about himself without there being any other witnesses to confirm his **testimony**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [You are testifying about yourself without any other witnesses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:13 (#2)

ἡ μαρτυρία σου οὐκ ἔστιν ἀληθής

"your testimony is not true"

The Pharisees are implying that the **testimony** of only one person **is not true** because of a rule in the law of Moses. According to Deuteronomy 19:15, a statement had to be confirmed by at least two witnesses in order to be considered true in legal decisions. If your audience is not familiar with the law of Moses in the Old Testament, then you can state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [your testimony about yourself

cannot be true because the law of Moses requires at least two witnesses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:14 (#1)

ὑμεῖς δὲ οὐκ οἴδατε

"but you do not know"

In 8:14–20 Jesus uses the plural form of **you** to indicate that he is speaking to the Pharisees. He is not speaking directly to those who believe in him. If this would confuse your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but you Pharisees do not know]

See: Forms of You

John 8:15 (#2)

ἐγὼ οὐ κρίνω οὐδένα

"I do not judge anyone"

This could mean: (1) Jesus does not judge anyone in the same manner as the Pharisees, that is, **according to the flesh**. Alternate translation: [I do not judge anyone according to the flesh]; (2) Jesus is not judging anyone at that time. Alternate translation: [I do not judge anyone at this time]

See: Ellipsis

John 8:15 (#1)

τὴν σάρκα

"the flesh"

Jesus uses **the flesh** to refer to human standards. Such standards are superficial and based on the limitations of sinful human nature. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [standards limited by human nature] or [superficial human standards]

See: Metaphor

John 8:16 (#3)

μόνος οὐκ εἰμί

"I am not alone"

Jesus implies that he is **not alone** when he judges people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I am not alone in how I judge] or [I do not judge alone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:16 (#5)

ὁ & Πατήρ

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:16 (#4)

ὁ πέμψας με Πατήρ

"the Father having sent me"

This phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 5:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:16 (#1)

ἡ κρίσις ἡ ἐμὴ

"my judgment"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what I judge]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 8:16 (#2)

ἡ κρίσις ἡ ἐμὴ ἀληθινή ἐστιν

"my judgment is true"

Jesus is contrasting the nature of the Pharisees' **judgment** with the nature of his own **judgment**. Alternate translation: [my judgment is right] or [my judgment is according to what is true]

John 8:17 (#2)

δύο ἀνθρώπων ἡ μαρτυρία ἀληθής ἐστιν

"the testimony of two men is true"

Jesus is referring to a rule in the law of Moses. According to Deuteronomy 19:15, a statement had to be confirmed by at least two witnesses in order to be considered true in legal decisions. If it would be helpful to your readers, then you can state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [if the testimony of two men agrees, then it is valid] or [if two men say something that agrees, then it should be considered to be true]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:17 (#1)

γέγραπται

"it is written"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Jesus implies that "Moses" did it. Alternate translation: [Moses wrote]

See: Active or Passive

John 8:18 (#1)

μαρτυρεῖ περὶ ἐμοῦ ὁ πέμψας με Πατήρ

"the Father having sent me testifies about me"

In addition to Jesus himself, God **the Father** also **testifies about** Jesus. Jesus thus implies that his testimony is true, because there are two witnesses. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [my Father, who sent me, also brings evidence about me. So you should believe that what we tell you is true] or [my Father, who sent me, also testifies about me. Therefore, my testimony is true]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:18 (#2)

ὁ πέμψας με Πατήρ

"the Father having sent me"

This phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in verse 16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:18 (#3)

Πατήρ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:19 (#3)

εἰ ἐμὲ ᾔδειτε, καὶ τὸν Πατέρα μου ἂν ᾔδειτε

"if you had known me, you would have known my Father also"

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he is already convinced that the condition is not true. He knows that the Pharisees do not know who he really is and do not really know God. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [you do not know me, because if you did, you would also know my Father]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 8:19 (#2)

τὸν Πατέρα

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:19 (#1)

οὔτε ἐμὲ οἴδατε, οὔτε τὸν Πατέρα μου. εἰ ἐμὲ ᾔδειτε, καὶ τὸν Πατέρα μου ἂν ᾔδειτε

"You know neither me nor my Father; if you had known me, you would have known my Father also"

In this verse, **know** refers to knowing who Jesus and God actually are, not just knowing information about them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You know neither who I am nor who my Father is; if you had known who I am, you would have known who my Father is also]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:20 (#3)

τῷ γαζοφυλακίῳ

"the treasury"

A **treasury** is the place where treasures are stored. In Jesus' time, the temple **treasury** referred to a place in the courtyard that had containers for receiving money offerings. If your readers would not be familiar with this use of **treasury**, you could give a fuller description. Alternate translation: [the place where people gave money]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 8:20 (#1)

In this verse John finishes telling about the events in the story by giving background information about where these events happened. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Some languages may require the information about the setting to be placed at the beginning of this part of the story in 8:12.

See: Background Information

John 8:20 (#4)

οὔπω ἐληλύθει ἡ ὥρα αὐτοῦ

"his hour had not yet come"

The word **hour** is used to refer to the time God had planned for Jesus to be arrested and killed. See how you translated this phrase in 7:30. Alternate translation: [the right time to arrest him had not yet come]

See: Metonymy

John 8:20 (#2)

ταῦτα τὰ ῥήματα

"these words"

Here, **these words** refers to what Jesus had just spoken in verses 12–19. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these things about himself] or [these things to the Pharisees]

See: Metonymy

John 8:21 (#4)

ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω, ὑμεῖς οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"Where I go away, you are not able to come"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [You are not able to come to where I go]

See: Information Structure

John 8:21 (#3)

ἐν τῇ ἁμαρτίᾳ ὑμῶν

"in your sin"

Here, **sin** is singular. This could refer to one: (1) the specific sin of rejecting Jesus as the Messiah. Alternate translation: [in your sin of unbelief]; (2) sinfulness in general. Alternate translation: [in your state of sinfulness]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 8:21 (#1)

εἶπεν οὖν πάλιν αὐτοῖς

"Then again he said to them"

Then again here introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [At another time he again said to them]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 8:21 (#2)

ἐγὼ ὑπάγω & ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω

"I go away & Where I go away"

Two times in this verse Jesus uses **go away** to refer to his death and return to God in heaven. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 8:22 (#3)

ὅτι λέγει, ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω ὑμεῖς, οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"Is that why he says, 'Where I go, you are not able to come"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Is that why he says that where he goes, we will not be able to come]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 8:22 (#2)

μήτι ἀποκτενεῖ ἑαυτὸν

"He will not kill himself, will he"

John records the Jewish leaders using the form of a question in a way that expects a negative response but also expresses uncertainty about that response. If your language has a question form that assumes a negative response with uncertainty, you should use it here. Alternate translation: [Could it be possible that he will kill himself?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:22 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 8:22 (#4)

ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω ὑμεῖς, οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"Where I go, you are not able to come"

See how you translated this clause in the previous verse.

John 8:23 (#3)

τῶν κάτω

“the things below”

John records Jesus using **the things below** to refer to **this world**. It does not refer to hell. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You are from this lower world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:23 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἐκ τῶν κάτω ἐστέ

“You are from the things below”

In 8:23–30 Jesus uses the plural form of **you** to indicate that he is speaking to the Jewish leaders. He is not speaking directly to those who believe in him. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [You Jewish authorities are from below]

See: Forms of You

John 8:23 (#7)

τούτου τοῦ κόσμου & τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

“this world & this world”

Here, **this world** refers to everything in the universe that has been corrupted by sin and is hostile to God. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this sinful world ... this sinful world] or [this world that opposes God ... this world that opposes God]

See: Metonymy

John 8:23 (#6)

ὑμεῖς ἐκ τούτου τοῦ κόσμου ἐστέ, ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

“You are from this world; I am not from this world”

The phrase **from this world** could refer to: (1) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [You come from this world; I do not come from this world]; (2) the place where the subject belongs. Alternate translation: [You belong to this world; I do not belong to this world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:23 (#5)

ἐγὼ ἐκ τῶν ἄνω εἰμί

“I am from the things above”

John records Jesus using **the things above** to refer to heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am from heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:23 (#4)

ἐγὼ ἐκ τῶν ἄνω εἰμί

“I am from the things above”

The phrase **from the things above** could refer to: (1) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [I came from the things above]; (2) the place where the subject belongs, which is heaven. Alternate translation: [I belong to the things above]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:23 (#2)

ὑμεῖς ἐκ τῶν κάτω ἐστέ

“You are from the things below”

The phrase **from below** could refer to: (1) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [You came from the things below]; (2) the place where the subject belongs. Alternate translation: [You belong to the things below]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:24 (#1)

ἀποθανεῖσθε ἐν ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν & ἐγώ εἰμι, ἀποθανεῖσθε ἐν ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν

“you will die in your sins & I am, you will die in your sins”

This phrase **you will die in your sins** is different from the similar statement in verse 21 because **sins** is plural in this verse but singular in that verse. Therefore, make sure that you translate **sins** differently than how you translated “sin” in verse 21.

John 8:24 (#2)

ὅτι ἐγώ εἰμι

“that I am”

This could mean: (1) Jesus is identifying himself as Yahweh, who identified himself to Moses as “I AM” in Exodus 3:14. Alternate translation: [that I am the I AM]; (2) Jesus expects the people to understand that he is referring to what he already has already said about himself in the previous verse: “that I am from above”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction for this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:25 (#2)

τὴν ἀρχὴν ὅ τι καὶ λαλῶ ὑμῖν

"What have I even been saying to you from the beginning"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he has already told the Jewish leaders who he is. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I am who I have been telling you I am since the beginning!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:25 (#1)

ἔλεγον

"they said"

Here, **they** refers to the Jewish leaders. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish authorities said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 8:26 (#5)

ταῦτα λαλῶ εἰς τὸν κόσμον

"these things I say to the world"

John records Jesus using **the world** to refer to the people who live in **the world**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these things I say to everyone]

See: Metonymy

John 8:26 (#4)

κἀγὼ ἃ ἤκουσα παρ' αὐτοῦ, ταῦτα

"and the things that I heard from him, these things"

Jesus says that **the one who sent** him **is true** in order to imply that **these things** he **heard** and spoke are **true**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the true things that I heard from him, these true things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:26 (#3)

ὁ πέμψας με ἀληθής ἐστιν

"the one having sent me is true"

Here, **true** means to be truthful or to speak only the truth. If this use of **true** would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who sent me is truthful] or [the one who sent me tells the truth]

John 8:26 (#1)

ἀλλ' ὁ πέμψας με ἀληθής ἐστιν, κἀγὼ ἃ ἤκουσα παρ' αὐτοῦ, ταῦτα λαλῶ εἰς τὸν κόσμον

"But the one having sent me is true; and the things that I heard from him, these things I say to the world"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases and make a new sentence. Alternate translation: [But I will say to the world the things that I heard from him who sent me. He is true]

See: Information Structure

John 8:26 (#2)

ὁ πέμψας με & παρ' αὐτοῦ

"the one having sent me & from him"

These phrases refer to God. However, since the Jewish leaders did not understand what Jesus meant when he used these phrases, you do not need to explain their meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 8:27 (#2)

τὸν Πατέρα

"about the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:27 (#1)

In this verse John gives information about the Jewish leaders to explain their reaction to Jesus' teaching. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 8:28 (#5)

ἀπ᾽ ἐμαυτοῦ

“from myself”

See how you translated this phrase, **from myself**, in 5:30. Alternate translation: [on my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:28 (#1)

ὅταν ὑψώσητε

“When you have lifted up”

John records Jesus referring to when he would be **lifted up** on the cross to be killed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [When you have lifted me up on a cross to kill me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:28 (#2)

ὅταν ὑψώσητε τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“When you have lifted up the Son of Man”

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this clause in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 8:28 (#3)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

See how you translated **the Son of Man** in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:28 (#6)

καθὼς ἐδίδαξέν με ὁ Πατὴρ, ταῦτα λαλῶ

“just as the Father taught me, I speak these things”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:28 (#4)

ἐγώ εἰμι

“I am”

See how you translated this phrase in verse 24 and also see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction for this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:29 (#1)

ὁ πέμψας με

“the one having sent me”

This phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:29 (#2)

μετ᾽ ἐμοῦ

“with me”

Jesus uses **with me** to refer to God’s help. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [helping me]

See: Metaphor

John 8:30 (#1)

ταῦτα αὐτοῦ λαλοῦντος

“As} he is speaking these things”

Here, John is describing something that happened at the same time as the other clause in the sentence. If this might confuse your readers, you could make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [At the time Jesus was saying these things]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

John 8:31 (#3)

μείνητε ἐν τῷ λόγῳ τῷ ἐμῷ

“remain in my word”

The phrase **remain in my word** means to obey what **Jesus** said. If this might confuse your readers, you can express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obey what I have said]

See: Idiom

John 8:31 (#2)

ὑμεῖς

“you”

In 8:31–59 Jesus uses the plural form of **you** to indicate that he could be speaking to: (1) some Jewish people from Judea who were in the temple courtyard with Jesus. Alternate translation: [you Judeans]; (2) some of

the Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [you Jewish authorities]

See: Forms of You

John 8:31 (#1)

τοὺς & Ἰουδαίους

“the Jews”

In 8:31–59 **those Jews** could refer to: (1) some Jewish people from Judea who were in the temple courtyard with Jesus. Alternate translation: [those Judeans]; (2) some of the Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [those Jewish authorities]

See: Synecdoche

John 8:32 (#2)

τὴν ἀλήθειαν & ἡ ἀλήθεια

“the truth & the truth”

Here, **the truth** refers to what Jesus reveals about God, which would include his plan for forgiving sinful people through Jesus’ death on the cross. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is true about God … those true things]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 8:32 (#1)

ἡ ἀλήθεια ἐλευθερώσει ὑμᾶς

“the truth will free you”

Jesus speaks of **truth** as though it were a person who could **free** someone. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [knowing the truth will cause you to be free] or [if you obey the truth, God will set you free]

See: Personification

John 8:33 (#1)

πῶς σὺ λέγεις & ἐλεύθεροι γενήσεσθε

“how can you say, ‘You will be free”

The Jews are using the question form here to emphasize their shock at what Jesus has said. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [We do not need to be set free!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:33 (#2)

πῶς σὺ λέγεις & ἐλεύθεροι γενήσεσθε

“how can you say, ‘You will be free”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [how can you say that we will be free]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 8:34 (#2)

δοῦλός ἐστιν τῆς ἁμαρτίας

“is a slave of sin”

Here Jesus uses the word **slave** to refer to someone who cannot stop sinning. This implies that **sin** is like a master for the person who sins. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile instead. Alternate translation: [is like a slave to sin]

See: Metaphor

John 8:34 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 8:35 (#2)

ἐν τῇ οἰκίᾳ

“in the house”

Jesus uses **house** to refer to the family that lives inside the **house**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as a permanent member of a family]

See: Metonymy

John 8:35 (#1)

ὁ & δοῦλος οὐ μένει & ὁ Υἱὸς μένει

“the slave does not remain & the son remains”

Jesus is speaking of slaves and sons in general, not of one particular **slave** and **son**. If this would be misunderstood in your language, use a more natural phrase.

Alternate translation: [slaves do not remain ... sons remain]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 8:35 (#4)

ὁ Υἱὸς μένει εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“the son remains into eternity”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [the son remains in the house into eternity]

See: Ellipsis

John 8:35 (#3)

ὁ Υἱὸς μένει εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“the son remains into eternity”

This clause is in contrast to the previous clause. Although slaves do not remain permanent members of the family who owns them, sons are permanent family members. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a contrast. Alternate translation: [but the son remains into eternity]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

John 8:36 (#1)

ἐὰν & ὁ Υἱὸς ὑμᾶς ἐλευθερώσῃ, ὄντως ἐλεύθεροι ἔσεσθε

“if the Son frees you, you will be truly free”

It is implied that Jesus is talking about freedom from sin. Alternate translation: [if the Son sets you free from sin, you will truly be free]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:36 (#2)

ἐὰν & ὁ Υἱὸς ὑμᾶς ἐλευθερώσῃ

“if the Son frees you”

Unlike the generic use of **son** in the previous verse, here Jesus uses **the Son** to refer to himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person. Alternate translation: [if I, the Son, free you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 8:36 (#3)

ἐὰν & ὁ Υἱὸς ὑμᾶς ἐλευθερώσῃ

“if the Son frees you”

Jesus uses **frees** to refer to stopping people from being controlled by their sinful desires. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [if the Son frees you from being controlled by sin]

See: Metaphor

John 8:36 (#4)

ὁ Υἱὸς

“the Son”

Son is an important title for Jesus, **the Son** of God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:36 (#5)

ὄντως ἐλεύθεροι ἔσεσθε

“you will be truly free”

Jesus uses **free** to refer to people no longer being controlled by their sinful desires and thus able to avoid sinning. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [you will truly no longer be controlled by sin] or [you will truly be able to refrain from sin]

See: Metaphor

John 8:37 (#1)

ὁ λόγος ὁ ἐμὸς οὐ χωρεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν

“my word has no place in you”

This phrase **has no place in you** is an idiom that means to truly accept or believe something. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a similar idiom in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you do not receive my words in your hearts] or [you reject my words]

See: Idiom

John 8:37 (#2)

ὁ λόγος ὁ ἐμὸς

“my word”

Here, **word** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my message]

See: Metonymy

John 8:38 (#2)

καὶ ὑμεῖς & ἃ ἠκούσατε παρὰ τοῦ πατρὸς, ποιεῖτε

“and & what you heard from the father, you do”

In this clause, Jesus uses the phrase **the father** to refer to the devil. Despite using the same words as in the previous clause, here Jesus is not referring to God. However, since Jesus did not yet reveal what he meant when he used this phrase, but was speaking ambiguously, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 8:38 (#1)

τῷ Πατρὶ

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:39 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 8:39 (#3)

τέκνα τοῦ Ἀβραάμ

“children of Abraham”

Jesus uses **children** to mean “descendants.” If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [descendants of Abraham]

See: Metaphor

John 8:39 (#1)

ὁ πατὴρ

“father”

The people use **father** to refer to their ancestor. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Our forefather]

See: Metaphor

John 8:39 (#4)

τὰ ἔργα τοῦ Ἀβραὰμ

“the works of Abraham”

Jesus is using **of** to describe **works** that were done by **Abraham**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the works done by Abraham]

See: Possession

John 8:40 (#1)

τοῦτο Ἀβραὰμ οὐκ ἐποίησεν

“Abraham did not do this”

Here, **this** refers to what Jesus said earlier in the verse about what the Jews were trying to do to him. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Abraham did not seek to kill someone who told him the truth from God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:41 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ποιεῖτε τὰ ἔργα τοῦ πατρὸς ὑμῶν

“You do the works of your father”

Jesus uses the phrase **your father** to refer to the devil. However, since the Jews did not understand what Jesus meant when he used this phrase, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 8:41 (#2)

ἡμεῖς ἐκ πορνείας οὐ γεγεννήμεθα

“We have not been born from sexual immorality”

The Jews imply that Jesus does not know who his real father is and that his birth is the result of an immoral sexual relationship. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [We do not know about you, but we are not illegitimate children] or [We were all born from proper marriages]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:42 (#1)

εἰ ὁ Θεὸς Πατὴρ ὑμῶν ἦν, ἠγαπᾶτε ἂν ἐμέ

“If God were your Father, you would have loved me”

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he already knows that the condition is not true. Jesus knows that the Jews speaking to him

here do not love him and are not true followers of God. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [God is surely not your father, because if he were, you would love me]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 8:42 (#2)

ἀπ᾽ ἐμαυτοῦ ἐλήλυθα

“have I come from myself”

Here, **from** is used to indicate Jesus’ origin. He could only have authority if he came from God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [have I come on my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:42 (#3)

ἐκεῖνός

“that one”

Here, **that one** refers to God the Father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 8:43 (#2)

οὐ δύνασθε ἀκούειν τὸν λόγον τὸν ἐμόν

“you are not able to hear my words”

Here, **hear** means to listen to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. It does not mean simply to hear what someone says. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are not able to heed my words]

See: Metaphor

John 8:43 (#3)

τὸν λόγον τὸν ἐμόν

“my words”

Jesus uses **words** to refer to his teachings. See how you translated this phrase in 5:47. Alternate translation: [my teachings.]

See: Metonymy

John 8:43 (#1)

διὰ τί τὴν λαλιὰν τὴν ἐμὴν οὐ γινώσκετε

“Because of what do you not understand my speech”

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I will tell you why you do not understand what I say!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:44 (#5)

οὐκ ἔστιν ἀλήθεια ἐν αὐτῷ

“there is no truth in him”

Jesus speaks of **truth** as if it were an object that could exist inside someone. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he never speaks the truth]

See: Metaphor

John 8:44 (#6)

ἐκ τῶν ἰδίων λαλεῖ

“he speaks from his own {nature”

Alternate translation: [he speaks according to his character] or [he speaks what is most natural for him to speak]

John 8:44 (#3)

ἀνθρωποκτόνος ἦν ἀπ᾽ ἀρχῆς

“was a murderer from the beginning”

Here, **the beginning** refers to the time when the first humans, Adam and Eve, sinned. It does not refer to the very beginning of time. The devil tempted Eve to sin and Adam sinned as well. Because they sinned, all living things die as part of the punishment for sin. Therefore, Jesus calls **the devil** a **murderer** for starting the process that brought death to the world. You could indicate this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation: [was a murderer from the time when he tempted the first people to sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:44 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἐκ τοῦ πατρὸς τοῦ διαβόλου ἐστὲ

“You are from your father, the devil”

The phrase **from your father** could refer to: (1) the person to whom the subject belongs, as in the UST. (2) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [You came from your father, the devil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:44 (#4)

ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ οὐκ ἔστηκεν

"does not stand in the truth"

The phrase **does not stand in the truth** is an idiom that means to not accept or approve of what is true. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [does not approve of the truth]

See: Idiom

John 8:44 (#7)

ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ

"the father of it"

Jesus uses **father** to refer to the one who originated the act of lying. Since **the devil** is the first being to tell a lie, he is called the **father** of lying. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the first one to lie]

See: Metaphor

John 8:44 (#8)

ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ

"the father of it"

Here, **it** refers to the act of lying. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the father of lying]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 8:44 (#2)

ἐκεῖνος

"That one"

That one refers to **the devil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The devil]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 8:46 (#2)

εἰ ἀλήθειαν λέγω

"If I speak the truth"

John records Jesus speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what John is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since I speak the truth]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 8:46 (#1)

τίς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐλέγχει με περὶ ἁμαρτίας

"Which one of you convicts me concerning sin"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he has never sinned. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [None of you can convict me concerning sin!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:46 (#3)

διὰ τί ὑμεῖς οὐ πιστεύετέ μοι

"why do you not believe me"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to scold the Jews for their unbelief. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you have no reason for not believing me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:47 (#1)

ὁ ὢν ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ & ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ οὐκ ἐστέ

"He who is from God & you are not from God"

The phrase **from God** could refer to: (1) the person to whom the subject belongs, as in the UST. (2) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [He who came from God ... you did not come from God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:47 (#4)

τὰ ῥήματα τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the words of God"

Jesus uses **words** to refer to what God has said. See how you translated **words** in 5:47. Alternate translation: [the things that God has said]

See: Metonymy

John 8:47 (#3)

ἀκούει & ὑμεῖς οὐκ ἀκούετε

"hears & you do not hear"

Here, **hears** and **hear** mean to listen to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. See how you translated **hear** in verse 43. Alternate translation: [heeds ... you do not heed]

See: Metaphor

John 8:47 (#2)

ὁ ὢν ἐκ τοῦ Θεοῦ

"He who is from God"

Although **He** is masculine, Jesus is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [A person who is from God]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 8:48 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"The Jews"

Here, **The Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 8:48 (#3)

Σαμαρείτης εἶ σὺ

"you are a Samaritan"

Most Jewish people in Jesus' time hated and despised Samaritans, so his Jewish opponents here called Jesus a **Samaritan** in order to insult him. Use the natural form in your language to indicate that this is an insult. Alternate translation: [you are one of those accursed Samaritans] or [you are an enemy Samaritan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:48 (#2)

οὐ καλῶς λέγομεν ἡμεῖς ὅτι Σαμαρείτης εἶ σὺ, καὶ δαιμόνιον ἔχεις

"Do we not rightly say that you are a Samaritan and have a demon"

The Jews are using a rhetorical question here to accuse Jesus and to dishonor him. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [We certainly say rightly that you are a Samaritan and have a demon!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:48 (#4)

δαιμόνιον ἔχεις

"have a demon"

See how you translated this phrase in 7:20. Alternate translation: [a demon is inside of you!] or [you must be under the control of a demon!]

John 8:49 (#1)

ἐγὼ δαιμόνιον οὐκ ἔχω

"I do not have a demon"

See how you translated the similar phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [a demon is not inside of me] or [I am not under the control of a demon]

John 8:50 (#2)

ἔστιν ὁ ζητῶν καὶ κρίνων

"there is one seeking and judging"

Here, **one** refers to God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [God is the one seeking and judging]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 8:50 (#1)

οὐ ζητῶ τὴν δόξαν μου

"do not seek my glory"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I do not seek to glorify myself]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 8:50 (#3)

ὁ ζητῶν

"one seeking"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply

these words from the context. Alternate translation: [one seeking my glory]

See: Ellipsis

John 8:50 (#4)

κρίνων

“judging”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. Here, **judging** could refer to: (1) God **judging** between what Jesus said about himself and what his Jewish opponents were saying about him. Alternate translation: [judging between your testimony and mine]; (2) God condemning those who dishonor Jesus. Alternate translation: [judging those who dishonor me]

See: Ellipsis

John 8:51 (#4)

θάνατον οὐ μὴ θεωρήσῃ εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“he will certainly not see death into eternity”

Jesus uses **death** to refer to spiritual **death**, which is eternal punishment in hell that occurs after physical **death**. However, the Jews did not understand this. Therefore, you do not need to explain its meaning further here. Alternate translation: [he will certainly not die]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 8:51 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 8:51 (#2)

τὸν ἐμὸν λόγον

“my word”

Here, **word** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. See how you translated this phrase in 5:24. Alternate translation: [my message] or [what I say]

See: Metonymy

John 8:51 (#3)

θάνατον οὐ μὴ θεωρήσῃ

“he will certainly not see death”

Jesus uses **see** to refer to experiencing or participating in something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will certainly not experience death]

See: Metaphor

John 8:52 (#4)

ἐάν τις τὸν λόγον μου τηρήσῃ

“If anyone keeps my word”

See how you translated this in the previous verse.

John 8:52 (#6)

θανάτου

“death”

See how you translated **death** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

John 8:52 (#5)

οὐ μὴ γεύσηται θανάτου εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“he will certainly not taste death into eternity”

The Jews say here that Jesus used **taste** to refer to experiencing or participating in something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will certainly not ever experience death]

See: Metaphor

John 8:52 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“The Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 8:52 (#3)

σὺ λέγεις, ἐάν τις τὸν λόγον μου τηρήσῃ

“you say, ‘If anyone keeps my word”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [you say that if anyone keeps your word]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 8:52 (#2)

δαιμόνιον ἔχεις

“you have a demon”

Alternate translation: [a demon is inside of you] or [you must be under the control of a demon]

John 8:53 (#2)

τοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν

“our father”

See how you translated this phrase in verse 39.

See: Metaphor

John 8:53 (#1)

μὴ σὺ μείζων εἶ τοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν Ἀβραάμ, ὅστις ἀπέθανεν

“You are not greater than our father Abraham who died, are you”

The Jews are using this question to emphasize that they do not think that Jesus is **greater than Abraham**. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are certainly not greater than our father Abraham who died!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:53 (#3)

τίνα σεαυτὸν ποιεῖς

“Who do you make yourself out to be”

The Jews are using this question to rebuke Jesus for thinking that he is more important than Abraham. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should not think that you are so important!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:54 (#2)

ὃν ὑμεῖς λέγετε & Θεὸς ἡμῶν ἐστιν

“about whom you say, ‘He is our God”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [about whom you say that he is your God]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 8:54 (#1)

ὁ Πατήρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 8:55 (#1)

τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ

“his word”

Jesus uses **word** to refer what God has said. If this would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what God says]

See: Metonymy

John 8:56 (#3)

τὴν ἡμέραν τὴν ἐμήν

“my day”

Jesus uses **my day** to refer to the time when Jesus came to earth. If this would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my coming] or [the time when I would come to earth]

See: Metonymy

John 8:56 (#1)

ὁ πατὴρ ὑμῶν

“Your father”

See how you translated this phrase in verse 39.

See: Metaphor

John 8:56 (#4)

εἶδεν καὶ ἐχάρη

“he saw and was glad”

This phrase could mean: (1) Abraham literally **saw** a prophetic vision of Jesus coming to earth. Alternate translation: [he foresaw my coming through revelation from God and was glad]; (2) when his son Isaac was born, Abraham metaphorically **saw** that God was beginning to fulfill the covenant that would culminate in Jesus coming to earth. Alternate translation: [he

perceived my coming when God gave him a son, and he was glad]

See: Metaphor

John 8:56 (#2)

ἴδῃ & εἶδεν

"he might see & he saw"

Jesus uses **see** to refer to experiencing or participating in something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he might experience ... he experienced it]

See: Metaphor

John 8:57 (#2)

πεντήκοντα ἔτη οὔπω ἔχεις, καὶ Ἀβραὰμ ἑώρακας

"You do not yet have 50 years, and you have seen Abraham"

Here, **the Jews** opposing Jesus are using this question to express their shock that Jesus claims to have seen Abraham. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are less than fifty years old! You could not possibly have seen Abraham!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 8:57 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

See how you translated **the Jews** in 8:31. Alternate translation: [the Judeans] or [the Jewish leaders]

See: Synecdoche

John 8:58 (#2)

ἐγὼ εἰμί

"I am"

See how you translated **I am** verse 24 and also see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction for this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 8:58 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 8:59 (#2)

τοῦ ἱεροῦ

"the temple"

Jesus and his Jewish opponents were in the courtyard of **the temple**. See how you translated **temple** in 2:14.

See: Synecdoche

John 8:59 (#1)

ἦραν & λίθους, ἵνα βάλωσιν ἐπ' αὐτόν

"they picked up stones in order to throw at him"

The Jews opposing **Jesus** are outraged at what **Jesus** said in the previous verse. Here, John implies that they **picked up stones** in order to kill him by stoning because he had made himself equal to God (See: stone, stoning). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they picked up stones in order to kill him, because he claimed to be equal with God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus' sixth sign: he heals a blind man (9:1–12)
2. The Pharisees question the formerly blind man whom Jesus healed (9:13–34)
3. Jesus speaks with the formerly blind man and some Pharisees (9:35–41)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"Who sinned?"
Many of the Jews in Jesus' time believed that if a person was blind or deaf or crippled, it was because he, his parents, or someone else in his family had sinned. The rabbis even taught that it was possible for a baby to sin while still in the womb. This was not the teaching of the law of Moses. (See: sin, sinful, sinner, sinning; and law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God)

"A sinner"
The Pharisees call some people in this chapter "sinners." The Jewish leaders thought these people were sinful, but in reality the leaders were also sinful. This

can be taken as irony. (See: sin, sinful, sinner, sinning; and Irony)

"He does not keep the Sabbath"
The Pharisees thought that Jesus was working, and so breaking the Sabbath, by healing the blind man. (See: Sabbath)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Light and darkness
The Bible often speaks of unrighteous people, people who do not do what pleases God, as if they were walking around in darkness. It speaks of light as if it were what enables those sinful people to become righteous, to understand what they are doing wrong and begin to obey God. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

Seeing and being blind
Jesus uses the healing of the blind man as a metaphor for spiritual blindness. Just as a blind man cannot see the physical world, a man who is spiritually blind does not recognize God's truth, which includes his sinfulness and need for salvation. The blind man in this story is first healed from his physical blindness (9:6–7), then from his spiritual blindness (9:38). By contrast, the Pharisees are not physically blind but are spiritually blind. Jesus calls the Pharisees blind because they have seen him do great miracles that only someone sent from God could do, but they still refuse to believe that God sent him or that they are sinners who need to repent (9:39–40). (See: Metaphor)

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" in this chapter (9:35). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 9:1 (#1)

καὶ

"And"

And here shows that John intended for the events in this chapter to be directly connected to what Jesus said in the previous chapter. In chapter 8, Jesus said that he is the Light of the World. In this chapter, Jesus demonstrates that he is the Light of the World by giving physical sight and spiritual light to a blind man.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

John 9:2 (#1)

ἠρώτησαν αὐτὸν & λέγοντες

"asked him, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [asked him, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 9:2 (#2)

τίς ἥμαρτεν, οὗτος ἢ οἱ γονεῖς αὐτοῦ, ἵνα τυφλὸς γεννηθῇ

"who sinned, this one or his parents, so that he might be born blind"

This question reflects the ancient Jewish belief that sin caused illnesses and other deformities. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [Teacher, we know that sin causes a person to be blind. Whose sin caused this man to be born blind? did this man himself sin, or was it his parents who sinned?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:2 (#3)

ἵνα τυφλὸς γεννηθῇ

"so that he might be born blind"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that he might be blind when his mother bore him]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:3 (#3)

φανερωθῇ τὰ ἔργα τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the works of God might be revealed"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I might reveal the works of God]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:3 (#4)

ἐν αὐτῷ

"in him"

Here, **him** could refer to: (1) the man's body, especially his blind eyes. Alternate translation: [in his body]; (2) the man's body and spirit. Alternate translation: [in his body and spirit]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 9:3 (#2)

τὰ ἔργα τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the works of God"

Jesus is using **of** to describe **works** that are performed by **God**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the works done by God]

See: Possession

John 9:3 (#1)

ἵνα φανερωθῇ τὰ ἔργα τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐν αὐτῷ

"so that the works of God might be revealed in him"

John records Jesus leaving out some information that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [he was born blind so that the works of God might be revealed in him]

See: Ellipsis

John 9:4 (#3)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με

"of the one having sent me"

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:4 (#1)

ἡμᾶς

"us"

When Jesus says **us** here, he is including himself and the disciples who are with him. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 9:4 (#6)

ἔρχεται νὺξ

"Night is coming"

Jesus uses **Night**. He compares the time when he and his disciples cannot do God's work to the nighttime, which is the time when people normally cannot work because it is too dark to see. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [The time like the night hours is coming when people cannot work]

See: Metaphor

John 9:4 (#4)

ἕως ἡμέρα ἐστίν; ἔρχεται νὺξ

"while it is day. Night is coming"

Here, **day** and **night** could mean: (1) the time when Jesus was on the earth with his disciples and the time when he was no longer on earth, respectively. Alternate translation: [while I am still with you. The time when I will leave you is coming]; (2) a person's lifetime and the time that person dies, respectively. Alternate translation: [while we are still alive. The time when we will die is coming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:4 (#5)

ἕως ἡμέρα ἐστίν

"while it is day"

Jesus uses **day**. He compares the time when he and his disciples can do God's work to the daytime, which is the time when people normally work. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while it is the time like the daylight hours when people usually work]

See: Metaphor

John 9:4 (#2)

τὰ ἔργα τοῦ πέμψαντός με

"the works of the one having sent me"

Jesus is using **of** to describe **works** that God wants Jesus and his disciples to do. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the works that the one who sent me demands]

See: Possession

John 9:5 (#1)

ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ

"in the world"

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the earth on which people live. It does not refer only to the people in the world or to the entire universe. Alternate translation: [on the earth]

See: Metonymy

John 9:5 (#2)

φῶς εἰμι τοῦ κόσμου

"I am the light of the world"

See how you translated this clause in 8:12. Alternate translation: [I am the one who is like a light and who reveals God's truth and goodness to the world]

See: Metaphor

John 9:6 (#1)

ἐποίησεν πηλὸν ἐκ τοῦ πτύσματος

"made mud from the saliva"

Jesus used his fingers to mix the dirt and **saliva** into **mud**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [used his fingers to mix the dirt and saliva to make mud]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:7 (#2)

τὴν κολυμβήθραν τοῦ Σιλωάμ

"the pool of Siloam"

Jesus is using **of** to describe a **pool** that is called **Siloam**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the pool named Siloam]

See: Possession

John 9:7 (#5)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, ἀπεσταλμένος

"which is translated "Sent"

John assumes that his readers will know that he is saying what the name **Siloam** means when translated from the Aramaic language into Greek. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [which is the Aramaic word for "Sent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:7 (#7)

βλέπων

"seeing"

Here, **seeing** means that the man became able to see before he came back. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after becoming able to see]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:7 (#6)

ἦλθεν

"came back"

As the next verse suggests, the man **came back** to his home, not to Jesus. Your language may state "went" rather than **came** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural. Alternate translation: [went back]

See: Go and Come

John 9:7 (#3)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, ἀπεσταλμένος

"which is translated "Sent"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which means "Sent]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:7 (#1)

νίψαι & ἐνίψατο

"wash & washed"

Jesus wanted the blind man to **wash** the mud off of his eyes in the pool and that is what the man did. Jesus did not want him to bathe or **wash** his whole body. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and wash your eyes ... washed his eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:7 (#4)

ὃ ἑρμηνεύεται, ἀπεσταλμένος

"which is translated "Sent"

In this clause John provides a brief break in the storyline in order to explain to his readers what **Siloam** means. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [which means "Sent]

See: Background Information

John 9:8 (#2)

οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ καθήμενος καὶ προσαιτῶν

“Is not this the one sitting and begging”

The people here are using a rhetorical question to express their surprise at seeing the blind man who has been healed. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [This man is the one who used to sit and beg!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 9:8 (#1)

ὅτι προσαίτης ἦν

“that he was a beggar”

This clause is missing some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [those who had seen that he was a beggar]

See: Ellipsis

John 9:10 (#1)

πῶς ἠνεῴχθησάν σου οἱ ὀφθαλμοί

“How were your eyes opened”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [How did your eyes become opened?]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:10 (#2)

πῶς ἠνεῴχθησάν σου οἱ ὀφθαλμοί

“How were your eyes opened”

Here, **eyes opened** describes the ability to see by referring to something associated with vision coming into action, specifically, the **eyes**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [How are you able to see?]

See: Metonymy

John 9:11 (#4)

ἀνέβλεψα

“I received my sight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I could see]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 9:11 (#3)

νίψαι & καὶ νιψάμενος

“wash & and having washed”

See how you translated **wash** in 9:7. Alternate translation: [wash your eyes ... and having washed my eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:11 (#2)

πηλὸν ἐποίησεν

“made mud”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:6. Alternate translation: [used his fingers to mix the dirt with saliva to make mud]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:11 (#1)

ὁ λεγόμενος Ἰησοῦς

“called Jesus”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom we call Jesus]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:13 (#1)

ἄγουσιν

“They bring”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 9:14 (#1)

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about when Jesus healed the man. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 9:14 (#3)

ἀνέῳξεν αὐτοῦ τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

“opened his eyes”

Here, **opened eyes** describes the ability to see by referring to something associated with vision coming into action, specifically, the **eyes**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [caused him to see]

See: Metonymy

John 9:14 (#2)

τὸν πηλὸν ἐποίησεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς, καὶ ἀνέῳξεν αὐτοῦ τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

“Jesus made the mud and opened his eyes”

The negative reaction of the Pharisees described in the following verses is based on their belief that, according to their religious law, Jesus’ actions were considered to be work. Therefore, they believed that he was disobeying God’s command to rest and not work on the Sabbath. (See: law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God; and Sabbath). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Jesus made the mud and opened his eyes. These were two deeds the Pharisees considered to be work.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:15 (#3)

ἐνιψάμην

“I washed”

See how you translated **washed** in 9:11. Alternate translation: [I washed my eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:15 (#1)

πάλιν οὖν ἠρώτων αὐτὸν καὶ οἱ Φαρισαῖοι

“Then again the Pharisees also began asking him”

Here, **again** means that this is the second time people questioned the blind man whom Jesus had healed. It does not mean that this is the second time **the Pharisees** questioned him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Then, in addition to his neighbors questioning him, the Pharisees also began asking him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:15 (#2)

ἀνέβλεψεν

“he received his sight”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:11. Alternate translation: [he could see]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 9:16 (#1)

τὸ Σάββατον οὐ τηρεῖ

“he does not keep the Sabbath”

The phrase **he does not keep the Sabbath** means he disobeys the regulations for the Sabbath that God gave in the law of Moses. The Pharisees added many regulations which they considered to be equal with those that God had given. It was these additional regulations that Jesus was disobeying, thereby making the Pharisees very angry with him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he does not obeying our Sabbath regulations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:16 (#4)

σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated this term in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 9:16 (#5)

σχίσμα ἦν ἐν αὐτοῖς

“there was a division among them”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **division**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [they divided themselves against each other]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 9:16 (#2)

οὐκ ἔστιν οὗτος παρὰ Θεοῦ ὁ ἄνθρωπος

“This man is not from God”

Here, **from** is used to indicate Jesus’ origin. He could only have authority if he came **from God**. Since Jesus was not obeying the Pharisees’ rules, they refused to believe that God had given him authority. If it would be

helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [This man does not have God's authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:16 (#3)

πῶς δύναται ἄνθρωπος ἁμαρτωλὸς τοιαῦτα σημεῖα ποιεῖν

"How is a man, a sinner, able to do such signs"

Some people are using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that Jesus' signs prove he is not a sinner. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [A sinner cannot possibly do such signs!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 9:17 (#2)

ὅτι ἠνέῳξέν σου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

"since he opened your eyes"

Because the next verse indicates that the Pharisees did not believe that the man used to be blind, here, **since** does not mean that they thought the man had really been healed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [since you claim that he opened your eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:17 (#3)

ἠνέῳξέν σου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

"he opened your eyes"

Here, **he opened your eyes** describes the newly gained ability to see by referring to something associated with vision coming into action, specifically, the **eyes**. See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:14. Alternate translation: [he caused you to see]

See: Metonymy

John 9:17 (#1)

λέγουσιν

"they ask"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 9:18 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Therefore here indicates that what follows is the result of what the man said about Jesus in the previous verse. Because the formerly blind man believed Jesus was a prophet, **the Jews** who opposed Jesus refused to believe that the man had really been blind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Since the man said that Jesus was a prophet]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 9:18 (#2)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders, which in this chapter may have been a group of leaders among the Pharisees. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 9:19 (#2)

τυφλὸς ἐγεννήθη

"was born blind"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he was blind when you bore him]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:19 (#1)

ἠρώτησαν αὐτοὺς λέγοντες

"they asked them, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [they asked him, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 9:20 (#1)

τυφλὸς ἐγεννήθη

"he was born blind"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language.

Alternate translation: [he was blind when his mother bore him]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:21 (#1)

ἡλικίαν ἔχει

“has full maturity”

The phrase **full maturity** describes a person who is an adult and is legally responsible for himself. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is an adult] or [is a full-grown man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:22 (#3)

ἀποσυνάγωγος γένηται

“he would be put out of the synagogue”

John uses **put out of the synagogue** to refer to no longer being allowed to go into the synagogue and no longer belonging to the group of people who attend services at the synagogue. When people were **put out of the synagogue**, they were shunned by their local community. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he would not be allowed to enter the synagogue] or [he would no longer belong to the synagogue community]

See: Metaphor

John 9:22 (#2)

τοὺς Ἰουδαίους & οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“of the Jews & the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders, which in this chapter may have been a group of leaders among the Pharisees. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 9:22 (#1)

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about the man’s parents being afraid of the Jewish leaders. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 9:23 (#1)

ἡλικίαν ἔχει

“He has full maturity”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:24 (#1)

ἐφώνησαν & τὸν ἄνθρωπον

“they called the man”

Here, **they** refers to the Jewish leaders introduced in (9:18)

John 9:24 (#2)

δὸς δόξαν τῷ Θεῷ

“Give glory to God”

This is an idiom that Jewish people used when commanding someone to take an oath. It first appears in Joshua 7:19 when Joshua orders Achan to confess his sin. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [Speak the truth before God]

See: Idiom

John 9:24 (#3)

οὗτος ὁ ἄνθρωπος

“this man”

Here, John records the Jewish leaders saying **this man** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:25 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος

“that one”

Here, **that one** refers to the man who had been blind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the man who had been blind]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 9:26 (#1)

πῶς ἤνοιξέν σου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

“How did he open your eyes”

Here, **open eyes** describes the ability to see by referring to something associated with vision coming into action, specifically, the **eyes**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [How did he cause you to see?]

See: Metonymy

John 9:27 (#1)

τί πάλιν θέλετε ἀκούειν

"Why do you want to listen again"

The man is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize his amazement that the Jewish leaders have asked him to tell them again what happened. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I am surprised that you want to listen again to what happened to me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 9:27 (#2)

μὴ καὶ ὑμεῖς θέλετε αὐτοῦ μαθηταὶ γενέσθαι

"You do not want to become his disciples also, do you"

The formerly blind man actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. He knows that the Jewish leaders do not want to follow Jesus, but asks this question to ridicule them. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It sounds like you also want to become his disciples!]

See: Irony

John 9:28 (#1)

ἐκείνου

"of that one"

John records the Jewish leaders saying **that one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [of that so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:28 (#2)

ἡμεῖς δὲ τοῦ Μωϋσέως ἐσμὲν μαθηταί

"but we are disciples of Moses"

The pronoun **we** is exclusive. The Jewish leaders are speaking only of themselves. Your language may require you to mark this form. Alternate translation: [but we true Jews are disciples of Moses]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 9:29 (#1)

τοῦτον

"this one"

John records the Jewish leaders saying **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:29 (#2)

τοῦτον & πόθεν ἐστίν

"where this one is from"

The Jewish leaders use **from** to indicate Jesus' origin. He could only have authority if he came **from** God, but they say that they do not know where he came **from**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [where this one gets his authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:30 (#3)

ἤνοιξέν μου τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

"he opened my eyes"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:14. Alternate translation: [he caused me to see]

See: Metonymy

John 9:30 (#2)

πόθεν ἐστίν

"where he is from"

See how you translated **from** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [where he gets his authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:30 (#1)

ἐν τούτῳ γὰρ τὸ θαυμαστόν ἐστιν, ὅτι ὑμεῖς οὐκ οἴδατε

“Now this is a remarkable thing, that you do not know”

If the plain statement form for this seems unnatural, you could translate this as an exclamation and you may need to make a new sentence. Alternate translation: [This is amazing! You do not know] or [How remarkable! You do not know]

See: Exclamations

John 9:31 (#1)

ἁμαρτωλῶν & οὐκ ἀκούει & τούτου ἀκούει

“does not hear sinners & he hears this one”

Here, **hear** and **hears** mean paying attention to or listening to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. It does not mean simply to **hear** what someone says. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not heed sinners ... he heeds this one]

See: Metaphor

John 9:32 (#2)

ἠνέῳξέν & ὀφθαλμοὺς τυφλοῦ γεγεννημένου

“opened the eyes of one having been born blind”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:14. Alternate translation: [caused one having been born blind to see]

See: Metonymy

John 9:32 (#3)

τυφλοῦ γεγεννημένου

“of one having been born blind”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of one who was blind when his mother bore him]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:32 (#1)

οὐκ ἠκούσθη

“it has never been heard”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one has ever heard]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:33 (#2)

εἰ μὴ ἦν οὗτος παρὰ Θεοῦ

“If this one were not from God”

The formerly blind man is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he is already convinced that the condition is not true. He has concluded that Jesus must have come **from God** because he healed him. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If this one were not from God, but he is]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 9:33 (#1)

εἰ μὴ ἦν οὗτος παρὰ Θεοῦ, οὐκ ἠδύνατο ποιεῖν οὐδέν

“If this one were not from God, he would not be able to do anything”

The formerly blind man uses a double negative sentence pattern to emphasize the positive fact that Jesus must be **from God**. If this double-negative pattern would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [Only a man from God would be able to do anything like that!]

See: Double Negatives

John 9:33 (#3)

μὴ ἦν & παρὰ Θεοῦ

“were not from God”

See how you translated **from God** in 9:16. Alternate translation: [did not have God’s authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:33 (#4)

οὐδέν

“anything”

Here, **anything** does not mean “anything at all.” It means **anything** like the miraculous signs that Jesus was performing, particularly his healing of this man who was born blind. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [anything like healing a man blind from birth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:34 (#1)

ἐν ἁμαρτίαις σὺ ἐγεννήθης ὅλος, καὶ σὺ διδάσκεις ἡμᾶς

"You were completely born in sins, and you are teaching us"

The Jewish leaders are using a question to emphasize their belief that this man was not qualified to question their opinion. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You were completely born in sins, and you are not qualified to teach us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 9:34 (#4)

ἐξέβαλον αὐτὸν ἔξω

"they put him out"

John uses **threw him out** to refer to him no longer being allowed to go into the synagogue and no longer belonging to the group of people who attend services at the synagogue. When people were thrown out of the synagogue, they were shunned by their local community. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he was forbidden to enter the synagogue] or [he was forbidden to belong to the synagogue community]

See: Metaphor

John 9:34 (#2)

ἐν ἁμαρτίαις σὺ ἐγεννήθης ὅλος

"You were completely born in sins"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Your mother bore you completely in sins]

See: Active or Passive

John 9:34 (#3)

ἐν ἁμαρτίαις σὺ ἐγεννήθης ὅλος

"You were completely born in sins"

The Jewish leaders mention the formerly blind man being **born in sins** to imply that the **sins** of his parents had caused his blindness. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You were born blind completely because of your parents' sins]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:35 (#1)

ἐξέβαλον αὐτὸν ἔξω

"they had put him out"

See how you translated a similar phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [they had forbidden him from entering the synagogue] or [they had forbidden him from belonging to the synagogue community]

See: Metaphor

John 9:35 (#4)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:35 (#2)

εὑρὼν αὐτὸν

"having found him"

Here, **found** implies that **Jesus** had first searched for the man. It does not mean that Jesus unintentionally or accidentally met the man at another time. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [having looked for him and found him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 9:35 (#3)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man". However, the formerly blind man did not realize that Jesus was speaking of himself, and Jesus does not explain the metaphor to him until verse 37. Therefore, you do not need to explain that Jesus is speaking about himself here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 9:36 (#1)

κύριε

"sir"

The formerly blind man calls Jesus **sir** in order to show respect or politeness. He does not yet know that Jesus is the Lord. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 9:37 (#1)

καὶ ὁ λαλῶν μετὰ σοῦ ἐκεῖνός ἐστιν

"and that one is the one speaking with you"

Jesus is referring to himself in third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person form. Alternate translation: [and I, the one who is speaking with you, am that one]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 9:38 (#1)

Κύριε

"Lord"

Now that the formerly blind man knows that Jesus is the **Lord**, he calls Jesus **Lord**. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 9:38 (#2)

πιστεύω

"I believe"

Here, the formerly blind man is leaving out some words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from 9:36. Alternate translation: [I believe that you are the Son of Man]

See: Ellipsis

John 9:39 (#3)

ἵνα οἱ μὴ βλέποντες, βλέπωσιν; καὶ οἱ βλέποντες, τυφλοὶ γένωνται

"so that those not seeing might see and those seeing might become blind"

Here, **so that** could indicate that: (1) the rest of the verse is the result of Jesus' **judgment**, which may require starting a new sentence. Alternate translation: [The result of my judgment will be that those not seeing might see and those seeing might become blind]; (2) the rest of the verse is an explanation of the **judgment** Jesus mentioned at the beginning of the verse, which may also require starting a new sentence. Alternate translation: [That judgment is that those not seeing might see and those seeing might become blind]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 9:39 (#2)

ἵνα οἱ μὴ βλέποντες, βλέπωσιν; καὶ οἱ βλέποντες, τυφλοὶ γένωνται

"so that those not seeing might see and those seeing might become blind"

Here, **not seeing**, **see**, **seeing**, and **become blind** are metaphors. See the discussion of these metaphors in the introduction for this chapter. If these uses of these words would confuse your readers, you could use similes or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that those who know they are spiritually blind might receive spiritual sight, and those who falsely think they have spiritual sight might remain spiritually blind] or [so that those who recognize that they do not know God might know him, and those who falsely think they know God might continue not knowing him]

See: Metaphor

John 9:39 (#1)

εἰς κρίμα

"For judgment"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [In order to judge]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 9:40 (#1)

μὴ καὶ ἡμεῖς τυφλοί ἐσμεν

"We are not also blind, are we"

Several **Pharisees** are using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that they do not think that they are spiritually blind. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [We surely are not also blind!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 9:40 (#2)

μὴ καὶ ἡμεῖς τυφλοί ἐσμεν

"We are not also blind, are we"

Here the Pharisees use **blind** to refer to not knowing God's truth. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [We are not also ignorant of God's truth, are we?]

See: Metaphor

John 9:41 (#2)

οὐκ ἂν εἴχετε ἁμαρτίαν & ἡ ἁμαρτία ὑμῶν μένει

“you would have no sin & Your sin remains”

In these two phrases, Jesus speaks of **sin** as if it were an object that a person could possess or that could remain with a person. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you would not be sinful ... You are still sinful]

See: Metaphor

John 9:41 (#1)

εἰ τυφλοὶ ἦτε, οὐκ ἂν εἴχετε ἁμαρτίαν

“If you were blind, you would have no sin”

See how you translated **blind** in 9:39–40. Alternate translation: [If you did not know God’s truth, you would have no sin]

See: Metaphor

John 9:41 (#3)

λέγετε & βλέπομεν, ἡ ἁμαρτία ὑμῶν μένει

“you say, ‘We see.’ Your sin remains”

See how you translated **see** in 9:39. Alternate translation: [you say, ‘We know God’s truth.’ Your sin remains]

See: Metaphor

John 9:41 (#4)

λέγετε & βλέπομεν, ἡ ἁμαρτία ὑμῶν μένει

“you say, ‘We see.’ Your sin remains”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [you say that you see, so your sin remains]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus tells the Parable of the Sheep Pen (10:1–6)
2. Jesus says he is the gate of the sheep pen (10:7–10)
3. Jesus says he is the Good Shepherd (10:11–18)
4. The Jewish leaders disagree about who Jesus is (10:19–21)
5. Jesus says he is God at the Festival of Dedication (10:22–42)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Blasphemy
Blasphemy is when a person claims that he is God or claims that God has told him to speak when God has not told him to speak. The law of Moses commanded the Israelites to kill blasphemers by throwing stones at them until they died. When Jesus said, “I and the Father are one,” the Jews thought he was blaspheming, so they picked up stones to kill him. (See: blasphemy, blaspheme, blasphemous; and law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parables
Parables were short stories that Jesus told so that people who wanted to believe in him could easily understand the lesson he was trying to teach them. People who did not want to believe in him would not be able to understand the message (10:1–6).

Sheep
Jesus spoke metaphorically of people as sheep because sheep do not see well, do not think well, often walk away from those who care for them, and cannot defend themselves when other animals attack them. God’s people are similar to sheep in that they also are weak and do foolish things like rebelling against God. (See: ewe, ram, sheep, sheepfold, sheepshearer, sheepskin)

Sheep pen
A sheep pen was a space with a stone wall around it in which shepherds would keep their sheep for periods of time, such as over night. There were large sheep pens in which multiple flocks were kept, and also smaller sheep pens for a single flock. Once they were inside the sheep pen, the sheep could not run away, and animals and thieves could not easily get inside to kill or steal them. In 10:1–5, Jesus uses the sheep pen as a metaphor for the people of Israel. Out of the “sheep pen” of the Jewish people, Jesus calls his first “sheep.”

Laying down and taking up life
Jesus speaks of his life as if it were a physical object that he could: (1) lay down on the ground, which is a metaphor for dying, or (2) pick up again, which is a metaphor for becoming alive again.

John 10:1 (#2)

αὐλὴν τῶν προβάτων

“sheep pen”

A **sheep pen** is an enclosed or fenced area where a shepherd keeps his sheep. See the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter. If your readers would not be familiar with this way of protecting livestock, you could use a general expression for a roofless space surrounded by walls or a fence. Alternate translation: [walled area for protecting the sheep] or [place where sheep are kept]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 10:1 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 10:1 (#3)

κλέπτης & καὶ λῃστής

“a thief and a robber”

The words translated **thief** and **robber** describe two different kinds of criminals. A **thief** is a person who steals by stealth, but a **robber** is a person who steals by force or violence. For this reason, you may want to use “or” instead of **and** between these two terms. Alternate translation: [a thief or a robber]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:1–5 (#1)

In 10:1–5, Jesus speaks a parable, which he then uses for teaching purposes in 10:7–18. Here, the “shepherd” is a metaphor for Jesus and “sheep” is a metaphor for people. “His own sheep” are the people who follow Jesus, and the **thief**, **robber**, and “strangers” are the Jewish leaders, including the Pharisees, who try to deceive the people. Since Jesus does not explain the meaning of this parable here, you should not explain the metaphors within the parable itself.

See: Parables

John 10:2 (#1)

ποιμήν & τῶν προβάτων

“the shepherd of the sheep”

Jesus is using **of** to describe a **shepherd** who takes care of **the sheep**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the shepherd who cares for the sheep] or [the shepherd in charge of the sheep]

See: Possession

John 10:3 (#3)

τούτῳ & τῆς φωνῆς αὐτοῦ & τὰ ἴδια πρόβατα φωνεῖ

“for this one & his voice & he calls his own sheep”

In this verse, **this one**, **his**, and **he** refer to the shepherd mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for this shepherd ... the shepherd’s voice ... the shepherd calls his own sheep]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 10:3 (#2)

ὁ θυρωρὸς ἀνοίγει

“The gatekeeper opens”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [The gatekeeper opens the gate]

See: Ellipsis

John 10:3 (#5)

τὰ ἴδια πρόβατα φωνεῖ κατ’ ὄνομα

“he calls his own sheep by name”

Here, **his own sheep** are designated as a separate group among **the sheep** of the previous clause. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he calls his own sheep by name out from among all the sheep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:3 (#4)

τὰ πρόβατα τῆς φωνῆς αὐτοῦ ἀκούει

“the sheep hear his voice”

Here, **hear** could mean: (1) all the sheep in the pen **hear** the shepherd’s **voice**, but not all of them respond to it, as in the ULT. This meaning implies that there are multiple flocks in the sheep pen. (2) the sheep that belong to the shepherd heed or obey his **voice**. This implies that **the sheep** are identical with **his**

own sheep. Alternate translation: [the sheep heed his voice]

See: Metaphor

John 10:3 (#1)

ὁ θυρωρὸς

“The gatekeeper”

A **gatekeeper** is a person who guards the sheep pen and opens the gate for the shepherd. If your readers would not be familiar with this way of protecting livestock, you could use a general expression for a person who guards an entrance. Alternate translation: [The gate guard] or [The person guarding the gate]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 10:4 (#1)

ἔμπροσθεν αὐτῶν πορεύεται

“he goes ahead of them”

Shepherds in Jesus’ culture led their sheep by walking in front of them. If people who take care of livestock in your culture do not do this, you might need to state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he leads them to pasture by walking in front of them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:5 (#1)

τῶν ἀλλοτρίων τὴν φωνήν

“the voice of strangers”

The word **voice** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the strangers’ voices as a group. If your language does not use singular nouns in that way, you can use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the voices of strangers]

See: Collective Nouns

John 10:6 (#1)

ταύτην τὴν παροιμίαν

“this parable”

This **parable** is an illustration from the work of shepherds that uses metaphors. See the discussion of parables in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [this analogy]

See: Parables

John 10:6 (#2)

αὐτοῖς

“to them”

In this verse, **them**, **those ones**, and **they** refer to the Pharisees, whom Jesus was speaking with in 9:40–41. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly, as the UST does.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 10:7 (#2)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 10:7 (#3)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ θύρα

“I am the gate”

Jesus uses the word **gate** differently than he did in 10:1–2. Here, Jesus uses **gate** to say that he provides access into heaven, where God dwells. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [I am like the gate]

See: Metaphor

John 10:7 (#4)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ θύρα τῶν προβάτων

“I am the gate of the sheep”

Jesus is using **of** to describe himself as a **gate** that is for **the sheep** to use. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [I am the gate for the sheep]

See: Possession

John 10:7 (#5)

τῶν προβάτων

“of the sheep”

Jesus uses **sheep** to refer to people who believe in him. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [of those who follow me like sheep]

See: Metaphor

John 10:7 (#1)

In 10:7–18, Jesus uses ideas from the parable he told in 10:1–5 in order to teach about himself, those who believe in him, and those who deceive the people.

John 10:8 (#5)

οὐκ ἤκουσαν αὐτῶν

"did not hear them"

Here, **hear** means listening to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. It does not mean simply to **hear** what someone says. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [did not heed them]

See: Metaphor

John 10:8 (#3)

κλέπται & καὶ λῃσταί

"a thief and a robber"

The words translated **thief** and **robber** describe two different kinds of criminals. See how you translated this expression in 10:1. Alternate translation: [a thief or a robber]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:8 (#1)

πάντες ὅσοι ἦλθον πρὸ ἐμοῦ

"Everyone who came before me"

Everyone here is an exaggeration that refers to the majority of Israel's leaders, including the Pharisees and other Jewish leaders. Not every leader of Israel throughout history was wicked, but most were. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Most leaders who came before me]

See: Hyperbole

John 10:8 (#4)

τὰ πρόβατα

"the sheep"

In this verse, Jesus uses **sheep** to refer specifically to the Jewish people who believed in him. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sheep who follow me] or [the sheep, my disciples]

See: Metaphor

John 10:8 (#2)

κλέπται & καὶ λῃσταί

"a thief and a robber"

Jesus uses **thief** and **robber** to refer to the Jewish leaders who were deceiving the people. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [like a thief and a robber]

See: Metaphor

John 10:9 (#6)

νομὴν εὑρήσει

"will find pasture"

Jesus uses the phrase **find pasture** to refer to having one's needs provided for. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will find sustenance] or [will receive everything that he needs]

See: Metaphor

John 10:9 (#5)

εἰσελεύσεται, καὶ ἐξελεύσεται

"he will go in and go out"

The phrase **go in and go out** is a common Old Testament idiom meaning to travel and move around freely in a safe environment. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [he will move about freely] or [he will go around in a safe environment]

See: Idiom

John 10:9 (#4)

σωθήσεται

"he will be saved"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will save him] or [I will save him]

See: Active or Passive

John 10:9 (#3)

σωθήσεται

"he will be saved"

Here, **saved** refers to being **saved** from the eternal punishment in hell that all people deserve because of their sins. If this might confuse your readers, you could

express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [he will be saved from hell]

See: Metaphor

John 10:9 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ θύρα

"I am the gate"

Jesus uses the word **gate** to say that he provides access into heaven, where God dwells. See how you translated this phrase in 10:7. Alternate translation: [I am like the gate]

See: Metaphor

John 10:9 (#2)

δι' ἐμοῦ ἐάν τις εἰσέλθῃ

"If anyone enters through me"

Jesus uses **enters through me** to refer to trusting in him for salvation. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If anyone believes in me for salvation]

See: Metaphor

John 10:10 (#6)

ἵνα ζωὴν ἔχωσιν

"so that they might have life"

Here, **life** refers to eternal **life**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [so that they might have eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:10 (#3)

οὐκ ἔρχεται εἰ μὴ ἵνα κλέψῃ

"does not come except in order that he might steal"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [comes only in order that he might steal]

See: Double Negatives

John 10:10 (#7)

καὶ περισσὸν ἔχωσιν

"and might have it abundantly"

Here, **abundantly** implies that the eternal **life** Jesus' followers will receive has more blessings than anyone could expect. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and might have it with abundant blessings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:10 (#4)

κλέψῃ, καὶ θύσῃ, καὶ ἀπολέσῃ

"he might steal and kill and destroy"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [he might steal and kill and destroy the sheep]

See: Ellipsis

John 10:10 (#2)

ὁ κλέπτης

"The thief"

Jesus uses **thief** to refer to the Jewish leaders who were deceiving the people. See how you translated the similar use of this word in 10:8. Alternate translation: [Every leader is like a thief who]

See: Metaphor

John 10:10 (#1)

ὁ κλέπτης

"The thief"

Jesus is speaking of thieves in general, not of one particular **thief**. If this would be misunderstood in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [A thief]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 10:10 (#5)

ἔχωσιν

"they might have"

Here, **they** refers to the sheep, which is a metaphor for God's people. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the sheep might have]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 10:11 (#2)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ποιμὴν ὁ καλός

"I am the good shepherd"

Jesus uses the phrase **good shepherd** to refer to himself. Just as a **good shepherd** takes care of his **sheep**, Jesus takes care of his followers. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [I am like a good shepherd]

See: Metaphor

John 10:11 (#3)

τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ τίθησιν

“lays down his life”

Jesus uses **lays down his life** to refer to voluntarily dying. This is a polite way of referring to something unpleasant. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a different polite way of referring to this or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [voluntarily dies]

See: Euphemism

John 10:11 (#1)

In 10:11–18, Jesus uses ideas from the parable he told in 10:1–5 to proclaim that he is the good shepherd who leads his sheep to heaven and takes care of them.

John 10:11 (#4)

τῶν προβάτων

“the sheep”

See how you translated **sheep** in the 10:8.

See: Metaphor

John 10:12 (#4)

τὰ πρόβατα & τὰ πρόβατα

“the sheep & the sheep”

See how you translated **sheep** in the 10:8.

See: Metaphor

John 10:12 (#3)

τὸν λύκον & ὁ λύκος

“the wolf & the wolf”

A **wolf** is a fierce wild dog that is known for attacking and devouring livestock. If your readers would not be familiar with this animal, you could use the name of a fierce predator or wild dog in your area that commonly eats farmers’ livestock, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the fierce predator … that predator]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 10:12 (#5)

ὁ λύκος ἁρπάζει αὐτὰ καὶ σκορπίζει

“the wolf seizes and scatters them”

This clause describes two events. The first event causes the second event. When **the wolf** attacks and **seizes** a sheep, the other sheep scatter. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could show this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [the wolf seizes a sheep, and the rest of the sheep scatter]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

John 10:12 (#1)

ὁ μισθωτὸς

“the hired man”

Jesus uses the phrase **hired servant** to refer to the Jewish leaders and teachers. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each of your leaders is like a hired servant]

See: Metaphor

John 10:12 (#2)

ὁ μισθωτὸς

“the hired man”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the man whom someone hired]

See: Active or Passive

John 10:13 (#2)

οὐ μέλει αὐτῷ περὶ τῶν προβάτων

“it is not a concern to him about the sheep”

Jesus compares a **hired man** who abandons **the sheep** to the Jewish leaders and teachers who do not care for God’s people. See how you translated **sheep** in the 10:8. Alternate translation: [he is not concerned about the sheep, just like your leaders are not concerned about God’s people]

See: Metaphor

John 10:13 (#1)

μισθωτός

“a hired man”

See how you translated a similar phrase in the previous verse.

See: Active or Passive

John 10:14 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ποιμὴν ὁ καλός

“I am the good shepherd”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11. Alternate translation: [I am like a good shepherd]

See: Metaphor

John 10:15 (#2)

τὴν ψυχήν μου τίθημι

“I lay down my life”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 10:11. Alternate translation: [I voluntarily die]

See: Euphemism

John 10:15 (#1)

ὁ Πατὴρ & τὸν Πατέρα

“the Father & the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:15 (#3)

τῶν προβάτων

“the sheep”

See how you translated this phrase in the 10:8.

See: Metaphor

John 10:16 (#3)

κἀκεῖνα & ἀγαγεῖν

“to bring them also”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. This could mean: (1) Jesus will bring them to himself, as in the UST. (2) Jesus will bring them to God. Alternate translation: [to bring them also to God]

See: Ellipsis

John 10:16 (#4)

τῆς φωνῆς μου ἀκούσουσιν

“they will hear my voice”

Here, **hear** refers to listening to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. See how you translated this word in 10:8. Alternate translation: [they will heed my voice]

See: Metaphor

John 10:16 (#5)

μία ποίμνη

“one flock”

Jesus uses **flock** to refer to all of his followers, including Jews and non-Jews, as if they are one group, like a **flock** of **sheep**. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one group]

See: Metaphor

John 10:16 (#1)

ἄλλα πρόβατα ἔχω, ἃ οὐκ ἔστιν ἐκ τῆς αὐλῆς ταύτης

“I have other sheep that are not from this sheep pen”

Jesus uses **other sheep** to refer to his followers who are not Jews. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [I have disciples who are not from the Jews]

See: Metaphor

John 10:16 (#6)

εἷς ποιμήν

“one shepherd”

Jesus uses **shepherd** to refer to himself. See the discussion of this in the introduction for the chapter. See also how you translated **shepherd** in 10:11.

See: Metaphor

John 10:16 (#2)

τῆς αὐλῆς ταύτης

“this sheep pen”

Jesus uses **sheep pen** to refer to the people of Israel. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people]

See: Metaphor

John 10:17 (#4)

ἵνα πάλιν λάβω αὐτήν

“so that I might take it up again”

Jesus refers to becoming alive again as if life were an object that he could **take up**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that I might cause myself to be alive again]

See: Metaphor

John 10:17 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτό, με ὁ Πατὴρ ἀγαπᾷ, ὅτι ἐγὼ τίθημι τὴν ψυχήν μου, ἵνα πάλιν λάβω αὐτήν

“Because of this the Father loves me, because I lay down my life so that I might take it up again”

Here, **this** refers to all the information in the second clause. If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [Because I lay down my life so that I might take it up again, the Father loves me]

See: Information Structure

John 10:17 (#3)

ἐγὼ τίθημι τὴν ψυχήν μου

“I lay down my life”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 10:11. Alternate translation: [I voluntarily die]

See: Euphemism

John 10:17 (#2)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:18 (#1)

οὐδεὶς ἦρεν αὐτὴν ἀπ’ ἐμοῦ

“No one takes it away from me”

Jesus refers to his life as if it were an object that someone could take away. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [No one is causing me to die]

See: Metaphor

John 10:18 (#2)

ἐγὼ τίθημι αὐτὴν & θεῖναι αὐτήν

“I lay it down & to lay it down”

See how you translated the similar phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [I voluntarily die ... to voluntarily die]

See: Euphemism

John 10:18 (#3)

ἐγὼ τίθημι αὐτὴν ἀπ’ ἐμαυτοῦ

“I lay it down from myself”

The reflexive pronoun **myself** is used here to emphasize that Jesus voluntarily lays down his own life. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [I myself lay it down]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 10:18 (#5)

τοῦ Πατρός μου

“my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:18 (#4)

πάλιν λαβεῖν αὐτήν

“to take it up again”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [to cause myself to be alive again]

See: Metaphor

John 10:19 (#2)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders, which in this chapter and the previous chapter may have been a group of leaders among the Pharisees. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 10:19 (#3)

διὰ τοὺς λόγους τούτους

“because of these words”

Here, **these words** refers to what Jesus has just said to **the Jews** in the previous verses. It was not the words themselves that caused division, but the meaning of what Jesus said. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of the things he said]

See: Metonymy

John 10:19 (#1)

σχίσμα πάλιν ἐγένετο ἐν τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"A division again occurred among the Jews"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **division**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The Jews divided themselves against each other again]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 10:20 (#1)

δαιμόνιον ἔχει

"He has a demon"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 7:20. Alternate translation: [A demon is inside of him!] or [He must be under the control of a demon!]

John 10:20 (#2)

τί αὐτοῦ ἀκούετε

"Why do you listen to him"

Jesus' opponents are using the form of a question to emphasize that the people should not listen to Jesus. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should certainly not listen to him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 10:21 (#2)

μὴ δαιμόνιον δύναται τυφλῶν ὀφθαλμοὺς ἀνοῖξαι

"A demon is not able to open the eyes of the blind, is he"

The people are using the form of a question to emphasize that they do not believe that a **demon** could heal a **blind** person. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Certainly a demon cannot cause a blind man to see!] or [Certainly a demon cannot give sight to blind people!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 10:21 (#1)

ταῦτα τὰ ῥήματα οὐκ ἔστιν δαιμονιζομένου

"These are not the words of a demon-possessed man"

Here, **words** refers to what a **demon-possessed man** would say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [These things are not what a demon-possessed man would say]

See: Metonymy

John 10:21 (#3)

τυφλῶν ὀφθαλμοὺς ἀνοῖξαι

"to open the eyes of the blind"

Here, **open the eyes** describes the ability to see by referring to something associated with vision coming into action, specifically, **the eyes**. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to cause the blind to see]

See: Metonymy

John 10:22 (#2)

τὰ ἐνκαίνια

"the Festival of Dedication"

The **Festival of Dedication** is an eight-day holiday that Jews celebrate in the **winter** to remember when they dedicated the Jewish temple to God after it had been defiled by the Syrians. If your readers would not be familiar with this holiday, you could use a general expression to explain it. Alternate translation: [the Jewish temple dedication festival] or [the Jewish festival for remembering the dedication of their temple]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 10:22 (#1)

Some Jews begin to question Jesus during **the Festival of Dedication**. This verse gives background information about the time when the events of 10:24–39 took place. The next verse gives background information about the place where those events too place. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 10:23 (#1)

περιεπάτει ὁ Ἰησοῦς ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“Jesus was walking in the temple”

Jesus was walking in the courtyard of **the temple**. See how you translated **temple** in 8:14. Alternate translation: [Jesus was walking in the temple courtyard]

See: Synecdoche

John 10:23 (#2)

τῇ στοᾷ τοῦ Σολομῶνος

“the porch of Solomon”

The possessive form describes **the porch** that was associated with King **Solomon** in some way. It may have been the only remaining part of the temple built during the time of **Solomon**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the porch associated with Solomon]

See: Possession

John 10:23 (#3)

στοᾷ

“porch”

A **porch** was a structure with a roof; it had at least one wall missing and was attached to the side of a building. See how you translated this word in 5:2.

See: Translate Unknowns

John 10:24 (#2)

τὴν ψυχὴν ἡμῶν αἴρεις

“are you taking away our life”

Here, **taking away our life** is an idiom that means to keep people in suspense by not telling them something. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [will you keep us from knowing for sure?]

See: Idiom

John 10:24 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 10:25 (#3)

τοῦ Πατρός μου

“of my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:25 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Πατρός μου

“in the name of my Father”

Here, **name** could mean: (1) Jesus performed miracles by means of God’s authority. Alternate translation: [through my Father’s authority]; (2) Jesus performed miracles as God’s representative. Alternate translation: [as my Father’s representative]

See: Metonymy

John 10:25 (#4)

ταῦτα μαρτυρεῖ περὶ ἐμοῦ

“these testify concerning me”

Jesus speaks of his **works** as though they were a person who could testify and offer proof in a court of law. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these offer proof concerning me]

See: Personification

John 10:25 (#1)

τὰ ἔργα

“The works”

Here, **works** could refer to: (1) the miracles that Jesus did. Alternate translation: [The miracles]; (2) Jesus’ miracles and teaching. Alternate translation: [The miracles and teaching] See how you translated **works** in 5:36.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:26 (#1)

οὐκ & ἐκ τῶν προβάτων τῶν ἐμῶν

“not from my sheep”

Jesus uses **sheep** to refer to people who believe in him. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [not my followers] or [not my disciples]

See: Metaphor

John 10:27 (#3)

ἀκολουθοῦσίν μοι

“they follow me”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 8:12.

See: Idiom

John 10:27 (#2)

τῆς φωνῆς μου ἀκούουσιν

“hear my voice”

Here, **hear** means listening to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. See how you translated this word in 10:16. Alternate translation: [heed my voice]

See: Metaphor

John 10:27 (#1)

τὰ πρόβατα τὰ ἐμὰ

“My sheep”

See how you translated **My sheep** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [My followers] or [My disciples]

See: Metaphor

John 10:28 (#1)

οὐχ ἁρπάσει τις αὐτὰ ἐκ τῆς χειρός μου

“no one will snatch any of them from my hand”

Jesus uses the word **hand** to refer to his protective care and **snatch** to refer to removing someone from that care. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no one will steal any of them away from me] or [they all will remain secure forever in my care]

See: Metonymy

John 10:29 (#2)

οὐδεὶς δύναται ἁρπάζειν ἐκ τῆς χειρὸς τοῦ Πατρός

“no one is able to snatch them from the hand of the Father”

Jesus uses the word **hand** to refer to God’s protective care and **snatch** to refer to removing someone from that care. See how you translated **hand** and **snatch** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [no one will steal any of them away from my Father] or [they all will remain secure forever in my Father’s care]

See: Metonymy

John 10:29 (#1)

ὁ Πατήρ μου ὃς δέδωκέν μοι

“My Father, who has given them to me”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:30 (#2)

ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:30 (#1)

ἕν ἐσμεν

“are one”

The word translated as **one** means to be one entity. Although this expression implies that Jesus is God, he is not identical to God **the Father**. Therefore, **one** cannot be translated as “one person.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [are one entity]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:31 (#2)

ἵνα λιθάσωσιν αὐτόν

“so that they might stone him”

The Jews opposing Jesus are outraged at what Jesus said in the previous verse. Here, John implies that they wanted to kill him with stones because he had made himself equal to God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [so that they might stone him because he claimed to be equal with God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:31 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“The Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 10:32 (#3)

τοῦ Πατρός

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:32 (#4)

διὰ ποῖον αὐτῶν ἔργον, ἐμὲ λιθάζετε

“For which of those works are you stoning me”

Jesus is using irony. Jesus knows the Jewish leaders do not want to stone him because he has done **good works**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your certainly are not stoning me because of those works!]

See: Irony

John 10:32 (#1)

πολλὰ ἔργα καλὰ & αὐτῶν ἔργον

“many good works & of those works”

See how you translated **works** in 10:25. Alternate translation: [many good miracles ... of those miracles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:32 (#2)

ἐκ τοῦ Πατρός

“from the Father”

This phrase could refer to: (1) the source of the **good works**. Alternate translation: [originating from the Father]; (2) the one who enabled the **good works**. Alternate translation: [given to me by the Father]

John 10:33 (#4)

ποιεῖς σεαυτὸν Θεόν

“making yourself God”

This phrase means to claim to be God. It does not mean to try to make oneself into God or become God. Alternate translation: [saying that you are God]

John 10:33 (#2)

περὶ βλασφημίας

“for blasphemy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **blasphemy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because you are blaspheming]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 10:33 (#1)

ἀπεκρίθησαν αὐτῷ οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“The Jews answered him”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:31. Alternate translation: [The Jewish authorities answered him]

See: Synecdoche

John 10:33 (#3)

βλασφημίας

“blasphemy”

The **Jews** use the word **blasphemy** with its technical sense, which refers to a human being claiming to be God. This is what the Jewish leaders felt Jesus was doing in 10:30. Here, **blasphemy** does not have a general sense of “insult.” See the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [committing the crime of blasphemy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:34 (#2)

οὐκ ἔστιν γεγραμμένον

“Is it not written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Did not a prophet write]

See: Active or Passive

John 10:34 (#6)

ἐγὼ εἶπα, θεοί ἐστε

“I said, “You are gods”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [I said that you are gods]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 10:34 (#5)

ἐγὼ εἶπα, θεοί ἐστε

“I said, “You are gods”

Jesus quotes Psalm 82:6 where God calls some humans **gods**. Jesus does this in order to show that God also used the word "god" to refer to people other than himself. In the verse that Jesus quotes, the first person **I** refers to God. If this might be misunderstood by your readers, you could state it explicitly. Alternate translation: [I, God, said, "You are gods]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 10:34 (#3)

οὐκ ἔστιν γεγραμμένον ἐν τῷ νόμῳ ὑμῶν

"Is it not written in your law"

Jesus uses **written in your law** to introduce a quotation from (Psalm 82:6). Psalms is considered to be part of the Old Testament "wisdom literature." However, the Jews sometimes used **law** broadly to refer to the entire Old Testament. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state explicitly that Jesus was quoting from Psalms. Alternate translation: [Has it not been written in the Psalms]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 10:34 (#4)

ἐν τῷ νόμῳ ὑμῶν

"in your law"

Jesus is using the name of the first part of the Hebrew Scriptures, the **law**, to represent the entire Hebrew Scriptures in general. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your Scriptures]

See: Synecdoche

John 10:34 (#1)

οὐκ ἔστιν γεγραμμένον ἐν τῷ νόμῳ ὑμῶν & ἐγὼ εἶπα, θεοί ἐστε

"Is it not written in your law, 'I said, "You are gods"

Jesus uses the form of a question to add emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [It is certainly written in your law, 'I said, "You are gods.]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 10:35 (#3)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐγένετο

"the word of God came"

Jesus used the term **word** to describe the message that God said by using words. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God's message came]

See: Metonymy

John 10:35 (#4)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐγένετο

"the word of God came"

Jesus speaks of **the word of God** as though it were a person who moved toward those who heard it. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God spoke his word]

See: Personification

John 10:35 (#6)

οὐ δύναται λυθῆναι ἡ Γραφή

"the Scripture is not able to be broken"

This phrase could mean: (1) no one can prove that the Scriptures are false or contain errors. Alternate translation: [the Scriptures are not able to be proven false]; (2) the authority of Scripture cannot be ignored. Alternate translation: [the Scriptures are not able to be ignored]

See: Metaphor

John 10:35 (#1)

Verses 35 and 36 are one sentence. In this sentence, Jesus argues by moving from a weaker reason to a stronger reason (an argument from the lesser to the greater). Based on the scripture he quoted in verse 34, Jesus argues that, since God calls humans **gods** in that verse, it is even more appropriate to call him God because he is the Son of God. You may need to change the order of the clauses in order for this idea to be clearer in your language.

John 10:35 (#2)

εἰ ἐκείνους εἶπεν θεοὺς

"If he called them gods"

If indicates a conditional sentence that extends until the end of the next verse. Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what John is saying is

not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since he called them gods]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 10:35 (#5)

οὐ δύναται λυθῆναι ἡ Γραφή

“the Scripture is not able to be broken”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one can break the Scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 10:36 (#1)

ὃν ὁ Πατὴρ ἡγίασεν καὶ ἀπέστειλεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον, ὑμεῖς λέγετε & βλασφημεῖς, ὅτι εἶπον, Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ εἰμι

“do you say to the one the Father sanctified and sent into the world, ‘You are blaspheming,’ because I said, ‘I am the Son of God”

Jesus uses the form of a question to rebuke his opponents for accusing him of blasphemy. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you should not say to the one the Father sanctified and sent into the world, ‘You are blaspheming,’ because I said, ‘I am the Son of God!’]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 10:36 (#3)

ὃν ὁ Πατὴρ ἡγίασεν καὶ ἀπέστειλεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“to the one the Father sanctified and sent into the world”

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to me whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 10:36 (#4)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:36 (#6)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the Son of God”

This phrase, **the Son of God**, is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:36 (#5)

βλασφημεῖς

“You are blaspheming”

Jesus is leaving a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. See how you translated “blasphemy” in 10:33 and also see the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [You have committed the crime of blaspheming God] or [You are guilty of blaspheming God]

See: Ellipsis

John 10:36 (#2)

ὑμεῖς λέγετε & βλασφημεῖς, ὅτι εἶπον, Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ εἰμι

“do you say & You are blaspheming,’ because I said, ‘I am the Son of God”

If the direct quotations inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the two instances of second direct quotations as indirect quotations. Alternate translation: [do you say ... that he is blaspheming because I said that I am the Son of God]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 10:37 (#2)

τοῦ Πατρός

“of & Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 10:37 (#1)

τὰ ἔργα τοῦ Πατρός μου

“the works of my Father”

Jesus is using **of** to describe **works** that God wants him to do. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:4. Alternate translation: [the works that my Father demands]

See: Possession

John 10:38 (#4)

ἐν ἐμοὶ ὁ Πατὴρ, κἀγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρί

"the Father {is} in me, and I in the Father"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that the truth of what Jesus is saying. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [my Father and I are completely joined together as one]

See: Doublet

John 10:38 (#1)

εἰ δὲ ποιῶ

"But if I am doing them"

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [But since I am doing them]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 10:38 (#3)

ἐν ἐμοὶ ὁ Πατὴρ, κἀγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρί

"the Father {is} in me, and I in the Father"

Jesus uses the word **in** to express the close personal relationship between himself and God. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my Father has a close relationship with me, and I have a close relationship with my Father]

See: Idiom

John 10:38 (#2)

τοῖς ἔργοις πιστεύετε

"believe in the works"

Here, **believe in** means to acknowledge that the **works** Jesus does are done with the authority of the Father and prove that he is God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [believe that the works I do are from God] or [believe that the works I do are done with God's power]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:39 (#1)

ἐξῆλθεν ἐκ τῆς χειρὸς αὐτῶν

"he went away out of their hand"

Here, John used the word **hand** to refer to the custody or possession of the Jewish leaders. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he escaped from them]

See: Metonymy

John 10:40 (#3)

ἦν Ἰωάννης τὸ πρῶτον βαπτίζων

"John first was baptizing"

Here, **first** refers to the beginning of John's ministry. It does not mean that **John** was the **first** person to baptize people in that location. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [John was baptizing during the first days of his ministry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:40 (#1)

πέραν τοῦ Ἰορδάνου

"beyond the Jordan"

Here, **beyond the Jordan** refers to the region of Judea that is on the east side of the **Jordan** River, which is the side opposite from Jerusalem. See how you translated this expression in 1:28. Alternate translation: [on the side of the Jordan River opposite from Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:40 (#4)

ἔμεινεν ἐκεῖ

"he stayed there"

Jesus remained on the east side of **Jordan** for a short period of time. If your language requires a length of time for **stay**, you can use a general expression. Alternate translation: [Jesus stayed there for several days]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:40 (#2)

ἦν Ἰωάννης

"John"

Here, **John** refers to Jesus' cousin, often referred to as "John the Baptist." (See: John (the Baptist)) It does not refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. See how you translated **John** in 1:26. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Immerser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 10:41 (#2)

τούτου

"this one"

Here, **this one** refers to Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [this man, Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 10:41 (#1)

σημεῖον

"sign"

See how you translated **sign** in 2:11. See also the discussion of signs in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracle]

John - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus returns to Judea (11:1–16)
2. Jesus' seventh sign: Jesus makes Lazarus become alive again (11:17–46)
3. The Jewish leaders plan to kill Jesus (11:47–57)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Ancient Jewish burial customs
According to the burial customs of that time, a dead person's family would wrap the dead body with many strips of linen cloth and place it on a table inside a tomb. The tomb was either a cave or a room cut out of the side a large rock. According to Jewish tradition, the body was left to decompose in the tomb for one year. Then the family would place the bones in a stone box. If your readers would be unfamiliar with these burial customs, then you may need to provide explanations in your translation or in a note for 11:38–44.

Passover
After Jesus made Lazarus become alive again, the Jewish leaders were determined to kill Jesus, so he started traveling secretly from place to place. The Pharisees knew that he would come to Jerusalem for the Passover festival because God had commanded all Jewish men to celebrate the Passover in Jerusalem. Thus they planned to catch him and kill him during Passover (11:55–57). (See: Passover)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"One man dies for the people"
In the law of Moses, God commanded the priests to kill animals so that God would forgive the people's sins. In this chapter, the high priest Caiaphas says, "It is better for you that one man dies for the people than that the whole nation perishes" (11:50). He said this because he loved his "place" and "nation" (11:48) more than he loved the God who had made Lazarus become alive again. He wanted Jesus to die so that the Romans would not destroy the temple and Jerusalem. However, God wanted Jesus to die so that he could forgive all of his people's sins.

"The Jews"
This term is used in three different ways in this chapter. Unlike in other parts of John's Gospel, it is used here primarily to refer to the Jewish people who were living in Judea, especially Judean friends and relatives of Lazarus. Some of these Judeans believed in Jesus and others opposed him (11:36–37). The term is also used specifically at least once in this chapter to refer to the Jewish leaders who opposed Jesus and were trying to kill him (11:8 and possibly 11:54). Finally, the term is used in 11:55 to refer to the Jewish people in general. The translator may wish to use the terms "Judeans," "Jewish authorities," and "Jewish people" to clarify these distinctions.

Hypothetical situation
When Martha and Mary said, "If you had been here, my brother would not have died," they were speaking of a situation that could have happened but did not happen (11:21, 32). Jesus had not come, and their brother did die.

John 11:1 (#3)

Μάρθας τῆς ἀδελφῆς αὐτῆς

"her sister Martha"

Because those who wrote scripture usually listed the names of siblings in order from oldest to youngest, the list in 11:5 suggests that **Martha** was the oldest and **Lazarus** was the youngest of the three siblings. If your

language uses different words for **sister** depending on birth order, use the word for an older **sister** here. Alternate translation: [her older sister Martha]

See: Kinship

John 11:1 (#2)

ἦν δέ τις ἀσθενῶν Λάζαρος ἀπὸ Βηθανίας

"Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus from Bethany"

This verse introduces **Lazarus** as a new character in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character. Alternate translation: [There was a man named Lazarus, who was from Bethany and was sick]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 11:1 (#1)

11:1–2 provide background information about **Lazarus** and his sisters. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 11:2 (#1)

ἦν δὲ Μαρία ἡ ἀλείψασα τὸν Κύριον μύρῳ, καὶ ἐκμάξασα τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ ταῖς θριξὶν αὐτῆς

"Now Mary was the one having anointed the Lord with myrrh and having wiped his feet with her hair"

John refers to an event that would happen at a time following the events recorded in this chapter (12:1–8). If this might confuse your readers, you could translate this as a future event. Alternate translation: [Now it was Mary who would later anoint the Lord with myrrh and wipe his feet with her hair]

See: Order of Events

John 11:2 (#2)

ὁ ἀδελφὸς Λάζαρος

"brother Lazarus"

Because those who wrote scripture usually listed the names of siblings in order from oldest to youngest, the list in 11:5 suggests that Martha was the oldest and **Lazarus** was the youngest of the three siblings. If your language uses different words for **brother** depending on birth order, use the word for a younger **brother** here. Alternate translation: [younger brother Lazarus]

See: Kinship

John 11:3 (#3)

Κύριε, ἴδε, ὃν φιλεῖς ἀσθενεῖ

"Sir, behold, he whom you love is sick"

Here, the **sisters** are using a present statement to make a request indirectly. They tell Jesus that Lazarus is **sick**, because they want Jesus to come and heal him. If this use of a statement is confusing in your language, you can use a more natural form for instruction. Alternate translation: [Sir, behold, he whom you love is sick and needs your help]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 11:3 (#4)

ἴδε

"behold"

Here, **behold** means to take notice of something or pay attention to something. It is used here to emphasize the urgency of the words that follow. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [take notice]

See: Metaphor

John 11:3 (#1)

ἀπέστειλαν & αἱ ἀδελφαὶ πρὸς αὐτὸν λέγουσαι

"the sisters sent to him, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [the sisters sent to him, and they said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 11:3 (#2)

ἀπέστειλαν & πρὸς αὐτὸν

"sent to him"

John is leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [sent messengers to him] or [sent a message to him]

See: Ellipsis

John 11:4 (#1)

οὐκ ἔστιν πρὸς θάνατον

"is not to death"

Here, **not to** indicates that what follows is not the result of the **sickness**. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [This sickness will not result in death]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 11:4 (#5)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the Son of God"

Jesus is referring to himself in third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person form, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 11:4 (#3)

ὑπὲρ τῆς δόξης τοῦ Θεοῦ

"for the glory of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in order to glorify God]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 11:4 (#6)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Son of God"

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 11:4 (#4)

ἵνα δοξασθῇ ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ δι' αὐτῆς

"so that the Son of God may be glorified by it"

Jesus is stating the second purpose for Lazarus's **sickness**. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a second purpose clause. Alternate translation: [and for the purpose of glorifying the Son of God]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 11:4 (#2)

ἀλλ' ὑπὲρ τῆς δόξης τοῦ Θεοῦ

"but for the glory of God"

Jesus is stating the purpose for Lazarus's **sickness**. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose clause. Alternate translation: [but for the purpose of glorifying God]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 11:5 (#2)

τὴν ἀδελφὴν

"sister"

Because those who wrote scripture usually listed the names of siblings in order from oldest to youngest, the list in 11:5 suggests that Martha was the oldest and Lazarus was the youngest of the three siblings. If your language uses different words for **sister** depending on birth order, use the word for a younger **sister** here. Alternate translation: [younger sister]

See: Kinship

John 11:5 (#1)

In this verse John briefly stops telling about the events in the story in order to give background information about Jesus' relationship with **Lazarus** and his sisters. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 11:6 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Therefore connects this verse to the previous verse in order to indicate that Jesus delayed going to Lazarus because he loved him and his sisters. Jesus' delay is not in contrast to his love for them. Although Lazarus's family would suffer for a short time, they would experience a great blessing when Jesus brought Lazarus back to life. Alternate translation: [Because Jesus loved them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 11:7 (#1)

λέγει

"he says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:8 (#2)

πάλιν ὑπάγεις ἐκεῖ

"you are going back there again"

The disciples use the form of a question to emphasize that they do not want Jesus to go to Jerusalem. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose

in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you surely should not go back there again!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 11:8 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19 and the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter.

See: Synecdoche

John 11:9 (#1)

οὐχὶ δώδεκα ὧραί εἰσιν τῆς ἡμέρας

"Are there not 12 hours in the day"

Jesus is using the form of a question for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [There are surely 12 hours in the day.]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 11:9 (#2)

ἐάν τις περιπατῇ ἐν τῇ ἡμέρᾳ, οὐ προσκόπτει, ὅτι τὸ φῶς τοῦ κόσμου τούτου βλέπει

"If someone walks in the daytime, he does not stumble, because he sees by the light of this world"

Jesus speaks about **someone** walking **in the daytime** in order to comfort his disciples who were worried about going to Judea. In this metaphor Jesus uses **the light of this world** to refer to himself, who has previously called himself "the Light of the World" in 8:12 and 9:5. This whole metaphor could mean: (1) if Jesus and his disciples did God's work during the limited time God had given him to work with them (**the daytime**), they would not fail (**stumble**) because Jesus was with them. This interpretation has a similar meaning to Jesus' statement in 9:4. Alternate translation: [If you do God's work during the time I am here, you will succeed, because you are with me, the light of this world.]; (2) someone who acts according to God's will (**walks in the daytime**) does not fail (**stumble**) because Jesus guides that person. Alternate translation: [If someone acts according to God's will, he will succeed, because I, the light of this world, will guide him]

See: Metaphor

John 11:10 (#1)

ἐὰν δέ τις περιπατῇ ἐν τῇ νυκτί, προσκόπτει, ὅτι τὸ φῶς οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν αὐτῷ

"But if someone walks at night, he stumbles because the light is not in him"

In this verse Jesus expands the metaphor from the previous verse about a person walking outside. In this metaphor Jesus uses **the light** to refer to himself, who has previously called himself "the Light of the World" in 8:12 and 9:5. This whole metaphor could mean: (1) if his disciples tried to do God's work after the limited time God had given him to be with them (the **night** which comes after "the daytime"), they would fail (**stumble**) because Jesus would not be with them. This interpretation has a similar meaning to Jesus' statement in 9:4. Alternate translation: [If you try to do this work after I have left, you will fail because I, the light, am not with you.]; (2) someone who does not act according to God's will (**walks at night**) is an unbeliever who fails completely (**stumble**) because that person does not know Jesus. Alternate translation: [If someone does not act according to God's will, he will fail because he does not know me, the light]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 11:11 (#2)

Λάζαρος ὁ φίλος ἡμῶν κεκοίμηται

"Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep"

Jesus uses **fallen asleep** to refer to being dead. This is a polite way of referring to something unpleasant. Since Jesus explains the meaning in 11:14, you do not need to explain it here. However, If you have an idiom for this idea in your language, you may use it here.

See: Euphemism

John 11:11 (#1)

λέγει

"he says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:11 (#3)

ἀλλὰ πορεύομαι ἵνα ἐξυπνίσω αὐτόν

"but I am going so that I may wake him out of sleep"

Here, **wake him out of sleep** refers to Jesus' plan to cause Lazarus to become alive again. If you have an idiom for this idea in your language, you may use it here. Since the disciples do not understand what Jesus is saying here, do not translate this plainly.

See: Idiom

John 11:12 (#1)

εἰ κεκοίμηται

"if he has fallen asleep"

See how you translated **fallen asleep** in the previous verse.

See: Euphemism

John 11:13 (#2)

ἐκεῖνοι

"those ones"

Here, **those ones** refers to Jesus' disciples. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 11:13 (#1)

In this verse John briefly stops telling the events in the story in order to give background information about Jesus' conversation with his disciples. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 11:13 (#3)

λέγει

"he is speaking"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:13 (#4)

τῆς κοιμήσεως τοῦ ὕπνου

"the sleep of slumber"

John is using **of** to describe **sleep** that is **slumber**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [sleep that is actually sleep] or [natural sleep]

See: Possession

John 11:14 (#1)

τότε & εἶπεν αὐτοῖς ὁ Ἰησοῦς παρρησίᾳ

"Jesus then said to them plainly"

Here, **plainly** means to say something clearly without using and metaphors or others figures of speech. Because the disciples did not understand the metaphor Jesus told them in 11:11, he told them the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Jesus then said to them in words that they could understand]

John 11:15 (#2)

ἵνα πιστεύσητε

"so that you may believe"

Jesus is leaving out some words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. You may also need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [for I allowed this to happen so that you may believe in me] or [for I let Lazarus die so that you may believe that I am the Messiah]

See: Ellipsis

John 11:15 (#1)

δι' ὑμᾶς

"for your sakes"

Alternate translation: [for your benefit] or [for your good]

John 11:16 (#1)

Δίδυμος

"Didymus"

Didymus is the name of a man. It is a Greek word that means "twin" and is Thomas' other name.

See: How to Translate Names

John 11:17 (#1)

ὁ Ἰησοῦς εὗρεν αὐτὸν, τέσσαρας ἤδη ἡμέρας ἔχοντα ἐν τῷ μνημείῳ

"Jesus found him having already been in the tomb for four days"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Jesus found him; people had put his body in the tomb four days earlier]

See: Active or Passive

John 11:18 (#2)

ἀπὸ σταδίων δεκαπέντε

“15 stadia away”

The word **stadia** is the plural of “stadium,” which is a Roman measurement of distance equivalent to about 185 meters or a little over 600 feet. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or a footnote. Alternate translation: [about two miles away]

See: Biblical Distance

John 11:18 (#1)

ἦν δὲ ἡ Βηθανία ἐγγὺς τῶν Ἱεροσολύμων, ὡς ἀπὸ σταδίων δεκαπέντε

“Now Bethany was near Jerusalem, about 15 stadia away”

This verse gives background information about the place where this event took place. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [This event took place in Bethany, which was near Jerusalem and was about 15 stadia away]

See: Background Information

John 11:19 (#1)

This verse gives background information about the people who were present when this event took place. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 11:19 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to people living in Judea, particularly the Jewish friends of Lazarus’ family. It does not refer to the Jewish leaders or those Jews who opposed Jesus. See the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:19 (#3)

τοῦ ἀδελφοῦ

“their brother”

See how you translated **brother** in 11:2.

See: Kinship

John 11:20 (#1)

ἤκουσεν & Ἰησοῦς ἔρχεται

“she heard, “Jesus is coming”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this statement as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [she heard that Jesus was coming]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 11:21 (#2)

ὁ ἀδελφός

“brother”

See how you translated **brother** in 11:2.

See: Kinship

John 11:21 (#1)

εἰ ἦς ὧδε, οὐκ ἂν ἀπέθανεν ὁ ἀδελφός μου

“if you were here, my brother would not have died”

Martha is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but she knows that the condition is not true. **Jesus** had not been there and her **brother** had **died**. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [if you had been here, but you were not, my brother would not have died, but he did]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 11:23 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:23 (#3)

ὁ ἀδελφός

“brother”

See how you translated **brother** in 11:2.

See: Kinship

John 11:23 (#2)

ἀναστήσεται ὁ ἀδελφός σου

“Your brother will rise again”

Here, **rise again** is an idiom that refers to a died person becoming **alive again**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your brother will become alive again]

See: Idiom

John 11:24 (#2)

ἀναστήσεται

“he will rise again”

See how you translated **rise again** in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 11:24 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:24 (#3)

ἐν τῇ ἀναστάσει

“in the resurrection”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **resurrection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when God resurrects people] or [when God brings people back from the dead]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 11:24 (#4)

ἐν τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

“on the last day”

Here, **the last day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, Jesus returns to earth, and the bodies of those who are dead are raised from their graves. (See: day of the Lord, day of Yahweh). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the day when God judges everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:25 (#3)

κἂν ἀποθάνῃ

“even if he dies”

Here, **dies** refers to physical death. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [even if his body dies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:25 (#2)

ἡ ζωή

“the life”

Here, **Jesus** calls himself **the life** in order to say that he is the one who gives people eternal **life**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the one who makes people live forever] or [the one who causes people to live forever]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:25 (#4)

ζήσεται

“will live”

Here, **live** refers to having eternal life. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [will have eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:25 (#1)

ἡ ἀνάστασις

“the resurrection”

Here, **Jesus** calls himself **the resurrection** in order to say that he is the one who causes dead people to come back to life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the one who resurrects dead people] or [the one who brings dead people back to life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:26 (#2)

οὐ μὴ ἀποθάνῃ εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

“may certainly not die into eternity”

Here, **die** refers to spiritual death, which is eternal punishment in hell that occurs after physical death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind this use of **die** explicitly. See

how you translated a similar phrase in 6:50. Alternate translation: [may certainly not die spiritually into eternity] or [may certainly not experience spiritual death into eternity]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:26 (#3)

οὐ μὴ ἀποθάνῃ εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα

"may certainly not die into eternity"

Jesus is using a figure of speech that expresses a strong positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [may certainly live into eternity]

See: Litotes

John 11:26 (#1)

πᾶς ὁ ζῶν

"everyone living"

Here, **living** refers to having eternal life, as "live" does in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [everyone who has eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:27 (#1)

λέγει

"She says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:27 (#2)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Son of God"

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 11:27 (#3)

ὁ εἰς τὸν κόσμον ἐρχόμενος

"coming into the world"

This phrase refers to a prophet the Jews were waiting for, based on God's promise to send **into the world** a prophet like Moses, which is recorded in Deuteronomy 18:15. If your readers will not be familiar with this Old Testament reference, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [whom God said he would send into the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:28 (#1)

τὴν ἀδελφὴν

"sister"

See how you translated **sister** in 11:5.

See: Kinship

John 11:28 (#2)

διδάσκαλος

"Teacher"

Here, **Teacher** refers to Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Teacher, Jesus,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:30 (#1)

οὔπω δὲ ἐληλύθει ὁ Ἰησοῦς εἰς τὴν κώμην

"Now Jesus had not yet come into the village"

John provides a brief break in the story to give background information regarding the location of Jesus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [At that time Jesus had not yet come into the village]

See: Background Information

John 11:31 (#2)

οἱ ὄντες μετ' αὐτῆς ἐν τῇ οἰκίᾳ καὶ παραμυθούμενοι αὐτήν

"being with her in the house and comforting her"

This phrase is making a distinction between **the Jews** who were **comforting Mary** in her **house** and those who were not doing so. It is not giving us further information about **the Jews**. If this might confuse your readers, you could make the relationship between these phrases more clear. Alternate translation: [the Jews, that is, those Jews who were with her in the house and comforting her]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

John 11:31 (#1)

οἱ & Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

See how you translated **the Jews** in 11:19.

John 11:32 (#1)

ἔπεσεν αὐτοῦ πρὸς τοὺς πόδας

“she fell down at his feet”

Here, **fell down** means that Mary voluntarily threw herself down on the ground in front of Jesus to show the respect that she had for him. The phrase does not mean that **Mary** involuntarily **fell down**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [she prostrated herself at his feet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:32 (#3)

Κύριε, εἰ ἦς ὧδε, οὐκ ἄν μου ἀπέθανεν ὁ ἀδελφός

“Lord, if you were here, my brother would not have died”

See how you translated this sentence in 11:21.

John 11:32 (#2)

ἔπεσεν αὐτοῦ πρὸς τοὺς πόδας, λέγουσα αὐτῷ

“she fell down at his feet, saying to him”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [she fell down at his feet and said to him]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 11:33 (#4)

ἐνεβριμήσατο τῷ πνεύματι

“he was deeply disturbed in the spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to Jesus’ **spirit**. It does not refer to the Holy Spirit. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he was deeply disturbed within himself] or [he was deeply disturbed inside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:33 (#1)

τοὺς & Ἰουδαίους

“the Jews”

See how you translated **the Jews** in 11:19.

John 11:33 (#3)

ἐνεβριμήσατο

“he was deeply disturbed”

The word translated as **deeply disturbed** could mean: (1) Jesus was experiencing very intense negative emotions, in which case the meaning would be similar to **troubled**. Alternate translation: [he was deeply moved]; (2) Jesus was angry or indignant, which is what the word means in other books in the Bible. Alternate translation: [he was outraged]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:33 (#2)

ἐνεβριμήσατο τῷ πνεύματι καὶ ἐτάραξεν ἑαυτόν

“he was deeply disturbed in the spirit and he troubled himself”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. John combines these phrases to express the intense emotional distress that Jesus was feeling. Alternate translation: [he was very upset]

See: Doublet

John 11:34 (#1)

ποῦ τεθείκατε αὐτόν

“Where have you laid him”

Jesus is referring to putting Lazarus’ dead body in a tomb as laying him down. This is a polite way of referring to something unpleasant and accurately describes the Jewish burial practice of laying a dead body on a table inside the tomb. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a different polite way of referring to this or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [Where have you entombed him?]

See: Euphemism

John 11:35 (#1)

ἐδάκρυσεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς

“Jesus wept”

The word translated as **wept** is different from the word used to describe the weeping of Mary and the Jews with her in 11:31–33. The word here just means to shed tears. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus cried] or [Jesus shed tears]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:36 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

See how you translated **the Jews** in 11:19.

John 11:37 (#1)

οὐκ ἐδύνατο οὗτος, ὁ ἀνοίξας τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τοῦ τυφλοῦ, ποιῆσαι ἵνα καὶ οὗτος μὴ ἀποθάνῃ

“Was this one, having opened the eyes of the blind man, not able to act so that this one also would not die”

Some of the Jews use the form of a question to express their surprise that Jesus did not heal Lazarus. This could mean: (1) they believed that Jesus loved Lazarus, but doubted his ability to heal him. Alternate translation: [He opened the eyes of the blind man, but he was not able to keep this man from dying.]; (2) they thought that Jesus did not really love Lazarus because he healed the blind man but not him. Alternate translation: [He could open the eyes of the blind man. So if he really loved this man, he surely would have healed him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 11:37 (#2)

ὁ ἀνοίξας τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τοῦ τυφλοῦ

“having opened the eyes of the blind man”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:14. Alternate translation: [who caused the blind man to see]

See: Metonymy

John 11:38 (#2)

ἦν δὲ σπήλαιον, καὶ λίθος ἐπέκειτο ἐπ’ αὐτῷ

“Now it was a cave, and a stone lay against it”

John provides a brief break in the story to describe the tomb where the people had entombed Lazarus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [The place Lazarus was entombed was a cave that had a stone laying against it.]

See: Background Information

John 11:38 (#1)

ἐμβριμώμενος ἐν ἑαυτῷ

“being deeply disturbed in himself”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 11:33.

John 11:39 (#3)

τεταρταῖος γάρ ἐστιν

“for it is four days”

This means that it has been **four days** since Lazarus **died**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for he has been dead for four days] or [for it has been four days since he died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:39 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει

“says & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:39 (#2)

ἡ ἀδελφὴ

“the sister”

Martha was Lazarus’ oldest **sister**. If your language uses different words for **sister** depending on birth order, use the word for a older or oldest **sister** here. Alternate translation: [the oldest sister]

See: Kinship

John 11:40 (#5)

τὴν δόξαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the glory of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God glorified] or [how glorious God is]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 11:40 (#4)

τὴν δόξαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the glory of God”

This could mean: (1) God receives the glory. Alternate translation: [the glorification of God]; (2) glory that comes from God. Alternate translation: [the glory from God]

See: Possession

John 11:40 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:40 (#2)

οὐκ εἶπόν σοι, ὅτι ἐὰν πιστεύσῃς, ὄψῃ τὴν δόξαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Did I not say to you that, if you believe, you will see the glory of God”

Jesus is using the form of a question to emphasize that God is about to do something wonderful. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I certainly said to you that, if you believe, you would see the glory of God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 11:40 (#3)

ἐὰν πιστεύσῃς

“if you believe”

Jesus is leaving out some words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [if you believe in me] or [if you believe that I am the Messiah]

See: Ellipsis

John 11:41 (#2)

Πάτερ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 11:41 (#1)

ὁ & Ἰησοῦς ἦρεν τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς ἄνω

“Jesus lifted up his eyes”

Here, “lifted up his eyes” is an idiom that means to look upward. See how you translated a similar phrase in 4:35.

See: Idiom

John 11:42 (#1)

τὸν ὄχλον τὸν περιεστῶτα

“the crowd that is standing around”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 11:44 (#1)

δεδεμένος τοὺς πόδας καὶ τὰς χεῖρας κειρίαις, καὶ ἡ ὄψις αὐτοῦ σουδαρίῳ περιεδέδετο

“his feet and hands having been bound with cloths, and his face having been bound with a cloth”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone having bound his feet and hands with cloths, and someone having bound his face with a cloth]

See: Active or Passive

John 11:44 (#3)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 11:44 (#2)

δεδεμένος τοὺς πόδας καὶ τὰς χεῖρας κειρίαις, καὶ ἡ ὄψις αὐτοῦ σουδαρίῳ περιεδέδετο

“his feet and hands having been bound with cloths, and his face having been bound with a cloth”

Wrapping a dead body in strips of **cloth** was the burial custom in this culture. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter. If your readers would not be familiar with such a custom, you could describe it more specifically, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [his feet and hands having been bound with burial cloths, and his face having been wrapped with a burial cloth] or [his feet, hands, and face having been wrapped in clothes for burial]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 11:45 (#1)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the Jews”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:19.

John 11:47 (#1)

Συνέδριον

“the Sanhedrin”

The **Sanhedrin** is the name of the highest ruling council of the Jews. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Sanhedrin, their ruling council]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:47 (#2)

Συνέδριον

“the Sanhedrin”

Sanhedrin is the name of a governing body.

See: How to Translate Names

John 11:47 (#5)

σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of signs in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 11:47 (#4)

οὗτος ὁ ἄνθρωπος

“this man”

The Jewish leaders say **this man** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:47 (#3)

τί ποιοῦμεν

“What will we do”

It is implied here that the council members are talking about Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [What are we going to do about Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:48 (#4)

τὸ ἔθνος

“nation”

Here, **nation** refers to all of the Jewish people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jewish nation] or [the people of our nation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:48 (#3)

καὶ ἀροῦσιν ἡμῶν καὶ τὸν τόπον

“and will take away both our place”

Here, **place** could mean: (1) the Jewish temple, as in the UST. (2) the city of Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [and will take away both our city, Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:48 (#1)

πάντες πιστεύσουσιν εἰς αὐτὸν

“all will believe in him”

The Jewish leaders were afraid that the people would try to make Jesus their king and rebel against the Roman government. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everyone will believe in him, make him king, and revolt against the Roman government]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:48 (#2)

ἐλεύσονται οἱ Ῥωμαῖοι

“the Romans will come”

The Jewish leaders use **the Romans** to refer to the Roman army. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Roman soldiers will come]

See: Synecdoche

John 11:49 (#1)

εἷς & τις ἐξ αὐτῶν, Καϊάφας

“one certain man among them, Caiaphas”

This phrase introduces **Caiaphas** as a new character in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character. Alternate translation: [there was a man among them named Caiaphas]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 11:49 (#2)

ὑμεῖς οὐκ οἴδατε οὐδέν

“You do not know anything”

Here, **Caiaphas** uses an exaggeration in order to insult his hearers. If this would confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language that shows contempt. Alternate translation: [You do not understand what is happening] or [You speak as though you know nothing]

See: Hyperbole

John 11:50 (#1)

καὶ μὴ ὅλον τὸ ἔθνος ἀπόληται

“and the whole nation would not perish”

Caiaphas implies that the Roman army would kill all of the people of the Jewish **nation** if Jesus is allowed to live and cause a rebellion. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the Romans would not kill all the people of our nation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:50 (#2)

καὶ μὴ ὅλον τὸ ἔθνος ἀπόληται

“and the whole nation would not perish”

Here, **nation** refers to all of the Jewish people. See how you translated this word in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [and all the people of our nation would not perish]

See: Synecdoche

John 11:51 (#3)

ἀποθνῄσκειν ὑπὲρ τοῦ ἔθνους

“to die for the nation”

See how you translated **nation** in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

John 11:51 (#2)

ἀλλὰ ἀρχιερεὺς ὢν τοῦ ἐνιαυτοῦ ἐκείνου

“but being high priest that year”

This clause indicates the reason why Caiaphas **prophesied** a true prophecy from God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because he was high priest that year]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 11:51 (#1)

ἀφ’ ἑαυτοῦ

“from himself”

Here, **from himself** could mean: (1) Caiaphas was speaking something he had thought of himself. Alternate translation: [on his own initiative]; (2) Caiaphas was speaking from his own authority, which is how the phrase is used in 5:19. Alternate translation: [on his own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:51–52 (#1)

In 11:51–52 John interrupts the story to explain that Caiaphas was prophesying even though he did not realize it at the time. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 11:52 (#1)

τοῦ ἔθνους

“the nation”

See how you translated **nation** in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

John 11:52 (#2)

τὰ τέκνα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the children of God”

John uses the word **children** to express the relationship between God and those who trust Jesus for salvation. That relationship is like the relationship between **children** and their father. See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to chapter 1. Since this is an important metaphor in the Bible, you should keep it in your translation. However, you can use a simile if it might confuse your readers. Alternate translation: [those who are like God’s children]

See: Metaphor

John 11:52 (#3)

ἵνα καὶ τὰ τέκνα τοῦ Θεοῦ, τὰ διεσκορπισμένα συναγάγῃ εἰς ἕν

“so that also the children of God having been scattered would be gathered together into one”

If your language does not use the passive voice, you could express the ideas of these two passive phrases in active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. You may need to change the sentence structure in order to do this. Alternate translation: [so that also Jesus would gather together into one the children of God whom God had scattered]

See: Active or Passive

John 11:52 (#4)

συναγάγῃ εἰς ἕν

"would be gathered together into one"

John is leaving out a word that some languages would need in order for the sentence to be complete. The word **people** is implied by the context. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [would be gathered into one people]

See: Ellipsis

John 11:53 (#2)

ἐβουλεύσαντο

"they plotted"

The word translated as **plotted** could mean: (1) the Jewish leaders made plans together for how to kill Jesus. Alternate translation: [they schemed]; (2) the Jewish leaders were determined to kill Jesus. Alternate translation: [they resolved]

John 11:53 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

John is telling his readers what the Jewish leaders did as a result of what Caiaphas said in 11:49–50. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 11:54 (#3)

τὴν χώραν

"the country"

Here, **country** could refer to: (1) an area of land. Alternate translation: [the area] or [the district]; (2) the rural area outside cities where fewer people live. Alternate translation: [the countryside] or [the rural area]

John 11:54 (#1)

παρρησίᾳ περιεπάτει ἐν τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"walked openly among the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** does not refer to the Jewish people in general. It could refer to: (1) the Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [among the Jewish authorities]; (2) the people living in Judea. Alternate translation: [among the Judeans]

See: Synecdoche

John 11:54 (#2)

παρρησίᾳ περιεπάτει ἐν τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"walked openly among the Jews"

John uses **walked openly** to mean "walked around where everyone could see him." If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [walked around where all the Jews could see him]

See: Metaphor

John 11:54 (#4)

κἀκεῖ ἔμεινεν μετὰ τῶν μαθητῶν

"There he stayed with the disciples"

Jesus and his disciples **stayed** in Ephraim for a short period of time. If your language requires a length of time for **stayed**, you can use a general expression. Alternate translation: [There he stayed with the disciples for a time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 11:55 (#2)

τῆς χώρας

"the country"

Here, **country** could refer to: (1) an area of land. Alternate translation: [the area] or [the district]; (2) the rural area outside cities where fewer people live. Alternate translation: [the countryside] or [the rural area]

John 11:55 (#1)

ἀνέβησαν & εἰς Ἱεροσόλυμα

"went up to Jerusalem"

The phrase **went up** is used here because Jerusalem is at a higher elevation than the surrounding areas. See how you translated **went up** in 7:10.

John 11:56 (#5)

ὅτι οὐ μὴ ἔλθῃ εἰς τὴν ἑορτήν

“That he may certainly not come to the festival”

The people are leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous sentence. Alternate translation: [Does it seem to you that he will come to the festival?]

See: Ellipsis

John 11:56 (#4)

ὅτι οὐ μὴ ἔλθῃ εἰς τὴν ἑορτήν

“That he may certainly not come to the festival”

The people are using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that they do not think Jesus will **come** to the **Passover** festival. The speakers here were wondering if Jesus would come to the festival since the Jewish leaders wanted to kill him. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [He will certainly not come to the festival!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 11:56 (#3)

τί δοκεῖ ὑμῖν

“What does it seem to you”

This is an idiom used to ask for someone’s opinion. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [What is your opinion]

See: Idiom

John 11:56 (#1)

ἐζήτουν & τὸν Ἰησοῦν

“they were looking for Jesus”

Here, **they** refers to the Jewish people who had traveled to Jerusalem before the Passover celebration, as described in the previous verse. If this use of **they** might be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people who came to Jerusalem before the Passover celebration were looking for Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 11:56 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“in the temple”

The people were standing in the courtyard of **the temple**. See how you translated **temple** in 8:14.

See: Synecdoche

John 11:56–57 (#1)

The event in 11:57 occurs before the event in this verse. If this order might confuse your readers, you can combine these verses and put the text of 11:57 before the text of this verse.

See: Order of Events

John 11:57 (#1)

δὲ οἱ ἀρχιερεῖς

“Now the chief priests”

This event occurs before that of the previous verse. If this order might confuse your readers, you can combine these verses and put the text of this verse before the text of 11:56. Another option would be to clearly state that this verse refers to an earlier event. Alternate translation: [Earlier, the chief priests]

See: Order of Events

John - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Mary pours perfume on Jesus (12:1–11)
2. Jesus enters Jerusalem (12:12–19)
3. Some Greeks come to Jesus (12:20–26)
4. Jesus predicts his death (12:27–36)
5. John explains the Jews’ rejection of Jesus (12:37–43)
6. Jesus says that he is God (12:44–50)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry sections in 12:38 and 40, which are quotations from the Old Testament.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Mary poured perfume on Jesus’ feet
The Jews would put oil on a person’s head to make that person feel welcome and comfortable. They would also put oil on a person’s body after the person had died but before they buried the body. However,

they would never think to put oil on a person's feet, because they thought that feet were dirty.

The donkey and the colt
Jesus rode into Jerusalem on an animal, which was a common practice for kings. The kings of Israel in the Old Testament rode on donkeys. So by riding on a donkey Jesus was showing that he was the king of Israel.

Glory
Scripture often speaks of God's glory as a great, brilliant light. When people see this light, they are afraid. In 12:16 John says that the glory of Jesus is his resurrection and possibly his return to heaven as well.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Light and darkness
In 12:35–36, 46, Jesus uses an extended metaphor in which light represents what is true and good, and darkness represents what is false and evil. He applies that light metaphor to himself in order to show that he is the embodiment of God's truth and goodness. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

Paradox
A paradox is a true statement that appears to describe something impossible. A paradox occurs in 12:25: "He who loves his life will lose it; but he who hates his life in this world will keep it for eternal life." But in 12:26 Jesus explains what it means to keep one's life for eternal life.

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" several times in this chapter. Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 12:1 (#2)

ἤγειρεν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"had raised from the dead"

Here, **raised** is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [had caused to live again]

See: Idiom

John 12:1 (#1)

οὖν & πρὸ ἓξ ἡμερῶν τοῦ Πάσχα

"Then, six days before the Passover"

John uses this phrase to mark the beginning of a new event. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later, six days before the Passover]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 12:2 (#1)

τῶν ἀνακειμένων

"the ones reclining to eat"

At a relaxed meal such as this one, it was the custom in this culture for host and guests to eat while lying down comfortably around a table that was close to the ground. You could translate this by using the expression in your language for the customary posture at a meal. Alternate translation: [those sitting down at the table to eat]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 12:3 (#2)

μύρου

"of perfumed oil"

Here, **perfumed oil** refers to a liquid made from the oils of pleasant-smelling plants and flowers. This **oil** was put on a person's skin or hair in order for that person to smell pleasant. If your readers would not be familiar with this **oil**, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [of scented liquid]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 12:3 (#4)

νάρδου πιστικῆς πολυτίμου

"of very precious pure nard"

The **perfumed oil** was made from the **oil** of a **nard** plant, which is sometimes called "spikenard." The **oil** is extracted from the roots of this plant. If your readers would not be familiar with **nard** plants, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [of very precious scented plants]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 12:3 (#1)

λίτραν μύρου

"a litra of perfumed oil"

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either

in the text or a footnote. A **litra** is about one third of a kilogram or three quarters of a pound. If your language does not measure liquids by weight, you may refer to its volume equivalent, which would be about half a liter. You might also refer to the container that could hold that amount. Alternate translation: [about half a liter of perfume] or [a one-half liter bottle of perfume]

See: Biblical Weight

John 12:3 (#3)

μύρου νάρδου πιστικῆς πολυτίμου

"of perfumed oil of very precious pure nard"

John is using **of** to describe **perfumed oil** that is made from **very precious pure nard**. If this use of the possessive **of** would be confusing in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [of perfumed oil made from very precious pure nard]

See: Possession

John 12:3 (#5)

ἡ δὲ οἰκία ἐπληρώθη ἐκ τῆς ὀσμῆς τοῦ μύρου

"Now the house was filled with the fragrance of the perfumed oil"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now the fragrance of the perfumed oil filled the house]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:4 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 12:5 (#1)

διὰ τί τοῦτο τὸ μύρον οὐκ ἐπράθη τριακοσίων δηναρίων, καὶ ἐδόθη πτωχοῖς

"For what reason was this perfumed oil not sold for 300 denarii and given to the poor"

Judas is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he thought the **perfumed oil** should not be poured on Jesus. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation, and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [This perfume could have been sold for 300 denarii and given to the poor!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 12:5 (#3)

πτωχοῖς

"to the poor"

Judas is using the adjective **poor** as a noun in order to describe a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [to people who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 12:5 (#2)

τριακοσίων δηναρίων

"for 300 denarii"

The word **denarii** is the plural form of "denarius." It was a denomination of money in the Roman Empire that was equivalent to one days' wages. Alternate translation: [for 300 days' wages]

See: Biblical Money

John 12:6 (#1)

In this verse John interrupts the story to explain why Judas made the statement in the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 12:6 (#3)

τῶν πτωχῶν

"the poor"

See how you translated **the poor** in the previous verse.

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 12:6 (#4)

ἀλλ' ὅτι κλέπτης ἦν

"but because he was a thief"

John is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [but he said this because he was a thief]

See: Ellipsis

John 12:6 (#5)

τὰ βαλλόμενα

“the things being put in it”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [what people gave him to put in it]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:6 (#2)

εἶπεν & τοῦτο, οὐχ ὅτι περὶ τῶν πτωχῶν ἔμελεν αὐτῷ, ἀλλ’ ὅτι κλέπτης ἦν

“he said this, not because it was a concern to him about the poor, but because he was a thief”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [he said this because he was a thief, not because it was a concern to him about the poor]

See: Information Structure

John 12:7 (#1)

ἄφες αὐτήν, ἵνα εἰς τὴν ἡμέραν τοῦ ἐνταφιασμοῦ μου, τηρήσῃ αὐτό

“Leave her alone so that she might have kept it for the day of my burial”

This could mean: (1) Jesus is stating the purpose for which Mary did not sell the perfume. In this case he would be leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. This translation would require supplying those words from Judas’ objection in 12:5 and making a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Leave her alone. She did not sell this perfumed oil so that she might keep it for the day of my burial]; (2) Jesus is giving the purpose for his command in the previous clause. In this case he would be implying that there was some leftover perfumed oil which Mary could later put on his dead body. Alternate translation: [Leave her alone so that she might keep it for the day of my burial]

See: Ellipsis

John 12:7 (#2)

ἄφες αὐτήν, ἵνα εἰς τὴν ἡμέραν τοῦ ἐνταφιασμοῦ μου, τηρήσῃ αὐτό

“Leave her alone so that she might have kept it for the day of my burial”

If Jesus is stating the reason why Mary had the perfume, then Jesus is implying that Mary’s actions can be understood as anticipating his death and **burial**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. You may need to add a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Leave her alone. She did not sell this perfumed oil so that she might keep it to prepare my body for burial, as she had just done]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:8 (#5)

ἐμὲ δὲ οὐ πάντοτε ἔχετε

“but you do not always have me”

Jesus implies that he will not always be with them, because he will die. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but I will not always be here with you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:8 (#4)

ἔχετε μεθ’ ἑαυτῶν & ἔχετε

“you & have & with you & you do & have”

In this verse every occurrence of **you** is plural and refers to the disciples and those who were with Jesus at the dinner.

See: Forms of You

John 12:8 (#3)

τοὺς πτωχοὺς

“the poor”

See how you translated **the poor** in the 12:6.

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 12:8 (#1)

τοὺς πτωχοὺς γὰρ πάντοτε ἔχετε μεθ’ ἑαυτῶν, ἐμὲ δὲ οὐ πάντοτε ἔχετε

“For you always have the poor with you, but you do not always have me”

Jesus’ statement in this verse implies that Mary acted properly by pouring the expensive perfume on him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She acted appropriately, because you always have the poor with you, but you do not always have me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:8 (#2)

τοὺς πτωχοὺς & πάντοτε ἔχετε μεθ' ἑαυτῶν

"you always have the poor with you"

Jesus implies that there will always be opportunities to help **the poor**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you always have the poor with you that you can help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:9 (#5)

ἤγειρεν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"he had raised from the dead"

See how you translated this phrase in 12:1.

See: Idiom

John 12:9 (#1)

οὖν

"Then"

Then is used here to mark a break in the main storyline. This break continues until the end of 12:11. In this verse John gives background information about a new group of people that has come to Bethany. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 12:9 (#2)

ὁ ὄχλος πολὺς

"a large crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:9 (#4)

ἐστιν

"he is"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 12:9 (#3)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to people from Judea. See the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [the Judeans]

See: Synecdoche

John 12:10 (#2)

καὶ τὸν Λάζαρον ἀποκτείνωσιν

"they might also put Lazarus to death"

Here, **also** implies that **the chief priests** want to kill **Lazarus** in addition to Jesus, whom they have already plotted to kill in 11:53. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they might put Lazarus to death in addition to Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:10 (#1)

ἐβουλεύσαντο

"plotted"

See how you translated **plotted** in 11:53.

John 12:11 (#1)

δι' αὐτὸν

"because of him"

This phrase implies that the fact that Lazarus was alive after he had been dead caused many **Jews** to believe in Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because Lazarus was alive after having died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:11 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"of the Jews"

See how you translated this phrase in 12:9.

John 12:11 (#3)

ὑπῆγον

"went away"

John uses **went away** to refer to the fact that **many of the Jews** stopped believing the teachings of the Jewish religious authorities and starting trusting Jesus instead. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [stopped listening to them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:12 (#2)

ὁ ὄχλος πολὺς

“the great crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:12 (#1)

τῇ ἐπαύριον

“On the next day”

John uses this phrase to mark the beginning of a new event. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [On the day after that happened,]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 12:12 (#3)

τὴν ἑορτήν

“the festival”

Here, **festival** refers to the Jewish Passover festival. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Passover festival]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:13 (#3)

ὡσαννά! εὐλογημένος ὁ ἐρχόμενος ἐν ὀνόματι Κυρίου, καὶ ὁ Βασιλεὺς τοῦ Ἰσραήλ

“Hosanna! Blessed {is} the one coming in the name of the Lord, even the King of Israel”

This sentence is a quotation from Psalm 118:25–26. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 12:13 (#2)

ἐκραύγαζον

“cried out”

This phrase introduces a quotation from the Old Testament book of Psalms (Psalm 118:25–26) which occurs next in the verse. The Jews recite Psalm 118 at the Passover festival to express their hope that the Messiah would come.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:13 (#1)

τὰ βαΐα τῶν φοινίκων

“the branches of the palm trees”

In that culture a **palm tree** branch was a symbol that represented the nation of Israel. Here, the people were waving these **branches** to express their belief that Jesus was the Messiah who would free Israel from Roman rule. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this use of **the branches of the palm trees** by stating the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the branches of the palm trees, which represented their hope to be freed from Roman rule]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:13 (#5)

ἐν ὀνόματι Κυρίου

“in the name of the Lord”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s power and authority. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the Lord’s authority] or [as God’s representative]

See: Metonymy

John 12:13 (#4)

ὡσαννά

“Hosanna”

Hosanna is the Greek pronunciation of an expression in the Hebrew language that means “Please save!” It is a quotation from part of Psalm 118:25. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Save us now!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:14 (#1)

In 12:14–16 John interrupts the story to give background information about how Jesus fulfilled an Old Testament prophecy about the Messiah riding on a **donkey**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 12:14 (#2)

εὑρὼν & ὁ Ἰησοῦς ὀνάριον, ἐκάθισεν ἐπ᾽ αὐτό

“Jesus, having found a young donkey, sat on it”

John implies that Jesus will ride the **donkey** into Jerusalem. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus, having found a young donkey, sat on it, riding it into the city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:14 (#3)

καθώς ἐστιν γεγραμμένον

“just as it is written”

This phrase introduces a combination of parts of various quotations from the Old Testament which occur in the next verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that John is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [just as the prophets wrote in the Old Testament] or [as it had been written in the scriptures]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:14 (#4)

καθώς ἐστιν γεγραμμένον

“just as it is written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as prophets wrote in the Scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:15 (#3)

πῶλον ὄνου

“a colt of a donkey”

A **colt** is a young male **donkey**.

John 12:15 (#1)

This verse is a combination of parts of various quotations from the Old Testament. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 12:15 (#2)

θυγάτηρ Σιών

“daughter of Zion”

Here, **daughter of Zion** is used to refer to the people who lived in Jerusalem. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you people of Jerusalem]

See: Metonymy

John 12:16 (#2)

ὅτε ἐδοξάσθη Ἰησοῦς

“when Jesus was glorified”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, John implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [when God glorified Jesus]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:16 (#1)

ταῦτα

“these things”

In this verse, **these things** refers to the words of the Old Testament prophecies that were quoted in the previous verse, which were fulfilled in the events described in 12:13–14. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [these words from the scriptures]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:16 (#3)

ἐδοξάσθη

“was glorified”

Here, **glorified** could refer to: (1) when Jesus became alive again after he was killed. Alternate translation: [when Jesus came back to life]; (2) when Jesus returned to heaven. Alternate translation: [when Jesus went back to heaven]; (3) both Jesus’ resurrection and return to heaven. Alternate translation: [when Jesus came back to life and went back to heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:16 (#4)

ταῦτα ἦν ἐπ᾽ αὐτῷ γεγραμμένα

“these things had been written about him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the prophets have written these things about him]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:17 (#3)

ἤγειρεν αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"raised him up from the dead"

See how you translated this phrase in 12:1.

John 12:17 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

"the crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:17 (#2)

ἐμαρτύρει & ὁ ὄχλος ὁ ὢν μετ' αὐτοῦ

"testified the crowd being with him"

Here, **the crowd** refers to the group of Jews who had seen Jesus raise Lazarus from the dead at Bethany in Chapter 11. This is a different **crowd** than the crowd mentioned in the next verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [one crowd testified that they had been with him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:18 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

"the crowd"

Here, **the crowd** refers to a group of people who were coming out of Jerusalem to see Jesus as he came. This is a different **crowd** than the crowd mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a second crowd]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:18 (#2)

τοῦτο αὐτὸν πεποιηκέναι τὸ σημεῖον

"he had done this sign"

This phrase refers to Jesus raising Lazarus from the dead, an event that was mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [he had done this sign, bringing a dead man back to life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:18 (#3)

τὸ σημεῖον

"sign"

See how you translated **sign** in 2:11. See also the discussion of signs in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracle]

John 12:19 (#3)

ὁ κόσμος

"the world"

Here, **world** refers to the people who lived in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every person in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 12:19 (#1)

θεωρεῖτε ὅτι οὐκ ὠφελεῖτε οὐδέν

"You see that you are accomplishing nothing"

The Pharisees imply here that it might be impossible to stop Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [It seems like we can do nothing to stop him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:19 (#2)

ἴδε, ὁ κόσμος ὀπίσω αὐτοῦ ἀπῆλθεν

"Behold, the world has gone after him"

The Pharisees use **the world** as an exaggeration to express their shock that so many people have come out to follow Jesus. If this would confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language that shows shock. Alternate translation: [Behold, it seems like everyone has gone after him]

See: Hyperbole

John 12:19 (#4)

ὀπίσω αὐτοῦ ἀπῆλθεν

“has gone after him”

Here, **gone after** means to follow Jesus and become his disciple. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has become his disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:20 (#1)

δὲ Ἕλληνές τινες

“Now certain Greeks”

This phrase marks the introduction of **certain Greeks** as new characters in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

John 12:20 (#5)

τῇ ἑορτῇ

“the festival”

This refers to the Jewish Passover **festival**. See how you translated this word in 12:12.

John 12:20 (#4)

ἵνα προσκυνήσωσιν ἐν τῇ ἑορτῇ

“so that they might worship at the festival”

John is leaving out a word that some languages would need in order a clause to be complete. If you language requires an object for the verb **worship**, you can supply it from the context. Alternate translation: [to worship God at the festival]

See: Ellipsis

John 12:20 (#3)

τῶν ἀναβαινόντων

“the ones going up”

The phrase **going up** is used specifically for the act of going to Jerusalem, which is a city at a higher elevation than the area around it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those going up to Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:20 (#2)

Ἕλληνές

“Greeks”

The term **Greeks** refers to non-Jewish people who lived in the Roman Empire. It does not refer only to people from the country of Greece or to people who speak the Greek language. (See: Greek, Grecian, Hellenist) You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Gentiles] or [non-Jews]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:21 (#3)

κύριε

“Sir”

Speaking to **Philip**, the Greeks called him **Sir** in order to show respect or politeness. (See: lord, Lord, master, sir)

John 12:21 (#1)

Βηθσαϊδὰ

“Bethsaida”

See how you translated **Bethsaida** in 1:44.

See: How to Translate Names

John 12:21 (#4)

θέλομεν τὸν Ἰησοῦν ἰδεῖν

“we want to see Jesus”

The Greeks are using a statement to make a request. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a more natural form for a request. Alternate translation: [may we see Jesus?] or [could you take us to see Jesus?]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 12:21 (#2)

ἠρώτων αὐτὸν λέγοντες

“asked him, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [asked him by saying]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:22 (#1)

λέγει τῷ Ἀνδρέᾳ

“speaks to Andrew”

Philip tells **Andrew** about the Greeks’ request to see **Jesus**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could

state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [relates to Andrew what the Greeks had said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:22 (#2)

ἔρχεται & καὶ λέγει & ἔρχεται & καὶ λέγουσιν

“goes and speaks & go and speak”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 12:22 (#3)

λέγουσιν τῷ Ἰησοῦ

“speak to Jesus”

Philip and **Andrew** tell **Jesus** about the Greeks’ request to see him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [speak to Jesus about what the Greeks had said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:23 (#1)

ἀποκρίνεται αὐτοῖς λέγων

“answers them, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [answered them by saying]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:23 (#3)

ἵνα δοξασθῇ ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“so that the Son of Man might be glorified”

Jesus refers to his upcoming death, resurrection, and return to heaven as the time when he would be **glorified**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [so that the Son of Man might be glorified through his death, resurrection, and ascension]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:23 (#5)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

See how you translated **the Son of Man** in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:23 (#6)

ἵνα δοξασθῇ ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“so that the Son of Man might be glorified”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who will do the action, Jesus implies that God will do it. Alternate translation: [so that God might glorify the Son of Man]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:23 (#2)

ἐλήλυθεν ἡ ὥρα

“The hour has come”

See the discussion of this in the introduction to Chapter 4 and see how you translated this phrase in 4:21.

See: Metonymy

John 12:23 (#4)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 12:24 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 12:24 (#2)

ἐὰν μὴ ὁ κόκκος τοῦ σίτου πεσὼν εἰς τὴν γῆν ἀποθάνῃ, αὐτὸς μόνος μένει; ἐὰν δὲ ἀποθάνῃ, πολὺν καρπὸν φέρει

“unless a grain of wheat, having fallen into the earth, dies, it remains by itself; but if it would die, it bears much fruit”

Jesus uses **a grain of wheat** to refer to himself. He speaks of the death of that **grain** to refer to his death, burial, and resurrection. He also uses **fruit** to refer to those people who will trust in him for salvation after

his resurrection. Just as a seed is planted and grows into a plant that will bear **much fruit**, so will many people trust in Jesus after he is killed, buried, and raised back to life. If this would confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am like a grain of wheat. Unless that grain of wheat, having fallen into the earth, dies, it remains by itself; but if it would die, it bears much fruit]

See: Metaphor

John 12:25 (#1)

ὁ φιλῶν τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ, ἀπολλύει αὐτήν

"The one loving his life loses it"

Here, **the one loving his life** refers to someone who thinks that his own physical life is more important than anything else. If this clause would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Whoever values his own life more than anything else will still die]

See: Idiom

John 12:25 (#2)

ὁ μισῶν τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ τούτῳ, εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον φυλάξει αὐτήν

"the one hating his life in this world will keep it for eternal life"

Here, **the one hating his life** refers to someone who values his own physical life less than he values being a disciple of Jesus. The word "hating" here does not refer to having negative feelings about one's life or despising oneself. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whoever values being my disciple more than he values his own life will keep it for eternal life]

See: Idiom

John 12:25 (#3)

εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

"for eternal life"

The phrase **eternal life** states the result of what precedes it. The **one hating his life** will **keep** that life, which will result in **eternal life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [and also gain eternal life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 12:26 (#2)

ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ, ἐκεῖ καὶ ὁ διάκονος ὁ ἐμὸς ἔσται

"where I am, there will my servant also be"

Jesus implies that those who serve him will be with him in heaven. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when I am in heaven, my servant will also be there with me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:26 (#1)

ἐμοὶ ἀκολουθείτω

"let him follow me"

In this context, to **follow** someone means to become that person's disciple. See how you translated a similar phrase in 1:43. Alternate translation: [let him follow me as my disciple]

See: Idiom

John 12:26 (#3)

ὁ Πατήρ

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 12:27 (#3)

τῆς ὥρας ταύτης & τὴν ὥραν ταύτην

"this hour & this hour"

In this verse **this hour** refers to the time when Jesus would suffer and die on the cross. See how you translated **hour** in 12:23.

See: Metonymy

John 12:27 (#2)

Πάτερ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 12:27 (#1)

τί εἴπω, Πάτερ, σῶσόν με ἐκ τῆς ὥρας ταύτης

"what might I say? 'Father, save me from this hour"

Jesus uses a rhetorical question to emphasize what he will not do. Although Jesus desires to avoid crucifixion,

he chooses to be obedient to God and let himself be killed. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I will not say, 'Father, save me from this hour!']

See: Rhetorical Question

John 12:27 (#4)

διὰ τοῦτο

"because of this"

Here, **this reason** refers to Jesus' suffering and death on the cross. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in order to suffer and die,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:28 (#2)

δόξασόν σου τὸ ὄνομα & καὶ ἐδόξασα & δοξάσω

"glorify your name & I have both glorified {it & I will glorify {it"

In this verse, **name** and **it** refer to God himself. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [glorify yourself ... I have both glorified myself ... I will glorify myself]

See: Metonymy

John 12:28 (#1)

Πάτερ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 12:28 (#3)

ἦλθεν & φωνὴ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"a voice came from heaven"

John refers to the sound of God's **voice** as if it were an object that **came from heaven**. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God spoke from heaven]

See: Metaphor

John 12:29 (#1)

ὁ & ὄχλος

"the crowd"

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:30 (#1)

οὐ & ἡ φωνὴ αὕτη γέγονεν

"This voice did not come"

Jesus refers to the sound of God's **voice** as if it were an object that came down from heaven (See: 12:28). If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God did not speak this]

See: Metonymy

John 12:31 (#2)

τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

"of this world"

Here, **this world** is used to refer to all the people in the **world**. See how you translated **world** in 1:29.

See: Metonymy

John 12:31 (#1)

νῦν κρίσις ἐστὶν τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

"Now is the judgment of this world"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Now God will judge this world]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 12:31 (#3)

νῦν ὁ ἄρχων τοῦ κόσμου τούτου ἐκβληθήσεται ἔξω

"Now will the ruler of this world be thrown out"

Here, **ruler of this world** refers to Satan. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Now Satan will be thrown out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:31 (#4)

νῦν ὁ ἄρχων τοῦ κόσμου τούτου ἐκβληθήσεται ἔξω

"Now will the ruler of this world be thrown out"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you

must state who will do the action, Jesus implies that God will do it. Alternate translation: [Now God will throw out the ruler of this world]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:32 (#1)

ὑψωθῶ ἐκ τῆς γῆς

“I am lifted up from the earth”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people lift me up from the earth]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:32 (#3)

πάντας ἑλκύσω πρὸς ἐμαυτόν

“will draw everyone to myself”

See how you translated “draws” in 6:44. Alternate translation: [will pull everyone to myself]

John 12:32 (#4)

πάντας ἑλκύσω πρὸς ἐμαυτόν

“will draw everyone to myself”

Here, **everyone** is an exaggeration that Jesus uses to refer to all people groups, both Jews and non-Jews. The context of non-Jewish people coming to see Jesus in 12:20 suggests this meaning. This clause does not mean that every individual person will believe in Jesus. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [will draw people from both Jews and non-Jews] or [will draw people, all people, Jews and non-Jews alike]

See: Hyperbole

John 12:32 (#2)

ἐὰν ὑψωθῶ ἐκ τῆς γῆς

“if I am lifted up from the earth”

Here, **lifted up from the earth** could refer to: (1) Jesus’ crucifixion only, in which case **earth** would refer to the ground. Alternate translation: [if I am lifted up from the ground on a cross]; (2) Jesus’ crucifixion and return to heaven, in which case **earth** refers to both the ground and the planet. See the discussion about double meaning in the Part 3 of the Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [if I am lifted up from the earth on a cross and then up to heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:33 (#1)

In this verse John explains the meaning of what Jesus said in the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 12:34 (#5)

τίς ἐστιν οὗτος ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“Who is this Son of Man”

This could mean: (1) they are asking to know the identity of **the Son of Man**. Alternate translation: [What is the identity of this Son of Man?]; (2) they are asking to know what Jesus means when he says, “Son of Man.” Alternate translation: [What kind of Son of Man are you talking about?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:34 (#1)

ὁ ὄχλος

“the crowd”

See how you translated **crowd** in 5:13.

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:34 (#4)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου & ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man & Son of Man”

See how you translated **the Son of Man** in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:34 (#2)

τοῦ νόμου

“the law”

The crowd is using the name of the first part of the Hebrew Scriptures, the law, to represent the entire Hebrew Scriptures in general. See how you translated this use of **the law** in 10:34. Alternate translation: [the Scriptures]

See: Synecdoche

John 12:34 (#3)

δεῖ ὑψωθῆναι τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“it is necessary for the Son of Man to be lifted up”

Here, the phrase **lifted up** means “crucified.” You could include this information if that would be helpful

to your readers. Alternate translation: [it is necessary for the Son of Man to be crucified]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:35 (#5)

σκοτία

"darkness"

Jesus uses **darkness** to refer to what is false and evil. See how you translated this term in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

John 12:35 (#3)

περιπατεῖτε

"Walk"

Jesus uses **Walk** to refer to how a person lives and behaves. He is telling the crowd to live and act according to the example that he has shown them while he has been with them. If this would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Behave righteously]

See: Metaphor

John 12:35 (#6)

ὁ περιπατῶν ἐν τῇ σκοτίᾳ

"the one walking in the darkness"

Jesus uses this phrase to refer to a person who lives a sinful life and behaves sinfully. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [the one who lives sinfully] or [the one who does not behave righteously]

See: Metaphor

John 12:35 (#4)

ἵνα μὴ σκοτία ὑμᾶς καταλάβῃ

"so that darkness might not overtake you"

Jesus uses **darkness** as though it were a person who could **overtake** someone. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [so that you do not act sinfully, as if the darkness of sin had taken control of you]

See: Personification

John 12:35 (#2)

τὸ φῶς ἐν ὑμῖν ἐστιν & ὡς τὸ φῶς ἔχετε

"The light will be with you & while you have the light"

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these phrases in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, the light, will be with you ... while you have me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 12:35 (#1)

τὸ φῶς ἐν ὑμῖν ἐστιν & ὡς τὸ φῶς ἔχετε

"The light will be with you & while you have the light"

Jesus uses **light** to refer to refer to himself. He is "the Light of the World" who reveals God's truth and goodness the way a **light** reveals a person's surroundings. See how you translated **light** in 8:12. Alternate translation: [The one who reveals God's truth and goodness will be with you ... while you have him]

See: Metaphor

John 12:36 (#1)

τὸ φῶς & εἰς τὸ φῶς

"the light & in the light"

Both occurrences of **the light** here refer to Jesus. See how you translated **light** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

John 12:36 (#2)

υἱοὶ φωτὸς

"sons of light"

Here, **sons of light** is an idiom that refers to people who live according to God's truth and goodness, which Jesus has revealed to them. Here, **sons** does not refer specifically to male children and **light** does not refer to Jesus. If this expression would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [people who share in God's truth and goodness]

See: Idiom

John 12:37 (#1)

σημεῖα

"signs"

See how you translated **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction

to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 12:37–43 (#1)

In 12:37–43 John interrupts the main storyline in order to explain how the Jewish people had fulfilled prophecies that had been spoken by the prophet Isaiah. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information for these verses.

See: Background Information

John 12:38 (#2)

ὁ λόγος Ἠσαΐου τοῦ προφήτου

“the word of Isaiah the prophet”

Here, **word** refers to the specific prophecy written down by Isaiah that is quoted in the second half of this verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this prophecy of Isaiah the prophet]

See: Metonymy

John 12:38 (#4)

Κύριε, τίς ἐπίστευσεν τῇ ἀκοῇ ἡμῶν? καὶ ὁ βραχίων Κυρίου τίνι ἀπεκαλύφθη

“Lord, who has believed our report, and to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed”

This sentence is a quotation from Isaiah 53:1. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 12:38 (#5)

Κύριε, τίς ἐπίστευσεν τῇ ἀκοῇ ἡμῶν? καὶ ὁ βραχίων Κυρίου τίνι ἀπεκαλύφθη

“Lord, who has believed our report, and to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed”

This quotation from Isaiah 53:1 contains two rhetorical questions to express the prophet’s dismay that the people do not believe his **report**. If you would not use rhetorical questions for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as two statements or exclamations and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Lord, no one has believed our message! It seems like the arm of the Lord has been revealed to no one!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 12:38 (#6)

ὁ βραχίων Κυρίου τίνι ἀπεκαλύφθη

“to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to whom has the Lord revealed his arm]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:38 (#1)

ἵνα ὁ λόγος Ἠσαΐου τοῦ προφήτου πληρωθῇ

“so that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in order to fulfill the word of Isaiah the prophet]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:38 (#7)

ὁ βραχίων Κυρίου

“the arm of the Lord”

John quotes **Isaiah** using **arm** to refer to the Lord’s power. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Lord’s power]

See: Metaphor

John 12:38 (#3)

ὃν εἶπεν

“in which he said”

This phrase introduces a quotation that occurs in the rest of this verse. The quotation is from the Old Testament book written by Isaiah the prophet (Isaiah 53:1). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that John is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [which Isaiah said in the Old Testament]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:39 (#1)

τοῦτο

“this”

Here, **this** refers to the reason for the Jews' unbelief. That reason is given in the quotation from **Isaiah** provided in the next verse. It does not refer back to the quotation from **Isaiah** in the previous verse.

John 12:39 (#2)

ὅτι πάλιν εἶπεν Ἡσαΐας

"for Isaiah had again said"

This phrase introduces a quotation from the Old Testament book written by **Isaiah** the prophet (Isaiah 6:10) which occurs in the next verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that John is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [for Isaiah had again said in the Old Testament] or [for according to Isaiah]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 12:40 (#7)

καὶ στραφῶσιν

"and might turn"

John quotes Isaiah using **turn** to mean "repent," which means to stop sinning and start obeying the Lord. If this might confuse your readers, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they would repent] or [and they would stop sinning and obey God]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#8)

καὶ ἰάσομαι αὐτούς

"and I will heal them"

John quotes Isaiah using **heal** to refer to forgiving people of their sins. It does not refer to physical healing. If this might confuse your readers, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I would forgive them]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#6)

νοήσωσιν τῇ καρδίᾳ

"might understand with their heart"

John quotes Isaiah using the phrase **understand with their heart** to refer to the Jewish people truly understanding something. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [might fully understand] or [might understand deep within themselves]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#5)

μὴ ἴδωσιν τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς

"they might not see with their eyes"

John quotes Isaiah using the phrase **see with their eyes** here to refer to people understanding something that they **see**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they might not see and perceive]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#2)

τετύφλωκεν αὐτῶν τοὺς ὀφθαλμούς

"He has blinded their eyes"

John quotes Isaiah using **blinded their eyes** to refer to causing people to not be able to understanding what they see. Although the Jews saw Jesus' many miracles, most of them did not understand that those miracles proved that Jesus was sent by God. If this use of **blinded** and **eyes** would confuse your readers, you could state the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [He has caused them to not be able to understand] or [He has made them like those who are blind]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#4)

αὐτῶν τὴν καρδίαν & τῇ καρδίᾳ

"their heart & with their heart"

Both occurrences of the singular noun **heart** in this verse refer to all of the hearts of the people as a group. If your language does not use singular nouns in that way, you can use a different expression. Alternate translation: [their hearts ... with their hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

John 12:40 (#3)

ἐπώρωσεν αὐτῶν τὴν καρδίαν

"he has hardened their heart"

John quotes Isaiah using the phrase **hardened their heart** to refer to causing the Jewish people to become stubborn. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he has made them stubborn]

See: Metaphor

John 12:40 (#1)

τετύφλωκεν αὐτῶν τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς καὶ ἐπώρωσεν αὐτῶν τὴν καρδίαν, ἵνα μὴ ἴδωσιν τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς καὶ νοήσωσιν τῇ καρδίᾳ, καὶ στραφῶσιν καὶ ἰάσομαι αὐτούς

"He has blinded their eyes, and he has hardened their heart; so that they might not see with their eyes and might understand with their heart, and might turn, and I will heal them"

This verse is a quotation from Isaiah 6:10. It is a prophecy that God told Isaiah to speak against the Jewish people because they kept rejecting God. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 12:41 (#1)

τὴν δόξαν αὐτοῦ

"his glory"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how glorious he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 12:42 (#3)

μὴ ἀποσυνάγωγοι γένωνται

"they would not be put out of the synagogue"

John uses **put out of the synagogue** to refer to no longer being allowed to go into the synagogue and no longer belonging to the group of people who attended services at the synagogue. When people were put out of the synagogue, they were shunned by their local community. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they would not be allowed to enter the synagogue] or [they would no longer belong to the synagogue community]

See: Metaphor

John 12:42 (#2)

ἵνα μὴ ἀποσυνάγωγοι γένωνται

"so that they would not be put out of the synagogue"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that the Pharisees would not ban them from the synagogue]

See: Active or Passive

John 12:42 (#1)

τῶν ἀρχόντων

"the rulers"

Here, **rulers** refers to the Jewish religious leadership, specifically the Jewish council called the Sanhedrin, which made decisions about Jewish law. (See: council) See how you translated **rulers** in 3:1. Alternate translation: [the members of the Jewish ruling council]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:43 (#3)

τὴν δόξαν τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"the glory of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, John is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both **men** and women. Alternate translation: [the glory of people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 12:43 (#2)

τὴν δόξαν τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"the glory of men"

John is using **of** to describe **glory** that is given by **men**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the glory that is given by men]

See: Possession

John 12:43 (#1)

ἠγάπησαν & τὴν δόξαν τῶν ἀνθρώπων μᾶλλον ἤπερ τὴν δόξαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"they loved the glory of men more than the glory of God"

Here, **loved** refers to preferring one thing over something else. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they preferred the glory of men more than the glory of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:43 (#4)

τὴν δόξαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the glory of God”

John is using **of** to describe **glory** that is given by **God**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the glory that is given by God]

See: Possession

John 12:44 (#3)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

“the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:44 (#2)

Ἰησοῦς & ἔκραξεν καὶ εἶπεν

“Jesus cried out and said”

John uses **cried out** to imply that Jesus was speaking loudly to a crowd of people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus cried out and said to a crowd]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:44 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Now here introduces a new event that happened at some time after the events in 12:20–36. The story does not say how long after the previous events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [At another time]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 12:45 (#1)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

“the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:46 (#3)

ἐν τῇ σκοτίᾳ μὴ μείνῃ

“might not remain in the darkness”

Jesus uses **darkness** to refer to what is false and evil. See how you translated **darkness** in 12:35 and also see the discussion of **light** and **darkness** in the introduction for Chapter 1. Alternate translation: [might not remain in sin and evil]

See: Metaphor

John 12:46 (#1)

ἐγὼ φῶς εἰς τὸν κόσμον ἐλήλυθα

“I have come {as} a light to the world”

Jesus uses **light** to refer to himself. See how you translated **light** in 8:12. Alternate translation: [I have come as the one who reveals God’s truth and goodness to the world]

See: Metaphor

John 12:46 (#2)

εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“to the world”

Here, **world** refers to the people who live in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the people living in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 12:47 (#2)

καὶ μὴ φυλάξῃ

“but does not keep {them”

Here, **keep** means to obey. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but does not obey them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:47 (#4)

τὸν κόσμον

“the world”

See how you translated **the world** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

John 12:47 (#1)

μου & τῶν ῥημάτων

“my words”

Here, **words** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my message] or [what I say]

See: Metonymy

John 12:47 (#3)

ἐγὼ οὐ κρίνω αὐτόν & ἵνα κρίνω τὸν κόσμον

"I do not judge him & so that I might judge the world"

In this verse, the word **judge** implies condemnation. Jesus did not come to condemn people to be eternally punished in hell. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I do not condemn him ... so that I might condemn the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:48 (#2)

τὸν κρίνοντα & κρινεῖ

"one judging & will judge"

See how you translated this **judge** in the previous verse.

John 12:48 (#4)

ἐν τῇ ἐσχάτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

"on the last day"

See how you translated this phrase in 6:39.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:48 (#1)

τὰ ῥήματά μου

"my words"

See how you translated **my words** in the previous verse.

John 12:48 (#3)

τὸν κρίνοντα αὐτόν; ὁ λόγος ὃν ἐλάλησα, ἐκεῖνος κρινεῖ αὐτὸν

"one judging him. The word which I have spoken, this will judge him"

Jesus refers to his **word** as though it were a person who could judge someone. He means that his teachings will be used as the criterion by which God will judge those who have rejected Jesus. If this might be confusing to your readers, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one by which he will be judged. The word which I have spoken, this will be the standard by which you will be judged]

See: Personification

John 12:49 (#2)

ὁ & Πατὴρ

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 12:49 (#3)

τί εἴπω, καὶ τί λαλήσω

"what I should say and what I should speak"

Here, **what I should speak** could refer to: (1) the manner in which Jesus **should speak**. Alternate translation: [what I should say and the manner in which I should say it]; (2) the same meaning as **what I should say**, in which case the two phrases would be a doublet used for emphasis and could be combined into one clause. Alternate translation: [exactly what I should say]

See: Doublet

John 12:49 (#1)

ἐξ ἐμαυτοῦ

"from myself"

Here, **from** is used to indicate the source of what Jesus spoke. See how you translated this phrase in 7:17. Alternate translation: [by my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:50 (#2)

ἡ ἐντολὴ αὐτοῦ ζωὴ αἰώνιός ἐστιν

"his command is eternal life"

This phrase means that what God commanded Jesus to say gives **eternal life** to those who believe it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [his command gives eternal life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 12:50 (#1)

οἶδα, ὅτι ἡ ἐντολὴ αὐτοῦ

"I know that his command"

Here, **his command** refers to the teachings that God commanded Jesus to speak, as mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I know that what he commanded me to speak]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. The Passover meal begins: Jesus washes his disciples' feet (13:1–20)
2. Jesus predicts that Judas will betray him (13:21–30)
3. Jesus commands his disciples to love each other (13:31–35)
4. Jesus predicts that Peter will deny him (13:36–38)

The events of this chapter are commonly referred to as the "Last Supper." In many ways this Passover meal parallels the sacrifice of Jesus as the lamb of God. (See: Lord's Supper; and Passover)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The washing of feet
People in the Ancient Near East thought that feet were very dirty. Only servants would wash people's feet. The disciples did not want Jesus to wash their feet, because they considered him to be their master and themselves to be his servants, and it was a servant's job to wash the feet of master and guests. However, Jesus wanted to show them that his disciples need to humbly serve and love each other. (See: Symbolic Action)

I AM
John records Jesus saying these words as an independent phrase one time in this chapter (13:19). They stand alone as a complete sentence, and they literally translate the Hebrew expression "I AM," by which Yahweh identified himself to Moses in Exodus 3:14. For these reasons many people believe that when Jesus said these words he was claiming to be Yahweh. (See: Yahweh, Yah).

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"The disciple whom Jesus loved"
The Apostle John first referred to himself as the disciple "whom Jesus loved" in this chapter (13:23). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. If this is the case, then you will need to add a first person pronoun to these references and the other references to John in (13:23–25). If your language can retain the third person references, then you may still want to make these references to John explicit by adding "John" next to them. See the discussion of this in Part 1 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: John (the apostle); and First, Second or Third Person)

"Son of Man"
Jesus refers to himself as the "Son of Man" in this chapter (13:31). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. See the discussion of this concept in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: Son of Man, son of man; and First, Second or Third Person)

John 13:1 (#1)

ἦλθεν αὐτοῦ ἡ ὥρα

"his hour had come"

Here, the word **hour** is used to refer to the time God had planned for Jesus to be arrested and killed. See how you translated this word in 7:30. Alternate translation: [the right time to arrest him had come]

See: Metonymy

John 13:1 (#2)

Πατέρα

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 13:1 (#4)

εἰς τέλος ἠγάπησεν αὐτούς

"he loved them to the end"

Here, **to the end** could mean: (1) **to the end** of Jesus' life. If you use this meaning, make sure that you do not translate this phrase in a way that could imply that Jesus did not continue to love them after his death. Alternate translation: [he loved them to the time of his death]; (2) utterly or completely. Alternate translation: [he loved them to the uttermost]

See: Idiom

John 13:1 (#3)

τοὺς ἰδίους & ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ

"his own in the world"

This phrase refers to Jesus' disciples. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly.

Alternate translation: [his own disciples who were with him in the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:1–4 (#1)

It is not yet **Passover**, and **Jesus** is with his disciples for the evening meal. 13:1–4 explain the setting of the story and give background information about Jesus and Judas. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 13:2 (#2)

Ἰούδας, Σίμωνος Ἰσκαριώτης

“of Judas, {son} of Simon Iscariot”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:71.

See: How to Translate Names

John 13:2 (#1)

τοῦ διαβόλου ἤδη βεβληκότος εἰς τὴν καρδίαν, ἵνα παραδοῖ αὐτὸν Ἰούδας, Σίμωνος Ἰσκαριώτης

“the devil having already put into the heart of Judas, {son} of Simon Iscariot, so that he might betray him”

Here, **put into the heart** is an idiom that means to cause someone to think about something. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the devil had already caused Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon, to think about betraying Jesus]

See: Idiom

John 13:3 (#1)

εἰδὼς

“knowing”

Here, the word **knowing** could mean: (1) the rest of this verse is the reason why Jesus did the result that John describes in the next verse. Alternate translation: [because he knew]; (2) this verse provides a contrast between who Jesus is and what he would do in the next verse. Alternate translation: [although he knew]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 13:3 (#2)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 13:3 (#3)

εἰς τὰς χεῖρας

“into his hands”

John uses **hands** to refer to power and authority. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into his power]

See: Metonymy

John 13:4 (#3)

τίθησιν τὰ ἱμάτια

“takes off his outer clothing”

Here, **outer clothing** refers to clothing that is worn over undergarments. It does not refer to a coat that would be worn over a person’s regular clothing. Use the term in your language for the regular clothing that people wear on top of their underwear.

John 13:4 (#1)

ἐγείρεται & τίθησιν

“he gets up & takes off”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:4 (#4)

λαβὼν λέντιον

“having taken a towel”

Here, **towel** refers to piece of cloth that is long enough to wrap around Jesus’ waist and still has enough left-over cloth to wipe the disciples’ feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [having taken a long towel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:4 (#2)

ἐγείρεται ἐκ τοῦ δείπνου

“he gets up from supper”

During Jesus’ time, people would often eat meals while lying on their sides on low couches next to the table. Here, **gets up** means that Jesus went from lying on his side on a couch next to the table where he was

eating **supper** to standing up. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he gets up from the table where he was eating supper]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:5 (#2)

ᾧ ἦν διεζωσμένος

"that was tied around himself"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that he had tied around himself]

See: Active or Passive

John 13:5 (#1)

βάλλει

"he pours"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:6 (#1)

ἔρχεται & λέγει

"he comes & He says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:6 (#2)

Κύριε, σύ μου νίπτεις τοὺς πόδας

"Lord, do you wash my feet"

Peter is using a rhetorical question here to show that he does not want Jesus to wash his feet. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Lord, it is not right for you to wash my feet!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 13:7 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

"after these things"

Here, **these things** refers to Jesus' crucifixion and resurrection. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after the events that are about to take place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:8 (#2)

ἐὰν μὴ νίψω σε, οὐκ ἔχεις μέρος μετ' ἐμοῦ

"If I do not wash you, you have no share with me"

Jesus uses two negative statements to convince **Peter** to allow him to **wash** his **feet**. If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [I must wash you so that you can have a share with me]

See: Double Negatives

John 13:8 (#3)

ἐὰν μὴ νίψω σε, οὐκ ἔχεις μέρος μετ' ἐμοῦ

"If I do not wash you, you have no share with me"

Jesus' use of **no share with me** could imply: (1) that Peter must let him wash his feet if he wants to receive his **share** of the inheritance that God promised to give his people. Alternate translation: [If I do not wash you, you will not share in God's promised inheritance with me]; (2) that Peter must let him wash his feet if he wants to continue being his disciple. Alternate translation: [If I do not wash you, you will no longer be my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:8 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:9 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:9 (#2)

μὴ τοὺς πόδας μου μόνον

“not only my feet”

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [wash not only my feet]

See: Ellipsis

John 13:10 (#2)

ὁ λελουμένος οὐκ ἔχει χρείαν, εἰ μὴ τοὺς πόδας νίψασθαι

“The one that has been washed has no need, except to wash his feet”

In this verse, Jesus uses **washed** to refer to God forgiving a person for their sins. He also uses **feet** to refer to daily sins, because people in Jesus’ culture had to wash their **feet** frequently due to wearing sandals while walking on dusty, dirty roads. If this might confuse your readers, you could state their meanings clearly or use similes. Alternate translation: [The one who has received God’s forgiveness for their sins, only needs to be forgiven for his daily sins]

See: Metaphor

John 13:10 (#5)

ὑμεῖς

“you”

Here Jesus uses the word **you** to refer to all of his disciples, not only Peter. Use a plural form of **you** if your language distinguishes between singular and plural **you**.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

John 13:10 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:10 (#4)

ἀλλ’ ἔστιν καθαρὸς ὅλος; καὶ ὑμεῖς καθαροί ἐστε

“but he is completely clean, and you are clean”

In this verse, Jesus uses **clean** to refer to someone who has been forgiven for their sins. If this might be confusing in your language, you could state its meaning clearly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but he has been completely forgiven for his sins, and you have been forgiven]

See: Metaphor

John 13:10 (#3)

ὁ λελουμένος

“The one that has been washed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The one who someone has washed]

See: Active or Passive

John 13:11 (#1)

Here John interrupts the story to give the reason why Jesus made his comment in the end of the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 13:11 (#2)

οὐχὶ πάντες καθαροί ἐστε

“Not all are clean”

See how you translated **clean** in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Not all of you have received God’s forgiveness]

See: Metaphor

John 13:12 (#1)

γινώσκετε τί πεποίηκα ὑμῖν

“Do you understand what I have done for you”

Jesus is using a question to emphasize the importance of what he is teaching his disciples. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You need to understand what I have done for you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 13:13 (#1)

ὑμεῖς φωνεῖτέ με ὁ Διδάσκαλος καὶ, ὁ Κύριος

“You call me ‘The Teacher’ and ‘The Lord”

Jesus implies that his disciples have great respect for him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [You show me great respect when you call me ‘Teacher’ and ‘Lord.’]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:14 (#1)

εἰ οὖν ἐγὼ ἔνιψα ὑμῶν τοὺς πόδας, ὁ Κύριος καὶ ὁ Διδάσκαλος

“If I then, the Lord and the Teacher, have washed your feet”

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [If I then, the Lord and the Teacher, have washed your feet, and I have]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 13:15 (#1)

καθὼς ἐγὼ ἐποίησα ὑμῖν, καὶ ὑμεῖς ποιῆτε

“you also would do just as I did to you”

Jesus is using a statement to give an instruction. Jesus is telling his disciples to follow his example and serve one another. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a more natural form for instruction. Alternate translation: [you also must do just as I did to you]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 13:16 (#3)

οὐκ ἔστιν δοῦλος μείζων τοῦ κυρίου αὐτοῦ, οὐδὲ ἀπόστολος μείζων τοῦ πέμψαντος αὐτόν

“a slave is not greater than his master, nor {is} a messenger greater than the one having sent him”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that Jesus’ disciples are not more important than him, so they should humbly serve each other. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [none of you are greater than me]

See: Doublet

John 13:16 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 13:16 (#5)

οὐδὲ ἀπόστολος μείζων τοῦ πέμψαντος αὐτόν

“nor {is} a messenger greater than the one having sent him”

Jesus uses **messenger** and **the one who sent him** to refer to his disciples and himself, respectively. He is telling his disciples that they should humbly serve each other because they are not more important than him, and he has humbly served them. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express Jesus’ meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you are not greater than me]

See: Metaphor

John 13:16 (#2)

οὐκ ἔστιν δοῦλος μείζων τοῦ κυρίου αὐτοῦ, οὐδὲ ἀπόστολος μείζων τοῦ πέμψαντος αὐτόν

“a slave is not greater than his master, nor {is} a messenger greater than the one having sent him”

Here, **greater** means to be more important or deserving of more respect than another person. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a slave is not respected more than his master, nor is a messenger respected more than the one who sent him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:16 (#4)

οὐκ ἔστιν δοῦλος μείζων τοῦ κυρίου αὐτοῦ

“a slave is not greater than his master”

Jesus uses the words **slave** and **master** to refer to his disciples and himself, respectively. He is telling his disciples that they should humbly serve each other because they are not more important than him, and he has humbly served them. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express Jesus’

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are not greater than me]

See: Metaphor

John 13:17 (#1)

εἰ ταῦτα οἴδατε

"If you know these things"

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [If you know these things, which you do,]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 13:17 (#2)

μακάριοί ἐστε

"you are blessed"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Jesus implies that God did it. See the UST.

See: Active or Passive

John 13:18 (#4)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

"so that the scripture might be fulfilled"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this is in order to fulfill the scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 13:18 (#6)

ὁ τρώγων μετ' ἐμοῦ τὸν ἄρτον, ἐπῆρεν ἐπ' ἐμὲ τὴν πτέρναν αὐτοῦ

"The one eating bread with me lifted up his heel against me"

This sentence is a quotation from Psalm 41:9. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 13:18 (#7)

ὁ τρώγων μετ' ἐμοῦ τὸν ἄρτον, ἐπῆρεν ἐπ' ἐμὲ τὴν πτέρναν αὐτοῦ

"The one eating bread with me lifted up his heel against me"

The phrase, **The one eating bread with me**, here is an idiom that refers to someone who acts like a friend would act. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [The one who has acted like he is my friend]

See: Idiom

John 13:18 (#5)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

"so that the scripture might be fulfilled"

Jesus uses **that the scripture might be fulfilled** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 41:9). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [so that what is written in the Psalms might be fulfilled]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 13:18 (#8)

ἐπῆρεν ἐπ' ἐμὲ τὴν πτέρναν αὐτοῦ

"lifted up his heel against me"

Here, **lifted up his heel** is an idiom that refers to someone who has become an enemy. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [has turned against me] or [has become my enemy]

See: Idiom

John 13:18 (#1)

οὐ περὶ πάντων ὑμῶν λέγω

"I am not speaking about all of you"

Jesus is referring back to what he just said in the previous verse. He means that not all of those to whom he is speaking will be blessed for serving each other, because one of them, Judas Iscariot, will betray him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am

not speaking this about all of you] or [I am not saying that God will bless all of you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:18 (#2)

ἐγὼ οἶδα τίνας ἐξελεξάμην

"I know whom I have chosen"

Jesus states that he knew the character of every person he chose to be his disciple. Therefore, he knew Judas would betray him when he chose him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I know exactly the kind of men I have chosen to be my disciples]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:18 (#3)

ἀλλ' ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

"but so that the scripture might be fulfilled"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [but I chose one who will betray me so that the scripture might be fulfilled]

See: Ellipsis

John 13:19 (#1)

ἀπ' ἄρτι λέγω ὑμῖν

"From this moment I tell you"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context, as modeled by the UST.

See: Ellipsis

John 13:19 (#2)

ἐγώ εἰμι

"I am"

See how you translated **I am** in 8:24, and also see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction for Chapter 8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:20 (#3)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

"the one having sent me"

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:20 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 13:20 (#2)

ὁ λαμβάνων & λαμβάνει & λαμβάνων, λαμβάνει

"the one receiving & receives & receiving & receives"

In this verse, **receiving** and **receives** mean to accept or welcome a person into one's presence with friendliness. See how you translated this word in 1:12.

See: Doublet

John 13:21 (#1)

ἐταράχθη τῷ πνεύματι

"was troubled in spirit"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 11:33.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:21 (#2)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

"Truly, truly, I say to you"

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 13:23 (#2)

ἀνακείμενος

"reclining to eat"

During Jesus' time, people would often eat meals while lying on their sides on low couches next to a table. If your readers would not be familiar with this meal practice, you could use a general expression for sitting to have a meal. Alternate translation: [seated at the table]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 13:23 (#1)

εἷς ἐκ τῶν μαθητῶν αὐτοῦ & ὃν ἠγάπα ὁ Ἰησοῦς

“one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved”

This phrase refers to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 1 of the Introduction to the Gospel of John and the discussion in the introduction for this chapter. If this phrase would be confusing to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [I, one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved] or [John, one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:23 (#3)

ἐν τῷ κόλπῳ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

“against the chest of Jesus”

In Jesus’ culture, lying with one’s head **against** the side of another person when having a meal was considered to be a sign that the two people had a very close friendship. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [closely beside Jesus as a close friend]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:24 (#1)

τούτῳ

“to this one”

Here, **this one** refers to John, who calls himself the disciple “whom Jesus loved” in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the disciple whom Jesus loved] or [to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:25 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

13:28 indicates that the disciples did not know why Jesus spoke to Judas in the way he did. This means that they must not have heard the conversation in this verse and the next, because John and Jesus were speaking quietly. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [said in a quite voice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:25 (#3)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:25 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος & λέγει

“that one says”

Here, **that one** refers to John, who calls himself the disciple “whom Jesus loved” in 13:23. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [that disciple whom Jesus loved says] or [I say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:26 (#1)

Ἰούδᾳ Σίμωνος Ἰσκαριώτῃ

“to Judas, {son} of Simon Iscariot”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:71.

See: How to Translate Names

John 13:27 (#1)

καὶ μετὰ τὸ ψωμίον

“And after the bread”

John is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [And after Judas took the bread]

See: Ellipsis

John 13:27 (#3)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:27 (#2)

τότε εἰσῆλθεν εἰς ἐκεῖνον ὁ Σατανᾶς

“Satan then entered into him”

Here, **entered into** is an idiom that means that **Satan** took control of Judas. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [Satan then started to command Judas]

See: Idiom

John 13:28 (#2)

τῶν ἀνακειμένων

"of the ones reclining to eat"

See how you translated **reclining to eat** in 13:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:28 (#1)

In 13:28–29 John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide background information about the disciples' confusion. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 13:29 (#3)

τοῖς πτωχοῖς ἵνα τι δῷ

"so that he might give something to the poor"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [Give something to the poor]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 13:29 (#2)

ἑορτήν

"festival"

Here, **festival** refers to the Jewish Passover festival. See how you translated this word in 12:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:29 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:30 (#1)

ἦν δὲ νύξ

"Now it was night"

In this sentence John provides background information about the time of day when Judas **went out** to betray Jesus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 13:31 (#6)

ὁ Θεὸς ἐδοξάσθη ἐν αὐτῷ

"God has been glorified in him"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will glorify God]

See: Active or Passive

John 13:31 (#3)

νῦν ἐδοξάσθη ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"Now the Son of Man has been glorified"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Jesus implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [Now God will glorify the Son of Man]

See: Active or Passive

John 13:31 (#4)

ἐδοξάσθη ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man has been glorified"

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, the Son of Man, have been glorified]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 13:31 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:31 (#5)

ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

"the Son of Man"

See how you translated **the Son of Man** in 1:51.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 13:31 (#2)

νῦν ἐδοξάσθη ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου, καὶ ὁ Θεὸς ἐδοξάσθη ἐν αὐτῷ

"Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him"

In this verse, Jesus twice uses the past tense **has been glorified** in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If this is confusing in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [Now the Son of Man will be glorified, and God will be glorified in him]

See: Predictive Past

John 13:32 (#1)

In some Bibles, this verse begins with the clause, "If God has been glorified in him". However, these words are not in most of the oldest ancient manuscripts. Nevertheless, if a translation of the Bible already exists in your region, consider using whichever reading is found in that version. If a translation does not already exist, we recommend that you follow the reading in the ULT text.

See: Textual Variants

John 13:32 (#2)

αὐτὸν & αὐτόν

"him & him"

Both occurrences of the pronoun **him** refer to the Son of Man, Jesus. If this use of **him** would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Son of Man ... the Son]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 13:32 (#3)

ὁ Θεὸς δοξάσει αὐτὸν ἐν αὐτῷ

"God will glorify him in himself"

The word **himself** here refers to God and is used to emphasize that God is the one who would **glorify** Jesus. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [God himself will glorify him]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

John 13:33 (#4)

ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω, ὑμεῖς οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν

"Where I go, you are not able to come"

See how you translated this sentence in 8:21.

See: Information Structure

John 13:33 (#3)

καὶ καθὼς εἶπον τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις & ὅπου ἐγὼ ὑπάγω, ὑμεῖς οὐ δύνασθε ἐλθεῖν, καὶ ὑμῖν λέγω ἄρτι

"and just as I said to the Jews, 'Where I go, you are not able to come.' Now I also say this to you"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [and just as I said to the Jews, now I also say this to you, 'Where I go, you are not able to come]

See: Information Structure

John 13:33 (#1)

τεκνία

"Little children"

Jesus is using the phrase **Little children** to describe the disciples to whom he is speaking. He loves them as if they were his own children. If this might confuse your readers, you could translate this plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [You dear disciples who are like children to me]

See: Metaphor

John 13:33 (#2)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"to the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 13:34 (#1)

καθὼς ἠγάπησα ὑμᾶς, ἵνα καὶ ὑμεῖς ἀγαπᾶτε ἀλλήλους

"just as I have loved you, so also you would love one another"

Jesus is using a future statement to give an instruction. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a more natural form for instruction. Alternate translation: [just as I have loved you, so also you must love one another]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 13:35 (#1)

πάντες

“everyone”

Jesus uses **everyone** as an exaggeration that refers only to those people who would see how the disciples loved each other. If this might confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression.

See: Hyperbole

John 13:36 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:37 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 13:37 (#2)

τὴν ψυχήν μου & θήσω

“I will lay down my life”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 10:11.

See: Euphemism

John 13:38 (#4)

οὐ μὴ ἀλέκτωρ φωνήσῃ, ἕως οὗ

“the rooster may certainly not crow before which”

Jesus is referring to a certain time of day. Roosters crow just before the sun appears in the morning. In other words, Jesus is referring to dawn. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before another morning begins]

See: Metonymy

John 13:38 (#1)

τὴν ψυχήν σου ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ θήσεις

“Will you lay down your life for me”

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. He knows that Peter is not really willing to **lay down** his life for Jesus. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You will certainly not lay down your life for me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 13:38 (#3)

οὐ μὴ ἀλέκτωρ φωνήσῃ, ἕως οὗ ἀρνήσῃ με τρίς

“the rooster may certainly not crow before which you will deny me three times”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this negative statement as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [you will surely deny me three times before the rooster crows]

John 13:38 (#5)

ἀλέκτωρ

“the rooster”

A **rooster** is a bird that calls out loudly around the time the sun comes up. If your readers would not be familiar with this bird, you could use the name of a bird in your area that calls out or sings just before dawn, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the bird that sings in the morning]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 13:38 (#2)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω σοι

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 13:38 (#6)

ἀλέκτωρ

“the rooster”

Jesus is not speaking of one particular **rooster** but of roosters in general. Alternate translation: [the roosters] or [the birds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus says he is the way to the Father (14:1–14)
2. Jesus promises that the Holy Spirit will come (14:15–31)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"My Father's house"
Jesus used these words to refer to heaven, where God dwells. It does not refer to any temple in Jerusalem or to a church building. (See: heaven, sky, heavens, heavenly)

The Holy Spirit
Jesus told his disciples that he would send the Holy Spirit to them. He called the Holy Spirit the Helper (14:16), who is always with God's people to help them and to speak to God for them. Jesus also called him the Spirit of Truth (14:17), who tells God's people what is true about God so they know him better and serve him well. (See: Holy Spirit, Spirit of God, Spirit of the Lord, Spirit)

John 14:1 (#3)

πιστεύετε εἰς τὸν Θεόν, καὶ εἰς ἐμὲ πιστεύετε

"Believe in God; believe also in me"

Both of these clauses could be: (1) commands, as in the UST. (2) statements. Alternate translation: [You believe in God; you also believe in me]

See: Statements — Other Uses

John 14:1 (#1)

In 14:1–7 the word "you" is always plural and refers to Jesus' disciples.

See: Forms of You

John 14:1 (#2)

μὴ ταρασσέσθω ὑμῶν ἡ καρδία

"Do not let your heart be troubled"

Jesus uses **heart** to represent the disciples' thoughts and emotions. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not let your thoughts be troubled]

See: Metaphor

John 14:2 (#2)

τοῦ Πατρός

"of & Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:2 (#3)

εἰ δὲ μή, εἶπον ἂν ὑμῖν, ὅτι πορεύομαι ἑτοιμάσαι τόπον ὑμῖν

"But if not, I would have told you, for I am going to prepare a place for you"

The word translated as **for** could also be translated as "that," in which case this sentence would be a question instead of a statement. With either interpretation the point of the sentence is the same: Jesus is emphasizing that what he has just said in the previous sentence is true. He is going to heaven **to prepare a place for** his people. Alternate translation: [But if not, would I have told you that I am going to prepare a place for you?]

John 14:2 (#1)

ἐν τῇ οἰκίᾳ τοῦ Πατρός μου

"In the house of my Father"

Jesus uses **house** to refer to heaven, which is the place where God dwells. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In the place where my Father dwells] or [In heaven where my Father dwells]

See: Metaphor

John 14:3 (#1)

ἐὰν πορευθῶ

"if I go"

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he knows that it will actually take place. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [when I go]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 14:4 (#1)

τὴν ὁδόν

"the way"

Jesus uses **the way**. This could refer to: (1) himself as the means by which people can go to God in heaven, which is clearly the meaning for **the way** in 14:6. (2) a manner of life that will eventually lead someone

to be with God in heaven. Since the disciples did not understand this when Jesus said it, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 14:5 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 14:5 (#2)

πῶς δυνάμεθα τὴν ὁδὸν εἰδέναι

"How are we able to know the way"

Thomas is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [We surely do not know the way!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 14:6 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 14:6 (#6)

Πατέρα

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:6 (#4)

ἡ ζωή

"the life"

Jesus uses **the life** to indicate that he is the means by which people can receive eternal **life**. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who makes people spiritually alive] or [the means by which one may receive eternal life]

See: Metaphor

John 14:6 (#3)

ἡ ἀλήθεια

"the truth"

Jesus uses **the truth** to indicate that he is the one who reveals God's truth to people. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who reveals God's truth] or [the means by which people can know God's truth]

See: Metaphor

John 14:6 (#2)

ἡ ὁδὸς

"the way"

Jesus uses **the way** to indicate that he is the means by which people can go to God, who is in heaven. Trusting in Jesus is the only way to have access to God. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who gives people access to the Father] or [the means by which one may come to the Father]

See: Metaphor

John 14:6 (#5)

οὐδεὶς ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα, εἰ μὴ δι' ἐμοῦ

"no one comes to the Father except through me"

Here, **through me** means that a person can come to God only by trusting Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [no one comes to the Father except by believing in me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:7 (#1)

εἰ ἐγνώκατε με

"If you have known me"

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement.

Alternate translation: [If you have known me, and you have known me]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 14:8 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 14:8 (#2)

Κύριε, δεῖξον ἡμῖν τὸν Πατέρα

"Lord, show us the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:9 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 14:9 (#4)

τὸν Πατέρα

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:9 (#5)

πῶς σὺ λέγεις, δεῖξον ἡμῖν τὸν Πατέρα

"How do you say, 'Show us the Father"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize what he is saying to Philip. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You really should not say, 'Show us the Father!']

See: Rhetorical Question

John 14:9 (#2)

τοσοῦτον χρόνον μεθ' ὑμῶν εἰμι, καὶ οὐκ ἔγνωκάς με, Φίλιππε

"So long a time I am with you, and you do not know me, Philip"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [So long a time I am with you, and you should know me, Philip!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 14:9 (#3)

ὑμῶν & ἔγνωκάς

"you & you do & know"

The first occurrence of **you** in this verse is plural, but the second occurrence is singular. Your language may require you to mark these forms.

See: Forms of You

John 14:10 (#2)

ἐγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρὶ, καὶ ὁ Πατὴρ ἐν ἐμοί ἐστιν

"I am in the Father, and the Father is in me"

See how you translated this expression in 10:38.

See: Idiom

John 14:10 (#1)

οὐ πιστεύεις ὅτι ἐγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρὶ, καὶ ὁ Πατὴρ ἐν ἐμοί ἐστιν

"Do you not believe that I am in the Father, and the Father is in me"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize what he is saying to Philip. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You really should believe that I am in the Father, and the Father is in me.]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 14:10 (#7)

τὰ ἔργα

"work"

See how you translated **work** in 7:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:10 (#3)

Πατρὶ & ὁ Πατὴρ & Πατὴρ

“Father & the Father & Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:10 (#6)

ἀπ’ ἐμαυτοῦ

“from myself”

See how you translated **from myself** in 5:30. Alternate translation: [on my own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:10 (#4)

τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἐγὼ λαλῶ ὑμῖν

“The words that I say to you”

Here, **you** is plural. Jesus shifts from speaking to Philip to speaking to all of his disciples.

See: Forms of You

John 14:10 (#5)

τὰ ῥήματα

“The words”

Here, **words** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The message] or [The teachings]

See: Metonymy

John 14:11 (#1)

ἐγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρὶ, καὶ ὁ Πατὴρ ἐν ἐμοί

“I {am} in the Father, and the Father {is} in me”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 14:11 (#2)

τὰ ἔργα

“the works”

See how you translated **work** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:12 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 14:12 (#5)

Πατέρα

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:12 (#2)

ὁ πιστεύων εἰς ἐμὲ, τὰ ἔργα ἃ ἐγὼ ποιῶ, κἀκεῖνος ποιήσει

“the one believing in me, the works that I do, he also will do”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [the one believing in me will also do the works that I do]

See: Information Structure

John 14:12 (#3)

τὰ ἔργα

“the works”

See how you translated **works** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:12 (#4)

καὶ μείζονα τούτων ποιήσει

“and he will do greater than these”

Jesus is leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply the word from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and he will do greater works than these]

See: Ellipsis

John 14:13 (#2)

ὅ τι ἂν αἰτήσητε ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“whatever you ask in my name”

Here, **ask in my name** could mean: (1) to request something as the representative of Jesus or as if Jesus himself were requesting it. Alternate translation: [whatever you might ask as if I were asking] or [whatever you might ask that I would ask]; (2) to request something with the authority of Jesus. Alternate translation: [whatever you ask with my authority]

See: Idiom

John 14:13 (#4)

ὁ Πατὴρ & Υἱῷ

“the Father & Son”

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:13 (#5)

ἐν τῷ Υἱῷ

“in the Son”

Jesus is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this phrase in the first person. Alternate translation: [in me, the Son]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 14:13 (#3)

ἵνα δοξασθῇ ὁ Πατὴρ ἐν τῷ Υἱῷ

“so that the Father may be glorified in the Son”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The one that may do the action could be: (1) Jesus, in which case **in the Son** would mean “by the Son.” Alternate translation: [so that the Son may glorify the Father]; (2) everyone who experiences the result of what has been asked. Alternate translation: [so that everyone may glorify the Father in the Son]

See: Active or Passive

John 14:13 (#1)

ὅ τι ἂν αἰτήσητε

“whatever you ask”

Jesus is leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply the word from the context. Alternate translation: [whatever you might ask God]

See: Ellipsis

John 14:14 (#1)

ἐάν τι αἰτήσητέ με ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“If you ask me anything in my name”

See how you translated **in my name** in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 14:15 (#1)

τὰς ἐντολὰς τὰς ἐμὰς τηρήσετε

“you will keep my commandments”

Here, **keep** means to obey. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you will obey my commandments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:16 (#1)

Παράκλητον

“Helper”

Helper here refers to the Holy Spirit. See the discussion of this term in the introduction for this chapter. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one who helps, the Holy Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:17 (#4)

ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσται

“will be in you”

Jesus uses the future tense **will** to indicate that the Holy **Spirit** would be inside Jesus’ disciples at a future point in time. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be in you at a future time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:17 (#1)

τὸ Πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας

“the Spirit of Truth”

The **Spirit of Truth** refers to the Holy Spirit. See the discussion of this term in the introduction for this

chapter. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit of Truth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:17 (#2)

τὸ Πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας

"the Spirit of Truth"

Jesus is using **of** to describe the **Spirit** who teaches people the **Truth** about God. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the Spirit that teaches God's truth]

See: Possession

John 14:17 (#3)

ὃ ὁ κόσμος οὐ δύναται λαβεῖν

"whom the world is not able to receive"

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the people in the **world** who oppose God. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whom the people in this world who oppose God are not able to receive] or [whom those who oppose God are not able to receive]

See: Metonymy

John 14:18 (#2)

ἔρχομαι

"I am coming"

Here Jesus uses the present tense **I am coming** to refer to something that will happen in the near future. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the future tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [I will come]

See: Predictive Past

John 14:18 (#1)

οὐκ ἀφήσω ὑμᾶς ὀρφανούς

"I will not leave you as orphans"

Jesus uses **orphans** to refer to people who have no one to care for them. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will not leave you with no one to care for you]

See: Metaphor

John 14:19 (#1)

ὁ κόσμος

"the world"

See how you translated **the world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 14:19 (#3)

ὅτι ἐγὼ ζῶ

"Because I live"

Here Jesus uses the present tense **I live** to refer to when he comes back to life after his death. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the future tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [Because I will live]

See: Predictive Past

John 14:19 (#2)

ὅτι ἐγὼ ζῶ, καὶ ὑμεῖς ζήσεσθε

"Because I live, you will also live"

In this verse, Jesus uses **live** to refer to living forever after one's resurrection. Because Jesus will live forever after his death and resurrection, so too will his disciples life forever after they die and are resurrected. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Because I live forever, you will also life forever]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:20 (#3)

τῷ Πατρί μου

"my Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:20 (#2)

ἐγὼ ἐν τῷ Πατρί μου, καὶ ὑμεῖς ἐν ἐμοὶ, κἀγὼ ἐν ὑμῖν

"I am in my Father, and you {are} in me, and I {am} in you"

In this verse Jesus uses **in** to indicate being united with someone. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am united with my Father, and you are united with me, and I am united with you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:20 (#1)

ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ

"In that day"

On that day here refers to the time that Jesus' disciples would see him again after his resurrection. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [When you see me again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:20 (#4)

ὑμεῖς ἐν ἐμοὶ, κἀγὼ ἐν ὑμῖν

"you {are} in me, and I {am} in you"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize the unity between Jesus and his disciples. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [you and I are just like one person]

See: Doublet

John 14:21 (#2)

τηρῶν αὐτὰς

"keeping them"

Here, **keeping** means obeying. See how you translated this word in 14:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:21 (#4)

τοῦ Πατρός μου

"my Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:21 (#5)

ἐμφανίσω αὐτῷ ἐμαυτόν

"I will show myself to him"

This could mean: (1) Jesus will reveal himself to his disciples after his resurrection, as also stated in 14:19. Alternate translation: [I will show myself to him after I live again]; (2) Jesus will reveal his character to the minds of anyone who loves and obeys him, as suggested by his statement in 14:23. Alternate translation: [I will reveal to him what I am like]; (3) Jesus will both reveal himself to his disciples after his resurrection and reveal his character to everyone who loves and obeys him. Alternate translation: [I will reveal myself to him after I live again and will reveal what I am like]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:21 (#3)

ὁ δὲ ἀγαπῶν με, ἀγαπηθήσεται ὑπὸ τοῦ Πατρός μου

"and the one loving me will be loved by my Father"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and my Father will love the one loving me]

See: Active or Passive

John 14:21 (#1)

ὁ ἔχων τὰς ἐντολάς μου

"The one having my commandments"

Jesus speaks of **commandments** as if they were an object that someone could possess. If your readers would not speak of knowing **commandments** in this way, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The one knowing my commandments]

See: Metaphor

John 14:22 (#1)

Ἰούδας, οὐχ ὁ Ἰσκαριώτης

"Judas (not Iscariot"

Here, **Judas** is the name of a man who was another disciple of Jesus. He was not the other disciple named **Judas** who was from the village of Kerioth and betrayed Jesus.

See: How to Translate Names

John 14:22 (#3)

τί γέγονεν, ὅτι ἡμῖν μέλλεις ἐμφανίζειν σεαυτὸν

"what has happened that you are about to show yourself to us"

Judas uses the expression **what has happened** to express his confusion about what Jesus said in the previous verse. The Jewish people were expecting the Messiah to come and reveal himself to the whole **world**, but Jesus said he would only show himself to his disciples. Therefore, **Judas** thinks something has caused Jesus to act differently than he had expected. You could include this information if that would be

helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [what is causing you to only show yourself to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:22 (#2)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 14:22 (#4)

ἡμῖν

"to us"

When **Judas** says **us**, he is speaking of himself and Jesus' other disciples, so **us** would be exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 14:22 (#5)

τῷ κόσμῳ

"to the world"

Here, **world** refers to the people who live in it. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the people living in the world]

See: Metonymy

John 14:23 (#1)

τὸν λόγον μου τηρήσει

"he will keep my word"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 8:51.

See: Metonymy

John 14:23 (#3)

πρὸς αὐτὸν ἐλευσόμεθα, καὶ μονὴν παρ' αὐτῷ ποιησόμεθα

"we will come to him, and we will make a dwelling place with him"

When **Jesus** says **we** in this verse, he is speaking of himself and God the Father, so **we** would be exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 14:23 (#2)

ὁ Πατήρ μου

"my Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:23 (#4)

καὶ μονὴν παρ' αὐτῷ ποιησόμεθα

"and we will make a dwelling place with him"

This clause refers to God and **Jesus** dwelling within the person who **loves** and obeys **Jesus**. After Jesus' resurrection and return to heaven, he and God live inside every believer through the Holy Spirit. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and we will live within him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:24 (#1)

τοὺς λόγους μου οὐ τηρεῖ

"does not keep my words"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 8:51.

See: Metonymy

John 14:24 (#5)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με Πατρός

"of the Father having sent me"

Here this phrase refers to God. See how you translated this phrase3 in 5:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:24 (#3)

οὐκ ἔστιν ἐμὸς

"is not mine"

Here, **mine** refers to the source of what Jesus has said. What Jesus has said did not come from himself, but from God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [does not come from me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:24 (#6)

τοῦ & Πατρός

"of the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:24 (#4)

τοῦ πέμψαντός με Πατρός

“of the Father having sent me”

Jesus is using **of** to describe the source of **the word**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [has come from the Father who sent me]

See: Possession

John 14:24 (#2)

ὁ λόγος

“the word”

Here, **word** refers to what Jesus has just said in the preceding verses. If this would confuse your readers, you could express that meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these things I have just said] or [this statement]

See: Metonymy

John 14:26 (#2)

ὁ & Παράκλητος

“the Helper”

See how you translated **the Helper** in 14:16.

John 14:26 (#4)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“in my name”

Here, **in my name** could mean: (1) as the representative of Jesus or in place of Jesus. Alternate translation: [as my representative] or [in place of me]; (2) with the authority of Jesus. Alternate translation: [with my authority]

See: Idiom

John 14:26 (#1)

ὁ δὲ Παράκλητος, τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον, ὃ πέμψει ὁ Πατὴρ ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου, ἐκεῖνος ὑμᾶς διδάξει πάντα, καὶ ὑπομνήσει ὑμᾶς πάντα ἃ εἶπον ὑμῖν

“Now the Helper—the Holy Spirit whom the Father will send in my name—he will teach you everything, and he will remind you of everything that I said to you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of the phrases in this verse. Alternate translation: [Now the Helper will teach you everything, and he will remind you of everything that I said to you. He is the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name.]

See: Information Structure

John 14:26 (#5)

πάντα

“everything”

Here, **everything** is an exaggeration that Jesus uses for emphasis. He means that the **Holy Spirit** would teach the disciples all that they needed to know about what he had taught them. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the plain meaning. Alternate translation: [everything that you need to know about what I have said]

See: Hyperbole

John 14:26 (#3)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:27 (#4)

οὐ καθὼς ὁ κόσμος δίδωσιν, ἐγὼ δίδωμι ὑμῖν

“I do not give to you as the world gives”

Here, **as the world gives** could mean: (1) the manner in which **the world gives peace**. Alternate translation: [I do not give to you in the manner that the world gives]; (2) the type of **peace** that **the world gives**. Alternate translation: [I do not give to you the kind of peace that the world gives]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:27 (#5)

κόσμος

“world”

See how you translated the **world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 14:27 (#6)

μὴ ταρασσέσθω ὑμῶν ἡ καρδία

“Do not let your heart be troubled”

See how you translated this clause in 14:1.

See: Metaphor

John 14:27 (#2)

εἰρήνην ἀφίημι ὑμῖν

“I leave you peace”

Jesus speaks of **peace** as if it were an object that he could **leave** with someone. If this would confuse your readers, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [You will feel peace after I leave]

See: Metaphor

John 14:27 (#1)

εἰρήνην ἀφίημι ὑμῖν; εἰρήνην τὴν ἐμὴν δίδωμι ὑμῖν

“I leave you peace; I give you my peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I leave you a peaceful feeling; I give you my peaceful feeling]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 14:27 (#3)

οὐ καθὼς ὁ κόσμος δίδωσιν, ἐγὼ δίδωμι ὑμῖν

“I do not give to you as the world gives”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous sentence. Alternate translation: [I do not give to you peace as the world gives peace]

See: Ellipsis

John 14:28 (#2)

εἰ ἠγαπᾶτέ με, ἐχάρητε ἄν

“If you loved me, you would be glad”

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he knows that the condition is not true. Jesus knows that at this point his disciples do not truly love him in the way that they should. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If you loved me, but you do not, you would be glad, but your are not]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 14:28 (#3)

πορεύομαι πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα

“I am going to the Father”

Jesus implies that he will return to his **Father**. Alternate translation: [I am going back to the Father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:28 (#5)

τὸν Πατέρα & ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father & the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 14:28 (#1)

ἐγὼ εἶπον ὑμῖν, ὑπάγω καὶ ἔρχομαι πρὸς ὑμᾶς

“I said to you, ‘I am going away, and I will come to you”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [I said to you that I am going away, and I will come back to you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 14:28 (#4)

ὁ Πατὴρ μείζων μού ἐστιν

“the Father is greater than I am”

Jesus could mean: (1) that the Father has greater authority than the Son while the Son is on the earth. Alternate translation: [the Father has greater authority than I have here]; (2) that Jesus functions in a subordinate role to the Father for all time. Alternate translation: [the role of the Father is superior to the role that I have]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:29 (#1)

εἴρηκα ὑμῖν

“I have told you”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [I have told you this] or [I have told you what will happen]

See: Ellipsis

John 14:30 (#1)

ὁ τοῦ κόσμου ἄρχων

“the ruler of the world”

Here, **the ruler of this world** refers to Satan. See how you translated this phrase in 12:31.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:30 (#2)

ἐν ἐμοὶ οὐκ ἔχει οὐδέν

“he has nothing in me”

Here, **has nothing in me** means that Satan has no control over Jesus and cannot make him do anything. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he is not able to control me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 14:31 (#1)

ἀλλ’ ἵνα γνῷ ὁ κόσμος, ὅτι ἀγαπῶ τὸν Πατέρα, καὶ καθὼς ἐνετείλατο μοι ὁ Πατὴρ, οὕτως ποιῶ

“but so that the world might know that I love the Father, and just as the Father commanded me, thus I do”

Here, **so that** introduces a purpose clause. The first event that is done to accomplish this purpose could be: (1) a phrase Jesus left out that can be supplied from the context of the previous verses. Alternate translation: [but the ruler of this world is coming so that the world might know that I love the Father, and just as the Father commanded me, thus I do] or [but these things will happen so that the world might know that I love the Father, and just as the Father commanded me, thus I do]; (2) what is stated later in the sentence, in which case the order of the clauses must be changed. Alternate translation: [but just as the Father commanded me, thus I do so that the world might know that I love the Father]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 14:31 (#2)

ὁ κόσμος

“the world”

See how you translated **the world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 14:31 (#3)

τὸν Πατέρα & ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father & the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus says he is the vine (15:1–8)
2. Jesus commands his disciples to love each other (15:9–17)
3. Jesus promises that his disciples will be persecuted (15:18–16:4)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Vine
Jesus used the vine as a metaphor for himself. The vine of the grape plant takes water and minerals from the ground and gives them to the leaves and grapes that are on the branches. Without the vine, the branches, grapes, and leaves die. He wanted his followers to know that unless they loved and obeyed him, they would be unable to do anything that pleased God. (See: vine; grape, grapevine; and Metaphor)

“Remain in me”
Jesus uses the word “remain” as a metaphor. He is speaking of a believer being spiritually joined to someone else as if the person “remained” in the other person. Christians are said to “remain” in Christ. The Son is said to “remain” in believers. Many translators will find it impossible to represent these ideas in their languages in exactly the same way. In (15:7), the UST expresses this idea of “my words remain in you” as “obey what I have taught you.” Translators may find it possible to use this translation as a model.

John 15:1 (#2)

ἡ ἀληθινή

“true”

The word translated as **vine** refers specifically to the grapevine plant that produces grapes. If your readers would not be familiar with grapevines, use an equivalent word in your language for a **vine** that produces fruit. Alternate translation: [grapevine] or [fruit-producing vine]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 15:1 (#3)

ὁ Πατήρ μου

“my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:1 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος ἡ ἀληθινή

“I am the true vine”

Jesus uses the **true vine** to refer to himself. As a **vine** is the source of life for its branches, so Jesus causes people to live in a way that pleases God and brings other people to believe in Jesus. Since the **vine** is an important metaphor in the Bible, you should translate the words directly or use a simile and not provide a plain explanation in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [I am like a true vine]

See: Metaphor

John 15:1 (#4)

ὁ Πατήρ μου ὁ γεωργός ἐστιν

“my Father is the farmer”

Jesus uses **farmer** to refer to God. Just as a **farmer** takes care of the **vine** to ensure it is as fruitful as possible, so God takes care of his people. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [my Father is like a gardener]

See: Metaphor

John 15:1 (#5)

ὁ γεωργός

“the farmer”

While **farmer** is a general term for anyone who farms the ground, in this context it refers to someone who takes care of grapevines and grows grapes. Alternate translation: [vine grower] or [grape farmer]

John 15:2 (#1)

πᾶν κλῆμα ἐν ἐμοὶ μὴ φέρον καρπὸν & καὶ πᾶν τὸ καρπὸν φέρον & ἵνα καρπὸν πλείονα φέρῃ

“Every branch in me not bearing fruit & and every one that bears fruit & so that it might bear more fruit”

Jesus speaks about people who claim to be his disciples but are not by continuing the metaphor of a vine. In this paragraph, Jesus uses **branch** to refer to both true and false disciples. He also uses **bearing fruit**, **bears fruit**, and **bear more fruit** to refer to living in a manner that pleases God, especially demonstrating the Christian qualities called the “fruit of the Spirit” in Galatians 5:22–23. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [Everyone who claims to be my disciple but does not please God is like a branch in me that does not bear fruit ... and every person who pleases God is like a branch that bears fruit ... so that he might be like a branch that bears more fruit]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

John 15:2 (#2)

αἴρει αὐτό

“he takes it away”

Alternate translation: [he cuts it off of the vine and takes it away] or [he breaks it off of the vine and throws it away]

John 15:2 (#3)

καθαίρει αὐτὸ

“he prunes it”

The word translated as **prunes** could mean: (1) to remove excess parts from a plant. Alternate translation: [he trims it]; (2) to cause something to become clean. Alternate translation: [he cleans it]; (3) to remove excess parts from a plant in order to make it clean. See the discussion of John’s use of double meaning in Part 3 of the Introduction to this book. Alternate translation: [he prunes it so that it will be clean]

John 15:3 (#3)

ὑμεῖς & ὑμῖν

“You & to you”

The words **You** and **you** in this verse are plural and refer to the disciples of Jesus.

See: Forms of You

John 15:3 (#1)

ἤδη ὑμεῖς καθαροί ἐστε

“You are already clean”

The word translated as **clean** is related to the word translated as “prunes” in the previous verse. Here Jesus uses **clean** to imply that the branches have already been cleaned by pruning off the excess parts. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a

simile. Alternate translation: [You are like branches that have already been pruned and are clean]

See: Metaphor

John 15:3 (#2)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Here, **word** refers to the message or teachings of Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

John 15:4 (#1)

μείνατε ἐν ἐμοί, κἀγὼ ἐν ὑμῖν & ἐν ἐμοὶ μένητε

“Remain in me, and I in you & you remain in me”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 6:56. See also the discussion of **Remain in me** in the introduction for this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:5 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος; ὑμεῖς τὰ κλήματα

“I am the vine; you {are} the branches”

See how you translated **vine** in 15:1 and “branch” in 15:2.

See: Metaphor

John 15:5 (#2)

ὁ μένων ἐν ἐμοὶ κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτῷ

“The one remaining in me and I in him”

See how you translated this similar expression in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:5 (#3)

οὗτος φέρει καρπὸν πολύν

“he bears much fruit”

See how you translated **bears fruit** in 15:2.

See: Metaphor

John 15:5 (#4)

οὐ & ποιεῖν οὐδέν

“do nothing”

Jesus uses **do nothing** to refer to doing **nothing** that pleases God. It does not refer to doing **nothing** at all. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [do nothing that pleases God] or [do nothing acceptable to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:6 (#5)

καὶ συνάγουσιν αὐτὰ καὶ εἰς τὸ πῦρ βάλλουσιν, καὶ καίεται

“and they gather them and throw {them} into the fire, and they are burned up”

The first **they** in this verse refers to an indefinite subject, but the second **they** refers to the object. If this would be confusing in your language, you could translate them differently. Alternate translation: [and some helpers gather them and throw them into the fire, and they are burned up] or [and someone gathers them and throws them into the fire, and those branches are burned up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 15:6 (#3)

ἐβλήθη ἔξω ὡς τὸ κλῆμα καὶ ἐξηράνθη

“he is thrown outside like a branch and is dried up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the farmer throws him outside like a branch, and he dries up]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:6 (#4)

τὸ κλῆμα

“a branch”

Jesus uses **branch** to refer to someone who claims to be Jesus’ disciple, but is not. See how you translated the similar use of **branch** in 15:2.

See: Metaphor

John 15:6 (#6)

καίεται

“they are burned up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form

or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the fire burns them up]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:6 (#2)

μένῃ ἐν ἐμοί

“does & remain in me”

See how you translated **remain in me** in the previous two verses.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:6 (#1)

ἐὰν μή τις μένῃ ἐν ἐμοί, ἐβλήθη ἔξω ὡς τὸ κλῆμα καὶ ἐξηράνθη, καὶ συνάγουσιν αὐτὰ καὶ εἰς τὸ πῦρ βάλλουσιν, καὶ καίεται

“If anyone does not remain in me, he is thrown outside like a branch and is dried up, and they gather them and throw {them} into the fire, and they are burned up”

In the middle of this verse, Jesus changes from referring to the **branch** in a singular form to a plural form. If this change would be confusing in your language, you could change the singular forms into plural forms. Alternate translation: [If people do not remain in me, they are thrown outside like branches and are dried up, and they gather them into the fire, and they are burned up]

John 15:7 (#3)

ὃ ἐὰν θέλητε, αἰτήσασθε

“ask whatever you desire”

Jesus is leaving out a word that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply the word from the context. Alternate translation: [ask God whatever you desire]

See: Ellipsis

John 15:7 (#1)

μείνητε ἐν ἐμοὶ

“you remain in me”

See how you translated **remain in me** in the previous three verses.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:7 (#4)

γενήσεται ὑμῖν

“it will be done for you”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will do it for you]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:7 (#2)

τὰ ῥήματά μου ἐν ὑμῖν μείνῃ

“my words remain in you”

This is an idiom that means to obey Jesus. See how you translated a similar expression in 8:31

See: Idiom

John 15:8 (#4)

καρπὸν πολὺν φέρητε

“you would bear much fruit”

See how you translated a similar expression in 15:5.

See: Metaphor

John 15:8 (#2)

ἐν τούτῳ ἐδοξάσθη ὁ Πατήρ μου

“My Father was glorified in this”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You have glorified my Father in this]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:8 (#3)

ὁ Πατήρ μου

“My Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:8 (#1)

ἐν τούτῳ ἐδοξάσθη ὁ Πατήρ μου

“My Father was glorified in this”

Jesus is using the past tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If this is confusing in your language, you could use the

future tense. Alternate translation: [My Father will be glorified in this]

See: Predictive Past

John 15:8 (#5)

γένησθε ἐμοὶ μαθηταί

"you would be my disciples"

Alternate translation: [show that you are my disciples] or [demonstrate that you are my disciples]

John 15:9 (#2)

μείνατε ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ τῇ ἐμῇ

"Remain in my love"

Jesus uses **Remain in** to refer to continuing in a certain state. Jesus is commanding his disciples to continue being in a close and loving relationship with him by obeying his commands. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Continue having a loving relationship with me] or [Live in a way that enables you to continue experiencing my love]

See: Metaphor

John 15:9 (#1)

ὁ Πατήρ

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:10 (#1)

τηρήσητε & τετήρηκα

"you keep & have kept"

Here, **keep** and **kept** refer to obeying. See how you translated this word in 14:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:10 (#2)

μενεῖτε ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ μου & μένω αὐτοῦ ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ

"you will remain in my love & remain in his love"

See how you translated the similar clause in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

John 15:10 (#3)

τοῦ Πατρός

"of the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:11 (#1)

ταῦτα λελάληκα ὑμῖν, ἵνα ἡ χαρὰ ἡ ἐμὴ ἐν ὑμῖν ᾖ

"I have spoken these things to you so that my joy might be in you"

Alternate translation: [I have told you these things so that you will have the same kind of joy that I have]

John 15:11 (#2)

καὶ ἡ χαρὰ ὑμῶν πληρωθῇ

"and your joy might be complete"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that you will be completely joyful] or [so that you will be joyful to the fullest extent]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:13 (#3)

τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ θῇ

"would lay down his life"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 10:11.

See: Euphemism

John 15:13 (#1)

μείζονα ταύτης ἀγάπην οὐδεὶς ἔχει, ἵνα τις τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ θῇ ὑπὲρ τῶν φίλων αὐτοῦ

"No one has greater love than this—that he would lay down his life for his friends"

Alternate translation: [The greatest love a person can have for his friends is to voluntarily die for them] or [The best way that a person can show that he loves his friends is to willingly die for them]

John 15:13 (#2)

τὴν ψυχὴν

"life"

Here, **life** refers to physical **life**. It does not refer to eternal life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [physical life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:15 (#1)

τοῦ Πατρός μου

“my Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:16 (#2)

καὶ ὁ καρπὸς ὑμῶν μένῃ

“and your fruit would remain”

Here, **remain** means to last forever. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and your fruit should last forever]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:16 (#3)

ἵνα ὅ τι ἂν αἰτήσητε

“so that whatever you would ask”

Here, **so that** introduces a purpose clause. It could mean: (1) the content of this clause is the purpose for Jesus choosing his disciples. Alternate translation: [and he chose you so that whatever you would ask]; (2) the content of this clause is the purpose for the disciples’ fruit remaining. Alternate translation: [and this fruit would remain so that whatever you would ask]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 15:16 (#4)

τὸν Πατέρα

“of the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:16 (#5)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“in my name”

See how you translated **in my name** in 14:13.

See: Idiom

John 15:16 (#1)

καρπὸν φέρητε

“would bear fruit”

In this verse, **bear fruit** could mean: (1) preach the gospel to people who respond by trusting in Jesus, as suggested by the use of **go** before **bear**. Alternate translation: [would lead people to believe in me]; (2) live in a manner that pleases God, as **bear fruit** is used in 15:2–8. Alternate translation: [would do what pleases God]

See: Metaphor

John 15:17 (#1)

ταῦτα

“These things”

Here, **These things** could refer to: (1) the commands Jesus referred to in the previous verses. Alternate translation: [These commands]; (2) the command in the second half of this verse. Alternate translation: [This]

John 15:18 (#1)

εἰ ὁ κόσμος ὑμᾶς μισεῖ

“If the world hates you”

Jesus is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Jesus is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [If the world hates you, and it does hate you]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

John 15:18 (#2)

ὁ κόσμος

“the world”

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the people in the **world** who oppose God. See how you translated **world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 15:19 (#1)

εἰ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου ἦτε

“If you were from the world”

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he is already convinced that the condition is not true. He knows that his disciples are not **from the world**. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes

is not true. Alternate translation: [If you were from the world, but you are not]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 15:19 (#3)

ὅτι δὲ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου οὐκ ἐστέ, ἀλλ᾽ ἐγὼ ἐξελεξάμην ὑμᾶς ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου, διὰ τοῦτο μισεῖ ὑμᾶς ὁ κόσμος

“But because you are not from the world, but I chose you from the world, on account of this the world hates you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [But because you are not from the world, this world hates you, but I chose you from the world]

See: Information Structure

John 15:19 (#2)

τοῦ κόσμου & ὁ κόσμος & τοῦ κόσμου & τοῦ κόσμου & ὁ κόσμος

“the world, the world & the world & the world & the world”

See how you translated **the world** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

John 15:20 (#3)

εἰ τὸν λόγον μου ἐτήρησαν & τηρήσουσιν

“if they kept my word, they will & keep”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 8:51.

See: Metonymy

John 15:20 (#2)

οὐκ ἔστιν δοῦλος μείζων τοῦ κυρίου αὐτοῦ

“A slave is not greater than his master”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:20 (#1)

μνημονεύετε τοῦ λόγου οὗ ἐγὼ εἶπον ὑμῖν

“Remember the word that I said to you”

Jesus uses **word** to refer to what he says later in this sentence. If this use of **word** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remember the teaching that I said to you]

See: Metonymy

John 15:21 (#3)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

“the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:21 (#1)

ταῦτα πάντα ποιήσουσιν εἰς ὑμᾶς

“they will do all these things to you”

Here, **all these things** refers to the bad things Jesus told his disciples that the unbelievers in the world would do to them in 15:18–20. If this use of **these things** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will hate and persecute you]

See: Metonymy

John 15:21 (#2)

διὰ τὸ ὄνομά μου

“because of my name”

Here, Jesus uses **my name** to refer to himself. People will make his followers suffer because they belong to him. If this use of **name** would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because you belong to me]

See: Metonymy

John 15:22 (#2)

ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν

“they would not have sin”

Jesus speaks of **sin** as if it were an object that a person could possess. See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:41.

See: Metaphor

John 15:22 (#3)

ἁμαρτίαν & τῆς ἁμαρτίας

“sin & sin”

Jesus uses **sin** to refer specifically to the **sin** of rejecting Jesus and his teachings. It does not refer to **sin** in general, because everyone is guilty of **sin**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to

your readers. Alternate translation: [the sin of rejecting me and my teachings ... sin of rejecting me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:22 (#1)

εἰ μὴ ἦλθον καὶ ἐλάλησα αὐτοῖς

"If I had not come and spoken to them"

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he knows that the condition is not true. He knows that he did come and speak to the world. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If I had not come and spoken to them, but I did]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 15:23 (#1)

τὸν Πατέρα

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:24 (#5)

τὸν Πατέρα μου

"my Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:24 (#2)

εἰ τὰ ἔργα μὴ ἐποίησα ἐν αὐτοῖς ἃ οὐδεὶς ἄλλος ἐποίησεν, ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν

"If I had not done the works that no one else did among them, they would have no sin"

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he knows that the condition is not true. He has done **works that no one else did** among the people. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If I had not done the works that no one else did among them, but I did, they would have no sin, but they do have sin]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 15:24 (#4)

καὶ ἑωράκασιν

"they have both seen"

The object of the verb **seen** could be: (1) **the works** referred to earlier in the verse. Alternate translation: [they have both seen the works]; (2) Jesus and the **Father**, referred to at the end of the verse. Alternate translation: [they have both seen me and my Father]

See: Ellipsis

John 15:24 (#1)

εἰ τὰ ἔργα μὴ ἐποίησα ἐν αὐτοῖς ἃ οὐδεὶς ἄλλος ἐποίησεν, ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν & δὲ

"If I had not done the works that no one else did among them, they would have no sin, but"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [Because I have done the works that no one else did among them, they have sin, and]

See: Double Negatives

John 15:24 (#3)

ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν

"they would have no sin"

See how you translated this phrase in 15:22.

See: Metaphor

John 15:25 (#4)

τῷ νόμῳ

"law"

Jesus is using the name of the first part of the Hebrew Scriptures, the **law**, to represent the entire Hebrew Scriptures in general. See how you translated a similar expression in 10:34.

See: Synecdoche

John 15:25 (#5)

ἐμίσησάν με δωρεάν

"They hated me without a cause"

This sentence is a quotation from Psalm 35:19 or 69:4. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 15:25 (#2)

ὁ λόγος ὁ ἐν τῷ νόμῳ αὐτῶν γεγραμμένος

“the word that is written in their law”

Jesus uses **the word that is written** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 35:19 or 69:4). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that John is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [the statement that has been written in their scriptures]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 15:25 (#1)

ὁ λόγος

“the word”

Jesus uses **word** to refer to a specific prophecy in the Old Testament. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the prophecy]

See: Metonymy

John 15:25 (#3)

πληρωθῇ ὁ λόγος ὁ ἐν τῷ νόμῳ αὐτῶν γεγραμμένος

“the word that is written in their law might be fulfilled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they might fulfill the word that a prophet wrote in their law]

See: Active or Passive

John 15:26 (#1)

ὁ Παράκλητος

“the Helper”

See how you translated **Helper** in 14:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:26 (#3)

τὸ Πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας

“the Spirit of Truth”

See how you translated **the Spirit of Truth** in 14:17.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 15:26 (#2)

Πατρός & Πατρὸς

“Father & Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 15:27 (#1)

ἀρχῆς

“the beginning”

Jesus uses **beginning** to refer to the first days of his ministry. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the very first days when I began teaching the people and doing miracles]

See: Metonymy

John - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus promises that his disciples will be persecuted (15:18–16:4)
2. Jesus describes the work of the Holy Spirit (16:5–15)
3. Jesus says that he will return to his Father (16:16–28)
4. Jesus says that his disciples will soon abandon him (16:29–33)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Holy Spirit
Jesus told his disciples that he would send the Holy Spirit to them. The Holy Spirit is the Helper (14:16) who is always with God’s people to help them and to speak to God for them. He is also the Spirit of Truth (14:17) who tells God’s people what is true about God so they know him better and serve him well. (See: Holy Spirit, Spirit of God, Spirit of the Lord, Spirit)

“The hour is coming”
Jesus used the words, “the hour is coming,” to begin prophecies about events that were about to occur. He is not referring to the 60 minute hour, but to a point in time when these prophecies will be fulfilled. “The hour” in which people would persecute his followers (16:2) lasted for many years. However, “the hour” in which his disciples would scatter and leave him alone (16:32) was less than sixty minutes long. (See: prophet, prophecy, prophesy, seer, prophetess)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Simile
Jesus said that just as a woman is in pain when she gives birth to a baby, so also his followers would be sad when he died. But just as the woman is happy after the baby is born, so also his followers would be happy when Jesus became alive again. (See: Simile)

John 16:1 (#1)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** refers to what Jesus has just said in 15:18–25 about the coming persecution of his disciples. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the warnings that you will be hated by everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:1 (#2)

μὴ σκανδαλισθῆτε

“you might not fall away”

Jesus uses **fall away** to refer to no longer trusting in him or no longer being his disciple. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you might not stop trusting me] or [you might not stop being my disciple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:2 (#3)

ἵνα πᾶς ὁ ἀποκτείνας ὑμᾶς

“for everyone having killed you”

Here, **for** could indicate: (1) time, as in the UST. (2) an explanation of to what **an hour** refers. Alternate translation: [that everyone who kills you wants]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

John 16:2 (#2)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

“an hour is coming”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:21 and see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to Chapter 4.

See: Metonymy

John 16:2 (#1)

ἀποσυναγώγους

“put out of the synagogues”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 9:22.

See: Metaphor

John 16:3 (#1)

Πατέρα

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:4 (#3)

ἐξ ἀρχῆς

“in the beginning”

See how you translated **beginning** in 15:27.

See: Metonymy

John 16:4 (#1)

ταῦτα λελάληκα ὑμῖν

“I have spoken these things to you”

Here, **these things** refers to what Jesus has just said in 16:2–3 regarding what the Jews will do to his disciples. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I have told you that the Jews will persecute you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:4 (#2)

ὅταν ἔλθῃ ἡ ὥρα αὐτῶν

“when their hour comes”

See how you translated **hour** in 16:2.

See: Metonymy

John 16:5 (#1)

τὸν πέμψαντά με

“the one having sent me”

Here, **the one having sent me** refers to God. See how you translated this phrase in 4:34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:5 (#2)

καὶ οὐδεὶς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐρωτᾷ

“and none of you asks”

Jesus uses **and** to emphasize his surprise that they are not asking him where he is going, as they had done previously in 13:36 and 14:5. Use a natural form in your language to express this emphasis. Alternate translation: [but none of you are even asking] or [but how is it that none of you asks]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:5 (#3)

ἐρωτᾷ με, ποῦ ὑπάγεις

"asks me, 'Where are you going"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [asks me where I am going]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 16:6 (#1)

ἡ λύπη πεπλήρωκεν ὑμῶν τὴν καρδίαν

"sadness has filled your heart"

Jesus speaks of **sadness** as if it were a thing that could fill someone. If this use of **sadness** would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your heart is very sad]

See: Metaphor

John 16:6 (#2)

ἡ λύπη πεπλήρωκεν ὑμῶν τὴν καρδίαν

"sadness has filled your heart"

See how you translated **heart** in 14:1.

See: Metaphor

John 16:7 (#2)

Παράκλητος

"Helper"

See how you translated **Helper** in 14:26.

John 16:7 (#1)

ἐὰν & μὴ ἀπέλθω, ὁ Παράκλητος οὐκ ἐλεύσεται πρὸς ὑμᾶς

"if I do not go away, the Helper will not come to you"

If it would be more natural in your language, you can translate this double negative expression in a positive form. Alternate translation: [the Helper will come to you only if I go away]

See: Double Negatives

John 16:8 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος

"that one"

Here, **that one** refers to the Holy Spirit, who is called "the Helper" in the previous verse. If this use of **that one** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 16:8 (#3)

περὶ ἁμαρτίας, καὶ περὶ δικαιοσύνης, καὶ περὶ κρίσεως

"about sin and about righteousness and about judgment"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **sin**, **righteousness**, and **judgment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [about what is sinful and about what is righteous and about the fact that God will judge them]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 16:8 (#2)

κόσμον

"world"

See how you translated **world** in 1:29.

See: Metonymy

John 16:8 (#4)

περὶ δικαιοσύνης

"about righteousness"

Here, **righteousness** could refer to: (1) God's **righteousness**, which **the world** does not have. Alternate translation: [about the righteousness that the world lacks]; (2) the false **righteousness** in **the world**, such as the actions of the Pharisees, which people thought were **righteous**. Alternate translation: [about the world's false righteousness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:9 (#1)

περὶ ἁμαρτίας μέν, ὅτι οὐ πιστεύουσιν εἰς ἐμὲ

“about sin, because they do not believe in me”

Alternate translation: [about their sinfulness, because they are guilty of sin by not believing in me]

John 16:10 (#1)

περὶ δικαιοσύνης

“about righteousness”

See how you translated the phrase **about righteousness** in 16:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:10 (#3)

οὐκέτι θεωρεῖτέ με

“you will no longer see me”

Jesus uses this phrase to imply that anyone who could **see** him saw true righteousness. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you will no longer see my righteous example]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:10 (#2)

Πατέρα

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:11 (#1)

περὶ & κρίσεως

“about judgment”

See how you translated the phrase **about judgment** in 16:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:11 (#2)

ὁ ἄρχων τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

“the ruler of this world”

Here, **the ruler of this world** refers to Satan. See how you translated this in 12:31.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:11 (#4)

κέκριται

“has been judged”

This could mean: (1) Satan has already been condemned to future judgment. Alternate translation: [has already been condemned]; (2) Satan’s future judgment is so certain that Jesus uses the past tense. Alternate translation: [will be judged]

See: Predictive Past

John 16:11 (#3)

ὁ ἄρχων τοῦ κόσμου τούτου κέκριται

“the ruler of this world has been judged”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Jesus implies that God did it. Alternate translation: [God has judged the ruler of this world]

See: Active or Passive

John 16:13 (#2)

ὁδηγήσει ὑμᾶς ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ πάσῃ

“he will guide you into the whole truth”

Here, **truth** refers to true information about Jesus and God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will guide you into all truth about me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:13 (#3)

ἀφ’ ἑαυτοῦ

“from himself”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:19. Alternate translation: [on his own authority]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:13 (#4)

ὅσα ἀκούσει, λαλήσει

“he will say whatever he will hear”

Jesus implies that God the Father will speak to the Spirit. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will say whatever God tells him to say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:13 (#1)

τὸ Πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας

“the Spirit of Truth”

See how you translated the phrase **the Spirit of Truth** in 14:17.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:13 (#5)

τὰ ἐρχόμενα

“the things coming”

Alternate translation: [things that are about to happen] or [things that will soon take place]

John 16:14 (#1)

ἐκεῖνος

“That one”

Here, **That one** refers to the Holy Spirit, who is called “the Spirit of Truth” in the previous verse. If this use of **That one** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [The Holy Spirit]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 16:14 (#2)

ἐκ τοῦ ἐμοῦ

“from the things of mine”

Here, **the things of mine** could refer to: (1) what Jesus has said. Alternate translation: [from the things I have said]; (2) who Jesus is and what he has said and done. Alternate translation: [from my true identity and the things I have done]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:15 (#2)

ἐκ τοῦ ἐμοῦ

“from the things of mine”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:15 (#1)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:16 (#1)

οὐκέτι θεωρεῖτέ με

“you no longer see me”

Here Jesus uses **see** in the present tense to refer to something that will happen in the near future. If this is confusing in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [you will no longer see me]

See: Predictive Past

John 16:17 (#4)

ὅτι ὑπάγω πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα

“Because I go to the Father”

See how you translated this statement in 16:10.

John 16:17 (#2)

τί ἐστιν τοῦτο ὃ λέγει ἡμῖν

“What is this that he says to us”

The disciples use this clause to indicate that they do not understand what Jesus has just said about his death that will happen soon. Use the most natural way in your language to express this confusion. Alternate translation: [What is he talking about when he says to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:17 (#5)

τὸν Πατέρα

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:17 (#3)

μικρὸν καὶ οὐ θεωρεῖτέ με; καὶ πάλιν μικρὸν καὶ ὄψεσθέ με

“A little {while} and you do not see me, and again a little {while} and you will see me”

See how you translated the similar statement in the previous verse.

John 16:17 (#1)

τί ἐστιν τοῦτο ὃ λέγει ἡμῖν, μικρὸν καὶ οὐ θεωρεῖτέ με; καὶ πάλιν μικρὸν καὶ ὄψεσθέ με; καί ὅτι ὑπάγω πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα

“What is this that he says to us, ‘A little {while} and you do not see me, and again a little {while} and you will see me,’ and, ‘Because I go to the Father”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [What is this that he says to us when he says that in a little while we will not see him, and again a little while and we will see him, and also says that it is because he goes to the Father]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 16:18 (#1)

τὸ μικρόν

“A little {while”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

John 16:19 (#1)

περὶ τούτου ζητεῖτε μετ’ ἀλλήλων, ὅτι εἶπον, μικρὸν καὶ οὐ θεωρεῖτέ με; καὶ πάλιν μικρὸν καὶ ὄψεσθέ με

“Are you seeking among yourselves concerning this, that I said, ‘A little {while} and you do not see me, and again a little {while} and you will see me”

Jesus is using this question to get his disciples to focus on what he has just told them so that he can give an explanation. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are seeking among yourselves concerning this, that I said, ‘A little while and you do not see me, and again a little while and you will see me.’]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 16:19 (#3)

μικρὸν καὶ οὐ θεωρεῖτέ με; καὶ πάλιν μικρὸν καὶ ὄψεσθέ με

“A little {while} and you do not see me, and again a little {while} and you will see me”

See how you translated this statement in 16:16.

John 16:19 (#2)

ὅτι εἶπον

“that I said”

The word **that** introduces a clause that explains to what the preceding **this** refers. Use a word or phrase that introduces a further explanation or elaboration in your language. Alternate translation: [namely, that I said,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

John 16:20 (#2)

ὁ δὲ κόσμος χαρήσεται

“but the world will be glad”

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the people in the **world** who oppose God. See how you translated **world** 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 16:20 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 16:20 (#4)

ἡ λύπη ὑμῶν εἰς χαρὰν γενήσεται

“your sorrow will become joy”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **sorrow** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [you will change from being sorrowful to being joyful]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 16:20 (#3)

ὑμεῖς λυπηθήσεσθε

“You will be grieved”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You will have grief] or [What happens will grieve you]

See: Active or Passive

John 16:21 (#3)

οὐκέτι μνημονεύει τῆς θλίψεως

“she no longer remembers her suffering”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **suffering**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [she no longer remembers that she suffered]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 16:21 (#1)

ἡ γυνὴ ὅταν τίκτῃ, λύπην ἔχει, ὅτι ἦλθεν ἡ ὥρα αὐτῆς; ὅταν δὲ γεννήσῃ τὸ παιδίον, οὐκέτι μνημονεύει τῆς θλίψεως διὰ τὴν χαρὰν, ὅτι ἐγεννήθη ἄνθρωπος εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“When a woman gives birth, she has pain because her hour has come, but when she has given birth to the child, she no longer remembers her suffering, because of the joy that a man has been born into the world”

Jesus is speaking of women in general, not of one particular **woman**. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [When women give birth, they have pain because their hour has come, but when they have given birth to their children, they no longer remember their suffering, because of the joy that men have been born into the world]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 16:21 (#2)

ἡ ὥρα αὐτῆς

“her hour”

Here, **her hour** refers to the time when the **woman gives birth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the time for her to give birth]

See: Metonymy

John 16:22 (#1)

χαρήσεται ὑμῶν ἡ καρδία

“your heart will be glad”

See how you translated **heart** in 14:1.

See: Metaphor

John 16:23 (#1)

ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ

“in that day”

Here, **in that day** refers to the time that Jesus’ disciples would see him again after his resurrection. See how you translated this phrase in 14:20.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:23 (#2)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω ὑμῖν

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 16:23 (#3)

τὸν Πατέρα

“of the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:23 (#4)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“in my name”

See how you translated the phrase **in my name** in 14:13.

See: Idiom

John 16:24 (#1)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“in my name”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 16:24 (#2)

ἡ χαρὰ ὑμῶν ᾖ πεπληρωμένη

“your joy may be fulfilled”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 15:11.

See: Active or Passive

John 16:25 (#4)

Πατρὸς

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:25 (#2)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

“an hour is coming”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:21 and see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to Chapter 4.

See: Metonymy

John 16:25 (#1)

παροιμίαις

“figures of speech”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:6.

See: Parables

John 16:25 (#3)

παρρησίᾳ περὶ τοῦ Πατρὸς ἀπαγγελῶ ὑμῖν

“I will tell you plainly about the Father”

Alternate translation: [I will tell you about the Father in a way that you will clearly understand.]

John 16:26 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου

“in my name”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:13.

See: Idiom

John 16:26 (#1)

ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ

“In that day”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:20.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:26 (#4)

Πατέρα

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:26 (#3)

οὐ λέγω ὑμῖν, ὅτι ἐγὼ ἐρωτήσω τὸν Πατέρα

“I do not say to you that I will ask the Father”

Jesus implies that he will not have to **ask the Father** on behalf of his disciples, because they can ask God directly after Jesus becomes alive again. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I do not say to you that I will need to ask the Father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:27 (#1)

ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:28 (#1)

τοῦ Πατρὸς & τὸν Πατέρα

“the Father & the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:28 (#2)

εἰς τὸν κόσμον & ἀφίημι τὸν κόσμον

“into the world & I am leaving the world”

Here, **world** refers to the earth on which people live. It does not refer to the people in the world or to the entire universe. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the earth ... I am leaving the earth]

See: Metonymy

John 16:29 (#1)

λέγουσιν

“say”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 16:29 (#2)

παροιμίαν

“in figures of speech”

See how you translated this word in 16:25.

See: Parables

John 16:30 (#1)

οὐ χρείαν ἔχεις, ἵνα τίς σε ἐρωτᾷ

"you do not have need that anyone would question you"

By saying that Jesus does not need anyone to ask him questions, his disciples are implying that Jesus already knows what people will ask him before they ask. Since he already knows what they will ask him, he does not need them to ask him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [so, now you finally place your trust in me!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:31 (#1)

ἄρτι πιστεύετε

"Just now do you believe"

This could mean: (1) Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize what he is saying. Alternate translation: [So, now you finally place your trust in me!]; (2) Jesus is asking a question in order to express doubt that the disciples really believe in him, since he knows they will soon leave him. Alternate translation: [Do you really trust me now?]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 16:32 (#1)

ἔρχεται ὥρα

"an hour is coming"

See how you translated this phrase in 16:25.

See: Metonymy

John 16:32 (#3)

σκορπισθῆτε

"you might be scattered"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [others will scatter you]

See: Active or Passive

John 16:32 (#5)

ὁ Πατὴρ

"the Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 16:32 (#2)

καὶ ἐλήλυθεν

"and has come"

Here Jesus uses **has come** in the past tense to refer to something that will happen in the very near future. If this use of **has come** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [and will come right away]

See: Predictive Past

John 16:32 (#4)

εἰς τὰ ἴδια

"to his own"

Alternate translation: [each of you to his own place] or [every one of you to his own place]

John 16:33 (#1)

ἵνα ἐν ἐμοὶ εἰρήνην ἔχητε

"so that you might have peace in me"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for this idea, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **peace** in another way. Alternate translation: [so that you might experience a peaceful feeling in me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 16:33 (#4)

ἐγὼ νενίκηκα τὸν κόσμον

"I have conquered the world"

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the people in the **world** who oppose God. See how you translated **world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 16:33 (#3)

ἐν ἐμοὶ

"in me"

Here, **in me** refers to being united with Jesus or having a close relationship with him. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of your relationship with me]

See: Idiom

John 16:33 (#2)

εἰρήνην ἔχητε & θλῖψιν ἔχετε

"you might have peace & you have troubles"

Jesus speaks of **peace** and **troubles** as if they were objects that someone can possess. If these uses of **peace** and **troubles** might confuse your readers, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [you might be peaceful ... you experience troubles]

See: Metaphor

John - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is one long prayer that can be divided into three parts according to the topics of Jesus' prayer requests:

1. Jesus prays for himself (17:1–5)
2. Jesus prays for his disciples (17:6–19)
3. Jesus prays for all Christians (17:20–26)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Glory

Scripture often speaks of God's glory as a great, bright light that visually represents how great God is. When people see this light, they are afraid. In this chapter Jesus asks God to show his followers his true glory (17:1). (See: glory, glorious, glorify)

Jesus is eternal

Jesus existed before God created the world (17:5). John wrote about this in 1:1.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Prayer

Jesus is God's one and only Son (3:16), so he could pray differently from the way other people pray. He used many words that might seem to be commands. Your translation should make Jesus sound like a son speaking with love and respect to his father and telling him what the father needs to do so that the father will be honored.

John 17:1 (#2)

ἐπάρας τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτοῦ

"having lifted up his eyes"

See how you translated this idiom in 6:5.

See: Idiom

John 17:1 (#4)

Πάτερ & τὸν Υἱόν

"Father & Son"

Father and **Son** are important titles that describe the relationship between God and Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:1 (#7)

σου τὸν Υἱόν & ὁ Υἱὸς

"your Son & the Son"

Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 17:1 (#6)

δόξασόν

"Glorify"

Glorify here is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please glorify]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 17:1 (#5)

ἐλήλυθεν ἡ ὥρα

"the hour has come"

Jesus uses **hour** to refer to the time when Jesus would suffer and die. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the time for me to suffer and die has come]

See: Metonymy

John 17:1 (#1)

ταῦτα ἐλάλησεν

"said these things"

Here, **these things** refers to everything that Jesus told his disciples in chapters 13–16. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [described what would happen to him and his disciples]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:1 (#3)

εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν

“to the heaven”

Here, **heaven** refers to the sky. The Jews believed that **heaven**, the place where God dwells, was located above the sky. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [beyond the sky toward God in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:2 (#3)

πάσης σαρκός

“all flesh”

Jesus is describing people by referring to something associated with them, the **flesh** that they are made of. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [over all human beings]

See: Metonymy

John 17:2 (#2)

αὐτῷ & αὐτῷ, δώσῃ

“him & him, he would give”

Throughout this verse Jesus is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 17:2 (#1)

καθὼς ἔδωκας αὐτῷ ἐξουσίαν πάσης σαρκός

“since you gave him authority {over} all flesh”

Here, **since** indicates that this clause is the reason for the request given in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [because you gave him authority over all flesh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 17:3 (#1)

αὕτη δέ ἐστιν ἡ αἰώνιος ζωὴ

“Now this is eternal life”

The clause could mean: (1) the rest of the verse describes what **eternal life** is. Alternate translation: [Now this is what it means to have eternal life]; (2) the rest of the verse describes the means by which one receives eternal life. Alternate translation: [Now this is how people live forever]

John 17:3 (#2)

ὃν ἀπέστειλας, Ἰησοῦν Χριστόν

“the one you sent, Jesus Christ”

Jesus uses **the one you sent** and **Jesus Christ** to refer to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person, as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 17:4 (#1)

τὸ ἔργον & ὃ δέδωκάς μοι

“the work that you have given me”

Jesus uses **work** to refer to Jesus’ entire ministry while on the earth. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ministry that you have given me here]

See: Metonymy

John 17:5 (#1)

δόξασόν με σύ, Πάτερ, παρὰ σεαυτῷ, τῇ δόξῃ ᾗ εἶχον & παρὰ σοί

“Father, glorify me along with yourself with the glory that I had with you”

Here, **with yourself** and **with you** refer to Jesus and God the **Father** being physically near to each other. If this use of **with** might be confusing to your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [Father, glorify me at your side with the glory that I had at your side]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:5 (#3)

δόξασόν & σύ

“glorify”

Here, **glorify** is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please glorify]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 17:5 (#2)

Πάτερ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:5 (#4)

τῇ δόξῃ

“with the glory”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [with the glorious characteristics]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 17:5 (#5)

πρὸ τοῦ τὸν κόσμον, εἶναι

“before the world was made”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [before we made the world]

See: Active or Passive

John 17:6 (#3)

τὸν λόγον σου τετήρηκαν

“they have kept your word”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 8:51.

See: Metonymy

John 17:6 (#1)

ἐφανέρωσά σου τὸ ὄνομα

“I revealed your name”

Jesus uses **name** to refer to God himself. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I revealed you]

See: Metonymy

John 17:6 (#2)

ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου

“from the world”

See how you translated **world** in 1:29.

See: Metonymy

John 17:8 (#1)

τὰ ῥήματα

“the words”

See how you translated **words** in 5:47.

See: Metonymy

John 17:9 (#1)

τοῦ κόσμου

“the world”

Jesus uses **world** to refer to the people in the **world** who oppose God. See how you translated **world** in 14:17.

See: Metonymy

John 17:10 (#2)

ἐν αὐτοῖς

“in them”

This could mean: (1) **all things** are the means by which Jesus is glorified. Alternate translation: [by means of them]; (2) Jesus is glorified **in all things**. Alternate translation: [within them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:10 (#1)

δεδόξασμαι ἐν αὐτοῖς

“I am glorified in them”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they glorify me]

See: Active or Passive

John 17:11 (#3)

Πάτερ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:11 (#4)

τήρησον

“keep”

Here, **keep** is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It

may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please keep]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 17:11 (#5)

τήρησον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου

“keep them in your name”

Here, **name** could refer to: (1) God’s power. Alternate translation: [keep them by your power]; (2) God himself, as in 17:6. In this case, Jesus would be requesting that God keep his disciples united with God. Alternate translation: [keep them in unity with you]

See: Metonymy

John 17:11 (#1)

οὐκέτι εἰμὶ & πρὸς σὲ ἔρχομαι

“I am no longer & am coming to you”

Here Jesus uses **am** in the present tense to refer to something that will happen in the near future. If this is confusing in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [I will no longer … I am about to come to you]

See: Predictive Past

John 17:11 (#2)

ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ, καὶ αὐτοὶ ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ εἰσίν

“in the world, but they are in the world”

Jesus uses **world** to refer to both being on the earth and being among the people in the **world** who oppose God. If this use of **world** would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in this world with people who oppose you, but they are in this hostile world]

See: Metonymy

John 17:12 (#5)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“the son of destruction”

Here, **son of** is an idiom used to describe what a person is like. The defining characteristic of Judas was that he would be destroyed because he betrayed Jesus. If this use of **son of** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one characterized by destruction]

See: Idiom

John 17:12 (#3)

οὐδεὶς ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπώλετο, εἰ μὴ ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“not one of them perished, except for the son of destruction”

Jesus uses the past tense **perished** to refer to eternal punishment as if it had already happened, even though **the son of destruction** had not yet **perished**. If this use of the past tense might confuse your readers, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [not one of them will perish, except for the son of destruction]

See: Predictive Past

John 17:12 (#4)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“the son of destruction”

Here, **son of destruction** refers to Judas, the disciple who betrayed Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Judas, the son of destruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:12 (#1)

ἐγὼ ἐτήρουν αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου

“I kept them in your name”

See how you translated a similar phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

John 17:12 (#7)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

“so that the scripture would be fulfilled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that he would fulfill the scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 17:12 (#2)

οὐδεὶς ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπώλετο, εἰ μὴ ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“not one of them perished, except for the son of destruction”

Jesus uses **perished** and **destruction** to refer to spiritual death, which is eternal punishment in hell that occurs after physical death. If this use of these

words might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [not one of them died spiritually, except for the son of spiritual death] or [not one of them experienced spiritual death, except for the son of spiritual death]

See: Metaphor

John 17:12 (#6)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“the son of destruction”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the son that must be destroyed] or [the son whom you will destroy]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 17:13 (#1)

τῷ κόσμῳ

“the world”

See how you translated **the world** in 17:11.

See: Metonymy

John 17:13 (#2)

ἵνα ἔχωσιν τὴν χαρὰν τὴν ἐμὴν, πεπληρωμένην ἐν ἑαυτοῖς

“so that they would have my joy fulfilled in themselves”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that I might give them my full joy]

See: Active or Passive

John 17:14 (#3)

οὐκ εἰσὶν ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου, καθὼς ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου

“they are not from the world, just as I am not from the world”

The phrase **from the world** could refer to: (1) the place where the subject belongs. Alternate translation: [they do not belong to the world, just as I do not belong to the world]; (2) the origin of the subject. Alternate translation: [they did not come from the world, just as I did not come from the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:14 (#2)

ὁ κόσμος & ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου & ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου

“the world & from the world & I am not from the world”

Here, **the world** refers to the people in **the world** who oppose God. If this use of **the world** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people who oppose you ... from those who oppose you ... I am not from them]

See: Metonymy

John 17:14 (#1)

τὸν λόγον σου

“your word”

See how you translated **your word** in 17:6.

See: Metonymy

John 17:15 (#1)

τοῦ κόσμου

“the world”

Here Jesus uses **world** to refer to both being on the earth and being among the people in the **world** who oppose God. See how you translated this use of **world** in 17:11.

See: Metonymy

John 17:15 (#2)

τηρήσῃς αὐτοὺς ἐκ τοῦ πονηροῦ

“you would keep them from the evil one”

Here, **the evil one** refers to Satan. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you would keep them from Satan, the evil one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:16 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου οὐκ εἰσὶν, καθὼς ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου

“They are not from the world, just as I am not from the world”

See how you translated **from the world** in 17:14.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:17 (#2)

ἁγίασον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ

“Sanctify them by the truth”

The phrase **by the truth** could refer to: (1) the means by which Jesus’ disciples would be sanctified. Alternate translation: [Sanctify them by means of the truth]; (2) the realm in which Jesus’ disciples would be sanctified. Alternate translation: [Sanctify them in the truth]; (3) both the means and realm of the disciples’ sanctification. See the discussion of John’s use of double meaning in Part 3 of the Introduction to this book. Alternate translation: [Sanctify them by means of and in the truth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:17 (#3)

ὁ λόγος ὁ σὸς

“your word”

See how you translated **your word** in 17:6.

See: Metonymy

John 17:17 (#1)

ἁγίασον

“Sanctify”

Sanctify is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please sanctify]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

John 17:18 (#1)

εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“into the world”

Here, **the world** refers to the people who live in the world. See how you translated **the world** in 1:29.

See: Metonymy

John 17:19 (#2)

ἵνα ὦσιν καὶ αὐτοὶ ἡγιασμένοι ἐν ἀληθείᾳ

“so that they themselves may also be sanctified in truth”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that they may also sanctify themselves in truth]

See: Active or Passive

John 17:19 (#3)

ἡγιασμένοι ἐν ἀληθείᾳ

“sanctified in truth”

The phrase **in truth** could refer to: (1) the means by which Jesus’ disciples would be sanctified. Alternate translation: [sanctified by means of truth]; (2) the nature or degree of their sanctification. Alternate translation: [truly sanctified]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:19 (#1)

ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν ἐγὼ ἁγιάζω ἐμαυτόν

“for their sakes I have sanctified myself”

Jesus uses the phrases **for their sakes** and **sanctified** together to refer to his sacrificial death on the cross. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for their sakes I have sanctified myself to die as a sacrifice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:20 (#1)

διὰ τοῦ λόγου αὐτῶν

“through their word”

Here, **word** refers to the message that Jesus and his disciples proclaimed. If this use of **word** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through their message]

See: Metonymy

John 17:21 (#2)

σύ, Πάτερ, ἐν ἐμοὶ, κἀγὼ ἐν σοί

“you, Father, {are} in me, and I in you”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. See how you translated a similar phrase in 10:38. Alternate translation: [you, Father, and I are completely joined together as one]

See: Doublet

John 17:21 (#5)

ὁ κόσμος

“the world”

Here, **the world** is used to refer to all the people in **the world**. See how you translated **the world** in 1:29.

See: Metonymy

John 17:21 (#3)

Πάτερ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:21 (#1)

ἵνα & ἵνα

"that & that"

The first **that** in this verse indicates one of Jesus' prayer requests, namely, that all those who believe in Jesus would be united to each other. The second **that** indicates another prayer request, namely, that all those who believe in Jesus would be united to Jesus and God the Father. If this would not be clear in your language, you could make these two prayer requests more explicit by making them into two sentences. Alternate translation: [I request that ... I also request that]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:21 (#4)

ἵνα ὁ κόσμος πιστεύῃ ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας

"so that the world would believe that you have sent me"

Here, **so that** could indicate: (1) that what follows is the purpose for believers to be united to Jesus and God the Father, as in the UST. (2) that what follows is the result of believers being united to Jesus and God the Father. Alternate translation (with a comma preceding): [with the result that the world would believe that you have sent me]

John 17:22 (#1)

κἀγὼ τὴν, δόξαν ἣν δέδωκάς μοι, δέδωκα αὐτοῖς

"The glory that you gave to me, I also have given to them"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [I have also given to them the glory that you gave to me] or [I have honored them just as you have honored me]

See: Information Structure

John 17:23 (#1)

ἐγὼ ἐν αὐτοῖς

"I in them"

This verse explains the statement "they would be one, just as we are one," which is in the previous verse. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I mean that I am in them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:23 (#4)

ὁ κόσμος

"the world"

See how you translated **the world** in 17:21.

See: Metonymy

John 17:23 (#2)

ἵνα ὦσιν τετελειωμένοι εἰς ἕν

"so that they may be made complete as one"

Here, **so that** indicates that this is the second purpose for Jesus giving the glory he received from God to those who believe in him, which he stated in the previous verse. If this use of **so that** might confuse your readers, you could state this explicitly by repeating the idea from the previous verse and starting a new sentence. Alternate translation: [I have given them your glory so that they may be completely united]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 17:23 (#3)

ἵνα γινώσκῃ ὁ κόσμος ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας

"so that the world may know that you sent me"

Here, **so that** could refer to: (1) the purpose for those who believe in Jesus being **complete as one**. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of the world knowing that you send me]; (2) a third purpose for Jesus giving the glory he received from God to those who believe in him. This interpretation would require making a new sentence. Alternate translation: [I have also given them your glory so that the world may know that you sent me]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

John 17:23 (#5)

ἠγάπησας αὐτοὺς

"you loved them"

Here, **them** refers to those who believe in Jesus, just like **them** does at the beginning of the verse. These believers are also the main subject of Jesus' prayer in 17:20–26. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you loved those who believe in me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:24 (#1)

Πάτερ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:24 (#2)

ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ

"where I am"

Here Jesus uses **am** in the present tense to refer to something that will happen in the near future. If this is confusing in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [where I will soon be]

See: Predictive Past

John 17:24 (#5)

κόσμου

"of the world"

Here, **world** refers to the universe that God created. It does not refer only to the people in the world or only to the earth. Alternate translation: [the whole universe]

See: Metonymy

John 17:24 (#4)

πρὸ καταβολῆς κόσμου

"before the foundation of the world"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **foundation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [before we founded the world]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 17:24 (#3)

ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ

"where I am"

Jesus uses **where I am** to refer to heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [where I am in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 17:25 (#2)

ὁ κόσμος σε οὐκ ἔγνω

"the world did not know you"

Here, **the world** refers to the people in **the world** who are opposed to God. Alternate translation: [those who are against you did not know you]

See: Metonymy

John 17:25 (#1)

Πάτερ

"Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 17:26 (#2)

ἡ ἀγάπη ἣν ἠγάπησάς με, ἐν αὐτοῖς ᾖ

"the love with which you have loved me may be in them"

Jesus speaks of God's **love** as if it were an object that could be inside a person. If this use of **love** might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they may love others in the same way that you have loved me] or [the love with which you have loved me may be experienced by them]

See: Metaphor

John 17:26 (#1)

τὸ ὄνομά

"name"

Here, **name** refers to God himself. See how you translated this word in 17:6.

See: Metonymy

John 17:26 (#3)

κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτοῖς

"and I in them"

Jesus uses the word **in** to express the close personal relationship between himself and those who believe in him. See how you translated a similar phrase in 10:38.

See: Idiom

John - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Soldiers and guards arrest Jesus (18:1–11)
2. The priests question Jesus, and Peter denies Jesus (18:12–27)
3. Pilate questions Jesus (18:28–40)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"It is not lawful for us to put any man to death"
The Roman government did not allow the Jews to kill criminals, so the Jews needed to ask Pilate, the governor, to kill him (18:31).

King of the Jews
When Pilate asked if Jesus were the King of the Jews (18:33), he was asking if Jesus were claiming to be a political leader like King Herod, whom the Romans allowed to rule Judea. When he asked the crowd if he should release the King of the Jews (18:39), he is mocking the Jews, because the Romans and Jews hated each other. He was also mocking Jesus, because he did not think that Jesus was a king at all. (See: Irony)

John 18:1 (#2)

τοῦ χειμάρρου τοῦ Κεδρὼν

"the brook of the Kidron"

John is using **of** to describe a **brook** that is called **Kidron**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the Kidron Brook] or [the brook that people called "Kidron"]

See: Possession

John 18:1 (#1)

ταῦτα εἰπὼν, Ἰησοῦς

"Having spoken these things, Jesus"

John uses this phrase to mark the beginning of a new event that happened soon after the events that the story has just told. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Soon after Jesus spoke these words, he]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 18:1 (#3)

τοῦ χειμάρρου τοῦ Κεδρὼν

"the brook of the Kidron"

Kidron is a valley in Jerusalem that is between the Temple Mount and the Mount of Olives.

See: How to Translate Names

John 18:1 (#4)

ὅπου ἦν κῆπος

"where there was a garden"

The word translated as **garden** can refer to a place with flowers, vegetables, or trees. Matthew 26:36 and Mark 14:32 indicate that the **garden** that Jesus and his disciples went to was a grove of olive trees. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [where there was a grove of olive trees]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:1–2 (#1)

18:1–2 give background information for the events that follow. Verse 1 says where the events took place. Verse 2 gives background information about Judas. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:3 (#1)

ὑπηρέτας

"officers"

See how you translated **officers** in 7:32.

John 18:3 (#2)

ἔρχεται

"comes"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 18:4 (#1)

εἰδὼς πάντα τὰ ἐρχόμενα ἐπ' αὐτὸν

"knowing all the things happening to him"

Here, **knowing** introduces a clause that indicates the reason why Jesus went out to meet the soldiers and guards. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [since he knew all things happening to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 18:5 (#1)

Ἰησοῦν τὸν Ναζωραῖον

“Jesus the Nazarene”

The soldiers and guards call Jesus **the Nazarene** because he was from the town of Nazareth in Galilee. If this might confuse your readers, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Jesus, from the town of Nazareth]

See: How to Translate Names

John 18:5 (#3)

ἐγώ εἰμι

“I am”

This could mean: (1) Jesus is just answering their question. In this case he is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. Alternate translation: [I am he] or [I am whom you are looking for]; (2) Jesus is not only answering their question but also identifying himself as Yahweh, who identified himself to Moses as “I AM” in Exodus 3:14. Alternate translation: [I am God] or [I am the I AM]

See: Ellipsis

John 18:5 (#4)

ἵστήκει δὲ καὶ Ἰούδας, ὁ παραδιδοὺς αὐτὸν, μετ’ αὐτῶν

“Now Judas, the one betraying him, was also standing with them”

In this sentence John provides background information about Judas’ location when he was **betraying** Jesus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [Now Judas was also there with them to betray Jesus]

See: Background Information

John 18:5 (#2)

λέγει

“He says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 18:6 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι

“I am”

See how you translated **I am** in the previous verse.

See: Ellipsis

John 18:6 (#2)

ἔπεσαν χαμαί

“fell to the ground”

John implies that the men fell to the ground involuntarily because of Jesus’ power. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [fell to the ground because of Jesus’ power]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:7 (#1)

Ἰησοῦν τὸν Ναζωραῖον

“Jesus the Nazarene”

See how you translated **Jesus the Nazarene** in 18:5.

See: How to Translate Names

John 18:8 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι

“I am”

See how you translated **I am** in 18:5.

See: Ellipsis

John 18:9 (#2)

ἵνα πληρωθῇ ὁ λόγος ὃν εἶπεν

“This was} so that would be fulfilled the word that he said”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This happened in order to fulfill the word that he had said]

See: Active or Passive

John 18:9 (#1)

In this verse John provides some background information about Jesus fulfilling Scripture. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:9 (#3)

ὁ λόγος ὃν εἶπεν

“the word that he said”

Here, **the word** refers to what Jesus said while praying to God the Father in 17:12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [what he had said when he was praying to his Father]

See: Metonymy

John 18:10 (#3)

Μάλχος

“Malchus”

Malchus is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

John 18:10 (#1)

Σίμων & Πέτρος

“Simon Peter”

See how you translated **Simon Peter** in 1:40.

See: How to Translate Names

John 18:10 (#2)

μάχαιραν

“a sword”

The word translated as **sword** here refers to a small sword that is similar to a dagger or long knife. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a dagger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:11 (#2)

τὸ ποτήριον ὃ δέδωκέν μοι ὁ Πατὴρ, οὐ μὴ πίω αὐτό

“The cup which the Father has given me, should I certainly not drink it”

Here Jesus uses **cup** to refer to the sufferings he will soon experience as if they were a **cup** of bitter-tasting liquid that God would give him to **drink**. If this use of **cup** and **drink** would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [My suffering which the Father wants me to endure, should I certainly not endure it]

See: Metaphor

John 18:11 (#3)

Πατὴρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 18:11 (#1)

τὸ ποτήριον ὃ δέδωκέν μοι ὁ Πατὴρ, οὐ μὴ πίω αὐτό

“The cup which the Father has given me, should I certainly not drink it”

Jesus is using the form of a question to add emphasis to his statement. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I should certainly drink the cup that the Father has given to me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:12 (#2)

ἔδησαν αὐτὸν

“tied him up”

The soldiers **tied** Jesus’ hands together in order to prevent him from escaping. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [tied his hands to prevent him from escaping]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:12 (#1)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“of the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 18:13 (#1)

πρὸς Ἄνναν πρῶτον, ἦν γὰρ πενθερὸς τοῦ Καϊάφα, ὃς ἦν ἀρχιερεὺς τοῦ ἐνιαυτοῦ ἐκείνου

“first to Annas, for he was the father-in-law of Caiaphas, who was high priest that year”

Usually there would only have been one high priest, but at this time the Romans were appointing the high priests for Judea, and it caused a controversy. One Roman official had appointed **Annas**, but ten years later

another official deposed him and caused **Caiaphas** to be **high priest** instead. However, the Jews still considered Annas to be **high priest**. It would probably be best to state the matter as simply as possible for your readers. Alternate translation: [first to the high priest Annas, for he was the father-in-law of Caiaphas, who was the other high priest that year]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:14 (#2)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"the Jews"

See how you translated **to the Jews** in 18:12.

See: Synecdoche

John 18:14 (#3)

συμφέρει ἕνα ἄνθρωπον ἀποθανεῖν ὑπὲρ τοῦ λαοῦ

"it would be better for one man to die on behalf of the people"

See how you translated the similar clause in 11:50.

John 18:14 (#1)

In this verse John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide some background information about Caiaphas. This information helps the reader understand why they took Jesus to Caiaphas. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:14 (#4)

συμφέρει ἕνα ἄνθρωπον ἀποθανεῖν ὑπὲρ τοῦ λαοῦ

"it would be better for one man to die on behalf of the people"

Caiaphas is leaving out a clause that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from his original statement in 11:50. Alternate translation: [it would be better for one man to die on behalf of the people than to let the Romans kill all of the Jewish people]

See: Ellipsis

John 18:15 (#3)

τῷ ἀρχιερεῖ & τοῦ ἀρχιερέως

"to the high priest & of the high priest"

In verses 15–23, **the high priest** refers to Annas, which is indicated in 18:13. It does not refer to Caiaphas. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the high priest Annas ... of Annas]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:15 (#1)

ἠκολούθει & τῷ Ἰησοῦ & ἄλλος μαθητής. ὁ δὲ μαθητὴς ἐκεῖνος ἦν γνωστὸς τῷ ἀρχιερεῖ, καὶ συνεισῆλθεν

"another disciple followed Jesus. Now that disciple was known to the high priest, and he entered"

Here, **another disciple** and **that disciple** could refer to: (1) the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. This interpretation would mean that these phrases would be similar to the phrase "the other disciple, whom Jesus loved" that occurs in (20:2). Alternate translation: [I, another disciple, followed Jesus. Now I was known to the high priest, and I entered]; (2) an unknown disciple. Alternate translation: [a certain disciple, followed Jesus. Now that other disciple was known to the high priest, and he entered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:15 (#2)

ὁ δὲ μαθητὴς ἐκεῖνος ἦν γνωστὸς τῷ ἀρχιερεῖ

"Now that disciple was known to the high priest"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now the high priest knew that disciple]

See: Active or Passive

John 18:16 (#1)

ὁ μαθητὴς ὁ ἄλλος

"the other disciple"

See how you translated **the other disciple** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:16 (#2)

ὅς ἦν γνωστὸς τοῦ ἀρχιερέως

"who was known to the high priest"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form

or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom the high priest knew]

See: Active or Passive

John 18:17 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 18:17 (#2)

μὴ καὶ σὺ ἐκ τῶν μαθητῶν εἶ τοῦ ἀνθρώπου τούτου

"Are you not also from the disciples of this man"

The **female servant** is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that she believes **Peter** is one of Jesus' **disciples**. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are certainly also from the disciples of this man!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:18 (#2)

ἵστήκεισαν δὲ οἱ δοῦλοι καὶ οἱ ὑπηρέται, ἀνθρακιὰν πεποιηκότες, ὅτι ψῦχος ἦν, καὶ ἐθερμαίνοντο

"Now the servants and the officers were standing there, having made a charcoal fire, for it was cold, and they were warming themselves"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Now because it was cold, the servants and the officers had made a charcoal fire and were standing there, warming themselves]

See: Information Structure

John 18:18 (#1)

In this verse John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide some background information about the people who were warming themselves around the fire. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:18 (#3)

οἱ δοῦλοι

"the servants"

Here, **the servants** refers to the personal **servants** of the high priest. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the servants of the high priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:19 (#1)

ὁ & ἀρχιερεὺς

"the high priest"

According to 18:13 the **high priest** here is Annas. He would later send Jesus to Caiaphas in 18:24. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Annas, the high priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:20 (#4)

ὅπου πάντες οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι συνέρχονται

"where all the Jews come together"

Here, **all the Jews** is an exaggeration that Jesus uses to emphasize that Jesus spoke where many Jewish people could hear him. If this would confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language that shows emphasis. Alternate translation: [where so many Jews come together]

See: Hyperbole

John 18:20 (#2)

ἐγὼ παρρησίᾳ λελάληκα τῷ κόσμῳ

"I have spoken openly to the world"

Here, **to the world** is an exaggeration that Jesus uses to emphasize that he spoke publicly. If this would confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language that shows emphasis. Alternate translation: [I have spoken openly to the people] or [I have spoken openly for everyone to hear]

See: Hyperbole

John 18:20 (#5)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish people in general. It does not refer to the Jewish leaders. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could express

the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:20 (#1)

τῷ κόσμῳ

"to the world"

Jesus uses **the world** to refer to all of the people in the world. If this use of **world** would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to all people]

See: Metonymy

John 18:20 (#3)

ἐν συναγωγῇ

"in a synagogue"

Jesus is speaking of synagogues in general, not of one particular **synagogue**. If this would be misunderstood in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [in synagogues]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 18:21 (#2)

ἴδε

"Behold"

Jesus uses **Behold** to call attention to what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here. Alternate translation: [Take notice]

See: Metaphor

John 18:21 (#1)

τί με ἐρωτᾷς

"Why do you ask me"

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. The Jewish law required the Jewish leaders to question witnesses first in legal cases. Therefore, Jesus is using this question to emphasize that the Jewish leaders are breaking their own law by questioning him instead of questioning witnesses. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should not be asking me these questions!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:22 (#2)

οὕτως ἀποκρίνῃ τῷ ἀρχιερεῖ

"Do you answer the high priest in this manner"

The officer is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation, and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should not answer the high priest in this manner!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:22 (#1)

ἔδωκεν ῥάπισμα τῷ Ἰησοῦ εἰπών

"gave Jesus a slap, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [gave Jesus a slap and said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 18:23 (#1)

μαρτύρησον περὶ τοῦ κακοῦ

"testify about the wrong"

Alternate translation: [tell me what I said that was wrong]

John 18:23 (#2)

εἰ δὲ καλῶς, τί με δέρεις

"but if rightly, why do you strike me"

Jesus is using the form of a question to add emphasis to what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [but if rightly, you should not strike me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:24 (#1)

ὁ Ἅννας & πρὸς Καϊάφαν τὸν ἀρχιερέα

"Annas & to Caiaphas the high priest"

For political reasons both **Annas** and **Caiaphas** were high priests at this time. See how you translated these names in 18:13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:25 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Now here indicates that John is changing topics to return to the story about Peter in the high priest’s courtyard. 18:25–27 describe what Peter was doing in the courtyard while the high priest was questioning Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [In the meantime,] or [While Jesus was being questioned,]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

John 18:25 (#2)

μὴ καὶ σὺ ἐκ τῶν μαθητῶν αὐτοῦ εἶ

“Are you not also from among his disciples”

Someone in the high priest’s courtyard is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he believes **Peter** is one of Jesus’ **disciples**. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You are certainly also from the disciples of this man!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:26 (#1)

οὐκ ἐγώ σε εἶδον ἐν τῷ κήπῳ μετ’ αὐτοῦ

“Did I not see you in the garden with him”

One of the high priest’s **servants** is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he believes **Peter** is one of Jesus’ disciples. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I surely saw you in the garden with him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:26 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 18:26 (#3)

τῷ κήπῳ

“the garden”

See how you translated **garden** in 18:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:27 (#1)

πάλιν οὖν ἠρνήσατο Πέτρος

“Peter then denied {it} again”

Here, **it** refers to **Peter** knowing and being with Jesus. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Peter then denied again that he knew Jesus or had been with him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:27 (#2)

ἀλέκτωρ

“a rooster”

See how you translated **rooster** in 13:38.

See: Translate Unknowns

John 18:28 (#1)

John changes topics from describing what Peter was doing to describing what was happening to Jesus. In the next section, Jesus’ accusers bring him to Caiaphas to be questioned by him.

John 18:28 (#5)

ἦν δὲ πρωΐ. καὶ αὐτοὶ οὐκ εἰσῆλθον εἰς τὸ πραιτώριον, ἵνα μὴ μιανθῶσιν, ἀλλὰ φάγωσιν τὸ Πάσχα

“Now it was early in the morning, and they did not enter into the governor’s palace so that they would not be defiled, but might eat the Passover”

In this sentence John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide some background information about why the Jewish people with Jesus did not enter the **governor’s palace**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:28 (#8)

τὸ Πάσχα

“the Passover”

John is using the name of this part of the festival, **Passover**, to refer to the meal that people shared on that occasion. If your readers might not understand this, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Passover meal]

See: Metonymy

John 18:28 (#7)

αὐτοὶ οὐκ εἰσῆλθον εἰς τὸ πραιτώριον, ἵνα μὴ μιανθῶσιν, ἀλλὰ φάγωσιν τὸ Πάσχα

"they did not enter into the governor's palace so that they would not be defiled, but might eat the Passover"

Pilate, the Roman governor, was not a Jew. The Jewish leaders believed that they would become ceremonially unclean if they entered the house of someone who was not a Jew. If they became ceremonially unclean, then they would not be allowed to celebrate the Passover festival. Therefore, the Jewish leaders did not enter the governor's palace. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in the simplest way possible. Alternate translation: [they themselves did not enter into the governor's palace because the governor was a Gentile. They believed that entering a Gentile's home would defile them, so that they would not be allowed to eat the Passover.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:28 (#3)

ἄγουσιν οὖν τὸν Ἰησοῦν ἀπὸ τοῦ Καϊάφα

"Then they led Jesus from Caiaphas"

John implies that they are leading Jesus away from Caiaphas' house. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Then they led Jesus from Caiaphas' house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:28 (#6)

αὐτοὶ οὐκ εἰσῆλθον εἰς τὸ πραιτώριον, ἵνα μὴ μιανθῶσιν, ἀλλὰ φάγωσιν τὸ Πάσχα

"they did not enter into the governor's palace so that they would not be defiled, but might eat the Passover"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [they remained outside the governor's palace so that they would remain ceremonially clean, and might eat the Passover]

See: Double Negatives

John 18:28 (#4)

εἰς τὸ πραιτώριον

"to the governor's palace"

The **governor's palace** refers to the headquarters of the Roman governor. The next verse indicates that the Roman governor's name was Pilate. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the house of the Roman governor, Pilate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:28 (#2)

ἄγουσιν

"they led"

Here, **they** refers to the Jewish leaders and temple guards who were accusing Jesus. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish authorities and their guards led]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 18:29 (#1)

τίνα κατηγορίαν φέρετε κατὰ τοῦ ἀνθρώπου τούτου

"What accusation do you bring against this man"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **accusation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What crime do you accuse this man of committing]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 18:30 (#2)

εἰ μὴ ἦν οὗτος κακὸν ποιῶν, οὐκ ἄν σοι παρεδώκαμεν αὐτόν

"If this one were not an evildoer, we would not have handed him over to you"

The Jewish leaders are making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but they are already convinced that the condition is not true. They have concluded that Jesus is an evildoer. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If this one were not an evildoer, but he is, we would not have handed him over to you, but we did]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 18:30 (#3)

εἰ μὴ ἦν οὗτος κακὸν ποιῶν, οὐκ ἄν σοι παρεδώκαμεν αὐτόν

"If this one were not an evildoer, we would not have handed him over to you"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [This man is an evildoer, so we have brought him to you]

See: Double Negatives

John 18:30 (#1)

οὗτος

"this one"

Here the Jewish leaders say **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus without saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:31 (#2)

ἡμῖν οὐκ ἔξεστιν ἀποκτεῖναι οὐδένα

"It is not lawful for us to put anyone to death"

According to Roman law, the Jews could not **put anyone to death**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [According to Roman law, it is not lawful for us to put anyone to death]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:31 (#1)

εἶπον αὐτῷ οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"The Jews said to him"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 18:32 (#2)

ἵνα ὁ λόγος τοῦ Ἰησοῦ πληρωθῇ

"This was so that the word of Jesus would be fulfilled"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This happened in order to fulfill the word of Jesus]

See: Active or Passive

John 18:32 (#3)

σημαίνων ποίῳ θανάτῳ ἤμελλεν ἀποθνῄσκειν

"to indicate by what kind of death he was about to die"

Here, **kind of death** refers to the manner in which Jesus would die. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to indicate in what manner he was about to die]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:32 (#1)

In this verse John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide some background information about Jesus predicting how he would die. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:33 (#1)

ἐφώνησεν τὸν Ἰησοῦν

"summoned Jesus"

Here, **summoned** implies that **Pilate** ordered some of his soldiers to bring Jesus to him inside his headquarters. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [ordered his soldiers to bring Jesus inside to him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:34 (#1)

ἀπὸ σεαυτοῦ

"from yourself"

Here, **from** indicates the origin of Pilate's question. Jesus is asking Pilate if the question Pilate asked in the previous verse was his own idea. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [based on your own idea] or [on your own initiative]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:35 (#1)

μήτι ἐγὼ Ἰουδαῖός εἰμι

“I am not a Jew, am I”

Pilate is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he was not interested in Jewish religious disagreements. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Well I am certainly not a Jew, and I have no interest in these matters!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:35 (#2)

τὸ ἔθνος τὸ σὸν

“Your own nation”

Here, **nation** refers to the people who were part of the Jewish **nation**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your fellow Jews]

See: Metonymy

John 18:36 (#2)

τοῦ κόσμου τούτου & τοῦ κόσμου τούτου & ἐντεῦθεν

“this world & this world & from here”

In this verse, Jesus uses **this world** and **here** to refer to everything in the universe that has been corrupted by sin and is hostile to God. See how you translated a similar use of **this world** in 8:23.

See: Metonymy

John 18:36 (#3)

εἰ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου τούτου ἦν ἡ βασιλεία ἡ ἐμή, οἱ ὑπηρέται οἱ ἐμοὶ ἠγωνίζοντο ἄν, ἵνα μὴ παραδοθῶ τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“If my kingdom were from this world, my servants would fight so that I would not be handed over to the Jews”

Jesus is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he already knows that the condition is not true. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [If my kingdom were from this world, but it is not, my servants would fight so that I would not be handed over to the Jews, but they do not]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

John 18:36 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

“from this world”

See how you translated **from this world** in 8:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:36 (#4)

ἵνα μὴ παραδοθῶ τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“so that I would not be handed over to the Jews”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that someone would not have handed me over to the Jews]

See: Active or Passive

John 18:36 (#5)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“to the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 18:37 (#1)

σὺ λέγεις ὅτι βασιλεύς εἰμι

“You say that & am a king”

Here Jesus is probably answering Pilate’s question in the affirmative. However, since he does not clearly say, ‘Yes, I am a king,’ you do not need to explain the meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 18:37 (#4)

τῇ ἀληθείᾳ

“to the truth”

Here, **truth** refers to what Jesus reveals about God, which would include his plan for forgiving sinful people through Jesus’ death on the cross. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to the true things about God]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 18:37 (#6)

ἀκούει

“hears”

Here, **hears** means to listen to something with the intent to heed it and respond appropriately. See how you translated this word in 8:43. Alternate translation: [heeds]

See: Metaphor

John 18:37 (#2)

ἐγὼ εἰς τοῦτο γεγέννημαι, καὶ εἰς τοῦτο ἐλήλυθα εἰς τὸν κόσμον

“I & For this I have been born, and for this I have come into the world”

These two phrases mean the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that Jesus came to the earth to tell people the truth about God. If stating the same thing twice might be confusing for your readers, you can combine the phrases into one. Alternate translation: [For this reason I came here]

See: Parallelism

John 18:37 (#5)

πᾶς ὁ ὢν ἐκ τῆς ἀληθείας

“Everyone being from the truth”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to someone who believes the **truth** about God. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [Everyone who believes the truth]

See: Idiom

John 18:37 (#7)

μου τῆς φωνῆς

“my voice”

Jesus uses **voice** to refer to what Jesus says. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the things I say] or [to me]

See: Synecdoche

John 18:37 (#3)

τὸν κόσμον

“the world”

Here, **world** refers to the universe that God created. It does not refer only to the people in the world or only to the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the universe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:38 (#5)

ἐγὼ οὐδεμίαν αἰτίαν εὑρίσκω ἐν αὐτῷ

“I find no guilt in him”

Pilate speaks of **guilt** as if it were an object that can be inside a person. If your readers would not understand this, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I find no evidence that he is guilty of any crime]

See: Metaphor

John 18:38 (#2)

τί ἐστιν ἀλήθεια

“What is truth”

Pilate is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize that he does not believe anyone really knows what **truth** is. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No one can know the truth!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 18:38 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 18:38 (#3)

ἀλήθεια

“truth”

Here, **truth** refers to any true information. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **truth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What is true]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 18:38 (#4)

τοὺς Ἰουδαίους

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 18:39 (#2)

ἐν τῷ Πάσχα

“at the Passover”

Here, **the Passover** refers to the entire **Passover** festival. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the Passover festival]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:39 (#1)

ἕνα ἀπολύσω ὑμῖν

“I would release one {person} to you”

Pilate implies that he would **release** a prisoner when the Jewish leaders asked him to do so. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I would release one prisoner to you at your request] or [I would release one prisoner to you when you asked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:40 (#2)

μὴ τοῦτον, ἀλλὰ τὸν Βαραββᾶν

“Not this one, but Barabbas”

The Jewish leaders are leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Do not release this one, but release Barabbas]

See: Ellipsis

John 18:40 (#4)

ἦν δὲ ὁ Βαραββᾶς λῃστής

“Now Barabbas was a robber”

In this sentence John provides background information about **Barabbas**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 18:40 (#3)

τοῦτον

“this one”

The Jewish leaders say **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus without saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 18:40 (#1)

ἐκραύγασαν & πάλιν λέγοντες

“they cried out again, saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [they cried out again and said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 18:40 (#5)

λῃστής

“a robber”

The word usually translated **robber** can also refer to an insurrectionist, as is indicated by the description of **Barabbas** in Mark 15:7. Alternate translation: [an insurrectionist]

John - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Soldiers beat and mock Jesus (19:1–3)
2. The Jewish leaders convince Pilate to crucify Jesus (19:4–16)
3. Soldiers crucify Jesus (19:17–27)
4. Jesus dies on the cross (19:28–37)
5. Jesus’ friends put his body in a tomb (19:38–42)

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text in order to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 19:24, which are words from the Old Testament.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“Purple garment”
Purple is a color that is from a mixture of red and blue. The soldiers mocked Jesus by putting a purple garment on him. This was because kings wore purple garments. They spoke and acted like they were giving honor to a king, but everyone knew that they were doing it because they hated Jesus. (See: Irony)

"You are not Caesar's friend"
Pilate knew that Jesus was not a criminal, so he did not want to have his soldiers kill him. But the Jews told him that Jesus was claiming to be a king, and anyone who did that was breaking Caesar's laws (19:12).

Ancient Jewish burial customs
According to the burial customs of that time, a dead person's family would wrap the dead body with many strips of linen cloth and place it on a table inside a tomb. The tomb was either a cave or a room cut out of the side a large rock. According to Jewish tradition, the body was left to decompose in the tomb for one year. Then the family would then place the bones in a stone box. If your readers would be unfamiliar with these burial customs, then you may need to provide explanations in your translation or in a note for 19:39–42.

The tomb
The tomb in which Jesus was buried (19:41) was the kind of tomb in which wealthy Jewish families buried their dead. It was an actual room cut into a rock. It had a flat place on one side where they could place the body after they had put oil and spices on it and wrapped it in cloth. Then they would roll a large rock in front of the tomb so no one could see inside or enter.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Sarcasm
The soldiers were insulting Jesus when they said, "Hail, King of the Jews." Pilate was insulting the Jews when he asked, "Should I crucify your king?" He was probably also insulting both Jesus and the Jews when he wrote, "Jesus of Nazareth, King of the Jews." (See: Irony)

Gabbatha, Golgotha
John explained the meanings of these two Aramaic words ("The Pavement" and "The Place of a Skull"). Then he used Greek letters to express the sound of these words. You should also use the letters of your language to express the sounds of these Aramaic words.

John 19:1 (#1)

τότε οὖν ἔλαβεν ὁ Πειλᾶτος τὸν Ἰησοῦν καὶ ἐμαστίγωσεν

"Therefore, Pilate then took Jesus and whipped {him"

Pilate himself did not whip Jesus. John uses **Pilate** to refer to the soldiers whom Pilate ordered to whip Jesus. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Pilate then ordered his soldiers to take Jesus and whip him]

See: Synecdoche

John 19:2 (#2)

ἐπέθηκαν αὐτοῦ τῇ κεφαλῇ, καὶ ἱμάτιον πορφυροῦν περιέβαλον αὐτόν

"They put {it} on his head and put a purple garment on him"

In Roman culture, a **crown** and **purple garment** were worn by kings. The soldiers put a **crown** made from thorns and a **purple garment** on Jesus in order to mock him. If your readers would not understand this, you could express the meaning explicitly. See the discussion of this idea in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [They put it on his head and put a purple garment on him in order to ridicule him by pretending that he was a king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:2 (#1)

πλέξαντες στέφανον ἐξ ἀκανθῶν

"twisted together a crown from thorns"

John uses **thorns** to refer to small branches with **thorns** on them. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [twisted together a crown from thorny branches]

See: Synecdoche

John 19:3 (#1)

καὶ ἔλεγον, χαῖρε, ὁ Βασιλεὺς τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"and were saying, "Hail, King of the Jews"

Hail was a common greeting, but the soldiers use this greeting in order to mock Jesus. They also did not believe that Jesus was really the **King of the Jews**. They actually mean to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of their words. If this might confuse your readers, you could provide a brief explanation. Alternate translation: [and they said in a mocking manner, "Hail, King of the Jews]

See: Irony

John 19:4 (#2)

αὐτοῖς

"to them"

The pronoun **them** refers to the Jewish leaders who had brought Jesus to Pilate. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the Jewish authorities]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 19:4 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:4 (#3)

αἰτίαν ἐν αὐτῷ οὐχ εὑρίσκω

"I find no guilt in him"

See how you translated a similar clause in 18:38.

See: Metaphor

John 19:5 (#2)

τὸν ἀκάνθινον στέφανον καὶ τὸ πορφυροῦν ἱμάτιον

"the crown of thorns and the purple garment"

See how you translated **crown**, **thorns**, and **purple garment** in 19:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:5 (#1)

ἐξῆλθεν

"went"

Your language may state "came" rather than **went** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural in your language.

See: Go and Come

John 19:5 (#3)

λέγει

"he says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:6 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:6 (#3)

ἐγὼ & οὐχ εὑρίσκω ἐν αὐτῷ αἰτίαν

"I find no guilt in him"

See how you translated a similar clause in 19:4 and 18:38.

See: Metaphor

John 19:6 (#2)

ἐκραύγασαν λέγοντες

"they cried out, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [they cried out and said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:7 (#1)

ἀπεκρίθησαν αὐτῷ οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"The Jews answered him"

Here, **The Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 19:7 (#2)

Υἱὸν Θεοῦ ἑαυτὸν ἐποίησεν

"he made himself to be the Son of God"

Here, **made himself** is an idiom that refers to pretending to be something they think he is not. If this might confuse your readers, you could use plain language. Alternate translation: [he pretended to be the Son of God]

See: Idiom

John 19:7 (#3)

Υἱὸν Θεοῦ

"the Son of God"

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 19:8 (#1)

τοῦτον τὸν λόγον

“this word”

Here, **word** refers to what the Jewish leaders said in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [what they said about Jesus claiming to be the Son of God]

See: Metonymy

John 19:8 (#2)

μᾶλλον ἐφοβήθη

“he became even more afraid”

John is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [he grew even more afraid of condemning Jesus] or [he grew even more afraid than before of what might happen to him if he condemned Jesus]

See: Ellipsis

John 19:9 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:9 (#1)

εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὸ πραιτώριον πάλιν, καὶ λέγει τῷ Ἰησοῦ

“he entered into the governor’s palace again and says to Jesus”

John implies that the soldiers brought Jesus back into the governor’s palace so Pilate could speak with him. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he entered into the governor’s palace again and told the soldiers to bring Jesus back inside. Then he says to Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:10 (#2)

οὐκ οἶδας ὅτι ἐξουσίαν ἔχω ἀπολῦσαί σε, καὶ ἐξουσίαν ἔχω σταυρῶσαί σε

“Do you not know that I have authority to release you, and I have authority to crucify you”

Pilate is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should know that I am able to release you or to order my soldiers to crucify you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 19:10 (#1)

ἐμοὶ οὐ λαλεῖς

“Are you not speaking to me”

Pilate is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize his surprise that Jesus does not answer his question. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I cannot believe you are refusing to speak to me!] or [Answer me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 19:11 (#5)

μείζονα ἁμαρτίαν ἔχει

“has a greater sin”

Jesus speaks of **sin** as if it were an object that a person could possess in varying amounts. If this use of **sin** might be misunderstood in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are more sinful] or [has committed worse sin]

See: Metaphor

John 19:11 (#2)

εἰ μὴ ἦν δεδομένον σοι ἄνωθεν

“except for what has been given to you from above”

Here, **above** is used to refer to God who dwells in heaven **above**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [from heaven]

See: Metaphor

John 19:11 (#3)

εἰ μὴ ἦν δεδομένον σοι ἄνωθεν

“except for what has been given to you from above”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [except for what God has given to you]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:11 (#1)

οὐκ εἶχες ἐξουσίαν κατ' ἐμοῦ οὐδεμίαν, εἰ μὴ ἦν δεδομένον σοι ἄνωθεν

"You do not have any authority over me, except for what has been given to you from above"

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [You only have authority over me because that authority has been given to you from above]

See: Double Negatives

John 19:11 (#4)

μείζονα ἁμαρτίαν ἔχει

"has a greater sin"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [has a greater sin than your sin]

See: Ellipsis

John 19:12 (#5)

οὐκ εἶ φίλος τοῦ Καίσαρος

"you are not a friend of Caesar"

Alternate translation: [you do not support Caesar] or [you are opposing the emperor]

John 19:12 (#6)

βασιλέα ἑαυτὸν ποιῶν

"making himself a king"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 19:7.

See: Idiom

John 19:12 (#3)

τοῦτον

"this one"

The Jewish leaders say **this one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [this so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:12 (#1)

ἐκ τούτου

"At this"

Here, **this** refers to Jesus' answer. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [When Pilate heard Jesus' answer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:12 (#4)

ἐκραύγασαν λέγοντες

"cried out, saying"

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [cried out and said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:12 (#2)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 19:13 (#2)

ἤγαγεν ἔξω τὸν Ἰησοῦν

"brought Jesus out"

John implies that **Pilate** ordered his soldiers to bring Jesus out. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [commanded the soldiers to bring Jesus out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:13 (#1)

τῶν λόγων τούτων

"these words"

Here, **these words** refers to what the Jewish leaders had said in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [what the Jewish leaders said to him]

See: Metonymy

John 19:13 (#5)

εἰς τόπον λεγόμενον Λιθόστρωτον

“in a place called “The Pavement”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in a place the people called “The Pavement]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:13 (#6)

Ἑβραϊστὶ

“in Hebrew”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:13 (#3)

ἐκάθισεν

“sat down”

Since a person would sit down to teach or make official statements, the phrase **sat down** here implies that Pilate was going to speak to the people about what he had decided to do with Jesus. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [he sat down to judge]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:13 (#7)

Γαββαθᾶ

“Gabbatha”

John writes out the sounds of this Jewish Aramaic word with Greek letters. Since John translates the meaning earlier in the verse, you should write out this word using the most similar sounds in your language.

John 19:13 (#4)

ἐπὶ βήματος

“in the judgment seat”

The **judgment seat** was a special chair in which a leader sat when he was making an official judgment. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in the seat used for judging people]

See: Abstract Nouns

John 19:14 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Now marks a break in the storyline. Here John provides information about the upcoming Passover festival and the time of day when Pilate presented Jesus to the Jewish leaders. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 19:14 (#3)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:14 (#2)

ὥρα ἦν ὡς ἕκτη

“It was about the sixth hour”

In this culture, people counted the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. Here, **the sixth hour** indicates noon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [about noon] or [about 12:00 PM]

John 19:14 (#4)

λέγει τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“he says to the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 19:15 (#4)

λέγει αὐτοῖς ὁ Πειλᾶτος, τὸν βασιλέα ὑμῶν σταυρώσω

“Pilate says to them, “Should I crucify your king”

Pilate does not believe that Jesus is a king. He actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could provide a brief explanation. Alternate translation: [Pilate says to them in a mocking manner, “Should I crucify your king]

See: Irony

John 19:15 (#2)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:15 (#3)

τὸν βασιλέα ὑμῶν σταυρώσω

“Should I crucify your king”

Pilate uses **I** to imply that he would order his soldiers to crucify Jesus. Pilate himself did not crucify people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Should I command my soldiers to crucify your king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:15 (#1)

ἆρον! ἆρον

“Take {him} away! Take {him} away”

Take him away here implies taking a person away to be executed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Take him away to be killed! Take him away to be killed!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:16 (#1)

τότε & παρέδωκεν αὐτὸν αὐτοῖς, ἵνα σταυρωθῇ

“he then handed him over to them so that he might be crucified”

In this verse, the pronouns **them** and **they** refer to the Roman soldiers who would crucify Jesus. These pronouns do not refer to “the chief priests” in the previous verse because they did not crucify people. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 19:16 (#2)

ἵνα σταυρωθῇ

“so that he might be crucified”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that the soldiers might crucify him]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:16 (#3)

ἀπήγαγον

“and} led {him} away”

The phrase **led him away** implies that the soldiers led Jesus away in order crucify him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and led him away to be crucified]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:17 (#1)

εἰς τὸν λεγόμενον, Κρανίου Τόπον, ὃ λέγεται Ἑβραϊστὶ, Γολγοθᾶ

“to the {place} called “The Place of a Skull,” which in Hebrew is called “Golgotha”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to the place that the people called “The Place of a Skull,” which the Jews call “Golgotha” in Hebrew]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:17 (#2)

Ἑβραϊστὶ

“in Hebrew”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:17 (#3)

Γολγοθᾶ

“Golgotha”

John writes out the sounds of this Jewish Aramaic word using Greek letters. Since John translates the meaning earlier in the verse, you should write out this word using the most similar sounds in your language.

John 19:18 (#1)

μετ’ αὐτοῦ ἄλλους δύο

“with him two others”

John is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [they also crucified two others with him]

See: Ellipsis

John 19:19 (#2)

ἐπὶ τοῦ σταυροῦ

"on the cross"

Here, **the cross** refers specifically to **the cross** on which Jesus was crucified. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the cross they used to crucify Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:19 (#1)

ἔγραψεν & καὶ τίτλον ὁ Πειλᾶτος, καὶ ἔθηκεν ἐπὶ τοῦ σταυροῦ

"Pilate also wrote a title and put it on the cross"

John uses **Pilate** to imply that **Pilate** ordered his soldiers to write the title and put it on the cross. Pilate probably would not have done this himself. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Pilate also commanded his soldiers to write a title on a sign and put it on the cross]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:19 (#3)

ἦν & γεγραμμένον, Ἰησοῦς ὁ Ναζωραῖος, ὁ Βασιλεὺς τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"on it was written: JESUS THE NAZARENE, THE KING OF THE JEWS"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that person wrote on it these words: Jesus the Nazarene, the King of the Jews]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:20 (#2)

τῆς πόλεως

"the city"

Here, **the city** refers to Jerusalem. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the city called Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:20 (#5)

Ῥωμαϊστί

"in Latin"

Latin was the language spoken by the Roman government and Roman soldiers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the language spoken by the Romans]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:20 (#3)

καὶ ἦν γεγραμμένον Ἑβραϊστί, Ῥωμαϊστί, Ἑλληνιστί

"And it was written in Hebrew, in Latin, and in Greek"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The one who prepared the sign wrote the words in three languages: Hebrew, Latin, and Greek]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:20 (#4)

Ἑβραϊστί

"in Hebrew"

See how you translated this phrase, **in Hebrew**, in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:20 (#1)

ὁ τόπος & ὅπου ἐσταυρώθη ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"the place where Jesus was crucified"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the place where they crucified Jesus]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:21 (#2)

ἐκεῖνος

"That one"

The Jewish leaders say **That one** as a disrespectful way to refer to Jesus and to avoid saying his name. If your language has a similar way to refer to someone in an indirect but derogatory manner, you may use it here. Alternate translation: [That so-and-so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:21 (#1)

ἔλεγον οὖν τῷ Πειλάτῳ οἱ ἀρχιερεῖς τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"Therefore, the chief priests of the Jews said to Pilate"

The chief priests had to go back to Pilate's headquarters in order to speak to him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Then the chief priests of the Jews went back to Pilate and said to him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:21 (#3)

ἐκεῖνος εἶπεν, Βασιλεὺς εἰμι τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"That one said, "I am King of the Jews"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [That one said that he is the King of the Jews]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 19:22 (#1)

ὃ γέγραφα, γέγραφα

"What I have written I have written"

Pilate implies that he will not change the words on the notice. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [I have written what I wanted to write, and I will not change it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:22 (#2)

ὃ γέγραφα, γέγραφα

"What I have written I have written"

Pilate uses **I** to imply that he ordered his soldiers to write the title and put it on the cross. Pilate probably would not have done this himself. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [What I told them to write is what they have written]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:23 (#2)

δὲ

"Now"

There is a break from the main storyline that begins with the word **Now** and continues to the end of the next verse. In this break John tells us how this event fulfills Scripture. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 19:23 (#1)

καὶ τὸν χιτῶνα

"and the tunic"

The next verse implies that the soldiers kept the tunic separate from the clothes that they divided. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the tunic they did not divide]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:23 (#3)

ὑφαντὸς δι' ὅλου

"woven in one piece"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone had woven it in one piece]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:24 (#2)

λάχωμεν περὶ αὐτοῦ & ἔβαλον κλῆρον

"we should cast lots for it & cast lots"

The term **lots** refers to objects with different markings on various sides that were used to decide randomly among several possibilities. They were tossed onto the ground to see which marked side would come up on top. If your readers would not be familiar with **lots**, you could use a general expression for gambling. Alternate translation: [we should gamble for it ... gambled]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 19:24 (#3)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ ἡ λέγουσα

"This happened so that the scripture would be fulfilled which says"

John uses **that the scripture would be fulfilled** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book

(Psalm 22:18). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [This happened so that what is written in the Psalms might be fulfilled]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:24 (#5)

διεμερίσαντο τὰ ἱμάτιά μου ἑαυτοῖς, καὶ ἐπὶ τὸν ἱματισμόν μου ἔβαλον κλῆρον

"They divided my garments among themselves and cast lots for my clothing"

In these phrases, John quotes Psalm 22:19. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 19:24 (#4)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ ἡ λέγουσα

"This happened so that the scripture would be fulfilled which says"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [This fulfilled the scripture that said]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:24 (#1)

λάχωμεν περὶ αὐτοῦ, τίνος ἔσται

"we should cast lots for it, whose it will be"

The soldiers are leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. The soldiers will **cast lots** and the winner will receive the shirt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [we should cast lots for it in order to decide whose it will be] or [we should cast lots for it and the winner will get to keep it]

See: Ellipsis

John 19:25 (#1)

τῷ σταυρῷ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

"the cross of Jesus"

John is using **of** to describe **the cross** on which the soldiers had crucified Jesus. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the cross on which Jesus was crucified]

See: Possession

John 19:26 (#1)

τὸν μαθητὴν & ὃν ἠγάπα

"the disciple whom he loved"

See how you translated a similar phrase in 13:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:26 (#2)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:26 (#3)

γύναι

"Woman"

See how you translated **Woman** in 2:4.

John 19:26 (#4)

ἰδοὺ, ὁ υἱός σου

"behold, your son"

Jesus uses **son** to indicate that he wants his disciple, John, to be like a **son** to his mother. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [here is the man who will act like a son to you]

See: Metaphor

John 19:27 (#3)

ἴδε, ἡ μήτηρ σου

"Behold, your mother"

Jesus uses **mother** to indicate that he wants his **mother** to be like a **mother** to his disciple, John. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Here is the woman to whom you will be like a mother]

See: Metaphor

John 19:27 (#1)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:27 (#2)

τῷ μαθητῇ & ἔλαβεν ὁ μαθητὴς αὐτὴν εἰς τὰ ἴδια

“to the disciple & the disciple took her into his own {home”

In this verse, **the disciple** and **his** refer to John, who calls himself “the disciple whom he loved” in the previous verse and who is the author of this Gospel. If this would be confusing in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the disciple whom Jesus loved ... that disciple took her into his own home] or [to me ... I took her into my own home]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:27 (#4)

ἀπ’ ἐκείνης τῆς ὥρας

“from that hour”

Here, **hour** refers to a point in time. It does not refer to a 60-minute length of time. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from that time]

See: Metonymy

John 19:28 (#3)

πάντα

“all things”

Here, **all things** refers to everything that God sent Jesus to the world to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [all the things that God had sent him to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:28 (#4)

τελειωθῇ ἡ Γραφὴ

“the scripture might be completed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he might fulfill the scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:28 (#6)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 19:28 (#5)

ἵνα τελειωθῇ ἡ Γραφὴ

“so that the scripture might be completed”

John uses **that the scripture might be completed** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 69:21). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [so that what is written in the Psalms might be fulfilled]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:28 (#2)

ἤδη πάντα τετέλεσται

“all things had already been completed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he had already completed all things]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:28 (#1)

μετὰ τοῦτο

“After this”

After this introduces a new event that happened soon after the events the story has just told. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Soon afterward]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 19:29 (#5)

ὑσσώπῳ

“on a hyssop”

Here, **hyssop** refers to the stalk from a plant that grows in Israel. Matthew and Mark called this stalk a “reed” in Matthew 27:48 and Mark 15:36. If your readers would not be familiar with this plant, you could use the name of a plant in your area that has stalks or

reeds, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [a reed of a plant called hyssop]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 19:29 (#3)

σπόγγον οὖν μεστὸν τοῦ ὄξους ὑσσώπῳ περιθέντες

"so having put a sponge full of the sour wine on a hyssop"

John implies that someone dipped the **sponge** into the container full of sour wine so that the **sponge** would be **full of the sour wine**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [so having dipped a sponge in the container so that it was full of sour wine, they put it on a hyssop]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:29 (#2)

ὄξους & τοῦ ὄξους

"of sour wine & of the sour wine"

Here, **sour wine** refers to the inexpensive **wine** that common people in Jesus' culture would usually drink to quench thirst. Therefore, the person who gave Jesus this **sour wine** was acting kindly and responding to what he had said in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of common wine ... of that wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:29 (#1)

σκεῦος ἔκειτο ὄξους μεστόν

"A container full of sour wine was placed there"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Someone had placed there a container full of sour wine]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:29 (#4)

σπόγγον

"a sponge"

A **sponge** is a small object that can soak up and hold liquid that comes out of it when the **sponge** is squeezed. If your readers would not be familiar with this thing, you could use the name of something your readers would use for soaking up liquid, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [something to soak up liquid]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 19:30 (#2)

τετέλεσται

"It is finished"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The thing Jesus **finished** could be: (1) all the work that God had sent Jesus to the world to do. This interpretation would connect this phrase to the statement Jesus made in 17:4 when he said that he had "completed the work" that God had given him to do. Alternate translation: [I finished all that I came here to do]; (2) all the Old Testament prophecies about what Jesus would do the first time he came to the earth. This interpretation would connect this phrase to the statement in verse 28, "knowing that all things had already been completed, so that the scripture might be completed." Alternate translation: [I completed all that the scripture has said about me]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:30 (#3)

παρέδωκεν τὸ πνεῦμα

"he gave up his spirit"

This clause is an idiom that means "willingly die." If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [he allowed himself to die]

See: Idiom

John 19:30 (#1)

τὸ ὄξος

"the sour wine"

See how you translated this phrase, **the sour wine**, in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:31 (#4)

ἵνα μὴ μείνῃ ἐπὶ τοῦ σταυροῦ τὰ σώματα ἐν τῷ Σαββάτῳ

"so that the bodies would not remain on the cross during the Sabbath"

According to Jewish religious law, dead bodies could not remain on crosses during the Sabbath. Therefore, the Jewish leaders wanted Pilate to order his soldiers to execute the three men on crosses and remove their bodies before the Sabbath began at sundown. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [so that the bodies would not remain on the cross during the Sabbath, which the Jewish law forbids] or [so that the bodies would not remain on the cross during the Sabbath and thereby violate Jewish law]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:31 (#3)

παρασκευὴ

“a day of preparation”

Here, **day of preparation** refers to the day when the Jewish people prepared for both the Passover festival and the Sabbath. See how you translated a similar phrase in 19:14. Alternate translation: [the day when the Jews prepared for both the Passover festival and the Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:31 (#7)

ἵνα κατεαγῶσιν αὐτῶν τὰ σκέλη, καὶ ἀρθῶσιν

“that their legs would be broken and they would be taken away”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to have someone break their legs and take them away]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:31 (#8)

κατεαγῶσιν αὐτῶν τὰ σκέλη, καὶ ἀρθῶσιν

“their legs would be broken and they would be taken away”

The Jewish leaders wanted Pilate’s soldiers to break the legs of the men who were hanging on crosses because doing that would cause the men to die quickly. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [their legs would be broken so that they would die quickly and their bodies could be taken away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:31 (#6)

ἦν γὰρ μεγάλη ἡ ἡμέρα ἐκείνου τοῦ Σαββάτου

“for that Sabbath was an especially important day”

John notes that this **Sabbath** was **an especially important day** because it was the first day of the Passover celebration. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for that Sabbath was especially important because it occurred during the Passover festival]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:31 (#1)

οἱ οὖν Ἰουδαῖοι, ἐπεὶ παρασκευὴ ἦν, ἵνα μὴ μείνῃ ἐπὶ τοῦ σταυροῦ τὰ σώματα ἐν τῷ Σαββάτῳ (ἦν γὰρ μεγάλη ἡ ἡμέρα ἐκείνου τοῦ Σαββάτου), ἠρώτησαν τὸν Πειλᾶτον, ἵνα κατεαγῶσιν αὐτῶν τὰ σκέλη, καὶ ἀρθῶσιν

“Then the Jews, because it was a day of preparation, so that the bodies would not remain on the cross during the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was an especially important day), asked Pilate that their legs would be broken and they would be taken away”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Then, because it was the day of preparation, the Jews asked Pilate that the men’s legs would be broken and they would be taken away, so that the bodies would not remain on the cross during the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was an especially important day)]

See: Information Structure

John 19:31 (#2)

οἱ & Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 19:31 (#5)

ἐπὶ τοῦ σταυροῦ

“on the cross”

John is speaking of the three crosses on which the men were hanging. He is not referring to one particular **cross**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [on the three crosses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

John 19:32 (#1)

τοῦ ἄλλου τοῦ συνσταυρωθέντος αὐτῷ

“of the other one having been crucified with him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of the other man with whom they had crucified him]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:35 (#2)

ὁ ἑωρακὼς & αὐτοῦ & ἐκεῖνος οἶδεν ὅτι ἀληθῆ λέγει

“the one that had seen this & his & that one knows that he speaks the truth”

These phrases refer to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. He is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, the one who saw this ... my ... I know that I speak the truth]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 19:35 (#3)

ἵνα καὶ ὑμεῖς πιστεύητε

“so that you would also believe”

John is leaving out some of the words that this clause would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [so that you would also believe that Jesus is the Messiah]

See: Ellipsis

John 19:35 (#1)

This verse is a break from the main storyline in which John provides some background information about himself. John is telling readers that they can trust what he has written because he saw these events happen. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 19:36 (#4)

ὀστοῦν οὐ συντριβήσεται αὐτοῦ

“Not one of his bones will be broken”

This sentence is a quotation from Psalm 34:20. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 19:36 (#2)

ἐγένετο & ταῦτα

“these things happened”

Here, **these things** refers to the two events described in 19:33–34. If it would be more natural in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the soldiers did not break Jesus’ legs but pierced his side]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:36 (#5)

ὀστοῦν οὐ συντριβήσεται αὐτοῦ

“Not one of his bones will be broken”

This is a quotation from Psalm 34:20. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one will break even one of his bones]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:36 (#1)

ἐγένετο & ταῦτα, ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

“these things happened in order that the scripture would be fulfilled”

John uses **that the scripture would be fulfilled** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Psalm 34:20). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [these things happened in order that what is written in the Psalms might be fulfilled]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:36 (#3)

ἵνα ἡ Γραφὴ πληρωθῇ

“in order that the scripture would be fulfilled”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation:

[in order to fulfill the words that someone wrote in scripture]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:36–37 (#1)

19:36–37 are another break from the main storyline in which John tells us that the two events in 19:33–34 made some prophecies in scripture come true. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 19:37 (#2)

ὄψονται εἰς ὃν ἐξεκέντησαν

“They will look at him whom they pierced”

This sentence is a quotation from Zechariah 12:10. It may be helpful to your readers to indicate this by setting off all of this material with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

John 19:37 (#1)

ἑτέρα Γραφὴ λέγει

“another scripture says”

John uses **another scripture says** to introduce a quotation from an Old Testament book (Zechariah 12:10). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase that indicates that Jesus is quoting from an important text. Alternate translation: [the prophet Zechariah wrote in another scripture that]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

John 19:38 (#3)

Ἰωσὴφ & ἀπὸ Ἁριμαθαίας

“Joseph from Arimathea”

Arimathea was a city in Judea. Alternate translation: [Joseph who was from the city called Arimathea]

See: How to Translate Names

John 19:38 (#7)

ἐπέτρεψεν ὁ Πειλᾶτος

“Pilate gave him permission”

John implies that **Pilate** gave **Joseph** permission to take away Jesus’ body. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Pilate gave him permission to take away the body of Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:38 (#4)

διὰ τὸν φόβον τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“for fear of the Jews”

John is using **of** to describe the **fear** that **Joseph** felt for the Jewish leaders. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [because he feared the Jews]

See: Possession

John 19:38 (#1)

μετὰ & ταῦτα

“after these things”

After this introduces a new event that happened soon after the events the story has just told. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [soon afterward]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 19:38 (#6)

ἵνα ἄρῃ τὸ σῶμα τοῦ Ἰησοῦ & ἦρεν τὸ σῶμα αὐτοῦ

“that he might take away the body of Jesus & took away his body”

John implies that **Joseph** wanted to **take away the body of Jesus** in order to bury it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that he might take away the body of Jesus in order to bury it … took away and buried his body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:38 (#5)

διὰ τὸν φόβον τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“for fear of the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 19:38 (#2)

Ἰωσὴφ & ἀπὸ Ἁριμαθαίας

“Joseph from Arimathea”

Since Luke 23:50 indicates that **Joseph** was a member of the Sanhedrin, he was likely dwelling in Jerusalem. Therefore, John would mean here that **Joseph** was originally **from Arimathea**. **Joseph** had not come **from Arimathea** to Jerusalem for this occasion. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Joseph, who was originally from Arimathea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:39 (#1)

Νικόδημος

"Nicodemus"

Nicodemus was one of the Pharisees who respected Jesus. See how you translated this name in 3:1.

See: How to Translate Names

John 19:39 (#5)

ὡς λίτρας ἑκατόν

"about 100 litras in weight"

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this weight in terms of modern measurements either in the text or a footnote. One **litra** is about one third of a kilogram or three quarters of a pound. Alternate translation: [about 33 kilograms in weight] or [weighing about thirty-three kilograms]

See: Biblical Weight

John 19:39 (#2)

ὁ ἐλθὼν πρὸς αὐτὸν νυκτὸς τὸ πρῶτον

"the one having come to him at first at night"

This clause refers to the meeting between Jesus and Nicodemus that is described in chapter 3. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who had met Jesus before when he visited him at night]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:39 (#3)

φέρων μίγμα σμύρνης καὶ ἀλόης

"bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes"

According to the burial customs of Jesus' time, people prepared this **mixture** in order to put it on Jesus' body as a way to honor him and to counteract the smell of decay. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes to put on Jesus' body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:39 (#4)

σμύρνης καὶ ἀλόης

"of myrrh and aloes"

This **mixture of myrrh and aloes** consisted of pleasant-smelling substances that were mixed together into an ointment that was put on a dead body in order to counteract the smell of decay. If your readers would not be familiar with these substances, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [of pleasant-smelling substances]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 19:40 (#1)

ἔδησαν αὐτὸ ὀθονίοις μετὰ τῶν ἀρωμάτων

"wrapped it in linen cloths with the spices"

Wrapping a dead body in strips of cloth was the burial custom in this culture. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter. If your readers would not be familiar with such a custom, you could describe it more specifically, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [wrapped strips of linen cloth around his body and put spices under the strips of cloth]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 19:41 (#3)

ἐν ᾧ οὐδέπω οὐδεὶς ἦν τεθειμένος

"in which no one had yet been buried"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in which people had not yet buried anyone]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:41 (#1)

In this verse John interrupts the main storyline in order to provide some background information about the location of the tomb where they would bury Jesus. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 19:41 (#4)

οὐδέπω οὐδεὶς ἦν τεθειμένος

“no one had yet been buried”

The phrase **no one had yet** translates two negative words in Greek. John uses them together to emphasize that the tomb had never been used. If your language can use two negatives together for emphasis without them cancelling each other to create a positive meaning, it would be appropriate to use that construction here.

See: Double Negatives

John 19:41 (#2)

ἦν δὲ ἐν τῷ τόπῳ ὅπου ἐσταυρώθη κῆπος

“Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now in the place where they crucified Jesus there was a garden]

See: Active or Passive

John 19:42 (#1)

διὰ τὴν παρασκευὴν τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“because of the day of preparation of the Jews”

According to Jewish law, no one could work after sundown on **the day of preparation** because sundown marked the beginning of the Sabbath and Passover. This meant that they had to bury Jesus’ body quickly. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [because the Passover and Sabbath were about to begin that evening]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:42 (#2)

ἐκεῖ & διὰ τὴν παρασκευὴν τῶν Ἰουδαίων, ὅτι ἐγγὺς ἦν τὸ μνημεῖον, ἔθηκαν τὸν Ἰησοῦν

“because of the day of preparation of the Jews and because the tomb was close by, they laid Jesus there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [they laid Jesus there because of the day of preparation of the Jews and because the tomb was close by]

See: Information Structure

John 19:42 (#3)

τὴν παρασκευὴν τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the day of preparation of the Jews”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 19:14.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 19:42 (#4)

ἔθηκαν τὸν Ἰησοῦν

“they laid Jesus”

John is referring to putting Jesus’ dead body in a tomb as laying him down. This is a polite way of referring to something unpleasant, and it accurately describes the Jewish burial practice of laying a dead body on a table inside the tomb. See how you translated a similar expression in 11:34. Alternate translation: [they entombed Jesus]

See: Euphemism

John - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Mary Magdalene, Peter, and John go to Jesus’ tomb and find it empty (20:1–10)
2. Mary Magdalene meets Jesus (20:11–18)
3. Ten disciples meet Jesus (20:19–25)
4. Thomas meets Jesus (20:26–29)
5. John states the purpose for this Gospel (20:30–31)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The tomb

The tomb in which Jesus was buried (20:1) was the kind of tomb in which wealthy Jewish families buried their dead. It was a room cut into a rock. It had a flat place on one side where they could place the body after they had put oil and spices on it and wrapped it in cloth. Then they would roll a large rock in front of the tomb so no one could look inside or enter.

“Receive the Holy Spirit”

If your language uses the same word for “breath” and “spirit,” be sure that the reader understands that Jesus was performing a symbolic action by blowing air out of his mouth, and that Jesus was referring to the Holy Spirit, not his breath. (See: Symbolic Action; and Holy Spirit, Spirit of God, Spirit of the Lord, Spirit)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Rabboni
John used Greek letters to express the sound of this Aramaic word. Then he explained that the word means "Teacher." You should also use the letters of your language to express the sounds of the Aramaic word.

Jesus' resurrection body
We do not know what Jesus' body looked like after he became alive again. His disciples knew he was Jesus because they could see his face and touch the places where the soldiers had put the nails through his hands and feet and pierced his side. However, he could also walk through solid walls and doors and sometimes people did not recognize him. It is best not to say more than what the ULT says about Jesus' resurrection body.

Two angels in white
Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John all wrote about angels in white clothing with the women at Jesus' tomb. Two of the authors called them men, but that is only because the angels appeared in human forms. Two of the Gospel authors wrote about two angels, but the other two authors wrote about only one of them. It is best to translate each of these passages as it appears in the ULT rather than trying to make the passages all state the exact same thing. (See: Matthew 28:1–2 and Mark 16:5 and Luke 24:4 and John 20:12)

John 20:1 (#4)

βλέπει τὸν λίθον ἠρμένον

"sees the stone having been rolled away"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [sees that someone had rolled away the stone]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:1 (#3)

ἔρχεται & βλέπει

"comes & sees"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:1 (#2)

τῇ & μιᾷ τῶν σαββάτων

"on the first of the week"

Here John is actually using a cardinal number, "one," to mean **first**. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can also use a cardinal number here in your translation. Alternate translation: [on day one of the week]

See: Ordinal Numbers

John 20:1 (#1)

τῇ & μιᾷ τῶν σαββάτων

"on the first of the week"

John uses **first** to imply the **first** day of the week. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the first day of the week]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:2 (#6)

οὐκ οἴδαμεν ποῦ ἔθηκαν αὐτόν

"we do not know where they have laid him"

When Mary says **we**, she is speaking of herself and some women who came to the tomb with her. These women are mentioned in Matthew 28:1; Mark 16:1; and Luke 24:1, 10, 24. Since she is not speaking of the two disciples, **we** is exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

John 20:2 (#2)

μαθητὴν ὃν ἐφίλει ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"disciple whom Jesus loved"

This phrase refers to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 1 of the Introduction to the Gospel of John and the introduction to Chapter 13. See also how you translated similar phrases in 13:23 and 18:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:2 (#3)

αὐτοῖς

"to them"

If you translated **the other disciple whom Jesus loved** with a first person form earlier in the verse, then you will need to use the first person plural "us" here. Alternate translation: [to us]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:2 (#5)

τὸν Κύριον & αὐτόν

“the Lord & him”

Mary speaks of Jesus’ dead body as if it were Jesus himself. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [the Lord’s body … it]

See: Synecdoche

John 20:2 (#1)

τρέχει & ἔρχεται & λέγει

“she runs & comes & she says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:2 (#4)

αὐτοῖς

“to them”

If you translated **the other disciple whom Jesus loved** with a third person form and your language marks the dual form, then the pronoun **them** here would be in the dual form.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 20:3 (#2)

ἐξῆλθεν & ἦρχοντο

“went out & they went”

If you translated **the other disciple** in the previous verse with a third person form and your language marks the dual form, then the verbs **went out** and **went** would be in the dual form here.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

John 20:3 (#1)

ὁ ἄλλος μαθητής

“the other disciple”

See how you translated **the other disciple** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:3 (#3)

ἦρχοντο

“they went”

If you translated **the other disciple** in the previous verse with a third person form and your language marks the dual form, then the pronoun **they** here would be in the dual form.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 20:3 (#4)

ἦρχοντο

“they went”

If you translated **the other disciple** in the previous verse with a first person singular form, then you will need to use the first person plural “we” here. Alternate translation: [we went]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:4 (#2)

ὁ ἄλλος μαθητὴς

“the other disciple”

See how you translated **the other disciple** in 20:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:4 (#1)

ἔτρεχον & οἱ δύο ὁμοῦ, καὶ ὁ ἄλλος μαθητὴς προέδραμεν τάχειον

“the two were running together, and the other disciple quickly ran ahead”

If you translated **the other disciple** with a first person form in 20:2, then you will need to use first person pronouns in this verse. Alternate translation: [we were running together, and I quickly ran ahead]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:5 (#3)

ὀθόνια

“linen cloths”

Wrapping a dead body in strips of cloth was the burial custom in this culture. See the discussion of this in the introduction for Chapter 19. If your readers would not be familiar with such a custom, you could describe it more specifically, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the linen cloths in which they had wrapped Jesus’ body for burial]

See: Translate Unknowns

John 20:5 (#2)

βλέπει

“he sees”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:5 (#1)

βλέπει & οὐ μέντοι εἰσῆλθεν

“he sees & but he did not enter”

If you translated **the other disciple** with a first person form in the previous verse, then you will need to use first person pronouns in this verse. Alternate translation: [I saw ... but I did not enter]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:6 (#2)

αὐτῷ

“him”

If you translated **the other disciple** with a first person form in 20:4, then you will need to use the first person “me” here.

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:6 (#1)

ἔρχεται & θεωρεῖ

“comes & he sees”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:6 (#3)

ὀθόνια

“linen cloths”

See how you translated **linen cloths** in the previous verse.

See: Translate Unknowns

John 20:7 (#2)

αὐτοῦ

“his”

The pronoun **his** refers to Jesus, not to Peter or John. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 20:7 (#1)

τὸ σουδάριον, ὃ ἦν ἐπὶ τῆς κεφαλῆς αὐτοῦ

“the cloth that had been on his head”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the cloth that someone had put on his head]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:7 (#3)

ὀθονίων

“linen cloths”

See how you translated **linen cloths** in the previous verse.

See: Translate Unknowns

John 20:7 (#4)

ἀλλὰ χωρὶς ἐντετυλιγμένον εἰς ἕνα τόπον

“but having been folded up in one place by itself”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but someone had folded it up in one place by itself]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:8 (#3)

εἶδεν

“he saw”

John is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [he saw the linen cloths where Jesus’ body had lain]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:8 (#2)

εἰσῆλθεν & καὶ εἶδεν καὶ ἐπίστευσεν

“went in, and he saw and believed”

If you translated **the other disciple** with a first person form in this verse, then you will need to use the first person throughout this verse. Alternate translation: [went in, and I saw and believed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 20:8 (#1)

ὁ ἄλλος μαθητὴς

“the other disciple”

See how you translated **the other disciple** in 20:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:8 (#4)

ἐπίστευσεν

“believed”

John is leaving out some of the words that this phrase would need in many languages in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [he believed that Jesus had risen from the dead]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:9 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

For here indicates that this verse provides background information about the kind of belief that was mentioned in the previous clause. **For** here does not indicate a reason or cause. At that time, the disciples believed Jesus had risen from the dead only because the tomb was empty. They still did not understand that the scriptures said Jesus would rise from the dead. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [But even then]

See: Background Information

John 20:9 (#2)

ἐκ νεκρῶν ἀναστῆναι

“to rise from the dead”

Here, **rise from the dead** is an idiom that refers to a dead person becoming alive again. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [become alive after he died]

See: Idiom

John 20:10 (#1)

ἀπῆλθον & πάλιν πρὸς αὐτοὺς

“went away again to their {own homes”

Since the disciples were staying within walking distance of Jesus’ tomb, the **homes** they went to must have been in Jerusalem. They did not go back to their homes in Galilee. Alternate translation: [went back to where they were staying in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:11 (#1)

Μαρία

“Mary”

Mary here refers to **Mary** Magdalene. See how you translated this **Mary** in 19:25.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:12 (#4)

ἔκειτο

“had lain”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone had laid]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:12 (#3)

ἕνα πρὸς τῇ κεφαλῇ, καὶ ἕνα πρὸς τοῖς ποσίν, ὅπου ἔκειτο τὸ σῶμα τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

“one at the head and one at the feet of where the body of Jesus had lain”

Here, **at the head** and **at the feet** refer to the locations in the tomb where Jesus’ head and feet used to be. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one at the place of his head and one at the place of his feet where the body of Jesus had been]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:12 (#1)

θεωρεῖ

“she sees”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:12 (#2)

δύο ἀγγέλους ἐν λευκοῖς

“two angels in white”

Here, **white** refers to the color of the clothing that the angels were wearing. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [two angels in white clothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:13 (#2)

γύναι

“Woman”

See how you translated the similar use of **Woman** in 2:4 and 4:21.

John 20:13 (#1)

λέγουσιν & λέγει

“say & She says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:13 (#3)

τὸν Κύριόν μου & αὐτόν

“my Lord & him”

Mary speaks of Jesus’ dead body as if it were Jesus himself. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [my Lord’s body … it]

See: Synecdoche

John 20:15 (#3)

αὐτόν & αὐτόν & αὐτὸν

“him & him & him”

Mary speaks of Jesus’ dead body as if it were Jesus himself. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [my Lord’s body … it … it]

See: Synecdoche

John 20:15 (#2)

γύναι

“Woman”

See how you translated the word **Woman** in the previous verse.

John 20:15 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει

“says & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:15 (#4)

κἀγὼ αὐτὸν ἀρῶ

“and I will take him away”

Mary Magdalene implies that she would **take** Jesus’ body **away** and bury it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and I will take him away and bury him again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:16 (#4)

Ραββουνεί

“Rabboni”

Here John writes out the sounds of this Jewish Aramaic word with Greek letters. Since John translates the meaning later in the verse, you should write out this word using the most similar sounds in your language.

John 20:16 (#2)

Ἑβραϊστί, Ραββουνεί (ὃ λέγεται, Διδάσκαλε

“in Hebrew, “Rabboni” (which means “Teacher”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [“Rabboni” (which means “Teacher” in Hebrew)]

See: Information Structure

John 20:16 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει

“says & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:16 (#3)

Ἑβραϊστί

“in Hebrew”

See how you translated **in Hebrew** in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:17 (#5)

ἀναβαίνω

"I go up"

Jesus uses the present tense **I go up** to refer to something that will happen in the near future. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the future tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [I will go up]

See: Predictive Past

John 20:17 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:17 (#2)

τὸν Πατέρα & τὸν Πατέρα μου & Πατέρα ὑμῶν

"the Father & my Father & your Father"

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 20:17 (#3)

τοὺς ἀδελφούς μου

"my brothers"

Jesus used the word **my brothers** here to refer to his disciples. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [my disciples, who are like brothers,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:17 (#6)

πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα μου, καὶ Πατέρα ὑμῶν, καὶ Θεόν μου, καὶ Θεὸν ὑμῶν

"to my Father and your Father, and my God and your God"

These two long phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize to whom Jesus will return. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [to God, who is my Father and your Father]

See: Doublet

John 20:17 (#4)

εἰπὲ αὐτοῖς, ἀναβαίνω πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα μου, καὶ Πατέρα ὑμῶν, καὶ Θεόν μου, καὶ Θεὸν ὑμῶν

"say to them, 'I go up to my Father and your Father, and my God and your God"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [say to them that I go up to my Father and your Father, and my God and your God]

See: Quotes within Quotes

John 20:18 (#3)

ἔρχεται Μαριὰμ ἡ Μαγδαληνὴ

"Mary Magdalene comes"

John is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [Mary Magdalene comes to where the disciples were staying]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:18 (#1)

ἔρχεται

"comes"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:18 (#2)

ἔρχεται Μαριὰμ ἡ Μαγδαληνὴ

"Mary Magdalene comes"

Your language may state "goes" rather than **comes** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural. Alternate translation: [Mary Magdalene goes]

See: Go and Come

John 20:19 (#1)

τῇ μιᾷ σαββάτων

"the first of the week"

See how you translated **the first of the week** in 20:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:19 (#2)

τῇ μιᾷ σαββάτων

“the first of the week”

John is actually using a cardinal number, “one,” to mean **first**. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can also use a cardinal number here in your translation. Alternate translation: [on day one of the week]

See: Ordinal Numbers

John 20:19 (#5)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“of the Jews”

Here, **the Jews** refers to the Jewish leaders. See how you translated this term in 1:19.

See: Synecdoche

John 20:19 (#6)

εἰρήνη ὑμῖν

“Peace to you”

This is an idiomatic expression, based on the Hebrew word and concept of “shalom.” It was both a greeting and a blessing. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [I greet all of you and I wish for God to bless you]

See: Idiom

John 20:19 (#3)

τῶν θυρῶν κεκλεισμένων ὅπου ἦσαν οἱ μαθηταὶ

“the doors of where the disciples were having been closed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the disciples having closed the doors of where they were]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:19 (#4)

διὰ τὸν φόβον τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“for fear of the Jews”

See how you translated this phrase in 19:38.

See: Possession

John 20:20 (#1)

ἔδειξεν τὰς χεῖρας & αὐτοῖς

“he showed them his hands”

John uses **his hands** to refer to the nail marks from crucifixion that were in Jesus’ **hands**. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he showed them the nail marks in his hands]

See: Metonymy

John 20:20 (#3)

ἰδόντες τὸν Κύριον

“having seen the Lord”

This could refer to: (1) the time when the disciples rejoiced, as in the UST. (2) the reason why the disciples rejoiced. Alternate translation: [because they saw the Lord]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

John 20:20 (#2)

τὴν πλευρὰν

“his side”

John uses **his side** to refer to the wound that a Roman soldier made in Jesus’ **side** with a spear. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the spear wound in his side]

See: Metonymy

John 20:21 (#4)

ἀπέσταλκέν με & κἀγὼ πέμπω ὑμᾶς

“has sent me, so I send you”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [has sent me into the world, so I send you into the world]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:21 (#2)

Πατήρ

“Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 20:21 (#3)

καθὼς ἀπέσταλκέν με ὁ Πατήρ, κἀγὼ πέμπω ὑμᾶς

“Just as the Father has sent me, so I send you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [I send you just as the Father has sent me]

See: Information Structure

John 20:21 (#1)

εἰρήνη ὑμῖν

“Peace to you”

See how you translated **Peace to you** in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

John 20:22 (#2)

ἐνεφύσησεν

“he breathed on {them”

Here, **breathed on** refers to Jesus blowing air out of his mouth. It does not refer to the normal act of inhaling and exhaling air into one’s lungs. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he blew air on them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:22 (#3)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:22 (#1)

ἐνεφύσησεν

“he breathed on {them”

When Jesus **breathed on them**, he did this symbolic action in order to show that he would give his disciples the **Holy Spirit** in the near future. If this would be helpful to your readers, you could explain its significance. Alternate translation: [he breathed on them as a symbolic action] or [he breathed on them to symbolically show that he was going to give them the Holy Spirit]

See: Symbolic Action

John 20:23 (#1)

ἀφέωνται αὐτοῖς

“they have been forgiven for them”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will forgive them]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:23 (#3)

κεκράτηνται

“they have been retained”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will retain them]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:23 (#2)

ἄν τινων κρατῆτε, κεκράτηνται

“whoever’s {sins} you retain, they have been retained”

To retain **sins** means to not forgive someone for the **sins** that they have committed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [whoever’s sins you might not forgive, they will not be forgiven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:24 (#2)

ὁ λεγόμενος Δίδυμος

“the one called Didymus”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom people called Didymus]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:24 (#1)

τῶν δώδεκα

“the Twelve”

See how you translated **the Twelve** in 6:67.

See: Nominal Adjectives

John 20:25 (#2)

ἐὰν μὴ ἴδω ἐν ταῖς χερσὶν αὐτοῦ τὸν τύπον τῶν ἥλων, καὶ βάλω τὸν δάκτυλόν μου εἰς τὸν τύπον τῶν ἥλων, καὶ βάλω μου τὴν χεῖρα εἰς τὴν πλευρὰν αὐτοῦ, οὐ μὴ πιστεύσω

“Unless I see in his hands the mark of the nails and put my finger into the mark of the nails and put my hand into his side, I will certainly not believe”

If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [I will believe only if I see in his hands the mark of the nails and put my finger into the mark of the nails and put my hand into his side]

See: Double Negatives

John 20:25 (#1)

ἐὰν μὴ ἴδω ἐν ταῖς χερσὶν αὐτοῦ τὸν τύπον τῶν ἥλων, καὶ βάλω τὸν δάκτυλόν μου εἰς τὸν τύπον τῶν ἥλων, καὶ βάλω μου τὴν χεῖρα εἰς τὴν πλευρὰν αὐτοῦ, οὐ μὴ πιστεύσω

“Unless I see in his hands the mark of the nails and put my finger into the mark of the nails and put my hand into his side, I will certainly not believe”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [I will certainly not believe unless I see in his hands the mark of the nails and put my finger into the mark of the nails and put my hand into his side]

See: Information Structure

John 20:25 (#4)

εἰς τὴν πλευρὰν αὐτοῦ

“into his side”

See how you translated **his side** in 20:20.

See: Metonymy

John 20:25 (#3)

τὸν τύπον τῶν ἥλων

“the mark of the nails”

In both of these occurrences, Thomas is using **of** to describe **mark** made by **nails**. He is referring to the holes in Jesus’ hands that were made by the nails that soldiers used to crucify him. Alternate translation: [the marks made by nails ... those marks]

See: Possession

John 20:25 (#5)

οὐ μὴ πιστεύσω

“I will certainly not believe”

Thomas is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [I will certainly not believe that Jesus has become alive again]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:26 (#2)

τῶν θυρῶν κεκλεισμένων

“the doors having been closed”

See how you translated this phrase in 20:19.

See: Active or Passive

John 20:26 (#3)

εἰρήνη ὑμῖν

“Peace to you”

See how you translated **Peace to you** in 20:19.

See: Idiom

John 20:26 (#1)

ἔρχεται

“comes”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:27 (#4)

τὴν πλευράν μου

“my side”

Jesus uses **my side** to refer to the wound that a Roman soldier made in his **side** with a spear. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the spear wound in his side]

See: Metonymy

John 20:27 (#5)

μὴ γίνου ἄπιστος, ἀλλὰ πιστός

“do not be unbelieving, but believing”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize that Jesus wants Thomas to believe that he has become alive again. If your language does not use repetition to do this, you could use one phrase and provide emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you absolutely must believe]

See: Doublet

John 20:27 (#6)

μὴ γίνου ἄπιστος, ἀλλὰ πιστός

“do not be unbelieving, but believing”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [do not be unbelieving that I have become alive again, but believe it]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:27 (#1)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:27 (#3)

τὰς χεῖράς μου

“my hands”

Jesus uses **my hands** to refer to the holes in Jesus’ **hands** that were made by the nails that soldiers used to crucify him. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the nail marks in my hands]

See: Metonymy

John 20:27 (#2)

ὦδε

“here”

Jesus uses **here** to refer to the places on his **hands** where there were holes. These holes in Jesus’ **hands** were made by the nails that soldiers used to crucify him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in these holes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:29 (#3)

μακάριοι οἱ μὴ ἰδόντες

“blessed {are} the ones not having seen”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God blesses those not having seen]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:29 (#2)

πεπίστευκας & πιστεύσαντες

“you have believed & having believed”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [you have believed that I have become alive again ... having believed that I have become alive again]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:29 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 20:29 (#4)

μὴ ἰδόντες

“not having seen”

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [not having seen me]

See: Ellipsis

John 20:30 (#2)

ἃ οὐκ ἔστιν γεγραμμένα ἐν τῷ βιβλίῳ τούτῳ

“which have not been written in this book”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Since John wrote this Gospel, you should use the first person pronoun “I” to indicate who did the action. Alternate translation: [which I have not written in this book]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:30 (#1)

σημεῖα

“signs”

See how you translated the term **signs** in 2:11. See also the discussion of **signs** in Part 3 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. Alternate translation: [significant miracles]

John 20:30–31 (#1)

In 20:30–31 John comments about the story he has written in chapters 1 through 20. He also states his reason for writing this book. He does this in order to indicate that the story is almost finished. Use the natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion of a story.

See: End of Story

John 20:31 (#2)

ταῦτα δὲ γέγραπται

“but these things have been written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but the author wrote about these things]

See: Active or Passive

John 20:31 (#7)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι αὐτοῦ

“in his name”

Here, **in** indicates the means by which people can have eternal **life**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by means of his name]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:31 (#8)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι αὐτοῦ

“in his name”

Here, **his name** could refer to: (1) Jesus himself. Alternate translation: [through union with him] or [by the power of his person]; (2) calling on Jesus’ name for salvation. Alternate translation: [by calling on his name]

See: Synecdoche

John 20:31 (#1)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** could mean: (1) the miraculous signs that John wrote about in his Gospel and mentioned in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [these signs]; (2) everything that John wrote about in his Gospel. Alternate translation: [everything in this book]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:31 (#4)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Son of God”

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

John 20:31 (#6)

ζωὴν

“life”

Here, **life** refers to eternal **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 20:31 (#3)

πιστεύητε & ἔχητε

“you would believe & you would have”

In this verse **you** is plural and could refer to: (1) people who are reading this Gospel and do not trust in Jesus for salvation. Alternate translation: [you might believe … you might have]; (2) people who are reading this Gospel and already believe in Jesus. Alternate translation: [you would continue believing … you would continue to have]

See: Forms of You

John 20:31 (#5)

πιστεύοντες

"believing"

Jesus is leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [believing that Jesus is the Christ]

See: Ellipsis

John - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Jesus eats breakfast with his disciples (21:1–14)
2. Jesus restores Peter as his disciple (21:15–19)
3. Jesus and Peter speak about John (21:20–23)
4. John concludes his Gospel (21:24–25)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The metaphor of sheep
Before Jesus died, he spoke of himself taking care of his people as if he were a good shepherd taking care of sheep (10:11). After he became alive again, Jesus commanded Peter to take care of other believers in the same way. (See: Metaphor)

"The disciple whom Jesus loved"
The apostle John referred to himself as the disciple "whom Jesus loved" twice in this chapter (21:7, 20). Your language may not allow people to speak of themselves as if they were speaking about someone else. If this is the case, then you will need to use a first person pronoun for these references and the other references to John throughout this chapter. You would also need to use first person plural pronouns in this chapter for all references to the disciples as a group, since John was one of them. If your language can retain the third person references, then you may want to make these references to John explicit by adding "John" next to them. See the discussion of this in Part 1 of the General Introduction to the Gospel of John. (See: John (the apostle); and First, Second or Third Person)

Different words for "love"
In 21:15–17, Jesus and Peter speak to each other using two different words in the original language that could both be translated as "love." These words are often used interchangeably. However, when they are used together, as in 21:15–17, they can have slightly different meanings. One word can refer to a type of love that is based on affection and friendship, but the other word can refer to a type of love that is based on sincere devotion and high esteem for the person being loved. Although the UST translates both of these words as "love," the notes will provide more specific alternatives.

John 21:1 (#2)

θαλάσσης τῆς Τιβεριάδος

"Sea of Tiberias"

This **Sea** was also called "the Sea of Galilee." See how you translated the similar name in 6:1.

See: How to Translate Names

John 21:1 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

"After these things"

This phrase introduces a new event that happened some time after the events the story has just related. The story does not say how long after those events this new event happened. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Some time later]

See: Introduction of a New Event

John 21:2 (#2)

Κανὰ τῆς Γαλιλαίας

"Cana of Galilee"

See how you translated **Cana of Galilee** in 2:1.

See: How to Translate Names

John 21:2 (#1)

Θωμᾶς ὁ λεγόμενος Δίδυμος

"Thomas called Didymus"

See how you translated this phrase in 11:16.

See: Active or Passive

John 21:2 (#3)

οἱ τοῦ Ζεβεδαίου

"the {sons} of Zebedee"

This phrase refers to the disciples John and James, whom Jesus called "sons of thunder" in Mark 3:17. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [James and I, the sons of Zebedee]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:2–3 (#1)

21:2–3 provide background information on what happens in the story before Jesus appears to his disciples at the Sea of Tiberias. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 21:3 (#2)

ἡμεῖς

“We”

When the disciples say **We**, they are speaking of themselves without Peter, so **We** would be exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 21:3 (#1)

λέγει & λέγουσιν

“says & They say”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:3 (#3)

ἐρχόμεθα

“are coming”

Your language may state “going” rather than **coming** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [are going]

See: Go and Come

John 21:3 (#4)

ἐνέβησαν εἰς τὸ πλοῖον

“got into a boat”

Here, **got in a boat** implies that they also took the boat out on the Sea of Tiberias in order to fish. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [got into a boat and went fishing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:4 (#1)

ἐστιν

“it is”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:5 (#1)

λέγει

“says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:5 (#3)

μή τι προσφάγιον ἔχετε

“you do not have any fish to eat, do you”

Jesus asks this question in a way that expects a negative response. He knows that the disciples did not catch any fish. If your language has a question form that assumes a negative response, you should use it here. Alternate translation: [you were not able to get any fish to eat, were you?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:5 (#2)

παιδία

“Children”

Jesus uses the word **Children** as an affectionate way to address his disciples. If this would confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My dear friends]

See: Metaphor

John 21:6 (#1)

εὑρήσετε

“you will find some”

Here, **some** refers to fish. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you will find some fish]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:7 (#5)

ἔβαλεν ἑαυτὸν εἰς τὴν θάλασσαν

“threw himself into the sea”

This implies that Peter jumped into the **sea** in order to swim to the shore. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [threw himself into the sea and swam to shore]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:7 (#2)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:7 (#4)

ἦν γὰρ γυμνός

"for he was undressed"

Here, **undressed** does not mean that Peter was naked. Rather, Peter had taken off **his outer garment** so that it would be easier for him to work. Now that he was about to greet Jesus, he wanted to wear more clothing. Alternate translation: [for he had taken off most of his clothes]

See: Background Information

John 21:7 (#1)

ὁ μαθητὴς ἐκεῖνος ὃν ἠγάπα ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"that disciple whom Jesus loved"

This phrase refers to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 1 of the Introduction to John and the introduction for this chapter. See also how you translated similar phrases in 13:23, 18:15, and 20:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:7 (#3)

τὸν ἐπενδύτην διεζώσατο

"put on his outer garment"

Here, **outer garment** refers to a coat that would be worn over a person's regular clothing. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [put on his cloak]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:8 (#2)

ἦσαν

"they were"

If you translated "the disciple whom Jesus loved" in the previous verse with a first person form, then you will need to use the first person plural "we" here. You will also need to use first person plural pronouns in all occurrences of third person plural pronouns that refer to the disciples throughout the rest of this chapter. Alternate translation: [we were]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 21:8 (#1)

οὐ γὰρ ἦσαν μακρὰν ἀπὸ τῆς γῆς, ἀλλὰ ὡς ἀπὸ πηχῶν διακοσίων

"for they were not far from the land, but about 200 cubits away"

John provides this background information about the location of the boat the disciples were fishing in. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [for the boat was near the land, only about 200 cubits away]

See: Background Information

John 21:8 (#3)

πηχῶν διακοσίων

"200 cubits"

A **cubit** is a measurement of distance equivalent to a little less than half of one meter or about one yard. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or a footnote. Alternate translation: [about 90 meters] or [about 100 yards]

See: Biblical Distance

John 21:9 (#3)

ὀψάριον ἐπικείμενον, καὶ ἄρτον

"a fish laid on it and a bread loaf"

The words **fish** and **bread** are singular nouns. These could mean: (1) Jesus had one fish and one loaf of bread, as in the UST. (2) Jesus had an unknown amount of fish and bread that are referred to collectively. Alternate translation: [some fish laid on it, and some bread loaves]

See: Collective Nouns

John 21:9 (#2)

ἀνθρακιὰν κειμένην, καὶ ὀψάριον ἐπικείμενον

"a charcoal fire kindled and a fish laid on it"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation:

[a charcoal fire that Jesus had kindled, and a fish that Jesus had laid on it]

See: Active or Passive

John 21:9 (#1)

βλέπουσιν

"they see"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:10 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:11 (#1)

ἀνέβη οὖν Σίμων Πέτρος

"Therefore, Simon Peter went up"

Here, **went up** means that Simon Peter went back to the boat. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Simon Peter went up into the boat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:11 (#2)

οὐκ ἐσχίσθη τὸ δίκτυον

"the net was not torn"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the fish did not tear the net]

See: Active or Passive

John 21:12 (#1)

λέγει & ἐστιν

"says & it is"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:12 (#2)

ἐξετάσαι αὐτόν, σὺ τίς εἶ

"to ask him, "Who are you"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [to ask him who he is]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 21:13 (#1)

ἔρχεται & λαμβάνει & δίδωσιν

"comes & takes & gives {it"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:14 (#4)

ἐγερθεὶς ἐκ νεκρῶν

"having been raised from the dead"

Here, **raised from the dead** is an idiom that refers to a dead person becoming alive again. See how you translated a similar phrase in 20:9. Alternate translation: [having become alive after he died]

See: Idiom

John 21:14 (#3)

ἐγερθεὶς ἐκ νεκρῶν

"having been raised from the dead"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God having raised him from the dead]

See: Active or Passive

John 21:14 (#1)

τρίτον

"the third time that"

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [time number 3.]

See: Ordinal Numbers

John 21:14 (#2)

ἐφανερώθη

"was revealed"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [showed himself]

See: Active or Passive

John 21:15 (#3)

πλέον τούτων

"more than these"

Here, **these** could refer to: (1) the other disciples who were there with Jesus and Peter. This meaning would indicate Jesus is asking Peter if he loves Jesus more than the other disciples love him. Alternate translation: [more than these disciples love me]; (2) the fish, boat, and other equipment that were used for catching fish, which was Peter's former job. Alternate translation: [more than these fishing tools] or [more than your former job]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:15 (#2)

ἀγαπᾷς με & φιλῶ σε

"do you love me & I love you"

The two occurrences of **love** in this verse are two different words in the original language. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could show this in your translation. See the discussion of this concept in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [do you love me with great esteem ... I love you with affection] or [do you love me deeply ... I love you like a friend]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:15 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει & λέγει

"says & He says & He says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:15 (#4)

βόσκε τὰ ἀρνία μου

"Feed my lambs"

Jesus uses **Feed my lambs** to refer to providing for the spiritual needs of people who trust in Jesus. Here Jesus is commanding Peter to take care of other believers in the same way that Jesus took care of them while he was with them. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Take care of the people who believe in me like a shepherd feeds lambs]

See: Metaphor

John 21:16 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει & λέγει

"He says & He says & He says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:16 (#3)

ἀγαπᾷς με & φιλῶ σε

"do you love me & I love you"

The two occurrences of **love** in this verse are two different words in the original language. See how you translated these phrases in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:16 (#4)

ποίμαινε τὰ πρόβατά μου

"Take care of my sheep"

This sentence has the same meaning as "Feed my lambs" in the previous verse. See how you translated that similar sentence there. Alternate translation: [Take care of the people who believe in me like a shepherd takes care of lambs]

See: Metaphor

John 21:16 (#2)

δεύτερον

"a second {time"

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [time number 2.]

See: Ordinal Numbers

John 21:17 (#4)

εἶπεν αὐτῷ τὸ τρίτον, φιλεῖς με

"he said to him the third {time}, "Do you love me"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [he asked him the third time if he loved him]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

John 21:17 (#1)

λέγει & λέγει & λέγει

“He says & he says & says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:17 (#5)

βόσκε τὰ προβάτια μου

“Feed my sheep”

This sentence has the same meaning as “Feed my lambs” in verse 15 and “Take care of my sheep” in the previous verse. See how you translated those similar sentences in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [Take care of the people who believe in me like a shepherd feeds sheep]

See: Metaphor

John 21:17 (#2)

τὸ τρίτον

“the third {time”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use cardinal numbers here. Alternate translation: [time number 3 ... time number 3.]

See: Ordinal Numbers

John 21:17 (#3)

φιλεῖς με & φιλεῖς με & φιλῶ σε

“do you love me & Do you love me & I love you”

The three occurrences of **love** in this verse are all the same word in the original language. However, this word is different from the word Jesus used for **love** in the previous two verses when he asked Peter, “Do you love me?” You should use the same word for **love** in this verse that you used for Peter’s responses in the previous two verses when he said, “You know that I love you.” See the discussion of this concept in the introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [do you love me with affection ... Do you love me with affection ... I love you with affection] or [do you love me like a friend ... Do you love me like a friend ... I love you like a friend]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:18 (#3)

ἐκτενεῖς τὰς χεῖράς σου

“you will stretch out your hands”

Here, **stretch out** means to extend one’s hands away from one’s sides. This describes the posture of someone who is being crucified. It does not mean that the **hands** themselves stretch. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you will extend your hands out from your sides]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:18 (#1)

ἀμὴν, ἀμὴν, λέγω σοι

“Truly, truly, I say to you”

Jesus uses this phrase to emphasize the truth of the statement that follows. See how you translated this phrase in 1:51.

See: Doublet

John 21:18 (#2)

ἐζώννυες σεαυτὸν & ζώσει σε

“you used to gird yourself & will gird you”

Although **gird** means to put on a belt, Jesus uses it in this verse to refer to putting on clothes. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you used to dress yourself ... will dress you]

See: Metonymy

John 21:19 (#2)

λέγει

“he says”

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:19 (#3)

ἀκολούθει μοι

“Follow me”

See how you translated the phrase **Follow me** in 1:43.

See: Idiom

John 21:19 (#1)

τοῦτο δὲ εἶπεν σημαίνων ποίῳ θανάτῳ δοξάσει τὸν Θεόν

"Now he said this, indicating with what manner of death he will glorify God"

Now here indicates that in this sentence John is giving background information in order to explain what Jesus said in the previous verse. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information.

See: Background Information

John 21:20 (#5)

Κύριε, τίς ἐστιν, ὁ παραδιδούς σε

"Lord, who is the one betraying you"

See how you translated the similar sentence in 13:25.

John 21:20 (#2)

τὸν μαθητὴν ὃν ἠγάπα ὁ Ἰησοῦς

"the disciple whom Jesus loved"

This phrase refers to the apostle John, who wrote this Gospel. See the discussion of this phrase in Part 1 of the Introduction to John and the introduction for this chapter. See also how you translated similar phrases in 13:23, 18:15, 20:2, and 21:7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:20 (#1)

βλέπει

"sees"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:20 (#4)

ἐν τῷ δείπνῳ

"at the dinner"

John here refers to **the dinner** Jesus had with his disciples on the night before he was crucified. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the last dinner they had together before Jesus died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:20 (#3)

ἀκολουθοῦντα

"following them"

If your language marks the dual form, then the pronoun **them** here would be in the dual form.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 21:21 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:21 (#2)

Κύριε, οὗτος δὲ τί

"But Lord, what about this one"

Peter implies that he wants to know what will happen to John in the future. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Lord, what will happen to this one?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:22 (#2)

ἐὰν αὐτὸν θέλω μένειν

"If I want him to remain"

Here, **him** refers to John, the "disciple whom Jesus loved" in John 21:20.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 21:22 (#5)

μοι ἀκολούθει

"follow me"

See how you translated this sentence in 1:43.

See: Idiom

John 21:22 (#1)

λέγει

"says"

Here John uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story.

See: Predictive Past

John 21:22 (#4)

τί πρὸς σέ

“what {is that} to you”

Jesus is using a rhetorical question here to mildly rebuke Peter. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [that has nothing to do with you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

John 21:22 (#3)

ἔρχομαι

“I come”

Jesus uses **come** here to refer to the time in the future when he will return to earth from heaven. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I come back to this world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:23 (#5)

οὐκ ἀποθνήσκει & ὅτι οὐκ ἀποθνήσκει

“does not die & that he does not die”

John is using the present tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. If this might confuse your readers, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [will not die ... that he will not die]

See: Predictive Past

John 21:23 (#4)

ὁ μαθητὴς ἐκεῖνος

“that disciple”

Here, **that disciple** refers to the apostle John. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:23 (#7)

ὅτι οὐκ ἀποθνήσκει & αὐτὸν

“that he does not die & him”

The pronouns **he** and **him** here refer to John. If this might confuse your readers, you could state that explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 21:23 (#3)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

“the brothers”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, John is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [the fellow believers]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

John 21:23 (#6)

αὐτῷ

“to him”

The pronoun **him** here refers to Peter. If this might confuse your readers, you could state that explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

John 21:23 (#8)

ἐὰν αὐτὸν θέλω μένειν ἕως ἔρχομαι, τί πρὸς σέ

“If I want him to remain until I come, what {is that} to you”

See how you translated this sentence in the previous verse.

John 21:23 (#1)

οὗτος ὁ λόγος

“this word”

Here, **this word** refers to what **the brothers** say about John’s future in the next clause. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the following report about John’s future]

See: Metonymy

John 21:23 (#2)

ἐξῆλθεν & οὗτος ὁ λόγος

“this word spread”

John uses **spread** to refer to **this word** being repeated among the believers. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this word was repeated]

See: Metaphor

John 21:24 (#3)

οἴδαμεν

“we know”

The pronoun **we** is exclusive. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

John 21:24 (#4)

οἴδαμεν

“we know”

Here, **we** could refer to: (1) John and the other eyewitnesses to the earthly life of Jesus, as in 1:14 and 1 John 1:2–7. Alternate translation: [We eyewitnesses of Jesus’ life know]; (2) the elders in the church at Ephesus where John lived at the end of his life. Alternate translation: [We elders of the church at Ephesus know] However, since who **we** refers to is uncertain, it would be best not to explain the meaning further.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

John 21:24 (#1)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ μαθητὴς ὁ μαρτυρῶν περὶ τούτων, καὶ ὁ γράψας ταῦτα, καὶ οἴδαμεν ὅτι ἀληθὴς αὐτοῦ ἡ μαρτυρία ἐστίν

“This is the disciple testifying about these things and the one having written these things, and we know that his testimony is true”

In this verse John is speaking about himself in the third person. If this is confusing in your language, you can use the first person. Alternate translation: [I am the disciple who testifies about these things and who wrote these things, and we know that my testimony is true]

See: First, Second or Third Person

John 21:24 (#2)

τούτων & ταῦτα

“these things & these things”

In this verse, **these things** refers to everything that John has written in this Gospel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [everything in this book … all these things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

John 21:24–25 (#1)

In 21:24–25 John indicates the end of his Gospel by giving a closing comment about himself and what he has written in this book. Use the natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion of a story.

See: End of Story

John 21:25 (#2)

οὐδ’ αὐτὸν & τὸν κόσμον χωρήσειν τὰ γραφόμενα βιβλία

“not even the world itself to have enough room for the books being written”

John exaggerates to emphasize that Jesus did very many good things. If this would confuse your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language to show this emphasis. Alternate translation: [a very large amount of books about these miracles would be written]

See: Hyperbole

John 21:25 (#1)

ἐὰν γράφηται καθ’ ἕν

“if each one were written down”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [if someone wrote down each one]

See: Active or Passive

John 21:25 (#3)

τὸν κόσμον

“the world”

Here, **the world** refers to either the surface of the earth or the universe. Either meaning would achieve John’s purpose. If your language does not have a general expression for **world**, you could use an alternate expression. Alternate translation: [the whole earth] or [the whole universe]

See: Metonymy

John 21:25 (#4)

τὰ γραφόμενα βιβλία

“the books being written”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the books that someone would write]

See: Active or Passive